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Evola's *Tools of the Occult War*

I.I Tactics of the Occult War

Be wise as Lucifer and as innocent as the Holy Spirit.

The tactics of the **Occult War** describe the third dimension of history, that of depth, beyond the dimensions of space and time by which we conventionally view things. Yet, those who can only understand in terms of facts, material causes, and visible leaders still think at the level of brutes. Even worse, many men, wishing to be seen as intelligent, deliberately cultivate this view, thereby blinding themselves to any deeper understanding.

Let no one be deceived into believing that this is a simple matter. Even among those who desire to, or claim to, follow Tradition, there are many who fall victim to the tactics of the occult war, including some whom I have known personally for some time and would have expected a bit more insight.

This War, at its most fundamental layer, as the battle between the forces of Order and the forces of Chaos. This necessarily assumes, with-

out question or dispute, that there is a Cosmic Order, which we have been calling **Logos** and obviously a force behind that Logos, which we have called **Providence**, in accordance with Guenon and other Traditional and Hermetic authors. Hence, two requirements are imperative for anyone who wishes to consciously engage in this War.

1. He must understand the Cosmic Order
2. He must align his Will with the forces of that Order

The dimension of depth is the province of the Spirit, apart from and beyond any physical or material considerations. Obviously, then, to begin such an engagement, the spiritual warrior must first of all wage that battle in his own consciousness. Specifically, he must understand his own inner constitution, above all, the various layers of his soul life. He must strive to bring them into harmony with the Cosmic Order by subduing the lower layers to the higher. He must learn to harness the erotic and thumotic impulses that, left to themselves, lead to a process of inner integration.

To understand Gornahoor, readers must keep this foremost in mind. On the one hand, we have striven to describe the Cosmic Order in many different ways, apart from any a priori ideological commitment or allegiance to any particular movement or institution. We also hope to inspire others to take up arms in this battle in the way they see fit. In addition, one must also understand the forces of Chaos. Those forces employs several tactics, which we summarize below. We have already written about some of them in detail, others we shall take up as the need arises.

Scientific Suggestion This tactic involves the suggestion that science and the commitment to the world of facticity is the only way to understand the world. For example, we have described Francis Bacon's jettisoning of the knowledge of formal and final causes¹ as the basis for science,

¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3468>

to the point where an educated man no longer knows what they are and think it fantastic when they are explained to him.

Replacement When men are no longer satisfied with science, they may turn to abstruse philosophical or ideological explanations. Such philosophical systems are so complex and subtle that their adherents spend several years, usually in their youth, to fully grasp them. This commitment and one-pointedness prevent them from reaching the dimension of depth. We see this today, unfortunately, even among those who aspire to Tradition, but commit to philosophic ideas, often of French origin, a strange counterweight to Guenon.

Counterfeits When the effects of Chaos are too obvious to ignore, some may turn to Tradition, but more often a counterfeit of Tradition. For example, we see today those who commit to a form of neopaganism that never existed as a Tradition anywhere, any time. These counterfeits take up the visual symbols and residues of earlier Traditions, but lack the understanding of their spiritual foundations.

Inversion This tactic begins by attacking spiritual intuition and gnosis, replacing them by psychological considerations. The logic and rationality of metaphysics is abandoned in favour of irrational and subconscious forces. Hence, there is the rise of all sorts of neospiritualities, extolled even in some New Right circles, that reject the actual Traditions, which they consider too rigid and limiting. Just today, some woman tried to convince me that masturbation is the key to discovering God. It is certainly a democratic and egalitarian notion, although you would think that enlightenment would be universal by now.

Ricochet This occurs when the representatives of one Tradition oppose themselves to other Traditions. Gornahoor has taken pains to point

out how Traditions agree at the level of depths and has not opposed any real Traditions. Yet there are many who attack the dominant and most recent Tradition of the West, whether out of ignorance or malice, for a fleeting political advantage. In the attempt to attract committed adherents, they end up on the same side as their enemies. For example, neopagan groups use the tactics of their declared enemies to discredit the Medieval Tradition, thereby undermining Tradition itself. The Ricochet is the best way to destroy every unity and solidarity.

Dilution The forces of subversion replace an idea that seems too radical at a given time, with a more diluted version that seems more acceptable.

Misidentification of Principle with its Representatives This has been a very effective tactic of the forces of subversion, since the mass of men are nominalists, meaning they cannot even understand principles but only individual things. Thus if some leader or member or adherent of a Tradition has betrayed his principles, men come to reject the principles themselves. This is all too common, even those I know personally who claim to be “Traditionalists”.

Replacing Infiltrations Unfortunately, organizations and societies whose original impetus was to preserve and promote some aspect of Tradition degrade over time. The leaders, as well as members, of such groups become ignorant of their founding spirits, and instead grow accustomed to the material benefits and unearned prestige that accrue to such leadership. Such organizations are easily discredited along with the principles they had been created to uphold.

Simplification Instead of making the effort to grasp complex forces and multifarious phenomena, men are too easily attracted to overly sim-

plistic explanations. For example, the modern ideals of liberalism, socialism, scientism, and rationalism are the outcome of several historical antecedents among which are the Renaissance, the Reformation, French Revolution, Marxism.

Clearly, that is replacing a spiritual cause with a material one. Then there are those who are part of such subversive movements, yet beyond all logic, still expect a different result. Some see a superficial commitment to certain issues, and then assume they are natural allies. However, at the level of depth, nothing could be further from the truth. The most egregious example that bypasses 1500 years of Western history in a one sentence slogan, attribute all the modern deviations listed above to an alleged secularization of the Medieval Tradition. Yes, I have heard that from educated men, as I'm sure many readers have.

Based on writings of different authors.

Posted on 2012-01-25 by Cologero

1.2 The Tools of the Occult War

In this article from the January 1938 issue of *La Vita Italiana*, Julius Evola describes his understanding of the occult war and its tactics. This should clear up two widely spread misconceptions.

- The first misconception is that the occult war has something to do with so-called occult or magical practices. To the contrary, it is not a question of men employing higher, or transhuman, forces to achieve their aim, but rather of those forces using men, with or against their will, whether they are conscious of it or not, to achieve aims apart from the desires of men.
- The second misconception is that Evola is an adherent of conspiracy theories. Conspiracy theories restrict themselves

to a two dimensional understanding of history, where some small group of men control events for their own ends. Evola is referring to something much deeper.

The rest of the article speaks for itself and it is surprising how, today, such a view is barely comprehensible. This is despite the work of **Wilhelm Wundt**, who made a similar point from a purely secular point of view. Yet the rapidity of the way public opinion can be swayed ought to give one pause.

Whatever Evola says about the occult war can only be understood by keeping in mind Guenon's writings of the anti-tradition, counter-tradition, and related topics. It may be surprising to some that Evola mentioned the Catholics as holding a similar understanding to his. That is understandable to those who only know the Vatican II church. But older writings do indeed describe an occult or spiritual war; the older Church and Evola even agree on the specific historical organizations or agents of the anti-tradition. We will, at some future date, reproduce some of those writings.

Part I The occult war is when the forces of worldwide subversion lead from behind the scenes, adopting means that almost always elude ordinary methods of investigation. The notion of an occult war belongs to a tridimensional vision of history, to a history considered not according to the two dimensional surface of apparent causes, events, and leaders, but rather one depending on the third dimension of depth, the hidden dimension, which retrieves the decisive forces and influences which are often not even ascribable to the simple human element, whether individual or collective.

Having used the adjective "hidden", it is necessary to make its importance precise, indicating that it is not a question of an obscure and irrational substrate of scientific history, of something that could stand in the known part of it, but in the same relationship by which the subconscious stands to the consciousness of waking in the individual. This

analogy is certainly exact, if considered from the point of view of those who, in this tridimensional view of events, appear not as the *subjects*, but rather of the *objects* of history: in their acting and thinking, they do not take into account the true influences which they obey and the true ends that are accomplished through them. They have their true centre more in the subconscious and unconscious than in their waking consciousness, yet, in this respect, we can certainly say that it is in the subconscious that the most decisive movements of the occult war develop.

But from the point of view of the true *subjects* of history, things are quite different, and we can speak, in this regard, not of the subconscious or the unconscious, but we must think of super-intelligent forces, forces that know perfectly what they want and the most appropriate means to realize what they want. To suppose that this substrate of history is accounted for by the “irrational”, by “life”, by “becoming”, or by whatever else of those confused entities invented by modern historicism at the moment in which they thought they went beyond so-called scientific historiography, is among the most dangerous errors. We believe, on the contrary, that we see in that one of the suggestions prudently spread in certain circles typical of the aims of certain movements of the occult war in modern times.

We will explain ourselves more clearly in what follows. For now, it is enough to establish this point: we must not allow the third dimension of history to vanish in the fog of abstract and philosophical views, but we must consider it inhabited and occupied by quite precise “intelligences”, whose expression and closest mouthpieces were almost always certain secret societies or organizations, but which must not at all totally express the intelligences, but just having their beginning and end in them.

Examining the various conceptions of history widespread in the West, perhaps it is the Catholic conception, out of all of them, that can claim views of the same type. It is typical of such conceptions, in fact, to see history not as a mechanism of natural, political, economic, or social causes,

but as the unfolding of a type of plan (the “providential” plan) opposed by adverse forces and their historical emissaries, forces that assume either the moralistic designations of the “forces of evil” or the religious one of anti-Christian forces or forces of the Antichrist. One such conception can already furnish a foundation when it is transposed from the teleological plan to a practical plan and if it makes its general principle through an interpretation deepened by events. In the second place, when it is generalized, establishing its susceptibility to still be of value in non-Christian civilizations, for which it will be well, in this regard and with reference to human institutions, to speak generically of forces of tradition and forces of the anti-Tradition, the forces of the spiritual hierarchy and revolutionary subversion, the forces of the cosmos and of chaos. In this particular case, the anti-Traditional forces will also appear naturally as anti-Catholic forces, insofar as, in the Catholic tradition, they are intended to combat the Traditional spirit in general, to destroy the basis of every hierarchy and to ruin their historical representatives.

In our time, we will never be able to insist enough on the necessity of penetrating a view of the type that must not be considered as one among the many possible “speculations” of philosophy, but rather as an indispensable organ for true action. We are pleased to reproduce here a passage of the famous Protocols, to which we had previously called attention.

The purely brute mind of the gentiles is incapable of use for analysis and observation, and still more for the foreseeing whither a certain manner of setting a question may tend. In this difference in capacity for thought between the gentiles and ourselves may be clearly discerned the seal of our position as the Chosen People and of our higher quality of humanness, in contradistinction to the brute mind of the gentiles. Their eyes are open, but see nothing before them and do not invent (except perhaps, material things).

It is a truthfully alarming thing to think in how many cases such a judgment about the gentiles—who would be, this this special reference which makes Israel the principle agent of worldwide subversion, the non-Hebrews, but who can also be considered, in general, as those who we already called the “objects of history”—has still today a profound content of truth. The point of view of the greater part of the so-called “men of action”, compared to those of the hidden adversaries, can certainly be said to be babies: they concentrate all of the strength on what is directly graspable with the hands, and are incapable of establishing the relationships of cause and effect beyond the range of an extremely limited zone and of a nature almost always grossly material. Moreover, there is a fundamental lack of principles, since they almost always believe that the point of view of action cannot be “dogmatically” subordinated to principles, but must be related to the “unavoidable necessities of the moment”.

Unfortunately, this is still the level typical of most counter-revolutionary forces. It is a situation that can be compared to that of someone who finds himself perfectly equipped for the high mountain, with boots, sack, cord, and pick and then finds himself, after happily passing many tests, facing an expanse of water, at a lake or a sea, throws himself into it enthusiastically, believing that his equipment will still help him and lead him forward. Instead, it will only be of use to make him sink more rapidly to the bottom.

The occult war is exercised on that which, with an image drawn from positive science, we will call the “imponderables”, or imponderable quantities. It is adopted fairly often to produce nearly insensible changes, from which sizable effects will proceed slowly but fatally. It almost never acts with forces opposed to other forces, but rather through an opportune direction of it, so as to lead to the desired effects. What Wundt called the heterogony of ends², plays a fundamental part in it: it is precisely about acting, while some forces or men believe they are willing and producing a

²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Heterogony_of_ends

given effect, and it alone, in actuality, they will produce or prepare something else quite different from it, thus uncovering an influence and an intelligence that transcends them. It is for this reason that, on another occasion in *La Vita Italiana*, we said that the examination of the “differential” existing between the will and the event, between the principles or programs and the true consequences of it in history, offers the most valuable material for whoever truly wants to account for the true forces which history itself has obeyed.

But in this article we want to move beyond the general, and speak of a few of the most frequently used means, in our time, of the hidden powers of worldwide subversion to cover their action, to prevent that of their adversaries, and to continue to exercise their influence.

It is incumbent to point out that the idea here was often given by observations scattered in the various works of **Rene Guenon**. Guenon, in our opinion, has a nearly unique competence in all contemporary Western literature for similar types of problems.

Part II

These are the first four of the eight tools of the occult war identified by **Julius Evola**. For readers unfamiliar with the philosophical currents of Evola's time, “positive” is usually called “scientific” today, at least in English. He also criticizes the philosophies of life (e.g., certain Germans, perhaps even Nietzsche as “life-affirming”), becoming (Bergson, Whitehead), and absolute spirit (Hegel, Gentile).

As other manifestations of subversive forces, he goes on to mention a dilettantish “traditionalism” (which is rampant today) and even zoological racism (the “hipster racism” or “race realism” of today). Then there are all the New Age movements, which have only multiplied in the past 75 years. They hide the true Tradition and can be identified by their preoccupation with strange and unusual phenomena, rather than true spirituality; Evola calls

them demonic. We can add a certain fascination with the dark and the ugly, that some today want to identify with Tradition.

This is one topic that I hope will lead to many comments, discussing, identifying, and clarifying these tools of the subversive forces.

The Positivist Suggestion It is necessary to get used to thinking that the so-called “positive” mode of doing history and of considering events is somewhat less a spontaneous product and prejudice typical of a very limited mentality, than a *suggestion* spread methodically in modern culture by anti-traditional forces, with the purpose of “covering” their action. Whoever believes that history is simply made by men and determined exclusively by economic, political, and social factors sees nothing else. And it is exactly such a world that “sees nothing else” that is needed by whoever wants to act clandestinely. A civilization dominated by the “positivistic” prejudice offers the ideal condition for an action developing along the “third dimension”: and this is exactly the case of the current civilization.

Previously, we mentioned besides “positivistic” interpretations, those having as their basis abstract ideas of becoming”, of “life”, or even of the “Spirit”. In that we can consider a case of the application of a second tool of the occult war, which is:

The Tactic of the Surrogates It is followed, every time that the danger of an “awakening” is manifested and the energies seek to turn beyond the plan dominated by ideas, in the operation of which the occult game of the forces of subversion can easily take place. In the case now mentioned, these confused ideas of “becoming”, “life”, “absolute Spirit”, etc., in fact, are only a decoy thrown at those no longer satisfied with positivistic patterns, and those whose gaze does not bring itself where it should. From the fog of such ideas, the field of action remains so well covered, as by the dark night of “positivistic” agnosticism.

The “tactic of the surrogates” develops, however, in a much more characteristic and effective way under the form of:

Tactic of Falsifying Substitution This is what we are talking about. When the effects of destructive action, appearing even on the material plane and giving rise to clearly visible phenomena, exhibit a degree hot enough to provoke a reaction, this reaction confusedly seeks symbols and myths to serve as the base for an engine of reconstruction, and can also find it legitimate and consistent with its goal. It is almost always about symbols and points of reference that, in their historical aspect, remaining in the traditional past, recalled from atavistic depths through the forces of an organism that feels itself threatened by final destruction. In these cases, the occult war does not take place with a direct action, i.e., not by opposing such symbols, but ensures that they do not circulate and are not worth falsifying or counterfeiting, inasmuch as the reaction either remains limited, or diverted, or even overturned in an opposite direction, on which they naturally move on to apply the same influences present in the evil against which they wanted to act and in the decadence, from which they wanted to rise up from and believed in good faith to be rising up from.

This tactic can develop in diverse domains, in the political as well as in the spiritual camp, and seems today to have a totally special efficiency. It is worth looking at an example.

The most typical is constituted by “traditionalism”. The vague aspiration of a return to tradition, i.e., to a hierarchical and qualitative order centered in a transcendent spirituality and in an elite of its qualified and legitimate representatives, is diverted to in the form of “traditionalism”, i.e., of vague assumptions of a dilettantish, or militant, character that confuses Tradition with custom and the routine, that leads into a narrow-minded particularism, that stops at given, handed-down forms, and knows nothing of their spirit. In such a way, they present an easy

game to their adversaries and provide a good decoy to those who, through the false goal of anti-traditionalism, bring their true blow against tradition and foment new developments of revolutionary subversion. So the reaction remains contained and the maneuver leads successfully to prearranged goals. What, in certain extremist circles, the idea of race threatens to become because of some assumptions in terms of zoological materialism, as so even the Nordic-Aryan idea and even the pagan idea, come back to a conjuncture of the type. It is about ideas that, if they were understood and represented in accordance with their true nature and their ancient spiritual and traditional content, could certainly carry out a creative and healing action within the limits of some peoples of the North. As they appear instead in the circles already indicated, first of all because of a lack of principles, then because of a profound incomprehension and deformation of the ancient “Aryan” world, and finally through the tyranny of immediate interests and irrational impulses, make us suspect the effect of a distorting action of the type indicated. In relation to the new Italy, one should make every effort that something of the type does not occur in certain re-evocations of Romanity. The idea of ancient Rome certainly exists among those who today could have the greatest reconstructive efficacy: it is necessary to see that this efficacy is not paralyzed by means of the reconstituted facsimiles or by mere rhetorical resurrections, or by academic, erudite, archeological and even simply juridical, political assumptions, to which naturally elude completely the central strength and soul of the Roman symbol.

Tactic of Reversal The secret forces of worldwide subversion knew perfectly that the fundamental premise of order to be destroyed was the supernatural element, spirit conceived not as a philosophical abstraction, but rather as a higher reality and as the means of a process of transcendent integration of the personality. The limited influence that, in such a regard, the Catholic tradition could still have (here we cannot stop to

analyze the means to come to that conclusion), the subversive forces had to try in every way to ensure that every new contemporary aspiration toward the supernatural, developing outside of the dominant religion, became distorted and paralyzed. The whole of what can be called neo-spiritualism, with allusion to the various theosophical, spiritist, Orientalizing, and “occultistic” sects can be considered the effect of one such maneuver. In all that, again, it is a question almost exclusively of deformation, counterfeits, and distortions of spiritual doctrine, due to the least qualified persons, who in this respect, seem often to be subjected to a truly demonic influence.

The consequent outcome is twofold. First of all, it provided an easy way of extending the general discredit into which those counterfeits had to fall, to the doctrines in themselves, with which they were practically put in condition of no longer damaging. We can mention that, in recent times, the maneuver has even employed political factors: and there are some circles that, in good faith, are able to see only “Masonry” (something that was made the synonym of revolutionary, anti-Christianity or international subversion) wherever one speaks of secret associations of esoteric symbols, even when such references lead back to ancient traditions, whose original spirit and aristocratic nature everyone should note.

In the second place, because of poorly understood theories and false practices, they are joined to channel all the forces that, constricted by the suffocating stranglehold of materialism and yearning for something extra-natural, not toward the supernatural, but rather toward the subnatural, i.e., the subconscious, mediumship, and, in general, toward a world that, far from representing an integration of the personality, can only propitiate its collapse and disintegration, as much by making of it the tool of some of the darkest “influences”. So with neo-spiritualism the danger constituted by true spirituality was contained and reduced to an almost inessential minimum.

Part III

Tools 5 and 6 of the Occult War. In the Ricochet, Evola warns against causing divisions for particularistic reasons, particularly against another Tradition. Unfortunately, this is not uncommon today. He warns against scapegoating a group or organization for all problems. The focus must always remain on the plan of the subversive powers; focusing on the alleged agents will distract from the fundamental task.

Tactic of the Ricochet Attack It consists in provoking one of the forces to be torn down because of their still traditional character to undertake an action, that initially was aimed against a similar force and apparently of value to strengthen and increase the first force, but that then ricochets against it, dragging it down into the same ruins that it had propitiated against the other. By means of timely infiltrations, the secret forces of worldwide subversion often incite the representatives of a tradition to defend it through the discrediting another: whoever is subject to such a maneuver does not notice that to attack the tradition in the person of another people or civilization, for particularistic reason or contingent and inferior interests, means to be condemned to see itself attacked, sooner or later, in their own home, through a ricochet motion. The forces of worldwide subversion very much count on this tactic, and therefore make every effort to put every higher idea under the subjection of particularistic interests, pride, ambitions, and proletarian tendencies. They know that this is the best means to destroy every unity and true solidarity and to propitiate a state of division, in which their game will be extremely easy.

In this case, one can also allow every Machiavellian utilization of revolutionary forces back in. Some statesmen of scant discernment believed that propitiating or helping the revolution in the nations unfavorable to them was the best means to sustain and defend their true interests. Without realizing it, they prepared the exact opposite result, while they

believed they served the revolution like an instrument, they themselves became tools of the revolution, which had to reach them after having passed over the body of their adversaries. We can say that the entire history of modern times, above all starting from the French Revolution, was the theatre of a subversion that tragically worked in such a way. We can never insist enough, in such regard, on the fact that only the absolute, ascetic, unfaltering adherence to an idea can serve to safeguard against the forces of the occult war. Wherever this standard is abandoned and follows contingent factors, the front of the resistance is broken and, with it, the possibility of a true autonomy.

We do not want to fail to mention a final appearance of an similar maneuver: the ideology characteristic of the “principle of nationality”, the “self-determinism of the people”, and imperialism, proclaimed by the Allies to mobilize every force against the Central Powers and then to beat them World War I, is exactly the best among the ideologies adapted to propitiate a general revolt of the nations of color against the great European powers and to overturn every supremacy from them.

Tactic of the Scapegoat When the hidden forces of worldwide subversion avoid the danger of being unmasked in some of their aspects, they see to it that all the attention of their adversaries is directed and concentrated on some elements, that only in part, or only subordinately, can be considered as responsible for their evildoing. All the reaction is then unloaded on such elements, becoming the true scapegoats. And the hidden forces remain free to pursue their game, their adversaries believing they have at this point identified the enemy and do not have to look for others. We repeatedly admonish certain anti-Semitic extremists to remain well attentive, so that, in their seeing the Jew everywhere, they do not end up by making themselves victims of a trap of that type. The same admonition could be applied equally to those who instead see everywhere Masonry or Protestantism, and so on, analogous processes being also verified in many

other areas. It is necessary to guard against every unilateralism, never forgetting the complex plan of the occult forces which we must combat.

Part IV

The final segment of **Julius Evola**'s essay. The final tactic, the **Tactic of the Substitution of Principle to the Person**, is very important, as it describes the creation of the modern world from the Medieval period. As a corollary, it defines what can be meant by the **Right** in the relative sense: it is whatever resists the dissolution of a stage, and the **authentic Right**, in its only true meaning, is whatever works toward the stage prior to the successive degeneration of the castes.

Evola concludes with the necessity of recognizing and indicating the tools used in the occult war. Only then can a man be called a *counter-revolutionary*.

Tactic of Dilution This is a particular case of the “tactic of substitution”. To understand it, it is necessary to start from the idea, that the process that led us up to our current general crisis, had distant origins and various phases and that in each one of such phases—corresponding to specific forms of Civilization, State, ethics, etc.—the crisis was already present even in a less acute, more dilute, potential form rather than actual. The theory of “progress”, or evolutionism, can be considered as another of the suggestions hurled by the subversive hidden forces into the general environment, in order to distract anyone from looking from the perspective of the origins and always pushing well beyond the process of falling, under the thrust of false mirages, and, above all, of that of the conquests of the technical-mechanical civilization. However, the hard experience of tragic events in recent times saw to it that such a hypnosis was no longer able to conserve its efficacy and was no longer able to prevent many spirits from recognizing that the presumed course toward progress was a course

toward the abyss and that a going back was imposed. The hidden front then put into notion every means to prevent any radicalism. One of the preferred methods was, above all, putting a prejudice against “anachronism” into circulation, against “that which is no longer adapted for the times”, and then directing the forces that returned to look toward the origins, toward one or the other of those preceding phases, in which the crisis and evil were found in forms less advanced and, for that very reason, less visible. And even this trap had success. The leaders of worldwide subversion know naturally that, having come to that point, the danger is eliminated, because the whole was reduced to soon retrace the same path and to push, at the end of it, to dissolution even these forces that were awakened and that wanted to react and pull back.

We could also indicate many historical examples of this tactic, both recently and further in the past. Above all, the political Leaders of current anti-subversive movements should not lose it from view. Let us say in all frankness—since in such a field a lack of frankness is certainly equivalent to a fault—there are aspects of contemporary nationalism that would merit being tested thoroughly. Anyone can note, in fact, the anti-traditional, anti-hierarchical, revolutionary character that, in the past, compared to the preceding ecumene of imperial and feudal civilization, had the notion of nation. Now, it is the nation that today predominantly challenges to combat the extreme forms of the crisis and subversion, represented by various red internationals communist parties. There is therefore the necessity to formulate a concept of the nation different from that which makes of it a stage of the path that had to lead to what today we must combat. Several years ago we provided the necessary points of reference to confront and resolve this problem, and to distinguish two nationalisms *La Vita Italiana*, Mar, 1931. We must return to our essay.

Tactic of the Substitution of Principle to the Person It is undeniable that, in many respects, the decadence of traditional institutions

occurs through the decadence of their leaders and representatives. But this is not the only cause: in order to come to a true dissolution and involution, it is necessary that the tactic of the substitution of principle to the person be added to it, a new tool of the occult war, which works in the following way. When the representative of a given principle appears unworthy, a process against the principle in itself is set in motion in the person of this representative, or the process is extended from the person to the principle. They do not come to the conclusion that that representative does not measure up to the principle and must therefore be substituted with another person who can really represent it, but instead they go on to say that the principle itself is false or harmful and must be substituted with another principle.

In how many cases does the attack against this or that degenerate, vain, or vicious aristocrat get translated into the attack against the very aristocratic principle in itself and into a tool of demagogy? And perhaps the subversive and heretical action of Luther, having as his excuse the corruption of the representative of the Roman Church, had a different meaning? Again, history is rich with episodes of the type, equivalent to many other moments of the worldwide subversion. Let us remember that the ancient hierarchical system was constituted by a spiritual authority, under which stood the warrior aristocracy, then a bourgeois caste and then the working masses. The fall of this traditional system, in many of its aspects, had as its instrument the tactic here indicated. The warrior aristocracy rose up against the decadent representatives of the pure spiritual authority, not through substituting them with another, more worthy representatives of the same principle, but by drawing from that the pretense to be emancipated or lay claim for itself the supreme authority. In a following phase, i.e., in a following civilization, the Third Estate rises up against the degenerate warrior aristocracy not because it ceded the place to the true aristocrats, but to seize power for itself. In yet another phase, the process against capitalism and the bourgeoisie (i.e.,

against the Third Estate) in its destructive and negative aspects does not aim for a corresponding reform, but is only the excuse for the revolt of the proletariat and the usurpation of power—descending progressively from step to step—straight through to the party of the proletariat (bolshevism, communism).

Conclusion The fact that, for reasons of space, we only indicated some examples and we were concerned above all with the exposition of the principles, not to prevent—we hope—seeing what vast fields of application these principles can have and to that valuable results it could reach those who, adequately equipped, can apply them methodically in any field. Since one can assert without uncertainty that there is not a single area in which the occult battle of the forces of worldwide subversion are not in any developed way; and indeed these areas that would seem more unrelated to events of the type are those that, by principle, should be considered with the greatest wariness.

We repeat one more time that it is not a question of “philosophical positions”, but of things much more real and that there is no leader or combatant at the front of the counter-subversion and the tradition that can be called mature and at the peak of its true tasks, before having developed in itself the faculty of seeing clearly in this subterranean world of cause and of indicating quickly the action of this or that invisible tool which our enemy does not cease to adopt in every epoch that, like the current one, sounding the prelude to the moment of final decision and the final battle of all, a cycle of civilization.

Posted on 2012-05-07 by Aeneas

* * *

Lyon on 2018-05-07 at 14:54 said:

Hmmm... Does this possibly dovetail with the work of E Michael Jones, specifically in his work titled, *The Jewish Revolutionary Spirit and Its Impact on World History*? Jones, in that work, describing the comparatively small portion of the iceberg that can be seen above the surface.

I've only recently been introduced to his writings via Fidelity Press and his culturewars.com website. Admittedly, both Evola and Jones are approaching our predicament from differing vantage points.

As for Evola, the only work of his I've read in depth (... studied and ruminated) was *The Hermetic Tradition, Symbols and Teachings of the Royal Art*.

My understanding of both Jones and Evola are still in formation. Any general guidance and cautions on either is appreciated.

fractalkhaosstrikesonceagain on 2018-05-09 at 17:48 said:

As usual with your Blog GornaHoor: Thanks a lot Cologero for OPENING OUR EYES : You help us to face our real(s) foe(s) ...

jalexandermaximilian on 2020-08-18 at 21:08 said:

I've been thinking lately, about the past decade or so, of these occult forces, which use men, men who appear as powerful but are really just pawns of these forces. It seems now more than ever "leaders" are not in control of their own thoughts and actions It seems the world of men is being propelled toward some finale. Can it continue in this manner without a finale, or will it continue unto a whimper? This sort of understanding is why now I eschew all U.S. polytricks, the men you see are not in control of anything... even themselves. They may think they are. But their works and goals are all for another Thing. I seek God. Then wonder if I am my own Master? From where does even thought arise?

Lyon: Jews would merely be another group of pawns serving another more powerful force, they are certainly hardheaded and organized, but that seems to me to be a case of an external mind using them to its own goal with great success.

veritycacciatrix on 2022-01-09 at 05:34 said:

"For now, it is enough to establish this point: we must not allow the third dimension of history to vanish in the fog of abstract and philosophical views, but we must consider it inhabited and occupied by quite precise "intelligences", whose expression and closest mouthpieces were almost always certain secret societies or organizations, but which must not at all totally express the intelligences, but just having their beginning and end in them."

I witnessed this first hand less than a fortnight ago.

My son was doing some study on Garibaldi in Italian and he suggested I watch a video he'd seen on it (more for the comedy styling than the content).

I was following along and was surprised to see the most bloody battle location in the second War of Independence chosen due to its name.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 07:53 said:

Yes, subversion – ‘black magic’ works by subverting and perverting the true spiritual forces, in no small part through ‘bad practice’. Depending on the individual and their potential and actual power, this can indeed be disastrous. The abomination of the desolation, the breaching of the Holy of Holies. the rend must be fixed. The ancient forces tend to react badly – out of character, out of bed the ‘wrong way’ – when needlessly awoken (mediumship), roused for the wrong reasons. And yes, it is all too easy to be deceived outside the known framework, the ‘safe zone’, amounting to entering a labyrinth without the guiding thread which one follows in order to return. The severance of the silver cord is no laughing matter, one requires rescue!

logres on 2012-05-09 at 09:23 said:

Evola is unusually clear and prescient, and not so wordy, in these passages. Many thanks! I am interested in his idea that the Catholic Church (at that point, and perhaps still) could be made a bulwark against certain tendencies and currents. I fear that we may have moved beyond such a point, irremediably, although certainly the question cannot be decided on an empirical basis. My instinct tells me that the Church could still be awakened, that it slumbers, and that it is a sleeping giant. Who will awaken her?

logres on 2012-05-09 at 09:52 said:

Tactic number 3, falsifying substitution. Classic example of this would be the resurgent Confederacy of the southern states in 1865 – they thought they were fighting for altar and hearth – in reality, they were being used to provoke a frightful advance of the occult power, by obscuring the goal in the midst of a provoked reaction. I suppose 1938 Germany might be an even better example. Each time this “false start” occurs, it cements the overall process.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 12:38 said:

Oddly enough I was compelled yesterday to revisit one of Rudolf Steiner's stranger books, *Secret Brotherhoods and the Mystery of the Human Double*, in particular the lectures relating to Individual Spirit Beings and the Constant Foundation of the Universe.

I know there are no big Steiner fans here (unless they're hiding!), but in the present context he is very helpful and penetrates even further into the ‘nature of the beast’, as it were. I just transcribed a large portion of this work on Alchemical Weddings:

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/the-constant-formation-of-the-universe>

One thing I've omitted is the constant talk of 'post Atlantean epochs', be they fifth, sixth or whatever, as I've never really made sense of them, perhaps I don't like the labels.

Here is the end of the extract, which I think you might enjoy:

What lies in store for humanity is that cosmic forces will be won for humanity in a dual way that is wrong or a single way that is right. This will bring a genuine renewal to astrology, which is atavistic in its old form – a form in which it cannot continue to exist. Those who know about the cosmos will struggle against each other... for the remainder of earthly existence the dead will collaborate with us to a high degree.

The moment you penetrate fully into all the secrets of the double, you will find yourself able to assess the value of brains that are merely lumps which you have placed on a scale, lumps which can be brought to life solely by the double.

You must come to realise that all the wishy-washy talk of 'cosmic religiosity' or 'how powerful the yearning for it is', and so on is nothing other than a means of spreading fog over these matters which ought actually to be entering the world in clarity and which, above all, ought only to be carried in clarity into human life as practical moral and ethical impulses.

It generally sheds light on the nature of the occult war as it is manifesting now, very helpful I thought, along with Evola's texts. When occultists manage to agree you know you're onto something!

Also coincidentally, the recent talk of 'Saturn' made me think, firstly, that he was eaten by his children so we should really focus more on IoPitar? Also I was contacted by a group related to the Philosophers of Nature, so of course the memory of 'touching saturn' was revived. Interesting synchronicities from a personal point of view that may also resonate with others here.

logres on 2012-05-09 at 14:34 said:

Steiner was tainted with evolutionary worldviews, but "knew" better. That statement of his about religious "feeling" demonstrates such. Steiner was Goethe's heir, so he shared Goethe's failings. Just as there is a danger that the individual could "fail" and collapse in the postmortem state, so there is a cosmic danger that this world could implode, in more than a physical manner. Christians can "rest" in Christ's sure sacrifice, but this may entail complications which are unnecessary, not to mention enormous suffering.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 14:54 said:

well I think it's tricky to find any occultist (human after all) who doesn't have failings, though? Evola, Guenon etc are routinely attacked for being 'fascist' or whatever – I think it's partly a hazard of the job and a consequence of the times they lived in. Even VT had, in my opinion, unfair ideas to do with shamanism, so I can't even agree with him on everything. Lots of wisdom to be learned from them all but we must always take care to show discernment and

think for ourselves... also to be heedful of the fact that we are at a different stage in history, esoteric or otherwise. Nevertheless, I do think Steiner's insight into the occult war are very illuminating in the present context, bringing a bit more spirit to the dryness of Evola, which I nonetheless found useful.

Angolmois on 2012-05-09 at 15:10 said:

Steiner may be helpful as you say Charlotte, but in reality the only reason why Evola is "dry" is because he doesn't stray into unnecessary or fantastic areas in his analysis of the occult war.

You are certainly right about thinking for ourselves. Many esotericists have a hidden need, sometimes even a vice, to rest upon the shoulders of this or that authority.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 15:27 said:

I wonder how we should see the present wars around the world in light of all this... .

logres on 2012-05-09 at 22:25 said:

Charlotte, thanks for the quote, which I read in full at your site. I agree that Steiner is useful, just trying to place him in full context. As Cologero says, we learn from and (hopefully) in some sense, go beyond (in the sense of seeing their failings more clearly).

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:36 said:

I think we have to define 'fantastic' as it's a matter of opinion depending upon experience. From a rational perspective much of what Evola says is right, and yet I personally see a lot more depth in Steiner's analysis, which speaks to personal experience more concretely. Something is only 'fantastic' if you don't believe it's possible, but there are not the usual rules and boundaries in the 'other worlds', of time and space, for one, which are pretty enormous limiting factors on the physical plane. The rules 'on the other side' are different but the playing is just as hard. I agree, however, that one must learn to read Steiner in a particular way and not take everything to heart or on board, simply to scan for what resonates.

logres on 2012-05-10 at 08:34 said:

Ricochet – Luther thinks he is re-masculinizing the Church, but actually, the destruction of intellect & tradition leads to sentimentality. A warning... to me.

Angolmois on 2012-05-11 at 03:39 said:

... but actually, the destruction of intellect & tradition leads to sentimentality."

And it leads also to protestant capitalism, bouregous liberalism, and finally to "kulturkampf" and to the destruction of monasticism in the 19th century. Quite a ricochet.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 04:40 said:

so many actions and reactions in the course of history – eventually the balance will be found

Avery on 2012-05-10 at 23:52 said:

Substituting a principle for a person is a very interesting metaphor. It's really a process of the lower ranks being instructed that their superiors do not have special right but are only employing a general principle which can be understood by anyone, which leads them to think that the principle is more important than the person. They rid themselves of what they perceive as a useless middleman, only to discover that they are lost without a dedicated superior to guide them.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 06:06 said:

'superior'... hmmm... ..people have different qualities, in the ideal scenario they will take it in turns to lead depending on what is required – just like a team of long-distance walkers will take it in turns to keep the pace. This should of course happen organically and intuitive in a utopian sense, but in reality there tend to be infights and intrigues if there is no rigid plan to follow. It also supposes the basic equality of peoples, which I do believe in principle but in practice it doesn't always show through. Often people just need a chance to shine and being trapped in a rigidly hierarchical 'management structure' doesn't necessarily allow this. Nowadays people tend to be discouraged from thinking for themselves, one of the reasons I'm sure why alcohol is so widely prevalent, cheap and encouraged, whereas cannabis, for instance – something Americans could once pay their taxes with, and which it was compulsory for farmers to grow in England – is outlawed and demonised. Such is the fate of anything that interferes with the profit potential and control mechanisms of large corporations. I realise you guys probably hate this kind of talk and possibly I was missing the point of your comment, but I still felt moved to say this. Also it's true lol!

Cologero on 2012-05-11 at 08:38 said:

Sure, Charlotte, just as you allow your neighbours to "take turns" fixing your car, or providing you with healthcare.

Alcohol and marijuana are so popular because they are the great equalizers and levelers. In their "normal state", men differ considerably from each other, in their intelligence, wisdom, sanctity, ability ... in every conceivable way. But every drunk and every stoned-out person is exactly alike.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:01 said:

ah well, too much of anything is a bad thing, but I'm not one for stereotyping. I do find it intensely ironice that an extremely useful plant is demonised whereas super strength alcohol and tobacco (a totally non-beneficial product) are considered acceptable. You obviously don't know the history behind 'wacky backy', but I can promise you it was once considered so useful that to grow it was considered helping the war effort. And no, that doesn't mean I spent all day 'stoning'. Apart from anything else I hate tobacco. As for the pros and cons of mind altering substances we could go on all day about this if we were of the HPB, Crowley or Gurdjieff school – as it happens I tend to think there are far more cons because abuse happens far more often than use. However, the Pythia of Delphi and others like her might well disagree, as might the rainforest shamens or other representatives of ancient tradition. Nothing new age about it. Unlike LSD, which was created by the Tavistock Institute to create mind-blown hippies and other enemies. I hate to have to point it out, but probably even the Essenes partook of holy moly, according to recent evidence that has detected cannabis oil around their settlements – the medicinal benefits of this plant are beyond dispute, it's prejudice that makes people blind to it. As it happens I don't keep a car, it's bad for the environment, but when I did the neighbour did help fix it more than once. Healthcare in England is free for all and we like it that way... .

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:04 said:

actually, the one thing you CAN say about stoners is they're total pacifists and adept at minding their own business, whereas alcoholics are invariably violent towards self and others.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:12 said:

the reason alcohol and marijuana are popular is NOT because they're levellers, it's because in the case of the former it lowers inhibitions – good for social interaction – and stimulates the brain to produce dopamine, which is highly pleasureable. It is also very addictive, which leads to repeated use. THC and cannabidiol on the other hand are known neuroprotective antioxidants but the effects of smoking or ingesting it range from total euphoria, feelings of 'universal connectivity', increased empathy and other things that sound dreadful to some folk, to paranoia, nausea and delusions. Strong stuff. But I digress, let me get back to the study books.

Cologero on 2012-05-11 at 19:20 said:

You just stereotyped them, and proved my point. Drunks are all alike and stoners are all alike ... great levelers.

Charlotte on 2012-05-12 at 09:38 said:

what rubbish, I did no such thing!! I read Evola experimented a lot with hallucinogens – does that mean he's 'just like them' ?! :-)

Logres on 2012-05-13 at 00:30 said:

"... and always pushing well beyond the process of falling,"

I didn't understand the syntax here...

The overall thought that Satan leads men back in circles is a brilliant one. Tea Party? Reformation?

Cologero on 2012-05-13 at 08:23 said:

I'm open to suggestions to make it read more clearly ... the word is spingere: push, urge, drive. The idea is that the theory of progress is driving the process of the fall forward.

... by the way, recent high-level announcements and the instant worldwide reaction, seemingly coordinated, seem to demonstrate this tactic in action. So who can anticipate the next "thrust"?

Graham on 2012-05-15 at 23:26 said:

Re: the substitution of the principle to the person, there is a variant. It's interesting how modern popes and clergymen apparently recognize their own lack of spiritual authority, leading them to 'tone down' the principles they are supposed to represent. For instance, John Paul II rejecting the papal tiara was significant. Stated otherwise: conscious of their own lack of 'charismatic' authority, they seek to present the church as a bourgeois 'traditional' and 'bureaucratic' authority, something they feel at ease with.

Evola's Short Articles

2.1 Evola and Guenon

In an interview conducted in the mid 1960s —*Julius Evola: A Justified Pessimism*¹ — Evola provided a précis of his life's work. He answered all the questions very simply and it demonstrates how little his ideas changed in the preceding 40 years. This is how he answered the question about the influence of Guenon on his work:

Q In your book *Il Cammino del Cinabar*, where you laid out the genesis of your works, you acknowledged that the principal defender of the traditional worldview, Rene Guenon, exercised a certain influence over you, to the point that you have been called the “Italian Guenon”. Is there a perfect correspondence between your thought and Guenon's? And don't you believe, concerning Guenon, that certain circles overrate Oriental philosophy?

A My orientation does not differ from Guenon's insofar as it concerns the value attributed to the World of Tradition. By the World of

¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/JustifiedPessimism.pdf>

Tradition, we mean an organic and hierarchical civilisation in which all activities are oriented from above and are based on values that are not simply human values. Like Guenon, I wrote different works on traditional wisdom, studying their sources directly. The first part of my principal work, *Revolt against the Modern World*, is precisely a morphology of the world of tradition. There is also a correspondence between Guenon and me concerning the radical critique of the modern world. On this point, there are however some divergences between us. Given his “personal equation”, in traditional spirituality Guenon assigned knowledge and contemplation ahead of action; he subordinated the royal to the sacerdotal. I, on the other hand, have endeavoured to present and emphasise the traditional legacy from the point of view of the warrior caste and to show the possibilities equally offered by the way of action. A consequence of this different point of view is that, while Guenon employs an intellectual elite as the base for the possible reconstruction of Europe, as far as I’m concerned, I am more inclined to speak of an order. The judgments that Guenon and I give to Catholicism and Freemasonry also diverge. I believe, however, that Guenon’s formulation is not situated on the path of Western man, who is, in spite of everything, oriented especially toward action.

Commentary This leaves no doubt that there is profound agreement between the two thinkers, both on the nature of Traditional societies and their quarrels with the contemporary world. What is omitted are the Traditional teachings on the primordial tradition, the primordial state, the constitution of man as spirit/soul/body, the four phases of the cosmic cycle, and so on. But a careful reading shows that their “divergences” do not represent an insurmountable opposition, but rather reflect the same thing from a different point of view.

While Guenon holds that the primordial tradition takes different forms in different eras and cultures, he does not account for those differ-

ences. Evola goes a step further with his concept of the “race of the spirit”, such that a form that is suitable for one race may not be for another race.

The other divergence is related to the castes and the different spiritual stances appropriate to each one. Thus, Guenon describes the contemplative type of spirituality proper to the sacerdotal caste and Evola describes the one proper to the warrior caste. Their only difference, then, is the question of which one should be dominant. Once again, this can be resolved by the “race of the spirit”: the Eastern races are dominated by the spirit of contemplation and the Western race by the spirit of action. This is all consonant with cosmic law, and is represented by the teachings of Taoism, which Evola valued highly.

Bear in mind that what Evola means by action is more like the *wei-wu-wei* of Taoism — action/non-action — and not the frenzied activity of the modern world that was represented by Futurism, an artistic movement that Evola in his youth was associated with, but seems to have left behind. Evola ends his answer on this note:

Unfortunately, what characterises the modern European world is not action but its falsification, that is, an activism deprived of a foundation that is limited to the domain of purely material productions. They are detached from heaven under the pretext of conquering the earth, to the point of no longer knowing what action truly is.

Posted on 2007-12-21 by Cologero

2.2 Evola on Christianity in Europe

Continuing the translation of the interview in *La Nation Europeenne*:

*Julius Evola: A Justified Pessimism*²

²<http://www.geocities.com/Athens/Troy/1856/Muti.htm>

Q. Do you believe that the influence of Christianity was positive for European civilisation? Don't you think that having adopted a religion of Semitic origin has distorted certain traditional European values?

A. Speaking of Christianity, I often used the expression "the religion that came to prevail in the West." In fact the greatest miracle of Christianity was succeeding in asserting itself among the European peoples, even taking account the decadence into which numerous traditions of these peoples had plunged. Nevertheless, we must not forget the cases in which the Christianisation of the West was only superficial. Besides, if Christianity has, without any doubt, altered certain European values, there are also situations where these values were revived by Christianity, by rectifying and modifying itself. Otherwise, Catholicism would be inconceivable in its various "Roman" aspects. In the same way a part of Medieval civilisation would be inconceivable, without phenomena such as the appearance of the great Knightly orders, Thomism, a certain mysticism of a high level (e.g., Meister Eckhart), the spirit of the Crusades, etc.

Comment This is an important question and difficult to discuss due to certain subtleties and emotional attachments. On the one hand, the return to a decadent paganism, which can often take the form of a nature mysticism, must be rejected. On the other hand, an ignorant anti-Catholicism will make one miss those admirable phenomena mentioned by Evola.

These phenomena need to be studied from an Evolian point of view, though it is difficult to imagine who would be capable of it. For example, what was the animating spirit of the Knightly orders, particularly the Knights Templar (whose heresy conviction has recently been lifted)? Thomism represented a return to Greek and Roman philosophy. Aquinas pretty much replaced Hebrew law with the Stoic natural law. He also rejected the God of the Hebrews — the jealous "old man with a beard" — in

favour of a God more like that of Aristotle and Plato (even the Vedanta according to Guenon). The mystical trend of a Meister Eckhart was based on transcendence and the affirmation of a Self above the human world.

By understanding how these values were “revived” in a Medieval Christian form, it will be possible to understand how to revive those values again in the contemporary context.

I would like to add that in the “*Sintesi di dottrina della razza*”, Evola writes about “the great Aryan civilisations of the Orient, to ancient Rome, to the Germano-Roman Middle Ages.” (p 29)

Out of the ruins, will another arise?

Posted on 2007-12-28 by Cologero

* * *

Boreas on 2019-12-28 at 09:38 said:

A few nights back I saw a dream in which Evola said to me that “the Truth lies in Jesus”. Maybe Evola-the-harsh-critic-of-Christianity has had some revelations in postmortem states.

2.3 Evola on politics, morals, philosophy

These are the first two questions and answers from the interview published in “*La Nation Européenne*”.

Q. Do you believe that there exists a connection between philosophy and politics? Can a philosophy influence an undertaking of national or European political reconstruction?

A. I don’t believe that philosophy in the strictly theoretical sense of the term can have any influence over politics. In order to exercise an influence, it needs to embody an ideology or a conception of the world. It is what happened, for example, with the Enlightenment, with Marxist dialectical materialism, and with certain philosophic conceptions that

were incorporated in the conception of the world of German National Socialism. In general, the era of grand philosophical systems is over, now there only exist illegitimate and mediocre philosophies. In one of my early works from my philosophical period, I had included these words of Jules Lachelier actually, Jules Lagneau : “Modern philosophy is a reflexion that has ended by recognising its own impotence and the necessity of action that arises from within.” The proper domain of an action of this type has a meta-philosophical character. Hence, the transition that can be observed in my books which speak not of “philosophy”, but of “metaphysics”, of worldviews, and of traditional doctrines.

Q. *Do you think that morals and ethics are synonymous and should share a philosophy foundation?*

A. It is possible to establish a distinction, if by “morals” you mean customs and by “ethics”, a philosophical discipline (which is called “moral philosophy”). It seems to me, it is illusory to demand an absolute philosophical foundation for any ethics or morals. Without reference to something transcendent, morals can only have a relative, contingent, and social importance and can not overcome the criticisms of individualism, existentialism, and nihilism. I demonstrated it in my book “Ride the Tiger” in the chapter “In the World where God is Dead”. In this chapter I also dealt with the problematic posed by Nietzsche and existentialism.

Posted on 2007-12-31 by Cologero

2.4 The Science and technology Question

The next question from the interview published in “La Nation Europeenne” deals with science and technology.

Q. Your judgment of science and technology seems, in your work, to be negative. What are the reasons for your position? Don't you believe

that material conquests and the elimination of hunger and poverty will lead to the tackling of spiritual problems with more energy?

A. As to the second point you brought up, I will say that, as there exists a state of degradation due to poverty, so there exists a state of degradation due to affluence and prosperity. The “Welfare State” in which one can no longer speak of hunger and poverty, are far from engendering an increase in true spirituality; on the contrary, there is established a violent and destructive form of revolt by the new generations against the system in its entirety and against an existence devoid of any meaning (USA, England, Scandinavia). The problem consists, instead, in setting a just limit, constraining the frenzy of a capitalistic economy, the creator of artificial needs, and freeing the individual from his growing dependence on social and productive mechanisms. It would be necessary to establish a balance. Just until recently, the Japanese have provided the example of a balance of this type; it modernized itself and didn’t leave itself behind the West in the scientific and technical domains, while safeguarding its specific traditions. But today the situation is quite different.

There is another fundamental point to emphasize: it is difficult to adopt science and technology, while circumscribing them within the limits of a civilization’s material means and instruments, that is, while preserving, in regards to them, a certain distance; on the contrary, it is practically inevitable that it becomes impregnated with the world conceptions on which modern profane science bases itself, conceptions that are practically inculcated in our spirits by the methods of the customary methods of instruction and that has, on the spiritual plane, a destructive effect. The very concept of true knowledge is thus totally distorted.

This speaks for itself. If not, see the Sorcerer’s Apprentice.

However, if science is merely instrumental, then what is the nature of “true knowledge”. Can it, too, be “inculcated”?

Posted on 2008-01-06 by Cologero

* * *

CaseyAnn on 2013-07-03 at 14:06 said:

Excellent. This is always a struggle to explain to progressive secularists who see themselves as more charitable because they believe in an abstract brotherhood-of-all-nations void of any meaning.

Mark Citadel on 2015-02-08 at 15:17 said:

The best reason to be very wary about the goals of transhumanism, an element prominent within NeoReaction is pointed out by Evola. I would like to add another.

"Simply put, the technology that helps us survive has never kept up with the technology designed to kill us"

<http://citadelfoundations.blogspot.com/2015/02/the-utopian-scientists.html>

2.5 The European Empire

This is the final question from the interview of Julius Evola in "La Nation Européenne".

Q. In the history of Europe, there have been different attempts to form a "European Empire": Charlemagne, Frederick I, Frederick II, Charles V, Napoleon, Hitler, but no one has succeeded in recreating, in a stable manner, the Roman Empire. What were, in your opinion, the causes of these failures? Do you think that the construction of a European Empire is possible today? If not, what are the reasons for your pessimism?

A. In order to respond to this question in more than a summary manner, we would have to arrange for more time than is available in an interview. I will limit myself to say that the principal obstacles, in the case of the Holy Roman Empire, were the opposition of the Church, the inception of the revolt of the Third Estate (as in the case of the Communes), the birth of centralized national States that didn't admit any superior authority, and, lastly, the non-imperial, but imperialist—politics

of the French dynasty. I would not attribute a true imperial character to Napoleon's venture. In spite of all, Napoleon was the exporter of the ideas of the French Revolution, ideas that were utilized against traditional and dynastic Europe.

As for Hitler, it would be necessary to make some reservations in the measure in which his conception of the Empire was founded on the myth of the "Volk", conceptions that covered an aspect of collectivisation and nationalist exclusivism (ethnocentrism). It was only in the last period of the Third Reich that the views were broadened, on the one hand thanks to the idea of an Order, backed by certain factions of the SS, and on the other thanks to the international unity of European voluntary divisions that battled on the Eastern front.

On the contrary, it would not be necessary to forget the principle of a European Order that existed with the Holy Alliance (whose decline was imputable in great part to England) and also with the project called "Drei Kaiserbund" at the time of Bismark: the defensive line of the three emperors that should have also included Italy (with the Triple Alliance) and the Vatican, to oppose the anti-European manoeuvres of England and even America.

A "Reich Europa", not a "Nation Europa", would be the only formula acceptable from the traditional point of view for the realisation of an authentic and organic European unification. As to the possibility of realising European unity in this way, I cannot be a pessimist for the same reasons that have led me to say that today there is little room for a renaissance of "Ghibellinism", there is no point of higher reference, there is no foundation to give firmness and legitimacy to a principle of supranational authority. One cannot in fact neglect this fundamental point and be satisfied with making the appeal to "active solidarity" of Europeans against anti-European power, going beyond every ideological difference. Even when one succeeds, with this pragmatic method, to make a unity out of Europe, there would always be the danger of seeing born, in this

Europe, new disruptive contradictions, in particular as far as it concerns the ideological differences and through the effect of the lack of a principle, regarded as primordial, of a superior authority. "Community of destiny" has value only as a word of order of a practical character.

Today it is difficult to speak of a "common European culture". Modern culture does not know borders; Europe imports and exports "Cultural heritage", not only in the cultural domain, but also in taste, in the way of life, it always manifests more a general levelling that, joined with the productive levelling produced by science and technology, furnishes arguments not to those who desire a unified Europe, but rather to those would want to build a world State.

Again, we clash with the obstacle constituted by the nonexistence of a true superior differentiating idea that should be the nucleus of the European Empire. Beyond everything else, the general climate is unfavourable: the spiritual state of piety, of heroism, of loyalty, of honour in unity, that should serve as cement for the organic system of an imperial European Order is today, so to speak, nonexistent. The first task to accomplish should be a systematic purification of the antidemocratic and anti-Marxist spirits in the European nations. Then, it would be necessary to be able to shake up the large masses of our peoples in different ways, both by making the appeal to material interests, and with an action of a fanatic and demagogic character that, necessarily, would stimulate the subpersonal and irrational layers of man. These means would fatally entail certain risks. But all these problems can not be treated in a few words; nevertheless, I had a way of speaking of it in one of my books *Men among the ruins*.

Posted on 2008-01-08 by Cologero

2.6 Evola on Spanish Falangism

José Antonio Primo de Rivera was executed by the Spanish left on November 20, 1936. Although we are a day late because we were only recently provided with the Italian text, we will provide this translation of Evola's evaluation of the Spanish Falangists. Intended for the general public, it was published in January 1937 in **Tratto da Lo Stato**. It was subsequently included in the book **Fascismo e Terzo Reich** ("Fascism and the Third Reich").



Please see *What is Spanish Falangism*³ for the translated text.

We believe that the state does not have to justify its behaviour at every turn, just as no individual or social class does, in so far as it holds to a guiding principle all the time. All the while the state is made out to be God by Rousseau's idea that the state, or the will of those it represents, is always right. What makes the state like God is the belief that the will of the state, embodied by absolute monarchs in the past and now by the popular vote, is always right. The monarch may have erred; the popular vote may err because neither truth nor goodness derives from an act or assertion of the will. Goodness and truth are perennial tributaries of reason, and to ascertain whether one is in the right it is not enough to ask the king—whose dictate seemed always just to his supporters—nor enough to canvass the people—whose decision is always right according to the disciples of Rousseau. What must be done rather is to verify whether our actions and our thoughts are in agreement at every step with a permanent aspiration.

JOSÉ ANTONIO PRIMO DE RIVERA

Julius Evola takes the opportunity to express his own ideas on counter-revolution, under the pretext of evaluating the program of the Spanish

³http://www.gornahoor.net/?page_id=1202

Falangists from the later part of the 1930s. First of all, he points out that a political soldier must understand the cause for which he is fighting. Ideas, not blind action, are the driving forces behind historical change. Thus, he would seem to support the publication of manifestos or programs and be opposed to the helter-skelter approach of a destructive revolution under the hope of trying to pick up the pieces.

The same applies to nationalism. Beyond any concrete manifestation, a nation is at its base a spiritual reality, that is, “a predestined, cosmic unity.” Therefore, it cannot base itself on materialist categories such as race or territorial boundaries. Evola then digresses from this “particularism” and subtly brings up the idea of Empire as itself being a supranational spiritual reality. The Falangist state, therefore, is radically opposed to the liberal, secular, “night watchman” state.

As spiritual reality, the state is organic and results from “cells”: the family, the local community, and common business and professional associations. It is hierarchical and opposes any class conflict.

After defining the state, the Falangists deal with the individual. Once again, Evola notes the Traditional idea of the Person: free, autonomous, ordered to eternal life, an absolute value in himself. The Person’s freedom is legitimized from above and is opposed to individualistic self-assertion.

The Falange is opposed to materialism. Any movement based on biological determinism or race, and justified by empirical science is not a valid counter-revolutionary movement. They attach themselves to the Catholic faith, in reality, the only historical religion of Spain. Evola here comes very close to the Hermetic view of the Catholic religion. He sees in it a relation to the Primordial Tradition (the so-called “Church of John”) while simultaneously entertaining an anti-clericalism (“the Church of Peter”). Evola concludes with a positive evaluation of the Falange.

One sees in this that Evola, despite himself, is really of the **Old Right**. He sees the Europe before the French Revolution as sane and normal.

He also writes approvingly of the masters of the Old Right, from Joseph de Maistre, to Donoso Cortes to José Antonio Primo de Rivera. Any group claiming to be based on “Evola” needs to always keep the principles enunciated in his review in mind.

Posted on 2010-11-21 by Cologero

* * *

Will on 2011-01-10 at 14:06 said:

There is some great footage of Jose Antonio, as well as general information about the Falange, here in this documentary:

http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yzum_CU44jk

2.7 Christmas and the Winter Solstice

In ‘Roma e il natale solare nella tradizione nordico-aria’ (*La Difesa della razza*, 1940), Evola writes:

Very few suspect that the holidays i.e., Catholic holy days of today, in the century of skyscrapers, radio, great movements of the masses, are celebrated and continue ... a remote tradition, bringing us back to the times when, almost at the dawn of humanity, the rising motion of the first Aryan civilisation began; a tradition, in which, moreover, the great voice of those men is expressed rather than a particular belief.

A fact unknown to most must be first of all remembered, viz., that in its origins the date of **Christmas** and that of the beginning of the new year coincided, this date not being arbitrary, but connected to a precise cosmic event, namely, the **Winter Solstice**. The Winter Solstice falls in fact on December 25, which is the date of Christmas, subsequently known, but which in its origins had an essentially solar significance. That appears also in

ancient Rome: the date of Christmas in ancient Rome was that of the rising of the Sun, the unconquered God, *Natalis solis invicti*. With that, as the day of the new sun — *dies solis novi* — in the imperial epoch brought the beginning of the new year, the new cycle. But this “solar birth” of Rome in the imperial period, in its turn, referred to a somewhat more remote tradition of Nordic-Aryan origin. Of the reset, Sol, the solar divinity, appeared already among the *dii indigetes*, that is, among the divinities of Roman origin, passed on from even more distant cycles of civilisation. In reality, the solar religion of the imperial period, in a large measure had the meaning of a recovery and almost of a rebirth, unfortunately altered by various factors of decomposition, of a very old Aryan heritage.

First of all, let us clear up a misconception of the date December 25, which some have believed represents an error on Evola's part. **Julius Caesar**, in his calendar reform of 46 BC, did indeed set the date for the Winter Solstice on December 25. Over the centuries, the subtle error in the length of the Julian year gradually moved the astronomical date backwards. When **Pope Gregory** reformed the Julian calendar, he began with a later year, corresponding to a Church council, rather than the original year of 46 BC. Thus, the Winter Solstice moved back to around December 21 instead of the original December 25. Thus, Evola was correct in his claim that the data of Christmas was set to coincide with the Winter Solstice.

In the article, Evola goes on to tie in the date with the birth of Mithras. He also points out that in ancient Rome, the “day of the sun” was also the “Lord's day”, another tradition adopted by the Christians. He also ties this symbolism of the light with the prologue to John's Gospel.

The true light that gives light to every man was coming into the world

Evola concludes the article

In the Aryan and Nordic tradition and in Rome itself, the same theme had an importance not only religious and mystical, but sacred, heroic and cosmic at the same time. It was the tradition of a people, to whom the same nature, the same great voice, which I wrote about, at that date, a tradition of a mystery of resurrection, of the birth or rebirth of a beginning not only of “light” and new life, but also of Imperium, in the highest and most august meaning of the word.

Posted on 2010-12-28 by Cologero

* * *

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-20 at 13:22 said:
Magicians are supposed to rest on the winter solstice :-)

Cologero on 2011-12-20 at 14:53 said:
Thanks my plan, Charlotte.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-21 at 04:33 said:
Happy Hannukah! May the spiritual lights burn brighter than ever in these days of darkness.
Cxx

Attila on 2011-12-22 at 23:31 said:
I was informed by a neighbor that last night was celebrated as Shab-e Yalda in Iran- which ostensibly represents the turning point -where darkness starts to give way to light- probably in connection with the birth of Mithra- the Sun god of ancient Persia. It's a beautiful holiday in the line of other pre-Islamic Iranian celebrations such as Now-Ruz (1st day of Spring).

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-23 at 06:11 said:
Clearly a big day/night for the entire world and rest of the cosmos :-)

Perennial on 2012-12-20 at 03:12 said:
This is from a post I made on a debate on the date of Christmas in another forum I thought I would share: The feast of Sol Invictus began the week before, and as was common in the

traditional world the feast lasted several days. The day of the unconquered sun overlapped with the 25th, but did not fall on it. In addition, the feast of Sol Invictus was not widely celebrated until about 200 years after Christ's death, being popularised by Augustus Aurelian. In fact, it has been speculated that Sol Invictus was actually a rip-off of Christmas, and not the reverse. We know that the feast of Sol Invictus dates to no earlier than 274 AD at Rome. This was observed by Roman games every 4 years, evidenced by the surviving Chronology of 354, which lists the games as beginning on the 25th. However, Christmas, from ancient Martyologies, was already celebrated annually on the 25th in 336. In fact there is no reason to believe that Sol Invictus was observed December 25th prior to 354, a full 18 years after the Roman sacramentary records Christmas. In fact, scholars believe that August may have likely been the original month Sol was celebrated. Other works list solar game in October. Tertullian argued for December 25th being Christ's birth back in 198 AD, 76 years before Sol Invictus was even observed by Aurelian, so clearly none of this was new. As for the other nonsense, such as Saturnalia and the like, Saturnalia occurred in earl December, nowhere near Christmas, and ended before the 25th. Clearly, there is little connection between pagan deities and the Feast of the Nativity. The Holy Father rightly observes that Christ's birthday is dated 9 months after the Annunciation, when Our Lady conceived Our Lord. No mysteries here.

Cologero on 2012-12-20 at 10:29 said:

With all due respect, Perennial, you should be seeing mysteries everywhere; this is hardly the equivalent of a birth announcement in the NY Times. Please review your rosary.

Unfortunately, you are adopting the methods of "scientific" history, so praised in the documents of Vatican II, but whose effects have been quite corrosive. Expresssions such as "there is no evidence" or "there is no reason to believe" are far from establishing anything concrete.

The second mistake you make is thinking Gornahoor is like any other forums you may frequent. You may want to refute Saturnalia all you want, but I don't believe that was even mentioned in the post nor in Evola's text.

I suggest you read the chapter "The Limits of History and Geography" from "The Reign of Quantity" and try to rewrite your comment in its light.

Evola's, and Guenon's, point is that dates are not arbitrary. Pace, Evola, however, Christmas is not a decomposition, but rather a deepening and a recomposition. It renewed a decomposing Tradition, which we witness in the Middle Ages. It was such, also, that a poet like Virgil could anticipate the start of a new Golden Age.

Perennial on 2012-12-20 at 12:56 said:

I agree, Cologero. Obviously, this was written for a different context to be read by a different audience. I am not attempting to refute Evola, since i agree with him, and even though I do not believe that Christmas is based on the solstice, I also believe it is not arbitrary and the feast

occurs where it does for a reason. I do not think it is coincidence that all of these events occur in December, either. I shared this primarily to give some factual background to parallel the post, rather than compete with it.

2.8 The Future Order of Nations

In the September, 1941 issue of *La Vita Italiana*, **Julius Evola** wrote a review of *Das Reich der Völker* by the German political theorist, **Hans Keller**. The first part of Evola's essay is a review of the book. In the second part, whose translation appears below (*ff*), Evola provides his own conception of the role of the Volk. Clearly, Evola cannot support Keller's naturalism nor the role of the Volk as the vanguard or the base for the political organization.

In the Traditional perspective, the Volk is lunar or passive and therefore has to rely on a spiritual and political hierarchy for its full development. Thus Evola must needs oppose any sort of nationalism on the basis of an ethnicity or a race. In rejecting that sort of neo-Nordicism, Evola will lead us back to the ideal of Romanity.

Part I *In primis et ante omnia* we cannot adhere to the mythology of the *Volk*, of the "people nation", so dear to Keller, who makes them the base of his juridical edifice. Mussolini once spoke ironically of the "mysterious entity that calls itself the people". "People", be it only as "Volk", is a simple myth that always and inevitably sounds like demagogy: of the type which is accompanied by intense polemical applications to disvalue and degrade the significance of everything that is the State, the formative political force from above. Keller stands on the most naïve optimistic natural law: he believes that the people exist as a very precise entity, equipped with its own consciousness, its own will, determined by "eternal laws" superior to all political forms in which they are concretized, a depositary

of determinate values. We can only speak of similar things to some naïve types for whom, today, the natural meaning of nationality (quite different from every “nationalism” and deprived of a “political” character) becomes something extremely tenuous in the face of becoming the “mass” of the people and the advent of a civilization no longer based on truly traditional values. Hegel said, “the people is that part of the State that does not know what it wills”. That is precise. Our fascist idea is that the people, the nation, exists only as the State, in the State, and in a certain measure, only through the work of the State.

But our State is not the end of Keller’s artificial antitheses: it is not a juridical superstructure, a mere fact of “power”, an external power without basis. Our State is ethical and spiritual. It has the value of an *entelechy*, i.e., of a formative force on the nation and the “people”, who otherwise would remain a diffuse and unformed reality, vegetating on a naturalistic plane of life, without any metaphysical, ethical, or truly heroic tension.

Our point of view is detached both from the idea of natural law and the collectivizing of the people, as well as the abstract, juridical and rationalistic of the State. We are realists. We do not believe in the “people”, instead we believe in a guiding, formative elite and, wherever it happens, leaders of the people. Keller has in mind the State only as *caput mortuum*, i.e., as that which became in some cases, when the political structure created by leaders and elites personifying living traditions depersonalized themselves, objectified themselves, created an excuse to justify themselves, giving to understand the existence of public autonomous powers and of neutral juridical forms or norms to order to obtain in that way recognition to which the direct affirmation and the prominent prestige by the high stature of the Leaders and by superior princes was not enough.

To reach the same goal, i.e., to hold it without exhibiting it, along other directions, therefore, it is joined to the creation of a myth opposite in appearance to that of the neutral “State”, but in reality answering to the same end: the myth of the “people”. Keller lets himself avoid

the admission that the idea of the Volk was “discovered” in 1933. Even if the date is not for us so recent, having some precise antecedents especially in democratic nationalism and French Jacobinism, (in fact even in France, as the antitheses to an excess of *statism*, determined by the centralizing, absolutistic, and anti-aristocratic work followed by the kings up to Philip the Fair, it left, for the first time, the mystique of the nation, of the people as source of every law, not putting up with any authority from above)—even, therefore, if the Volk was not even discovered in 1933, only it stands in fact that the mythology referring to it is new, it was unknown by preceding civilizations and there came to life for precise political and propagandistic reasons: the “people” and *Volk*, far from being notions having, today, a real content, are two idea-forces, two myths taken up by a power to affirm a given political system, determined by circumstances, to capture and organize the forces—in themselves directionless and apt to follow very different suggestions—of the true people and to strengthen therefore a given type of political authority. For the less important socializing tendencies, it was not necessary to us in Italy to have recourse to this myth: to us the spiritual idea of the State, and moreover, the direct authority that proceeds from a Duce and from a Monarch were a sufficient base to lead to the same result.

Keller says that all the differences between *statute* law and law based on the idea of Volk lie in the judgment on human nature: in the first case, as in every idea of Reich and Imperium of Roman Catholic origin, it is pessimistic and does not have faith in human nature, while in the second case it has. But what is this “human nature”? We are not pessimists, but realists. We believe in human nature, but not of everyone, less than ever in the collectivity as the mass, whose psychology we know well. Instead, we believe in that of the minority who create the States, who animate the peoples, who lead the collectivities to the heights which they could never reach alone. Neither statism, therefore, nor natural law, but the aristocratic hierarchical ideal, without the charade that is necessary only

to demagogues and weak natures. That is what we mean by Roman and Aryan realism.

Keller says: “to the Romanesque people, only the State is important, even if they serve nationalistic motives in addition.”

We say that we can even renounce the additive motives; we value the Mussolinian idea, according to which the people is something weak and blind, before they came to constitute a reality and a unitary will, penetrated by higher meanings with the birth of the State. But we are not statist, because we do not make an idol of the State, as Keller and certain German jurists make of the Volk: because behind the State, in our view, there is somebody, there are Leaders, Monarchs—if you want, there is a “superrace”, in which alone “nation”, “people”, “race”, “tradition” cease to be abstractions. Every great “people” is always comprised of various influences, various racial elements, various traditions. It is the work of the elites to choose, to affirm, from among them all, a given element, to subordinate every other to it, leading back in that way to a precise order which otherwise would have remained heterogeneous and arrested in the form of a confused potentiality.

Part II

As Evola continues his analysis of the German legal scholar Hans Keller, we see recognizable themes. In particular, Keller comes surprisingly close to the New Right idea of Ethnopluralism. In Klemmer’s scheme, each people is free to define themselves, to realize themselves, and live independently of each in their own enclaves. So, the “New Right” is not so new after all, as it merely resurrects stillborn ideas from the past. Evola rejects this conception on several grounds.

The first and most obvious is Keller’s naturalistic starting point. Evola points out that for every Aryan civilization, the authority of their law was based on its relationship to the supernatural, and the lawgivers themselves were considered “divine”. So

Klemmer, and by extension the New Right, have nothing at all to do with the self-understanding of the European peoples of the past. Keller regards such claims as fantasies and projections of earthly leaders onto an imaginary plane. Any rightist movement must be related to a transcendental tradition; the pseudo-tradition of neo-paganism would not qualify for reasons that will be made clear in Part III.

The second difficulty with Keller's thesis is the very problem of defining a "volk". Keller speaks of nations of destiny or becoming, without specifying their actual destiny or the goal of the becoming. As such, it is not very helpful. Furthermore, it implies that there will be nations in a lesser or greater state of becoming. Would the latter have to treat the former as minors and guide their development?

In common with similar ideas held by new right movements today, Keller blamed "inorganicity and leveling" on the preceding religious Regnum. This thesis, Evola rejects. Keller's ethnopluralism is itself deracinated, since it lacks any content, or principles, that a supernatural conception of the Regnum would provide. Relations between ethnocentric conclaves are *ad hoc*, relativistic and, contingent. In contrast, Evola envisions a supranational Imperium, in which the superior power furnishes the structure to the others. This, he claims, is a real unity, opposed to the merely nominal unity defined by Keller.

The final objection is devastating. Keller sees a pacifistic union of separate peoples, each according to its nature. But Evola asks the question, "what if the nature of a people is to be a warrior race?" This, Evola claims, is an essential part of Indo-European civilizations. This will blow up the ideal of peaceful ethnocentric enclaves, since one (or more) of them will seek to establish an Empire over the others; this is an essential feature and not a historically contingent event that may or may not occur.

We see the Germanic nations to this day adopting most of

Keller's conceptions. The sight of 40,000 Norwegians singing together for peace will not convince another people, whoever they may be, who are of a warrior nature, to leave them in that desired peace. Evola's text follows:

Keller believes in immanent laws of the people, given by "nature", respected and followed in themselves, not originating from any power from above or however personified: in any case, having nothing to do with a "beyond". This is a "faith" like any other. In reality, it would be difficult to adduce a single legal system of ancient peoples, the Aryans included, for whom the authority of the laws was not related to a "divine" origin from above, and was not considered to have been introduced by legislators themselves "divine". But we already know Keller's point of view: instead of understanding the order proper to an earthly and temporal *Imperium* as the reflection of a transcendent order and, from another point of view, the secularization of law and authority as purely spiritual in origin, he tends to see in every idea of a spiritual *Regnum* a type of fantastic projection of the fantastic image of an earthly reign. This stands, more or less, at the intellectual level of Euhemerism⁴.

On the other hand, Keller finds it particularly difficult to define the concept of *Volk*. In certain cases, it seems that he values the national socialist conception of it as the criterion and measure, corresponding to the formula *Volksgemeinschaft*. Where he says that the "community of nations", the hoped for supranational order, will not be able to be realized until all the peoples have been realized according to the Nazi totalitarian social concept, expressed precisely by the formula mentioned. But on the other hand, he concedes:

It is not important to see how the individual peoples conceive themselves, even if each one leaves the other free to form for themselves a given concept of their own essence and to live in conformity with it.

⁴<http://www.etymonline.com/index.php?term=euhemerism>

This is the conclusion of the analysis of the various ideas of the people, a conclusion that evidently leads to a full indifferentism and a pale norm of reciprocal tolerance on the international plane. The fact that Keller insufficiently acknowledges race to define the people; that he introduced the rather indeterminate concept of the “community of destiny” (this is a greatness that is defined depending on directions and many directions exist in the history of a great people); that, finally, he speaks of a “people in becoming”, without being able to say exactly what will define the *terminus ad quem*, i.e., the definite form of such a becoming—all that goes to confirm the mythical and weak content of this conception of the *Volk*. The only coherent solution would be to assert dogmatically that nations as truly such do not exist before being “total nations” according to the national socialist formula of the *Volksgemeinschaft*.

Nevertheless, to assume this political form as a condition for the membership with full rights in the *orde nationum* is not, evidently, a falling short of the principle of respect of every “people”, even to the point of judging them “as lesser peoples” and putting them almost under guardianship, even under a foreign State, when it has not reached such a form.

There is more. Keller, as we saw, blames the inorganicity and the leveling that would be typical of every Roman or religious conception of the *Regnum*, or *Reich* if one prefers, of the nations. Such an accusation is even turned against his own conception. In the logic of this, in fact, we don’t encounter any obstacle to not end up in the utopian vision of an order that takes up all the peoples of the earth. And we don’t encounter any obstacle through the fact that this order is rather more abstract and deprived of content of that of the now defunct League of Nations. In it, would be a question of only taking care of the laws of each people, of teaching them, of maintaining peace and the balance of power—in summary, a type of administrative function that does not presuppose any specific vision of the world, no higher point of reference. But, in its turn,

the particularistic conception, relativistic, and collectivistic of the Volk, is the cause of that. If the authority of higher values is not recognized, it is evident that among the various “national” unities, only extrinsic relations, “gravitations” and “equilibria” will be able to exist, which do not involve, at its foundation, anything essential. In every way for us, such an *ordo nationum* as universal order is absurd and undesirable: we conceive of the concrete, differentiated, supranational unity, decentered in a well-defined vision of the world and in well-defined values that give the tone and the internal unity to a given “imperial space”. The superior civilization of a dominating race must furnish the reference point to a succession of political ethnic minors, in order that these, rising up from simply national values, and integrating such values, they find in them the basis to understand and to feel united to each other: to actually unite, and not in the style of an indifferent tolerance of belonging to the same club.

Therefore, these supranational unities, that will put a stop to the period of particularistic, schismatic, anti-European, as well as differentiated nationalism, will be able to even be combative. We see that Keller acknowledges war, but without recognizing in it any specific value, in the same way that he eventually acknowledges the State, in a transitional phase, as an instrument and pedagogue that may help tie “people” to realize themselves, finally, in a “total” form. The general intonation of his view remains pacifistic. Wherever he uses the word “power”, *Macht*, Keller thinks only of oppression, tyranny, violence, distortion of the people. He barely remembers Moltke’s phrase: “universal peace is only a dream, and not even a beautiful dream.”

Nevertheless, since every people, according to him, should be respected according to their own inclinations, we can certainly think that there exist peoples of a warrior race and calling—we noted everything that was said, starting from Klemm and D’Eichtal, about the typological distinction of “active races” and “passive races”, “conquering races” and slave races”,

etc. Keller, it is true, on the other hand, refers to research on savage tribes, where he would demonstrate natural inclinations to reciprocal respect and peace, for the purpose of challenging the idea that the natural state is the war of all against all. But much more documentation would be necessary to show such a thesis, against which, all the great Aryan history already remains: it is true, not a history of eternal war and for war itself, but history, nevertheless, which is consistent with virile and dominating natures, capable of realizing superior values in battle— superior, often, to all that can come from a climate of peace of naturalistic harmony. Among the rights recognized by Keller for the people, he acknowledges the right to “their own development”: it would therefore behoove us to ask why this development must be limited to the bourgeois domain of “culture and economy”, with the exclusion of everything that refers to the “power” factor, where the natural inclination of such people was exactly that of the warrior and heroic type. We think instead that the heroic and warrior elements are of particular importance even as the common basis of an “imperial space”, i.e., of a concrete and well-articulated order between a given group of nations.

Part III

The organization of a block of the type like the European, Aryan, and Roman block is the only concrete task of our future and the only object of a serious consideration in regards to a new law and a new ordering of the people.

JULIUS EVOLA

In this final installment of the essay, please note these points.

- Evola declares that Tradition is Roman, it forms a union with preceding traditions, with the Hyperborean tradition as its beginning.

- The Volk is a modern invention, opposed to Tradition. Its roots are found in Rousseau and the French Revolution.
- The life and traditions of early Germanic tribes is poorly documented, relying mostly on some comments of Tacitus, and the Eddas, which were preserved much later by post-pagans.
- However, since the Germans were Aryans, we can surmise about them, based on what we know of other Aryan civilizations. The Roman tradition, particularly that of the Middle Ages, is much more fully documented. Hence, that is where we put our focus.
- The State organizes the people and relates them to spiritual reality. However, this is not a superstructure whose purpose is only to aggrandize its leaders and oppress the masses, as some in the New Right believe.
- This orientation to transcendent values is a feature not only of the Christian Middle Ages, but also the authentic pagan traditions.
- Some civilizations may expand, creating a supranational organization. But this is not merely an administrative function, hegemony, or acting as the “world police”. Rather, it is to spread its vision of a spiritual, transcendental reality. Blocks of nations will arise, united by common transcendental values.

Finding it necessary, therefore, to draw a conclusion, only what refers to the polemic against an abstract juridical internationalistic normativism⁵ is acceptable in Keller's ideas, after all, up to this point that is what the idea of State has assumed in certain cases in the modern world, in full settlement and against depersonalized “neutral” forms, deprived of a substrate

⁵<http://fr.wikipedia.org/wiki/Normativisme>

of quality and true strength. The points of positive reference invoked by Keller against what are nevertheless as problematic as ever, and hardly acceptable from the point of view of a tradition, that we without difficulty declare to be Roman, in order to immediately add that it in its Romanity forms a unity with the traditions characteristic of every great past civilization, with that of ancient Aryanity at the head. In fact, as we said, this mythology of the *Volk*, of the people-nation as absolute source of every authority, is only a modern invention, that arose in Germany recently and that in Germany itself it now seems somewhat passé, through the same force of European events.

Keller's and other's efforts to relate it back to an ancient German tradition are artificial. We saw, as much, that Keller was constrained to condemn as non-German and "Romanizing" the very tradition of the Prussian State and to extend an analogy, he blamed the Medieval Empire. Perhaps he will be able to support himself on such a view of the primitive Germans. But such views interest us very little, because they cannot be authoritative: The "primitive" Germans are in fact only some isolated, dispersed and involute stocks of the Great Aryan tree, and we have to judge and understand their traditions on the basis of that which, in a rather more complete, precise, and documented form, present to us the great Aryan civilizations of antiquity, including the Roman.

In such ancient traditions, there are so many "myths", but of a more elevated and real content than the modern myth of the "*Volk*", which, as we noted, was essentially given to traditional and dynastic Europe by French Jacobinism and has a strongly collectivistic and anti-hierarchical flavor. According to our traditional point of view, the "nationalities" can exist but on a naturalistic plane, not yet political nor properly spiritual: in place of certain spontaneous forms of sensibility and of certain customs where, however, the primary element ends up being less the "nation" than the race. The centre and the indispensable condition of the nation as political and spiritual reality is instead the State. The State is not a mere fact

of “power” or a type of abstract juridical superstructure, but an ethical and spiritual reality and a formative and discriminatory force. This force, in its turn, is connected both to an elite, to a race of leaders and to the prestige proper to them, both to transcendent, to a certain extent, values (which are not necessarily only those of the Christian religion: ancient Iran, ancient Rome, etc., teach it) that legitimate them, because there is true authority only as authority from above.

The formative power of such principles, after having unified and animated a “people”, can be projected beyond its borders and, in different ways, does not exclude those of war, can give rise to higher unities, i.e., supranational, but nevertheless well defined, and ordered by a determinate law: they are the “imperial spaces”. The “rank” that goes to assure to a given nation the supranational directive function cannot be measured in materialist, administrative, bourgeois pacifist terms, and as quasi-police for collective security and peace. On the contrary, it is adherence to already noted transcendental values and to the corresponding faculty of animating, transporting, making capable of energy and commitment, capable even of confronting tragedy and misfortune, which is the sign of such a superiority. The logic of the system does not then lead to its extension to every nation of the world, but to its limitations and particular zones, as blocks of nations, blocks united by the same chain of an “Order”, capable, where it occurs, of the same heroic unanimity of a “crusade”.

Leaving aside both universalistic and nationalistic myths, *the organization of a block of the type like the European, Aryan, and Roman block is the only concrete task of our future and the only object of a serious consideration in regards to a new law and a new ordering of the people.*

Posted on 2012-04-24 by Aeneas

* * *

Cologero on 2012-04-26 at 08:50 said:

Evola makes clear the difference between volkisch movements and an authentic Tradition. It is absurd to make the people, or the folk, the ultimate judge of anything. According to Evola, it is the elite, by which he apparently means the ruling elite, who speak for the masses and animate them.

We can agree with that, as far as it goes, but, following the Master Rene Guenon, we assert that there is a spiritual elite beyond the ruling elite. The latter's task is to cooperate in disseminating the spiritual vision to the mass, through its rule and positive law.

Evola accepts the Catholic pessimistic view of human nature, but only for the mass. He believes that the ruling elite are different, a position he calls "realism". We think instead it is naive. Perhaps somewhere, at some time, the elite had achieved the Primordial State, but certainly not in recent memory.

Dominion on 2012-05-03 at 17:04 said:

Reading this, I'm reminded of two things:

The first is the French Emperor Napoleon. He used his power to spread the values of Liberalism across Europe and attempt to create a new order among the nations, even a new aristocracy. Apparently there can be an antitraditional "Imperium" as well.

The second is the European Federation envisioned by Guillaume Faye, where "Evola is reconciled with Marinetti."

But how, I wonder, is it possible to begin to create such an order? Certainly, the neofascist terrorist attacks of the 1970's did nothing to further the Evolian vision of certain members of that movement. Moreover, any hint of decline in the current order leads people to believe that we are not following the principles of the order itself (Liberalism, democracy, etc) properly. There seems to be no real chance in the near future of a spiritual order in the line of this essay being able to rise. How would you see this happening, given the current climate?

Cologero on 2012-05-03 at 20:57 said:

Evola claimed that Freemasonry was able to reorganize itself (after the chaos of Revolution) during Napoleon's reign, eventually leading to the formation of a Masonic Republic in France. As we shall see, despite appearances, that was not a source of order. Faye's "visions" are of no interest to us, as they are prone to change every few years. There is no reconciliation between truth and error; men are willing to make such distinctions.

How can order arise from disorder? That fantasy we leave to biologists and free market economists. Yet we have the answer to your question which was given by the writers of Tradition. Does anyone take it seriously?

Guenon says it must begin with an intellectual conversion, that is, the knowledge of principles. If an elite of those who have undergone a conversion can congeal, there is a possibility of change. Evola explains that every great Western civilization began with a divine revelation;

that is pretty much the same as what Guenon claimed, only that it is publicly acknowledged. That is, the elite through their Power and Will, can shape and form the people.

Either that thought rings true to you, and it motivates you, or it does not. You will never “see” this happening, unless you are among those are “making” this happen.

Graham on 2012-05-03 at 23:18 said:

“That is, the elite through their Power and Will, can shape and form the people.”

To prevent misunderstanding, it should be pointed out that the formal cause here is inspired. The elite aren't just making it up as they go along.

Cologero on 2012-05-03 at 23:45 said:

Thanks, Graham, for making that clear. It is an elite that is chosen from above, not those who manage to grab power. That is what distinguishes them from the likes of a Napoleon, as Dominion mentioned.

Dominion on 2012-05-04 at 02:46 said:

“How can order arise from disorder?”

Isn't the whole process of Initiation one from evolving from a disordered and finite ego to a True Will and Eternal Self? Perhaps I misunderstand, but that seems to be exactly what is being described. The answer would then be that the path from disorder to order is one of following the correct process and being guided by the proper laws and forces.

Graham on 2012-05-04 at 11:13 said:

Dominium, in saying that initiation is guided by “the proper laws and forces” you answered your own question, since he couldn't be guided by an order that didn't already exist in principle.

2.9 Coomaraswamy on Evola's Revolt

The first translation of any of **Julius Evola's** works into English was published in the prestigious Indian journal *The Visva-Bharati Quarterly* (Vol. V, Part IV, New Series, 1940), founded by the Nobel prize winning writer and poet, **Rabindranath Tagore**. **Ananda K Coomaraswamy AKC** wrote a brief introduction, which follows below, and the translation of the chapter “Man and Woman” from *Revolt against the Modern World*

was made by his wife, Luisa Runstein. A few of Evola's essays appeared in the British journal *East and West* in the 1950s, but the full translation of *Revolt* did not appear in English until 1995.

For obvious reasons, Evola's book could receive more understanding in India than in the West. The modern deracinated Westerner is ignorant of his own past. Hence he can discern nothing recognizable in Evola's "remarkable presentation and exposition of Traditional doctrine" (AKC), which was characteristic not only of Indian civilization, but also of ancient Rome and the Middle Ages. Instead, he remains smug in the "pretenses" of the modern world.

AKC did point out a serious error due to Evola's misunderstanding of a text from the *Aitareya Brahmana* (VIII, 27, Page 341 of Arthur Keith's translation). In a Hindu wedding ceremony, the groom says to his bride:

I am that, you are this, this you are, that I am; I am sky, you are earth.

When the King chooses his *Purohita*, i.e., the priest who offered sacrifices for the king since the gods would not accept those of the king directly, the *purohita* recites the groom's part to the king. Hence, in this regard, the priest is masculine in respect to the king. Evola assumed just the opposite, which led to the unfortunate characterization of the priesthood as lunar and regality as solar. Although this quotation was removed from subsequent editions of *Revolt*, this error persisted in Evola, even if inconsistently and ambiguously. This is AKC's note on that topic:

We refer in particular to the citation of the conjugal *rajnah purohita-varana-mantram* with which the priest takes the king as consort, saying, "I am sky, you are earth". Evola, inverting the roles of the king and priest, does so in a way that it was with these words that the king directed to the selected priest and consequently that the priest was to obey the king! The true relations were recognized by

the first Sanskrit scholars (Oldenberg, for example), by Guenon in *Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power*, by Hocart in *The Castes* and were recently discussed in a very recent article on the various aspects of Hindu regality (*Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power in the Indian Theory of Government*, 1942).

AKC's introduction to the translation follows.

Revolt against the Modern World, which contains the chapter titled "Man and Woman", whose translation follows, constitutes perhaps the most significant among the numerous works of the Italian philosopher Julius Evola. Evola's "Revolt" is, fundamentally, the affirmation of the universal metaphysical doctrine that has given form to traditional social institutions: thus this study treats social hierarchy ("caste"), the meaning of regality and empire, the relationship between the sexes, the mystery of rites, and from the same point of view interprets history and makes a destructive criticism of the pretenses of modern "civilization".

The book is not without defects: in particular he exalts beyond measure the importance of regality in relation to the priesthood (Kshatriya in relation to Brahma, raja in relation to Brahman), even erroneously interpreting Hindu texts to support his theses on this point. In addition, of everything amiss in a work of this type, in which the "serenity" of the heroic element results so rightly emphasized, he clearly shows an anti-Semitic prejudice, as can be seen in the superfluous characterization of Freud as a Jew. Nevertheless, this book constitutes a remarkable presentation and exposition of Traditional doctrine and could well serve as an introductory text for the student of anthropology and as a guide for Indology, especially for anyone who is interested in Hindu mythology and does not understand that, in the words of Evola, "the passage from mythology to religion constitutes a humanist decadence."

The chapter “Man and Woman” was chosen for translation because of its clear, uncompromising, and, we can add, dense peroration of the principles, that are reflected in the institutions and ideals, such as that of *sati*, that are no longer comprehensible and that certainly are no longer held dear, not even as memories by our politicians and reformers who, “whether by force or consent, were led to the accept the models of the West”.

That last quotation is from Peaks and Lamas, by Marco Pallis. AKC also provided ten footnotes to the translation, all but one of which supported the text with references to relevant passages in Hindu texts. The exception addressed Evola's claim that absolute “dedication” in love is typical for the woman in relation to the man. Giovanni Monastra describes AKC's objection:

That, according to Coomaraswamy, is true in the limits in which the husband constitutes for the wife the “symbol of God”. But, under the traditional aspect, in his turn the man also in relation to Divinity assumes a “feminine” role, rendering love with total dedication, without entailing any degradation, something different from what Evola means. Not even man can, therefore, be considered self-centered: the “internal sufficiency” which is mentioned in Revolt is a relative fact, not to be absolutized.

Traditional Mentality

We have touched upon only a very few of the “motifs” of folklore. The main point that we have wished to bring out is that the whole body of the motifs represent a consistent tissue of interrelated intellectual doctrines belonging to a **primordial wisdom** rather than to a primitive science; and that for this wisdom *it would be almost impossible to conceive a popular, or even in any common sense of the term, a human origin.*

ANANDA COOMARASWAMY

On a related note, I call attention to Coomaraswamy's perhaps misleadingly titled essay *Primitive Mentality*⁶. This version is missing the images from the original and most of the footnotes. I did include the most interesting footnotes, marked off in boxes.

Note that AKC refers to Evola twice in support of traditional society; this is certainly not a description of some fascist totalitarian dictatorship. Nevertheless, the traditional society is held together with a common mythology that orders their entire lives. Yet, within this structure, the individuals are free. When myth becomes religion, that is, it is compartmentalized into one aspect of life among others, then the culture begins to die.

AKC brings up the idea of a "common mind", without which an organic society is impossible. For the Traditional mind, based on transcendental principles, the idea of individual opinions is preposterous. Only in modern liberal societies is that conceivable. It does not make men free, but creates a atomized group of individuals who consider relationships as "contracts", not as living organic things. This is how the "folk" become the "mass".

Posted on 2012-05-28 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2012-05-28 at 19:44 said:

Excellent sleuthing here. Evola's writing on Japan is similar; he intuits the entire metaphysical structure of the traditional Japanese nation, and indeed I am laboring to get his work translated over here, but sometimes his readings of specific elements are mistaken for lack of cultural context. I at first thought of Evola as a writer who is "right even when he is wrong", but I now realize that he can be wrong sometimes and still successfully communicate a powerful idea.

⁶https://gornahoor.net/?page_id=4279

David on 2012-05-28 at 21:50 said:

I read Evola's work extensively, but never "about" him. This little text begs question then : where else did he misread or made errors ? Personnally, after reading him and myths (either Edda, Saint Graal, Gilgamesh, etc.) I seems to end to the same conclusion as he did : superiority of the Regal Divinity over both priest and warrior caste. Am I wronged ? If so, could someone tell me where to read something that would clarify all this ?

Sati Shankar on 2012-05-28 at 23:02 said:

The male and female, king and priest, and the warrior, there is a mutual, (if this term can be used) overlap, one emerges from the other without any superiority of the either, ... 'the Priest is the King himself, who appoints the Priest (Purohita) ... , without any numerical ordering ... the opposing relation between as denoted is a conventional one, not chronological or real order of coming into being', For example, the Son creates the Father as much as the Father the son ... 'there can be no paternity without a filiation and vice versa, and that is what is meant by the 'opposit relation'. The perspective of tradition has to emerge, as it does, from within which leads onto its whole.

Charlotte on 2012-05-30 at 13:23 said:

Wow, mysterious kitchen talk about the planetary spheres, that's impressive ... and there was I thinking it mainly centred on bread and circuses :-)

'Now a voice so fair, ascending,
Fills the air with love unending,
Rises on the silver moonbeams
Woven from Apollo's sun streams.
"Bold Orion, Starman leaping,
How my heart for you is beating.
I have set you there so thy fame
Lights the path of this, the sky-train!"
'Next she calls with gentle words
The creatures of her wooded world,
Speaks to them with tender charm
To keep the slightest safe from harm.
"Sweet you are as honey, bee.
Bear and Stag, come follow me.
Jump with me across the river."
Seeks she souls with bow and quiver.

Then the Goddess steps up on it –
Disc of night, the lamp of dreamers –
As the steeds with hooves of onyx
Take to flight with sweet Selene.

Foal on 2012-05-31 at 20:08 said:

The Hero donned his solar face,
Departed from his holy place,
Armed and ready for a magic battle,
To defend and exalt his sacred cattle.
The phalanx of warriors will he lead,
The Gods to determine who shall bleed,
Ten thousand men all decked for war,
Rich in spirit, in money poor.
The women cry and halt their men,
Sayeth fair Charlotte "We rather you remain in our love's den,"
"That leader of yours is too like Helios,"
"Aye", affirmeth a wizened sage, "I've said so many a time; too serious!"
But the fathers scoff at this hesitation,
"This world is for us procrastination!",
"Your priority is procreation,"
"We are concerned with a higher calling,"
"Our enemies to see a-falling!"
In bursteth a champion, his name was HOO,
"Wenches, save your chatter for the kitchen or the loo."
"On the morrow we commence our tour,"
"You are my lovers, but my destiny is Gornahoor."
By night the chariots pass the wall,
After a day of feasting at the town hall.
The women gather to make solemn sacrifice.
Noble sun appeareth, come morning,
Cold as ice.

Angolmois on 2012-06-01 at 04:50 said:

"What is this supposed to mean?"

That he scorched himself in the solar plexus. The Sun burns and kills as much as it illuminates and gives light and life. Solar heroes have transcended all this to a supra-personal plane and that is why they shine without burning.

Sati Shankar on 2012-06-17 at 00:37 said:

Friends, I hereby acknowledge all the participants of this thread that i will be referring to and using the information contained herein, in a Conference paper I am preparing. Due acknowledgement will be cited in the paper also.

Regards,Sati Shankar

Michael M on 2021-05-29 at 10:00 said:

"AKC brings up the idea of a "common mind", without which an organic society is impossible. For the Traditional mind, based on transcendental principles, the idea of individual opinions is preposterous."

A common mind is indeed necessary for organic society. An interesting statement at first, I believe many would object to such a commonality between persons as somehow impinging on their individual freedoms. Again, this doesn't actually follow because the choice to be an idiot or evil while possible isn't precisely what someone wants for their lives as "free", especially when constructing or advocating for a society in which that "freedom" deters true freedom. Accepting wisdom isn't a punishment but a path to liberation and then all things flow from it, organically. Unfortunately, it does not appear we have hit "rock bottom" yet, accepting wisdom does indeed cause some pain especially in the beginning.

The idea of common mind has always struck a chord with the true essence of Catholic or what some thinkers were trying to put forward in Sobornost. Something common and universal to all that guides the people and gives boundaries to keep them together. The idea of such a common mind would be the representation of the sphere – a vertical axis of principles that which all horizontal living revolves around with its own set of rules and regulations. Politics don't exist, because the principles cannot be debated, simply debated is the way to make decisions. But maybe I'm just romantically imagining life as a modern Beguine and Beghard in the countryside.

While societies cannot go back to such a mythology, the task at hands seems to incorporate the levels of mind common to all traditional societies. I don't mean synthesizing across societies, I mean appropriate to each society as the roots present are necessary for development. While the intellectual era of modernity has caused havoc, it is necessary to incorporate together. All functions of the human need to be acknowledged and then set to principles, I believe this is the task of the Christian, Christianizing all things with the Spirit. Maybe the virtue for the modern era is Chastity, which would be able to subdue the Lion (desires / consumption) and allow for Strength to come forth... Godspeed to everyone to convince others of such a virtue, let alone oneself.

2.10 The Modernity of Hobbes

Julius Evola's review of Carl Schmitt's monograph on Thomas Hobbes originally appeared in *Lo Stato*, January 1939. Together, they expose the mentality of the modern mind in the political realm. This article will appear in two parts. This part is Evola's review of Schmitt's essay. Given the length of this piece, and its depth, I will provide my own commentary at a later time. Its relevance to the failure of the "right" and "conservatism" to gain any traction in the modern world will become obvious.

According to **Carl Schmitt**, three thinkers, after a long period of ignorance of the meaning and value of their doctrine, due to the dominance of the rationalistic mentality in vogue up until recently, seem now ready for a new valuation. The first is **Vico**. The second is **Machiavelli**. The last is **Thomas Hobbes**.

We recognize today in Vico the precursor of a new historical method, the exploration of the world of origins and "myth", conceived as a fundamental element in the primordial life of nations. The period of new European political activism has liberated Machiavelli from unilateral and discredited widespread interpretations and recognized in him the adversary and overcomer of moralistic lies and political cant, the defender of the style proper to a "heroic realism". As for Hobbes, Carl Schmitt himself intended to rehabilitate and to clarify the true meaning of his political doctrine in a very recent monograph titled *Der Leviathan in der Staatslehre des Thomas Hobbes* (1938), a monograph so rich with interesting and also urgent points, to merit a special examination.

The political doctrine of Hobbes, as is well-known, is centered in the symbol of the Leviathan, reminiscent of the Bible. It speaks of the Leviathan for the first time in chapters 40 and 41 of the *Book of Job*, where

it is described as the most powerful and indomitable of the beasts of the sea. It is certain that, from this, his adversaries drew a precious inducement to jump on it, discrediting and maligning the Hobbesian doctrine, describing it as that in which the State becomes an omnipotent beast, a monster that devours and crushes everything. But in truth things, in respect to the Leviathan, are quite different.

Leaving aside, for the moment, the symbolic aspect, and limiting ourselves to the theoretic, in the Leviathan Hobbes sought to depict an almost mystical type of political totalitarianism, the State as a being that is simultaneously man and god, machine and beast, and that claims for itself the supreme authority and supreme law. Thus, as it is depicted in the cover of the original English edition of Hobbes' book, the Leviathan had none of the traits that could recall the biblical marine monster. It appears in it instead as a majestic human figure, crowned, holding the sword in his right hand and the staff in the left, i.e., the symbols of the double power, the temporal and religious. The union of these two powers is a fundamental point of Hobbes' doctrine. It would have been a single thing at its origins: essentially due to the Hebraic-Christian conceptions this unity would have been lost. It must be restored. The State, for Hobbes, must return to being a *deus mortalis* mortal god, something "transcendent". But already here the point that invalidates all of the Hobbesian doctrine is betrayed, and that had to cause the end of the same historical Leviathan: as Schmitt notes, Hobbes thought that the distinction of the two powers was foreign to pre-Christian conceptions, something, hitherto, correct: "since for him, religion was a part of the political", something incorrect. The opposite is in fact true: the foundation of the totalitarianism exhibited by all the great traditional political unities was in the fact that the political was a part of the religion, and not vice versa. And it is not about a subtlety, but a fundamental divergence: as we will soon have to see.

According to Hobbes' political sociology, the originary state is the

state of nature and specifically that of *homo homini lupus*⁷ and *bellum omnium contra omnes*⁸. From the anxiety at this stage and the need for security, peace, and order, the State draws its origin and, in truth, in an almost contractual way. There is no doubt that, in this regard, Hobbes belongs already to the “modern world” and is in severed antitheses with the preceding, medieval conception. Schmitt makes this point clearly: “The sovereign is not the *defensor pacis* Defender of Peace⁹ as a peace relating to God; he is the *creator pacis* creator of peace, only an earthly peace. The process is the inverse of the “divine right”: since the power of the State is omnipotent, it assumes a divine character only for this reason. But its omnipotence has an origin totally other than divine: it is a human work and is actualized through a contract stipulated by men.” Schmitt continues:

The decisive element here is that such a contract does not reflect, as in the medieval conception, the reality of a collective entity created by God, a natural preexisting order: on the contrary, the State, that order and collective entity, is the result of the intellect and creative human power and comes to life only through the contract. This contract is conceived in a completely individualistic way. Individuals, as atomic entities, encounter each other in their anxiety, until the light of the intellect penetrates them, and then a “consensus” arises in terms of a general and unconditioned submission in the face of the supreme power.

It is thus that in the armed and crowned figure of the Leviathan his body is represented as composed of an infinite multitude. We witness, here, an almost magical transformation (we will see that this attribute can assume in this the entirety of its significance): the absolute rises from

⁷Man is wolf to his fellow man

⁸War of all against all

⁹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Defensor_pacis

the relative. Individuals conjure up the Leviathan, recognizing in it the only way for salvation, security, peace: but with that they conjure something transcendent, something that is greater than their sum and the individuality of each contracting party, something, in respect to which they, hypothetically speaking, no longer have any power.

Hence, the image of the Leviathan as “machine”: *machine magna*, *machine machinarum* machine of machines. For the mentality of Hobbes’ time, still far from the technico-industrial era, the machine represented something mystical, not to say, magical: a human construction, it seemed nevertheless to possess its own life, expressing itself in its function. For which Hobbes’ Leviathan appears as “machine” as well as God, man, and beast. Hobbes, as Schmitt points out, is the first to have systematically exposed the idea of the State conceived as a *magnum artificium* great artifice, created by men and technically perfect, as “a machine” having in itself, i.e., in its function, its “truth” and its “right”. We reach, by that path, the Hobbesian formula expressing the extreme, but purely logical consequence of all this theory: *auctoritas, non veritas* authority, not the truth. It is the formula — it should be said, “exquisitely modern” — of irrationalism and political pragmatism.

Schmitt attempts, to tell the truth, a mitigation, saying that at the base of Hobbes’ view is the fact that he “no longer poses any distinction between authority and truth, making the *summa auctoritas* highest authority from the *summa potestas* highest power”, where that formula would express only the norm of a way of technical and realistic thinking, neutral in regards to “values” and “truth”, separating the metaphysical and religious notion of truth from the idea of command and political function, to confer on the latter a primary and undisputed autonomy. But how then not to see that the Leviathan would become only the symbol of temporal hypostatized power and that each of his pretenses to rule not only the sword, but also the staff, to encompass in itself not only the fortress, but also the temple (that is also found in the figuration) would

be usurpatory and the abuse of power?

In order to understand a theory, such as Hobbes', in its true significance, it must be considered not in itself, in the abstract, but in its operation in its historical "place". At the time in which Hobbes lived the crisis of the type of State we call "traditional" was more than visible and that the Middle Ages had known, to a certain extent. Here authority drew its absoluteness from the pretense of coming from above, of reflecting "truth" itself and putting in *fides* faith the fundamental cement of every political unity, it shaped this very unity to the elements of an essentially spiritual, and mediately religious, nature. In Hobbes' time the animating force for a State of such a type had already failed: its structure survived, i.e., a State that still conserved the absoluteness and the pretense of the supreme authority, previously conferred on it from reference to principles of a super-political order: metaphysical or a least religious.

Leviathan is the attempt to save and preserve these surviving forms by grafting on them a new principle of life. In a situation in which there no longer existed men capable of reawakening in individuals the heroic capacity for obedience and recognition on the base of super-individual and super-material principles, we look for a new myth and a new foundation: the contractual one with the related theory of the "state of nature". They seek, i.e., to persuade individuals that the supreme authority can be accepted regardless of the "truth", for its intrinsic utility in regards to exigencies, now, of a materialist and anti-heroic nature, like those that are at the base of the needs for security, peace, and order on the plane of purely human and contingent reality. It is such that, while the Leviathan is presented as a "machine", i.e., only a human construction, and its body, its substance, appears now constituted by the mass, except that it conserves some traits typical of the ancient traditional State; it claims for itself the unity of the two powers. The State is divine, although the "divine right of kings" is denied. Divine—"more than merely secular", according to the ancient English formula, *God's Lieutenant*—is for Hobbes the same

sovereign, although his authority is now destitute of every foundation from above and the replacement by an acknowledgment on the part of individuals on the basis of reason and convenience. An amphibious form, therefore, and, in its depths, contradictory.

Can we prescind, in regards to the Leviathan, from this historical placement? And then what must we think about this ambiguity? What import has the very contractualistic myth have in it?

It is clear that, once the State is secularized, the Leviathan becomes a colossus with feet of clay. Its absoluteness can still linger for a certain period, by inertia. Through the conditions of its life, it then goes on to have a fatal distinction, reproducing fundamentally the distinction between the two powers that the Leviathan had tried to surpass. And the distinction between the modern external world, in which, for various reasons, by chance or other, the individual subordinates himself and recognizes the “divinity” of the State, and a type of inner forum, in which the individual feels himself free and inviolable. This distinction is announced already with the “*cuius regio, eius religio*” whose realm, his religion¹⁰ of the Reformation, religion becomes thereby a politically conditioned fact; it was exacerbated in the period of Baroque absolutism, reached its critical stage with the so-called theory of the “positive” State or State “by right”. But with this condition necessary to conserve its “neutrality” and its absoluteness independent of any “truth” whatsoever, the Leviathan began to dig its own grave. And what Schmitt himself thinks in the political realm, without however stressing that it is a question of the result of a fatal logic. He says,

at the moment in which we admit the distinction between interiority and exteriority, the superiority of the former over the latter, therefore even that of the private sphere over the public sphere, it is already decisive. An external power, as far as integrally,

¹⁰http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cuius_regio,_eius_religio

specifically, and even loyally recognized as only a public and exterior power remains nevertheless something empty and dispirited. Such a terrestrial god has only the appearance, the *simulacra*, of divinity. There is nothing divine that can be imposed from the outside. *Non externa cogunt deos* Nothing divine lets itself be externally enforced.

In these words the essence of the process is understood that, by stages, has led to the individualistic, liberalistic, and rationalistic erosion of the true State. Having come this far, when even the State conserves leviathan-like traits of an absolute power, transcending the right and the strength of every individual, it is deprived of true autonomy, it becomes fatally an instrument of what Schmitt calls the “indirect power”. Characteristic of such a power, according to Schmitt, is the distribution of the relations between political command and risk, between power and responsibility, between protection and obedience: it is a question of a masked, and absolutely indirect, act that gathers all the advantages of power without explaining to anyone the risks naturally inherent in it. We easily recognize, in this precision, the nature typical of the forces that had, and have, the real power in the “agnostic” States of an apparently democratic of liberal type. The State becomes in effect a neutral machine that obeys the game of the “indirect power” more strongly.

Such a type of State therefore came into crisis, and new political forms arose, characterized by an abrupt aversion for every form of “indirect power” (up to the anti-Masonic and anti-Semitic country of the “single party” State), by a new love for political totalitarianism, for pure authority. By way of these new forms, what must one think, as in a certain measure seems to be the idea of Schmitt, of a “currentness” or “modernity” of Thomas Hobbes’ political myth?

After reviewing **Carl Schmitt**’s monograph, **Julius Evola** moves on to his own unique interpretation. At least, I am unaware of a similar interpretation. Rather than viewing Leviathan

as the beginning of the modern political world, he sees it as the residue of the Traditional world, the remnant of a civilization that has lost its connection to transcendent principles and is left only with its forms of authority.

Here, drawing from some ideas of **Donoso Cortes**, Evola sees the possibility of a recovery of Tradition from the stage of the Leviathan. Facing Europe in revolution, Donoso postulated the arrival of a “man on a white horse”, a dictator who would restore order and tradition. Of course, Donoso had in mind a Catholic state, but that doesn’t alter the essence of Evola’s view.

After touching on all that, it is rather awkward to respond to a similar question: in particular, why, if we must respond in the affirmative, would it be necessary to see if the correspondence, in the end, is resolved in a valorization of Hobbes, or in grounds for suspicion of other aspects of the new political forms? This point merits a brief examination.

For that, it is necessary to state beforehand that the connection of the Leviathan with the myth of the contract must be considered absolutely inessential and contingent. Schmitt demonstrates a sensibility of everything particular when he states that when an author makes use of an image, like the Leviathan, he enters a domain where it is no longer a question of verbal formulas, dialectical abstractions, or mere “values”, but instead they act and dominate forces and powers, thrones and agencies, which reminds us of these words from J. G. Hamann: “There is just one step from transcendental ideas to demonology”. It is about something “elementary”: the substance of the Leviathan is essentially irrational, and when individualistic and utilitarian motives can also serve, in a preliminary phase, to lead toward a similar form of State that, in its actualization, calls to life something else, attests to an evocation, a really magical deed, no longer having anything to do with the rationality and the utility of individuals.

From a collective whole something transcendent can come to life,

susceptible of manifestation in a center of pure irresistible power: power that, only as such, is truth and authority: the center the vortex. This is Leviathan.

We have already come to know this Leviathan as a phase of an involutive process: it is the survival of the ancient traditional State, whose absoluteness moved from the level of *veritas* to that of simple *auctoritas*. That, therefore, is in a retrospective vision. Let us now consider, instead, the possible return of the Leviathan to political developments beyond the acute phase of the crisis, i.e., beyond the complete individualistic breakup of the State. It should always depict a sovereignty deriving from the galvanized collective, therefore from forces of a prepersonal and irrational nature. It is not the collectivism of Marxism and bolshevism, since these movements, at least in their “myth” (and here, regarding “evocations”, the myth is not to be disregarded), oppose every form of sovereignty and are centered in a completely materialistic and uniformistic vision of the world. Instead, it would deal with every anti-individualistic and anti-rationalistic movement, that profess again a conception of the State as “*dio mortale*”, that fuels this symbol with potent forces of faith and sacrifice, but unfortunately without surpassing the stage that Keyserling would call “telluric”, i.e., the stage at which authority suffices and truth is superfluous; in which myths, and not true principles, are the best instrument to capture and organize collective forces; in which the miracle of an exceptional personality, of a “man of destiny” saturated with the “numinous”, and not a pure “divine right”, founds and legitimates sovereignty and command and confers a transcendent character to the idea of the State.

Seeing things this way, we can speak of a certain modernity of the Hobbesian Leviathan. But even in its new appearance it can claim so little, as in its emergence in the descending, involutive process to the character of a stable, definitive form. In the descent, once it reached the Leviathan from the true and traditional State, it was not possible to stop it, i.e., not

to descend still even lower. In the new processes, we will necessarily find ourselves, sooner or later, facing an alternative. Either the new totalitarian movements will not succeed in surpassing their purely activist and vitalistic irrational phase: and now it will be difficult for the new Leviathans to be able to completely secure itself in the face of “indirect powers”—with which they no longer mean the irresponsibility of parties or some secret associations, but influences of a deeper elusive nature, always capable of infiltrating wherever they do not find the way barred by the presence of authentic principles and in a firm, abiding truth: and such forces do not have as a goal the maintenance and the intensification of worldwide anti-traditional subversion. Or else, we will enter into a new phase in which the Leviathan, so to speak, will become the body formed to make possible the incarnation and the manifestation of a principle and a higher order: with that, the collectivistic and irrational aspect of the principle of totalitarianism and authority will be surpassed and will again implement a type of truly spiritual and traditional hierarchical organization.

We can already point out that an analysis of the purely symbolic aspect of the Leviathan would nearly lead to the same result. Once the affinity of the Leviathan with the dragon the other mythical characters is ascertained, Schmitt tries to demonstrate that symbols of the type would have negative and evil meanings especially in Semitic civilizations, while in others the dragon often appeared among the regal, imperial, and metaphysical symbols. That is not completely exact or, better said, this interpretation must be subordinated to another more general and essential one. Not only for the dragon or the serpent, but for many other ancient symbols, they assumed two opposed meanings, in relation to two different periods. When a power, in its positive, superior spiritual origin, falls and through regression becomes the tool of obscure, “elementary”, and “demonic” influences, in the symbolism of the various peoples, the symbols, once unknown, come to acquire a negative quality, while the positive ones that were originally proper, are transferred to other sym-

bols, alluding generally to a restorative function. That also fits exactly the Leviathan and confirms its ambiguous, double nature. And this duplicity, according to everything we said, reflects an alternative that will be decisive for the ultimate result of the forces of worldwide revolution.

Posted on 2012-07-05 by Cologero

* * *

Golgonooza on 2012-07-06 at 07:01 said:
Very interesting article, thank you.

Mihai on 2012-07-09 at 04:25 said:

This description of the “leviathan” corresponds very well with Plato’s tyrant, of which he gives an ample description in the “Republic”. As the “leviathan”, the tyrant is an inverted image of the “philosopher-king”, the latter being an image of superior principles, with knowledge of higher realities and laws, while the tyrant is an incarnation of the collective, inferior strata of the human psyche, being raised to power to represent the animalistic desires of the masses, in himself, the tyrant being the sum of ignorance.

In Christian terms, such a rule can be called “the reign of the Antichrist”, though not necessarily in an absolute sense.

2.II To Be of the Right

This essay by **Julius Evola** was originally published in the journal “Roma” on 19 March 1973 under the title “Essere di Destra”.

Right and Left are designations that refer to a political system already in crisis. In traditional systems of government, they were non-existent, at least if taken in their current meaning. In them there could be an opposition party, but not a revolutionary one, nor one that put the system itself in question, but rather it was loyalist and, in a certain way, workable. So in England, where one could speak of a “very loyal opposition of His

Majesty”. Things changed after facing the subversive movements of more recent times, and it is known that at their origin, the Right and the Left were defined on the basis of the places the opposed parties respectively occupied in parliament.

Depending on the level, the Right assumes distinct meanings. There is an economic Right based on capitalism, not without legitimacy if it does not abuse its power and if its antithesis is socialism and Marxism.

As to a political Right, it strictly acquires its full significance if a monarchy exists in an organic State: as was the case especially in central Europe, and also partly in conservative England.

But we can also disregard institutional presuppositions and speak of a Right in terms of a spiritual orientation and vision of the world. Then to be of the Right means, beyond being against democracy and every “social” mythology, to defend the values of Tradition as spiritual, aristocratic, and warrior values (in a derivative way, also with reference to a strict military tradition as, for example, happened in Prussianism). It means more than nourishing a certain disdain for intellectualism and for the bourgeois fetishism of the “cultured man”. (The representative of an old Piedmontese family paradoxically had this to say: “I divide our world into two classes: the nobility and those who have a university degree” and Ernst Jünger, in support, valorized the antidote constituted by a “healthy analphabetism”).

To be of the Right means also to be conservative, although not in a static sense. The obvious presumption is that there is something of substance worthy of being conserved, which however puts us facing a difficult problem. In reference to what constituted the immediate past of Italy after its unification: the Italy of the nineteenth century has certainly not left us a heritage of superior values to preserve or deeds to serve as the base. Even going further back in Italian history, we encounter only sporadic positions of the Right; it lacked a formative unitary force which existed in other nations, solidified over time from ancient monarchical

traditions of an aristocratic oligarchy.

However, in affirming that a Right must not be characterized by a static conservatism, we mean that there must be certain values or certain ideas based on solid ground, but that different expressions must be given to them, adequate to the development of the times, in order to not let them be bypassed, in order to take back, control, and incorporate everything that little by little is manifested in changing situations. This is the only sense in which a man of the Right can conceive “progress”; it is not a simple movement forward, as too many often think, especially among the left; Bernanos was able to speak aptly of a “escape forward” in this contest (“imbeciles, where are you fleeing ahead?”). “Progressivism” is a foible foreign to every positions of the Right. It is also because in a general consideration of the course of history — with reference to spiritual values rather than to material values, technical achievements, etc. — the man of the Right only recognized a descent, not progress nor a true ascent. The developments of current society can only confirm this conviction.

The positions of a Right are necessarily anti-corporate, anti-plebeian, and aristocratic; thus their positive counterpart will see value in the affirmation of the ideal of a well-structured, organic, hierarchical State, directed from a principle of authority. In this last regard, they therefore overlook the difficulties with regards to that from which such a principle can draw its foundation and its blessing. It is obvious that it cannot come from below, from the *demos*, in which, without offending the Mazzinians of yesterday and today, it does not express in the least the *vox Dei* voice of God, and if anything, the contrary. And one must also exclude the dictatorial and Bonapartist solutions, which can only have transient value, in emergency situations with contingent and short-term goals.

Again, we find ourselves compelled to refer instead to dynastic continuity, provided we keep in view at least what was called “authoritarian constitutionalism” in monarchic regimes, that is, a power that is not purely representative, but also active and regulatory. This is on the level

of that “decisionism” which De Maistre and Donoso Cortes had previously spoken about, in reference to decisions constituting the last resort, with all the responsibility tied to it and which must be assumed in person, when one is found facing the necessity of a direct intervention because the existing order has entered a crisis or new forces push onto the political scene.

Let us repeat however that the rejection in these terms of a “static conservatism” does not concern the level of principles. For the man of the Right, principles always constitute the solid base, the *terra firma* in the face of change and contingencies, and there the counter-revolution deserves a precise catchword. If we want, we can refer here instead to the formula, paradoxical only in appearance, of a “conservative revolution”. It concerns all the initiatives that are imposed through the removal of negative factual situations, necessary for a restoration and for an adequate revival of what has an intrinsic value and cannot be an object of discussion. In effect, in conditions of crisis and subversion, it can be said that nothing has a character so revolutionary as much as the renewal of such values. An ancient saying *usu vetera novant* the use of old and new, and it emphasizes the same context: the renovation that can actualize the revival of the “ancient”, i.e., the unchangeable traditional legacy.

With this, we believe that the positions of the man of the Rights are sufficiently clarified.

Posted on 2012-10-29 by Cologero

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Logres on 2012-10-30 at 20:33 said:

I corresponded briefly with John Michael Greer (Archdruid of North America) over a comment he made re: Evola, and here is what he said (reposted with permission)-

Question – “Would be interested in your take on Evola’s “garbling” of celestial/telluric currents...”

Greer:

"I doubt it will be congenial to the Gornahoor audience. Druidry shares much in common with traditional Taoism – I can say this with some basis in experience, having studied with a Taoist master and put a decade into one of the old temple styles of t'ai chi ch'uan – and the sense of the nature of polarity is an important piece of this common ground. The notion that any polarity ought to be resolved by the conquest of one extreme by the other, in both traditions, is simply wrong – and this is all the more true as Evola's hypothetical Uranian and Demetrian Traditions are at best, dubiously historic reifications of eternal spiritual realities. I'd point out that in alchemy, the King does not rape and enslave the Queen – not unless you want your alchemical working to misfire from the very beginning and produce a poison rather than an elixir. Instead, the King and Queen marry, mate, and fuse into the twofold Rebis, from which the living Stone is born. In the same way, yin and yang, the solar and telluric currents, the Uranian and Demetrian principles are incomplete and unbalanced when separated from one another, and produce not only balance and harmonious change but a new, third thing when brought together in the right way. Evola's problem, as I see it, was that he was too heavily influenced by the popular intellectual culture of his own time – his ranking of warriors above priests, for example, was taken straight out of Nietzsche, and the whole Uranian/Demetrian dualism is a projection of ideas borrowed from Weininger's *Geschlecht und Charakter* – most of the radical Right in his time was influenced by Weininger, which makes it all the more curious that nobody reads Weininger at all these days. It's all too common for those who believe they've found a timeless tradition to define it in terms that will look profoundly dated a generation or two thereafter!"

I'll note that Cologero has read Weininger, and that it is in the library. Although I find his comments useful up to a point, it seems to me to miss the point: Evola was a subtle and complex character addressing a specific time and danger – Greer seems to be engaged in polemics here, just like a typical modern. All the same, if anyone has pointers as to what to write back to him, I would be much interested...

Cologero on 2012-10-31 at 01:14 said:

I don't know what you want to say to him, Logres, since we have often criticized Evola here on similar grounds. Although Evola himself was versed in Taoism, even publishing an Italian translation of the *Tao Te Ching*, his duality of Solar and Lunar as Good and Evil is off the mark. He was too influenced by the likes of Bachofen and Weininger. It is one thing to use them to illustrate points, but quite another to inject them into his system. Part of Evola's "complexity" is the result of his prejudices. Evola should always be read in the light of Guenon, whom Evola acknowledged as the Master of the 20th century.

As we have amply documented, to his dying day, Evola preferred his own philosophical system to proper metaphysics. I am aware that that makes him more "exciting" to certain casts of mind, but to read Evola without a firm foundation in Guenon (or even one's own traditional teachings) will lead to serious misunderstandings.

Avery M on 2012-10-31 at 09:30 said:

Cologero, if you were to expand that single comment into a pamphlet or an ebook, it would make a fine introduction to reading Guenon and Evola side by side. One can eventually glean this stuff on one's own, especially if one tries to struggle through Evola's monstrous *Metaphysics of Sex* or Weiniger, but I think people would prefer a guide so that they don't have to do that.

Logres on 2012-10-31 at 15:33 said:

Agree with Avery. As to reply, agreed also that Evola ignores the feminine for purposes of constructing his world (that's clear enough from *Metaphysics of Sex*, one of the few Evola books I've read cover to cover). The problem is that he's "constructing" at all – however, his emphasis on Monotheism & the Empire is something the Druidry revival would eschew; and he doesn't so much "garble" celestial and teluric currents as separate them arbitrarily in order to purge what he doesn't have a use for. But this is exactly what Druidry does with paganism and monotheism. Or so it seems to me...

Saladin on 2012-10-31 at 19:57 said:

I am not sure if one MUST "read Evola in the light of Guenon". Just as there are many different manifestations of the Primordial Tradition, as religions, there can be different variations in interpreting that same Sanatana Dharma! Personally, I am indebted to both of them but I can see why Guenon should be given precedence.

As for replying to Mr. Greer: Please make clear to him that there exists two fundamentally different Taoisms. The Traditional one is the Taoism of Lao Tze and Chuang Tze (which in our era is almost impossible to find in any organized or initiatory form) but the other Taoism is nothing but a degenerate form of Shamanism. What is known by Taoism in Taiwan (and in mainland China if any remnants have survived the vicissitudes of Communism) by the term Taoism is a disparate practices of third rate Magic and popular superstition. "It is a set of ancient religions, ancestor worship, animism, shamanism, and magic, mixed to varying degrees with Buddhism, Confucianism, and Traditional Taoism." It appears what Mr. Greer refers to is the latter.

aperion on 2012-10-31 at 20:03 said:

No Avery, that would be too easy, nay, a a cop out. I mean is it really that difficult for modern youth to read a Weiniger (tempted to tap a double "g" but won't) through and through or even a very comprehensible "Metaphysics of Sex"? To hell with guides, both books are entirely coherent to anyone outside of specialist academic categories for those who care to actually read and comprehend books. Basically you want a summery or even care i day a Sacrament(!)- why do we even bother some my cry- , so you can avoid the pain of study. My diagnosis: man up beotch.

Logres on 2012-10-31 at 21:17 said:

In fairness to him, he states he reads the original texts (maybe in translation?) – the man has a first rate mind and is a gentlemen.

2.12 Historiography of the Right

This essay by Julius Evola was originally published in the journal “Roma” on 7 August 1973 under the title “Storiografia di Destra”.

In developing some considerations on the European meaning that can be attributed to Donoso Cortes, the Spanish thinker and an interesting type of the political man, who developed his activity in the period of the first European revolutionary and socialist movements, a noted German historian, Carl Schmitt, pointed out that while the left has systematically elaborated and perfected their historiography as the general background for their destructive action, nothing similar happened in the opposed camp of the Right. There the whole is reduced to some sporadic example in no comparable way, through consistency, radicalism, and breadth of horizons, to that which Marxism and the left possessed for some time.

To a large measure, this is correct. Actually, the only noted history that had more influence, excluding that of Marxist intonation, is essentially of liberal, illuminist, and masonic origins. It relates to those ideologies of the Third Estate that served only to prepare the ground for radical movements of the left, having itself an essentially anti-traditional foundation. An historiography of the Right still waits to be written, and that constitutes one of our signs of inferiority in respect to the ideologies and actions of unrest of the left. In particular, the so-called “homeland history” *storica patria* in vogue cannot fill the lacuna, because apart from certain of its possible national colorations and the moving re-evocations

of events and heroic figures, it itself is affected, in a large measure, by suggestions of thought that is not of the true Right and, especially, because it cannot stand in comparison, as far as the breadth of horizons, to the historiography of the left.

This is the fundamental point. In fact, we must recognize that the historiography of the left has been able to take the view on the essential dimensions of history: beyond conflicts and episodic political developments, beyond the history of nations it has been able to see the general process and realized fundamentals in recent centuries, in the sense of the transition from one type of civilization and society to another. That the basis of the interpretation was, in such regard, economic and classist, does not take away any of the breadth of the description of the whole treated by that historiography. That, as the essential reality beyond the contingent and particular, indicates to us, in the course of history, the end of the feudal and aristocratic civilization, the arrival of the liberal, capitalist, and industrial bourgeois civilization and, after this, the announcement and incipient realization of a socialist, Marxist, and finally communist civilization. Here the revolutions of the Third Estate and the Fourth Estate are recognized in their natural causal and tactical concatenation. The idea of higher level processes which, without intending or knowing it, served the more or less “sacred” egoisms of the people, the rivalries and ambitions of those who believed they “make history” without leaving the field of the particular, such ideas are certainly considered. They study exactly the transformations of the whole of the social structure and civilization that are the direct effect of the play of historical forces, rightly relegating the history of nations to the simple “bourgeois” phase of general development. (In fact, the “nations” did not arise in history as its subject but started from the revolution of the Third Estate and as its consequence.)

Measured by the historiography of the left, which is characteristic of other tendencies, it therefore appears superficial, episodic, bi-dimensional, sometimes even frivolous. A historiography of the Right should embrace

the same horizons as Marxist historiography, with the will to gather the real and essential elements of the historical process developed in recent centuries, beyond myths, superstructures, and also ordinary news. This, naturally, by inverting the signs and the perspective, i.e., seeing in the essential and convergent processes of recent history not the phases of a political and social progress but rather that of a general subversion. As is logical, the economic-material premise also needs to be eliminated, recognizing *homo oeconomicus* and the presumed inexorable determinism of the various means of production as mere fictions.

Much vaster, deeper, and complex forces were and are in the action of history. The particulars and even the myth of so-called “primordial communism” must be rejected and must be countered by the idea of organizations based predominately on a principle of a pure, sacred, and traditional spiritual authority as the civilizations that preceded those of the feudal aristocratic type. But, apart from this, we repeat, an historiography of the Right will recognize, not less than that of the left, the succession and concatenation of general distinct supra-national phases, which regressively led up to disorder and the current subversions: and this will be, for it, the basis for the interpretation of individual facts and upheavals, always attentive to the effect it produced in the total picture.

Here it is impossible to indicate, not even with any examples, all the fecundity of such a method, the unsuspected light that it would throw on a large number of events. The political-religious conflicts of the imperial Middle Ages, the constant schismatic action of France, the relations between England and Europe, the true meaning of the “achievements” of the French Revolution and little by little up to the episodes that particularly interest us, as the effective turn of the revolt of the Communes, the double aspect of the Risorgimento which national movement, triggered however by ideologies of the Third Estate, the significance of the Holy Alliance and the efforts of Metternich (that last great European), then that of the first world war with the ricochet action of its ideologies, the

discrimination of the positive and negative in the national revolutions that recently have been asserted in Italy and in Germany, and so on, in order to finally reach a vision in conformance with the naked reality of the true forces in battle today for the control of the world. Here is a choice of suggestive arguments, among so many, to which the historiography of the Right could be applied, revolutionizing the views that most people are accustomed to have on everything through the effect of historiography of the opposite orientation, and acting in an illuminating way.

An historiography so formulated, looking at the universal, would then be especially at the height of the times if it is true that, through the effect of objective irreversible processes, alignments increasingly stand out today that are not just ethnic and particular political and closed unities. Except that unfortunately only from the hoped for historiography would an increase in consciousness come. Its effectiveness as well as practice could have with difficulty, in the current state of things, the goal of an action, of a global and inexorable battle against the forces that stand for sweeping away what little that still remains of true European tradition. In fact, it could so happen that, as an opposing party, an international of the Right could exist, organized and equipped with strength like the communists. Now, unfortunately we know that through the lack of men of high stature and sufficient authority, for the predominance of party interests and small ambitions, for the lack of true principles and not through the lack of intellectual courage, a unitary alignment of the Right so far has not been possible to be constituted not even in our Italy and that only recently have initiatives of this type been announced.

Posted on 2012-11-05 by Cologero

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Cologero on 2012-11-05 at 21:34 said:

Since this essay was written, there has been no progress on this proposed task. The historiography of the left is accepted as obviously true: to wit, history, or at least modern history, has

been the progressive growth of knowledge, freedom, and tolerance; it has overcome a series of enslavement, oppression, and discrimination.

Opposed to this, Evola expresses the counter-view of Tradition. Modern history has been the decline from a spiritual, heroic, hierarchical civilization to a materialist, undifferentiated, meaningless existence. The cause is the "degeneration of castes".

He assumes that current events will be understood in this light, at least by the few who are up to this task. Are there any takers?

Nowhere, even with the micro-surge in the interest in Tradition in some quarters, is such an historiography being written. I assume the global right that Evola referred to was GRECE, or the New Right as it is more commonly called. Unfortunately, the perspective of this movement is far from what Evola is describing here.

Mihai on 2012-11-06 at 04:47 said:

Here is part of a comment I wrote elsewhere concerning the new right:

"The new-right claims to abhor modernity's reduction of everything to quantity and to promote quality and principles. Yet, their methods are as quantitative as those of the left and they believe that the key to victory is to "convince" as many people as possible and to have greater numbers than their leftist opponents. It seems that, for the new-right, the way to quality is to have the largest quantity on its side. Perplexing.

Last, but not least: The new-right claims to stand for solid principles and a superior vision of life. Yet, reading the likes of Alain de Benoist one only finds there a curious mixture of "rightist" jargon, a few Nietzschean slogans perpetuated mechanically, some vulgarized ideas from Evola and loads of mystifications.

Worst of all, the new-right is greatly infiltrated by all sorts of pathetic neo-paganisms, crowleyan occultisms, new-agey type of naturalism and, worst of all, darwinian evolutionism, this last being the main pillar on which the modern mentality is built.

Now I do not doubt that this right that is at stake here may, in the future, gain some political support and even find itself in a position of power. Fortunes are always changing. But then what? Are we to replace the current lie with some even more dangerous half-truths? Because this is what the so-called "principles" of the new-right amount to. And then we'll replace the caprice of the mass and of the lowest common denominator with the caprice of a single individual or that of a small circle of a pseudo-elite. Nazism was something like this, to be honest.

Graham on 2012-11-06 at 11:41 said:

Plinio Correa de Oliveira's 'Revolution and Counter-Revolution' could serve, at least, as a starting point for such a project.

aperion on 2012-11-10 at 18:40 said:

GRECE is old news, the manifestations of the “New Right” (both in Europe and in the U.S) have come a long way and are open to ideas aligning with Tradition. what’s more is that there is an audience for this material. What is lacking is leadership, outreach and the willingness to get knee deep in the mud by engaging with people both real and online. Evola hints at the prospects of networking with sympathizers in MATR (or what was politically possible at that time), as it is true that men are more often won over by example then sterile dialectical intercourse.

Now the time has come for Cologero to begin such a historiography of the Right, in a publishable print format.

Ulysses on 2016-11-06 at 15:03 said:

“Are there any takers?”

I had been trying to write a book titled “Catholicism and the Causation of the Modern Deviation”, but I didn’t have the necessary knowledge. By the time I do inshaAllah, I may have a new title, like “Genghis Khan and the Making of the Modern World”. <https://www.amazon.com/Genghis-Khan-Making-Modern-World/dp/B005D60U0C>

Cologero on 2019-06-26 at 19:53 said:

That’s not at all on the “right track” ... there is nothing about the “third dimension” of history.

Stay away from Bolton, or else stay away from here.

2.13 The Defeat and the Future of France

The following essay by **Julius Evola** was published as “La disfatta e il futuro dell Francia secondo l’Action Française” in *La Vita Italiana*, in April 1942. Due to its length, it will be posted in two installments.

This essay may be of historical interest to some, since, given that history is written by the victors, it offers a rare glimpse into the thinking of the losing sides in World War II. Evola is reviewing a book by Maurras that deals with the quick and humiliating defeat of France by the Germans.

There are recurring themes that repeat today. First of all, Maurras distinguishes between the real and the legal countries¹¹; the first is organic, consisting of those elements who embody the soul of France and the latter a strictly legal entity comprised of all those inhabiting a geographic area. Maurras derives many of his concepts from Medieval social theory. If contemporary Catholics are embarrassed by this, it is only because they are preaching a different religion.

Maurras points to partisan interests and party politics as a cause of weakness. We will simply point out, as does Maurras¹², that Right without the force to back it up is worthless. There are advantages to winning and consequences to losing. In the second part of this essay, Evola will develop his own critique of Maurras.

First part In a recently published book that quickly reached its 29th edition, Charles Maurras sought to penetrate the meaning and the causes of the tragic destiny that weighed on his country if only to indicate the ways along which France will be able in the future to bring itself back and restore itself, drawing solutions from the hard trial. *La seule France, Chronique des jours d'épreuve*, France alone, Chronicle of the days of trial, 1941 We believe it is not lacking interest, for our readers, to reproduce the principle theses of this book, given the personality of its author.

First of all, about the causes of the disaster. There are internal and external causes. Regarding the internal causes, Maurras flatly opposes the thesis of those who speak of a morally degraded France, physically degenerated, and decayed military virtues. The country of Joan of Arc, who already overcame the trial of 1914, should have been able to demonstrate, not less than any other nation, Germany included, the possibilities of a national exaltation of a heroic impulse. About this last point, in a

¹¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Maurrassisme#A_political_model_based_on_the_Real_Country.22.28pays_r.C3.A9el.29

¹²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=5247>

special chapter, Maurras remembers, on the contrary, a series of cases of warrior and heroic virtues of the French army, recognized, in this war, by the enemy himself, but demonstrated sporadically and in disparate circumstances, through the lack of all the conditions of a not unequal battle.

After making the distinction between the *real country* and the *legal country*, Maurras instead believes that he indicates the principle internal cause of the French defeat in the split and, then, the division and denationalization between these two countries. The natural resources of France will be divided through the split nature of its own government. While in Germany, a political factor that united and multiplied every force had the upper hand, in France an similar factor served only to break it up: power was in the hand of politicians dedicated to parliamentary discussions and chaotic successions: fifty ministers in twenty years and one hundred ten in seventy years. Moreover, this government was something superimposed on the real country, having in view mostly the interests of the part and the party—apart from the influences of international powers—than those of the nation. So while in Germany there was an intensive culture of patriotism, in France it was always more neglected and rhetorical. While in Germany there was an improvement and a concentration of all the forces of the State, in France there was deliquescence and dislocation.

Maurras was opposed to the idea that authoritarianism would be something German:

In the country of Louis XIV and Richelieu the concentration of the State would have been equally conceived and pursued according to a model of the most straightforward and most original French method.

The principle internal cause of the French disaster would therefore be in that. But, to tell the truth, Maurras forgot that the French recovery

of 1914 happened even without such conditions, having instead democratic and parliamentary France as its antecedents. Therefore other causes are also looked for: that Maurras forebodes when he speaks of the “constructed” character of the French war and indirect powers that determined it, by means of a type of hypnosis exercised on public opinion, after all those national elements that would have been able to oppose the manoeuvre were paralyzed. According to Maurras, it would have been up to the French nationalists to prevent the war in 1935, during the period of sanctions, then in 1936-1937 on the occasion of Spain and in September 1938, on the occasion of the Czechoslovakian crisis. But in August 1939 all the measures were taken to prevent public opinion from being influenced in a direction contrary to what was wanted: seven or eight days before the declaration of war a decree was issued that “blocked” the press and authorized the immediate suppression of all these newspapers that intended to oppose the warmongering tendencies. “What is visible in this war,” Maurras writes:

... is the constant progress of a plan, the development of a patiently hatched plot, to attract a herd of idiots in the trap constructed by the wicked... the declaration of war of September 3 was obtained on the basis of everything there is in the *demos* that is soft, vain, empty, absent, and nonexistent; it had to cross—and it crossed—the empty spaces of hesitation, imbecility, incoherence, and a more than animal stupidity: mineral—that of the billiard ball and whatever other heavy body provided with any mobility.

If the origin of such a declaration of war

was covered by vapours so sooty, it is fated that it was so rapidly dissipated.

Then, the lack of reaction of the national French soul after the first moment and, especially, after the first period of the listless and only nom-

inal war on the Maginot line. If we could oppose to that, that the awakening would nevertheless have had to be manifested once that, France being at this point at war, its national territory was directly threatened, Maurras indicates, here, the other technical and external causes relative to the French military unpreparedness and English treachery.

For example, he points out a typical case of deceit to the country. In the Chamber, with respect to aerial armaments, an engineer made a display showing that against 4000 German aeroplanes, the French could oppose only 800 and almost all of them fighters. The Head of the Government and the Minister of Air rushed to deny this assertion, demonstrating that the French air potential was instead about 2300 aircraft—making use however of inexact data, and referring simply to “naked” aeroplanes, far from being functional. Moreover, it counted on the help of the “English aviation power”. This is one of the many cases of the blindness and irresponsibility that, from the technical side, had a great weight in the French catastrophe, so that Maurras speaks of a true betrayal of the leaders vis-a-vis the French nation, except the remaining military honor.

Maurras held the idea that the only path that an intelligent and national government in France should have taken, especially after the events of 1938, was that of Rome. He accused France of not having followed the real national interests, but of being left to take part in a mere ideological war. It should have been clear that France was not able to do anything at all for Poland. Also suddenly initiating a serious war on the Maginot line, that would have been, says Maurras, to try to break through a wall with one’s head to help someone who was being assassinated outside of it. Other accusations were made in regard to the advance in Belgium, something that again would have obeyed suggestions of the English, concerned to maintain the coasts of the English Channel, more than the true strategic reasons for the French defense.

On all these points we cannot therefore be fully in agreement with Maurras. The way toward Rome, for France, would have been possible

only in the supposition of a preliminary upheaval in the national sense, at least to not reduce the whole to a simple compromise with its precise mental reservations. But in spite the efforts of Action Française and similar organizations, in France there was not ever a trace of such an upheaval, the predominant mentality being in fact far from the ideas of Fascist renewal. So as things stand, one cannot dispute that those who wanted to give to the war an essentially ideological character are not right—from their point of view, naturally. It is useless to hide it: sooner or later, with the front line of the democracies, plutocracies, and Bolshevism, it should have come to daggers. A new Monaco in 1939 would have only meant a new respite. Given the direction of the dynamism of the “fascist” nations, we believe it is difficult that it would have been able to reach a true and durable pattern of balance without a violent solution and to give Europe a new shape.

The intervention of France, therefore, in my opinion, returns perfectly to the logic of those who were leading it, at least as to the legal country, if not the real country. From such a point of view, a Frenchman should instead have accused the indefensible and incomprehensible blunders that the democratic front committed, beginning with Versailles, in the sense of not taking all the measures to thereby prevent the enemies from being revived. Instead of taking it, for ideological reasons and essentially for masonic and anti-traditional hatred against the Hapsburg Empire, it should have sought to dismember Germany and, at the time of the occupation of the Ruhr, to act without hesitation. Step by step, the demo-masonic front instead allowed the enemy to gather strength. Therefore, the only reasonable accusation to make, instead, would be that which, after arriving at 1939 and having “swallowed” the annexation of Austria, the division of Czechoslovakia, the weakening of the Little Entente¹³, and the definitive strengthening of the Axis Powers, it was by that time too late to do anything with the assurance of success: it was

¹³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Little_Entente

rather, especially for France, heading for suicide, because of the instinctive reaction awakened by an anxiety complex.

Second part This is Part II of the essay by **Julius Evola** that was published as “La disfatta e il futuro dell Francia secondo l’Action Française” in *La Vita Italiana*, in April 1942.

This piece is of historical interest since the issues in 1941 are still in play in 2013. We also get an “inside” look at certain thought processes when both Evola and Maurras expected victory for their side. Philippe Pétain and Charles Maurras had been well respected figures in France before the war but then ended their days in disgrace.

The scission in France referred to was between two generals: Charles de Gaulle and Pétain, the former representing the Republic and cosmopolitanism and the latter, identitarianism. I don’t know the specific features of the laws against the Jews; unfortunately, neither Evola nor Maurras admits that France was under the thumb of Germany, so that France’s internal “Jewish problem” was more far-reaching as many were sent off to concentration camps. This policy resulted in the discrediting of identitarian movements to this day as they stoke up that very real fear.

Defeat has consequences, so the victory of the Allies has established republican and cosmopolitan values as the default position of the West. Jewish and Masonic values are now considered part of the mainstream of Western thought and beyond debate. The third element, that of foreign immigration, is still contestable, although the opposition is weak and unconvincing.

The words must have stuck in his throat, since Evola could not quite name the “spiritual and traditional authority”. On the other hand, I doubt anyone in the Vatican II church would be happy to know that the Catholic Church was at the spiritual center of Vichy France. This shows how much the spirit of the church

has changed in the intervening 70 years, since it was then considered compatible with nationalism. Although it is now more cosmopolitan and its sophisticated social teachings are now little more than “Marxism light”, this has not led to more acclaim by the modern world as the architects of Vatican II had hoped, but instead has led to its marginalization.

However, that does not prevent what Maurras documents and says about English politics, which had not the least regard for French interests, from being completely fair. Maurras takes a truncated position against De Gaulle. He, on the contrary, dedicates a chapter to demonstrate that England, basically, continued to be even in more recent times, in spite of appearances, the enemy of France, jealous of its colonial empire: it has always done everything to impede them from taking the rank that was due to them. Maurras fears that England seeks to exploit the French disaster to realize definitively their hidden ambitions, indeed making use from De Gaulle for this end, and stoking the internal French schism by every means.

For this reason, Maurras exhorts his compatriots to convince themselves of the absolute necessity of an internal concentration on the government of Marshall Petain as conditions for any recovery of France, after such a hard and tragic experience. So he devotes the second part of his book to highlighting and developing everything that the new Government tried to do. Maurras, although a realist, is pro Petain, because he eventually moved to establish a personal, national, authoritarian government, saved from parliamentary bedlam. France must, in that way, rediscover the true idea of the State: the State connected to the real country, freed from international influences, strong and disciplined, but against every leveling centralization.

Having such a State in mind, Petain had already begun to act to return France to the French: and here Maurras illustrated the new laws intended to build a dam against the influx of foreigners, metics, and im-

migrants that previously had found in France a type of promised land. Laws against Jews and Masons followed. Regarding the Jews, Maurras made the French point of view clear: they do not originate from an anti-semitic hatred, but from the fact that a Jew can only be considered to be an alien, who as such cannot be equated to the citizens of a country and moreover must accept the conditions that are imposed on whoever desires to be a guest. Maurras however correctly observes that French legislation on the Jews conveys mainly a juridical point of view, inspired by effects more than by causes: Maurras' central point is to understand that a style and a hereditary mentality, a tradition and indelible custom will always make the Jewish substance something inassimilable and corrosive. Maurras recalls that France seized a large number of significant Jewish refugees, starting with the five Rothschilds. It advanced a sensible proposition: to appropriate such fortunes for the restructuring of rural debt, i.e., of those contracted or to contract for the acquisition and cultivation of land. That would mean to strengthen the class which more must be counted on for the reconstruction of a nation. As to the anti-masonic battle, Maurras brings to light the danger inherent in proceeding, in this regard, with a direct and practical action, extremely difficult where it is about a secret association. They can have effective results when they have complete possession of the State. As Mussolini did, only then will it be able to little by little paralyze the Masonic influence. The first step, i.e., the formal prohibition of Masonry, was already accomplished by France. What followed is:

to promote a moral publicity without rest and carry everywhere
the tip of its fire.

Maurras then alludes to social reforms: the question naturally arises the reconciliation of classes and social justice. But, in this regard, Maurras also makes a rather appropriate point:

If the protection of the poor is the natural duty of the State—when is not exercised spontaneously by some powers worthy of their strength—it must however also defend isolated, but just, powers against certain coalitions of “the poor” who gain an enormous voice, capable of crushing everything under the darkest and most brutal tyranny.

And France, which first had the Revolution (revolution, says Maurras correctly—is still so stupid to be called French, being instead the most cosmopolitan of all of them), has from historical experience everything that it needs in order to understand, better than any other nation, the timeliness of a similar warning.

After some other specific points, Maurras addresses the reform of education in France, indicating what was already done and what still is to be done. The fundamental need is that the State in France is made truly father of its schools by proceeding systematically in the formation of a new mentality in the next generations. In our opinion, this is really the crucial point, on which almost everything else depends. The French mentality still needs to be detoxified from the deleterious effects of ideology, which in that country has existed for a while and had a characteristic diffusion, in width as in depth. And that, in good measure, must happen through the schools.

Maurras indicates here correctly a point that, in the current state of reform, was not sufficiently considered; i.e., that which is not limited to a more or less autonomous moral teaching, but at whose center the principle of a spiritual and traditional authority is returned, the only one that can make well understood all the errors and deviations in which France has incurred: the return to the classical spirit, the battle against romanticism and humanitarianism, the decisive antithesis to the Revolution and all the phenomena of degeneration, decadence, and anarchy that were its consequences.

In one point of his book Maurras develops some rather important

considerations in connection to the idea that the French disaster of 1940 seems to be the ultimate effect of a chain of causes that go back far in time and of that only some are of general rule.

The mass that constitutes an avalanche is formed of sand and stone coming from the most various rocks, something that however does not prevent the observer from understanding the small movement or the smallest human push that detached the first lump of snow—thus, before the evidence of any accusing traces (an impression of human finger), before the still visible trajectory of any suspicious footprint (explicitly oriented, clearly directed), the watchful eye discovers in the right point the impulse and the form of a criminal act—that waits only to be identified with the name of its author.

This is an observation which demonstrates, in Maurras, the right orientation to truly deepen the secret history of his country and therefore even to identify the premises of a true reconstruction. Here we are in the area of what we call the “science of subversion”: in regard to which perhaps no country in the world offers such precious research material, as does France.

If we have to indicate any defect in Maurras’ book, it is that it does not touch at all the problem of the new European order and the corresponding supernational arrangement. We can well understand, in Maurras, the need connected to the formula: *France alone first*—he himself indicates as much its provisional nature, when he says that, if there is going to be a European “concert”, it is first necessary to make France able to play its part in it. But this image makes clear exactly the gap noted: a single part can be played correctly only by taking the movements from the central motif of an entire symphony. We therefore propose to French nationalism the further task of also taking this point into account and proceeding to an action of mental formation in the sense, as soon as the more immediate needs of reconstruction and internal recovery are realized.

Posted on 2012-11-19 by Aeneas

* * *

Logres on 2012-11-20 at 12:47 said:

De Gaulle gained his authority from being in charge of one of the few military counter-successes against the Germans, which actually happened at a few points – French arms were not inferior to Germans, whose military equipment was not at all overwhelmingly superior. Does Maurras have thoughts about De Gaulle? France is still a strange country – on the one hand, they banned the burka, but on the other, seem willing to tolerate the multicultural hordes seeping into their body politic today. One can't help but think that the Allies were punished for their open support of the Red cause in Spain during that terrible civil war, for spreading bloodshed amongst the Catholics, who were really fighting for their lives (although Franco wasn't exactly a solar king).

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-20 at 17:53 said:

This is indeed a very interesting piece and I thank Cologero for the translation.

In reading it my sympathies tend toward Maurras' thesis and not Evola's criticisms... this line struck me "Given the direction of the dynamism of the "fascist" nations, we believe it is difficult that it would have been able to reach a true and durable pattern of balance without a violent solution and to give Europe a new shape." Is Evola advocating aggressive warfare ? Not only is intra-Christian warfare morally wrong, it's also stupid when Russia was looming to swoop in and enslave all to pick fights over modern borders. If he really wanted a heroic sacred war, a new crusade, why not call on all Europeans and men of Tradition to unite as one and take up arms to destroy Communism ? The success of Spain & Portugal showed that neutrality was an option for France. An acquaintance of mine who is very much in the know told me once that if Italy had stayed neutral, she would have emerged the strongest nation in Europe after the war and fascism would have been extremely attractive then to all the ruined nations... .. the way I see it, allowing the Protestant nations to blow themselves up while the Catholic nations rested in peace would have made a far more fruitful world from a Traditional standpoint.

Franco was a hero, the living example of a dictator in Donoso Cortes's thoughts – a man who acts with power to hold back the tide.

What Catholics are criticising Gornahoor ? I haven't seen anything here that contradicts the magisterium of the Church. If you mean Modernists you must remember that they are not Catholics, they are heretics and condemned by Catholic dogma. Even if he wears a mitre if a man teach error he is a heretic and a true Catholic must stand up to defend the Faith.

Logres on 2012-11-20 at 18:46 said:

Several Catholics have argued & then left the site over what can only be described, the best I could tell, as a refusal of Cologero to speak certain phrases, or refrain from making other suggestions. This despite all efforts being made to accommodate. But that's my perspective, & I didn't follow it closely.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-20 at 19:05 said:

I can not speak for others, but I am a Catholic and find nothing in Gornahoor that opposes the Faith.

Cologero on 2012-11-20 at 23:42 said:

De Gaulle was earlier associated with Action Francaise. Obviously, the war separated them, Maurras becoming a collaborator and de Gaulle the leader of the Free French.

There is an important point made in this piece, and its consequences will be clear in the second part. Was the war to serve French national interests or was it an ideological war. Petain, and Maurras supported him, saw it the first way and implemented policies whose purpose was to promote and protect French interests. However, in retrospect, we see WW II as an ideological battle, viz., as a war of the free democracies (good) against totalitarian Fascism (evil). This view still dominates the self-understanding of the West to this day. Thus, we will see that Petain's policies were reprehensible by today's standards. Mircea Eliade reminds us of the eternal return and we will how this ideological war is still being played out in Europe and North America. To understand this essay will be to understand what is happening today.

Cassiodorus on 2013-02-03 at 14:30 said:

Off topic... Has anyone seen the recent debate between William Lane Craig and the atheist philosopher Alex Rosenberg at Purdue university?

It seems to me that Craig soundly defeated yet another representative of our free-thinking sophisticated intellectual elite.

Cologero on 2013-02-04 at 12:39 said:

Will all due respect, Cassiodorus, I'd prefer to stay on topic, although I see there is little interest in this topic.

As for that "debate", we can't even accept its premises. There is a distinction between philosophy (or what counts for it now) and metaphysics (at least what it used to mean). The former like "debate", the later prefers knowledge. So it is not a question of proving a "reasonable belief in God, but rather in "knowing" God, as the catechism says.

Keep in mind that there can be no "rules" for a debate such as those proposed, other than to be logical and keep your facts straight. A termination point must be agreed to otherwise there is endless chatter. Decision is necessary. Has any participant in similar debates suddenly

"resigned" by being convinced by his opponent? No, these debate are more like chariot races with their fans taking sides before the first word is even spoken.

Another point is that the participants make a career out of such debates; that makes them more like sophists than true philosophers. As for Mr. Craig, we don't accept the existence of the being he calls "God" anyway (at least as far as I understand him), so I don't know how he can "win". Consult *this*: <https://edwardfeser.blogspot.com/2009/11/william-lan-e-craig-on-divine-simplicity.html>, for example.

Jason-Adam on 2013-02-04 at 13:25 said:

I find it interesting that Evola finds himself in accord ultimately with Maurras and he does see nationalism in a positive light as a necessary first step in the battle against subversion. Quite a contrast from de Benoist's critique of nationalism which while correct vis a vis the concept of the empire winds up supporting the communist destruction of all identity.

Cologero on 2013-02-04 at 17:50 said:

True, Jason-Adam, Evola's only objection is that Maurras did not address the question of a super-national arrangement, although it is not clear to me what Evola himself may have had in mind. Perhaps Evola was not familiar with Maurras' 1922 essay on Latinity which did address that question.

I really am not familiar with Benoist's critique. What I don't see among the neo-pagans is how they address the issue of the spiritual and traditional authority which must be at the heart of any future return to Tradition; this would order the socio-economic systems. Does Benoist have a complete socio-economic position of his own?

Jason-Adam on 2013-02-04 at 20:52 said:

De Benoist has said that he is not a Traditionalist in the sense of believing in a *Philosophia Perennis* so it is puzzling that anyone could see him as a successor to Guenon or Evola.

He supports direct democracy and has stated that democracy is part of the Greco-Roman pagan tradition which Christianity destroyed so puts him right in line with the anti-mediaeval critique of the modern world and against the aristocratic conservatism of a de Maistre or Cortes which Evola supported.

I think the main similarity between Evola and de Benoist is simply their Germanophilia, other than that they are widely divergent thinkers.

Logres on 2013-02-04 at 21:12 said:

It's interesting that the neo-pagans and the proto-Fascists, despite having abundant intellectual energies and keen insight into certain aspects of Modernity, as well as having a will to resist, have not been able to coordinate among themselves an effective consensus, except at the

highest intellectual levels (Evola, Maurras, etc., who all read each one another), and that decades ago. It's almost as if the impetuous rush towards Chaos in the energies of Modernism has infected the adherents of these insightful and courageous intellectual giants. I really need to find more translations of Maurras in English. Especially the essay on Latinity (which is probably not available in ghetto-English). It might be worthwhile to define the "Classicism" of France (and also Europe) as something over against the supposed "Classicism" (or Republicanism/Grecianism) that dominated the events of 1789. Evola seems to allude to that in his "material for study" remark concerning those events.

Cassiodorus on 2013-02-05 at 16:27 said:

Cologero,

I basically agree with you. I am certainly no proponent of theistic personalism; It's definitely the classical theism of the Thomist for me. As far as the "debates" go, I have mixed feelings. Of course, you're quite right about the "chariot races". Nevertheless, I think Craig's efforts can bear some good fruit. To hear an analytical "philosopher" effectively challenge the "default" modern worldview of materialism and relativism in large public venues could be persuasive for our largely agnostic culture.

Cologero on 2013-02-06 at 07:33 said:

Maybe you know something I don't, but I don't see these debates persuading anyone. There may be some poaching at the margins in both directions, but no large scale movements. To change the default modern worldview would require a change in body biochemistry which is more than an argument is capable of. Now all Craig tries to do is to show that belief in his god is "reasonable". However, I don't think his belief is reasonable at all ... it is too close to a "Mr God" or even to the Mormon conception.

What may be more useful is a series of debates between Feser and Craig ... effort is better spent at this time, I think, to reduce the number of heretics rather than to convert the heathens.

Cassiodorus on 2013-02-06 at 11:37 said:

A series of debates between Craig and Feser- Yes! That would be excellent. In fact, I think some folks have even suggested that on Feser's blog. Cologero, I have taken note that the Aristotelian-Thomistists practically short circuit when the Divine Principle of "beyond-being" is brought into the conversation. I've been reading David Bentley Hart lately in an effort to understand the exact nature of the "dispute" between the Christian West and East.

Cassiodorus on 2013-02-06 at 11:40 said:

Did I say, Thomistists? Wow.

Cologero on 2013-02-06 at 23:06 said:

Cassiodorus, perhaps you can comment on this: *Orthodoxy and Aquinas*¹⁴

Cassiodorus on 2013-02-07 at 14:50 said:

I'll check it out.

Many thanks!!!

Jason-Adam on 2013-02-08 at 15:08 said:

The book on Orthodoxy and Aquinas is worthy of reading, it is quite the case that in the Middle Ages the eastern church was not so hostile towards Aristotle and scholasticism as one would expect, even the arch-anti-west Patriarch Gennadius was a strict Scholastic and hated the neo-platonism of Plethon.

This proves to me more and more that we can not understand developments in philosophy without understanding geopolitics. The Orthodox Church in Russia had to become anti-west in theology to justify Russia's sense of non-Europeanness and unique culture that is opposition to the west.

Which is why I question that, even if somehow Europe returned to Tradition, there would still be enmity between the 1st and 3rd Romes until one prevails.

2.14 Mohammed and Charlemagne

Julius Evola's review of the book "Mohammed and Charlemagne"
by Henri Pirenne, originally published in 1939.

People have often spoken of this book, especially since the recent release of the French edition: they attributed to him the merit of having upset the current idea of medieval civilization and its origins, thanks to his new and original views. This appreciation seems to us somewhat exaggerated. Certainly, we believe strongly that a history of the Middle Ages and its origins still needs to be written, given the numerous deformations and misunderstandings due to the rationalist and secularizing mentality

¹⁴<https://easternchristianbooks.blogspot.com/2013/02/marcus-plested-on-orthodoxy-and-aquinas.html>

of last century, which continue to prevail today on this subject. But to tell the truth, it is not in that sense that the Belgian researcher brings us new lights, just the opposite: after having begun his studies in the atmosphere of the economist school, the source of the doctrine of historical materialism, Pirenne depicts a further enlargement of its horizons which still feels the effects of the fundamental limitations of that school. We therefore find again in him an inclination to consider as the determining historical cause what, in our opinion, can have value at most as an accidental cause, so that to emphasize the economic and incidental period, conferring on it the greatest weight in the genesis of the forms of civilization.

This is the fundamental thesis defended by Pirenne in this, his final, work. That admirable construction which was the Roman Empire had an essentially Mediterranean character. The Mediterranean was its base and center. The sea, in all the force of the name *Mare nostrum*, carried and spread ideas, religions, merchandise; it is the spiritual and material crucible of the North and the South, of the West and the East, under the sign of Rome, while the outer provinces are only a buffer against the Barbarians. The totality of life is concentrated on the shores of the great Roman lake. That said, according to Pirenne, the Germanic invasions did not put an end either to the Mediterranean unity of the ancient world, nor to what one can consider to be the essence of Roman civilization, as it still was in the fifth century, that is, an epoch where the Emperor of the West no longer existed. Byzantium/Constantinople assumes the patrimony of Rome as the Mediterranean capital. In spite of the havoc and diverse losses, that transfer did not determine the appearance of new guiding principles, neither in the economic order nor in the social order, nor in the state of the language, nor in those of the institutions. What remained of civilization was Mediterranean; civilization was conserved along the shores of the sea and it is from there that the new phenomena arise. The establishment of the Germanic barbarians in the Western provinces of the Empire produced nothing original; they did not intend

to destroy the Empire nor to exploit it. Far from despising it, they admired it. Starting from the time of their establishment, all the heroic and original traits of the barbarian character have disappeared, according to Pirenne, absorbed by the Roman and Byzantine lands. And again following Pirenne, it is a fable to say that the Germans brought their morality of the young people, that is, of the people in whose heart personal connections of fidelity won over those of respect towards the State and was opposed to the cosmopolitan corruption of ancient civilization. That is the opposite which was produced and was true: the barbarians masterly knew how to adapt themselves to the Byzantine corruption, even contributing to aggravating it. Their structures were secular, they did not furnish any spiritual support. Constantinople remains the equivalent of the fallen Roman center. In the year 600, the world did not take a qualitatively different appearance to what it had in the year 400, and that principally because of the survival of the Mediterranean character of that civilization. The rupture with ancient Tradition and the Middle Ages (as a new civilization) begins therefore later than what is commonly supposed.

It is not the barbarian invasions which constituted an instrument of action, but rather a new phenomenon: the appearance of Islam with its rapid and unexpected progression. The consequence was the separation of the East and the West and the end of Mediterranean unity. Some countries like Africa and Spain, which had continued to be part of western civilization gravitated from that moment around the orbit of Baghdad. Islam represents a new religion and a new, unassimilable, aggressive, and irreducible civilization. By becoming a Muslim lake, the western Mediterranean ceased to be the route of cultural and economic exchanges of the Roman-Byzantine world, and the West found itself blocked and constrained to live folded in on itself. It is thus that the axis of the life of the world was displaced from the Mediterranean towards the North: not because of the effectiveness of spiritual and racial factors, but essentially

as the result of that contingency. That provoked the crisis of the Merovingian regime, up until the appearance of a new dynasty originating from the Germanic countries of the North, the Carolingian dynasty. The pope was allied to it, detaching himself from the Emperor of the East, who, absorbed in the battle against the Muslims, was no longer in a position to sustain and protect him. A Rome detached from Byzantine could not avoid looking north. It is thus that the Church prepared the new order of things. It had assumed the symbol of Rome, and its authority became greater than the State, not succeeding in maintaining a strong centralized administration, it let itself be absorbed by feudalism which came to take on a particular importance, for the same reason of the paralysis of Mediterranean commerce and exchanges.

Dominated by the Church and feudalism, Europe is going to take on a new appearance. The Middle Ages begins in a birth which, according to Pirenne, occupies the century between 650 and 750. It was a period of anarchy where the ancient tradition was lost and where new elements got the upper hand. The evolution ceased in the year 800 which sealed the definitive rupture of the West and the East, the former giving itself a new Roman Germanic Empire, now detached from the old Roman Empire prolonged by Byzantium. It constituted a new civilization and a new civil community whose symbol and instrument was Carolingian Europe, on the base of a Germanic element Romanized by the Church. Even when political unity disappeared, there subsisted an international unity of civilization which was followed up to the Renaissance, an essentially Carolingian imprint.

These are the basic theses of Pirenne's book. This quick and easy note suffices to let the reader take account of the part that the materialist mentality and an extrinsic consideration of history plays in these theses. And, as always in similar cases, what could have been a necessary cause comes to be considered as the sufficient cause and as the *conditio sine qua non*, from which the aberrant deductions arise. "It is rigorously true,"

says Pirenne, "that without Mohammed, Charlemagne is inconceivable." We have here the image of physical determinism according to which, for example, a thrust contains exactly everything that can explain the movement to which it passively constrained the inert body which receives the brunt of it. Pirenne doesn't even seem to suspect the *active* causes of history.

The thesis asserted that the Roman event has survived much longer than believed in the invasion and the influence of the barbarians, that it had not disappeared at the end of the Empire but that the Mediterranean unity had continued to live, under the sign of Byzantium, from the fifth to the eighth century, before being finally swept by Islam, and certain flattering for us and something to please us.

But, as the translator correctly points out in the preface, in order to sustain that thesis, it is not necessary to look beyond the façade, that is, to stick to the social and administrative structure of the ancient world, because behind that beautiful relatively intact appearance is found the putrefaction or something else from which the seed of that putrefaction emanates. It is a fact that, in order to assure the survival of the Roman event, Pirenne deliberately confuses it with the Byzantine event. He believes totally seriously that the process of the Byzantification of the Mediterranean world, which is produced up to the time of the Arab invasion, was able to truly assume the validity of the longevity of the ancient heritage.

A heritage which, in fact, had already undergone a fundamental alteration with the Christianization of the Mediterranean world. In order to not take that alteration into account, the author is again constrained to limit his considerations to the exterior, hierarchical, and political part of the Church, neglecting the properly spiritual factor. In reality, the survival of the Mediterranean unity had only a material and economic character, circumstantial for the most part. And it is just for that reason that an equally contingent circumstance, like the Arab invasion and the control by the Muslims of the maritime routes of the Mediterranean, was

able to easily break it. That is in fact elsewhere than where one finds the positive forces preparing the coming of the new age, in which something of the purity of the ancient world had to truly survive invisibly.

One must certainly recognize, with Pirenne, the necessity of moving the date of the beginning of the Middle Ages, considered as a civilization having its own appearance, from the instant of the fall of the Western Empire to that of the creation of the Holy Roman German Empire – that is, to move it ahead at least three centuries. These three centuries don't have a well-defined appearance. One could qualify them as the centuries of the interregnum. They do not yet correspond to a specific type of civilization. It is no longer Antiquity, but not yet the new times. Pirenne is however incorrect in not presenting the forces in gestation which already exercise a muddled action, in order to take ascendancy afterwards. He can be agreeable to us to hear him affirm and to see him struggle to demonstrate that the Germanic races lost their characteristics during their long entry into the Roman world and were "Romanized". But from nothing he can take nothing. It is not necessary to forget that, for the author, Romanization has often, we repeat, the meaning of Byzantization, consisting of assuming the vices and corruption of Byzantine decadence. At the point that he considers that what happened under the dynasty of the new Romanized barbarian States in the western basin of the Mediterranean was the decadence of a decadence. The author emphasizes almost tendentiously that corrupted, or at least passive and negative, aspect in order to be able to note the purely formal survival of Antiquity, while he ignores, at least in appearance, what there was positive in it.

He purely political deduction of the birth of the Holy Roman Empire is totally insufficient: he can expound it only to some minds located under the narcosis of materialism applied to history. To underline a fundamental point, Pirenne insists, for example, on the purely secular and profane character of the States and dynasties characteristic of the Germanic races up to the end of the Merovingian period – it is only with the

Carolingians and by the intervention of the Church which itself had been pushed by considerations of propriety that the royal power had assumed a sacred character. A more inexact affirmation that it was founded on an ambivalence making him believe that secularism exists everywhere where there is no indirect consecration granted by a distinct organization, that is, by the Church. In the same perspective, it would be necessary to deny the sacred character to a great part of the theocratic powers of Antiquity, and today even to those of the Japanese sovereign. In all these cases, it is an effect of tradition that a dynasty given can be sacred in itself and for itself, in virtue of some enigmatic heredity or destiny. Now, Pirenne seems to not know that what had already appeared, at the time of the invasions, in numerous "barbarian" tribes: among the Goths, they called the kings *Asen* ("divine heroes") and *Amals* ("celestials") because they believed that in the difference from the other tribes (or *Sippen*), their line drew its origin from the mystical *Asgard* and that their blood was not of a human nature. Certainly, we find these traditions in a state of involution and degeneration in the course of the period that we have called the interregnum, but not at the point of preventing, under certain conditions, a resumption, an awakening, a galvanization. That is exactly what happened, thanks to the tradition already mentioned and to a certain heroic morality, when an historic conjuncture led to the formation of the Holy Roman Empire. Here, the Roman symbol was the common reference of a supernatural order proposed by Christianity, which acted, so to say, as a catalyst on the manifestation and the survival of spiritual and racial forces latent and diverted in the course of the preceding period of Byzantization. Without admitting that latent survival of forces which then had to blossom under the form of a civilization having many affinities with the first Aryan societies, including the primordial Roman society, one could then explain the conflict between the Empire and the Church, between the Roman Ghibelline symbol and the Roman symbol of the Guelph. Or then, in Pirenne's manner and of so many other myopic historians, one

will be obliged to explain that conflict only as the function of temporal interests and ambitions, thus missing the true essence of the conflict, the essence that we have often had the chance to bring to light in several of our works.

What it comes down to, if up until Mohammed the positive element had been only the Roman-Byzantium component, how does he explain that once the Mediterranean unity was swept away, the besieged West did not elaborate a civilization of the same type? Pirenne says that the Carolingians had no concern with a situation created from all pieces, but they drew parts from fortuitous circumstances, and that the coup d'état which replaced the Merovingian dynasty, the only one which survived after the invasions, is explained only by the closing of the Mediterranean by the Saracens. Even if he could truly justify such a coup d'état, that would never explain the genesis of the new type of civilization by which the Middle Ages took its own appearance and which, in its great political-social structures, reproduced essentially the distinctive traits of all the Aryan civilizations of Antiquity.

On this last point, one must likewise note that Pirenne expresses, it would only be incidentally, the judgments which would not receive our agreement: in his opinion, the passage of an almost cosmopolitan economy of exchange, credit and commerce, favored as it was by the Mediterranean routes, to an essentially agrarian and feudal economy which had to leave its imprint on medieval society properly called, signifies regression and decadence. For us, it is on the contrary the civilization not pursuing mercantile objectives which represents a value. And in that case also, the emergency provoked by the irruption of Islam in the Mediterranean acted like a stimulant, but not as a determining cause: as it happens, an exterior contingency served only to compel something superior, which was latent, to become manifest and take over. Beginning with the Carolingian period, the traffic of merchandise and commerce, with the mobility of riches, became the prerogative of the Jews, and only much later, that of

the new centers foreshadowing the democratic and oligarchic-bourgeois corruption, so that the healthiest and purest forces of Germanic-Roman Europe separated themselves and developed their possibilities in a normal direction characteristic of a heroic, differentiated, and spiritual civilization.

Posted on 2016-02-28 by Cologero

Excerpts from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*

3.1 Against the Neopagans

On the Internet, there is an essay, attributed to Julius Evola, going by the title of “Against the Neopagans.” Since it has been so widely disseminated, it is impossible to know its source or the motivation behind it. In fact, it is the translation into English from the German translation of three chapters in *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*. After Italy’s ill-fated alliance with Germany in the late 30s, Mussolini felt compelled to come up with a racial policy to match that of Germany; previously, neither racism nor anti-semitism had been part of Fascist ideology.

Since Evola had been critical of German racial theories, Mussolini authorized the translation of Evola’s book into German *Grundrisse des Faschistischen Rassenlehre* as representing the Fascist position on race. I’ve compared the two versions and it seems the translation was not exact, but rather tendentious. Understandably, it leaves out passages that would only be of interest to Italians. What is more interesting, however, is that it omits passages that portrayed German thinkers in a negative light. For

example, these three paragraphs are omitted:

Regarding the anti-ascetic prejudice of neo-paganism , we already said: neo-paganism redoubles the incomprehension demonstrated by Nietzsche. The Aryan would not have known asceticism in the normal way: his true mysticism would have been on this side: he would never have thought about a supernatural fulfillment of the personality.

Superstitions, residues of the dark ages or of Etruscan magic, lies and instruments for the tactic of temporal dominion of the clergy selling indulgences: that how they regarded everything that is a sacrament, rite or supernatural power. This shows they do not know that all of the life of ancient, Aryan, and specifically pagan Roman, civilization always had a ritual character, the rite accompanying every form of collective and individual life, not in the sense of an empty ceremony, but as the instrument of a real connection between human and supernatural forces. Opposed to that, H S Chamberlain attributed to the Aryan spirit the conquests proper to the so-called free thought and modern profane science.

Naturally, when one believes that Lutheranism represented an awakening of the spirit of the Nordic race see *Foundations of the 19th Century* instead of representing, as it in fact did, the inducement for a further spiritual involution of the race and to a large extent its semitization: *incomprehension can only be added to more incomprehension*. Thus there was something ingenuous, as Guenon rightly noted, in the scandal that Protestantism felt when faced with the claim of infallibility that, in the order of transcendental knowledge (in the West, we say: in matters of “faith”) was accepted pacifically by ancient Aryan civilizations not for one man alone, as in Catholicism, but **for every member belonging legitimately to the brahman, that is, the “solar caste” of spiritual leaders.**

Posted on 2011-03-26 by Cologero

3.2 The Misunderstanding of Paganism

In order to illustrate some of the points made recently, we have invited an old friend, Tony Ciapo, to provide translations, with commentary, of some of Evola's works from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, *Defesa della razza*, and Evola's commentary on the Fascist movements of the first half of the 20th century. By exploring certain movements from the perspective of Tradition—which are far from any modernist misunderstandings—we expect to point who are in **Solidarity** with the few remaining men of Tradition left today and which viewpoints are in **Continuity** with Tradition itself. Tony will continue this task as long as interest is expressed and intelligent discussion ensues. The initial section is the fourth in the chapter “La razza aria e il problema spirituale”. His commentaries will appear inside boxes or between square brackets. There is no implication that either Evola or myself would have accepted all such.

The Misunderstanding of the new racist Paganism Having made the problem clear in such a way, it is perhaps appropriate to point out the misunderstanding—a misunderstanding of no small moment—characteristic of those contemporary extremist racist currents that believe that have resolved it in terms of a neopaganism. Such a misunderstanding, in truth, is already apparent precisely in the use of terms such as “pagan” and “paganism”. We ourselves had at one point adopted them and sincerely regret it.

This section follows the section “Ex Occidente Lux — The Religious Problem” (to be translated next), which is alluded to in the first sentence. There he discusses Catholicism, in particular its

teaching of a primordial revelation of the Fathers. Attentive readers of Gornahoor will recall that Catholicism regards itself as the latest manifestation of the primordial religion. Evola digs deeper to the pre-Christian religion of the **Ancient City**, whose lineaments we have been at pains to point out. In order to avoid the ambiguities and attendant misunderstandings of the term “paganism”, we will henceforth refer to it as the “**Old Religion**”. It should be obvious that the “contemporary currents” he opposes include the amalgam of racism and neopaganism associated with the theoreticians of National Socialism. There is no need to name names, as Evola means all of them. The book he sincerely regrets is Pagan Imperialism.

Certainly the word, *paganus*, appears in ancient Latin writers such as Livy with no special purpose. But this does not alter the fact that with the arrival of the new faith, the word *paganus* took on a decidedly pejorative meaning, adopted for use in early Christian apologetics. *Paganus* derives from *pagus*, meaning a village or slum, so that *paganus* means what is characteristic of a country hick or an uncultured, primitive man. In order to profess and glorify the new faith, a certain Christian apologetics, following the vice of overvaluing themselves through the discrediting of others, proceeded to a systematic and often conscious disparagement and misrepresentation of almost all the earlier doctrines, forms of worship, and traditions, which were made to correspond to the combined and pejorative designation “paganism”. Naturally, with this goal, it took care to highlight everything that, in the pre-Christian religions and traditions, lacked any normal or primordial character, rather than the clear significance of degenerate and decadent forms. Such a polemical *animus* then led, in particular, to attributing indiscriminately an anti-Christian character to everything that, prior to Christianity, could also simply be non-Christian and could not constitute an irreducible antithesis.

Evola is making the point that the Old Religion, much older

than Christianity, was not, and could not be, explicitly anti-Christian. Therefore, we have to distinguish the former from the paganism prevalent at the beginning of Christianity. By then the Old Religion had been largely forgotten and even when its rites and traditions were followed, it was done with little understanding. The Roman priesthood had been reduced to a formalism, while the aristocrats were more likely to adopt one of the many prevalent Greek philosophies or dabble in the so-called mysteries. As was recently pointed out, it was the plebs, initially without a religion, who were the “pagans” of the era. The first Christians came either from among the Hellenized Jews or the Romans who had converted to Judaism whether formally or by adopting their beliefs and ways. (Note that the Judaism at the time was quite different from the contemporary religion that goes by that name.) These would have been predominantly the third caste working as artisans, traders, and other pecuniary occupations.

Of course, the neopagans, following Nietzsche, now return the favor, by claiming it was really the Christians who were the “hicks”. Such mutual name-calling is unhelpful and pointless. Instead, *pace* the early apologists and neopagans, we follow **Valentin Tomberg**’s Hermetic maxim, *we must love our pagan past*, provided we understand by that the Old Religion.

On such a basis, it is therefore necessary to think that there is a “paganism”, meaning something essentially and tendentiously constructed. That is, it lacks any true correspondence to historical reality. We mean, correspondence to what the pre-Christian and especially Aryan world always was in its “normal” forms, and not only in decadent aspects or that were refashioned from the degenerate residues of older civilizations or inferior races.

Recommended background material:

Fustel’s *The Ancient City* is, by his own admission, indispensable

to understanding what Evola means by the pre-Christian Tradition.

For the history of the Early Christians and Jews, I rely upon the works of **Ernest Renan**.

Neopaganism and Naturalism Keeping all this in mind, we come today to discover a peculiar paradox: to wit, such a paganism never even existed but was constructed by Christian apologetics. Yet some “pagan” and anti-Christian movements of racism and extreme nationalism very frequently accept it, thus threatening to make it become true today for the first time in history. No more and no less than that.

This critique is devastating. Instead of recovering the primordial religion of their ancestors, these neopagans are adopting a caricature of that religion. It is obvious that the primary characteristics of neopaganism (anti-Christian, racism, nationalism) had no analog in ancient times and are purely anachronisms.

What are the principle traits of the pagan outlook on life, as its apologists believe and popularize?

Naturalism First and foremost: **naturalism**. All transcendence is totally unknown to the pagan view of life. It would remain in a mixture of spirit and nature, in an ambiguous unity of body and soul. There is nothing to its religion but a superstitious deification of natural phenomena or the energies of the races, elevated as so many idols. From this, in the first place, a particularism, a polytheism conditioned by blood and soil. In the second place, an absence of the spiritual personality and freedom, a state of innocence that is simply characteristic of beings of nature, of those not yet awakened to any truly supernatural aspiration. This “innocence”: license, “sin”, and the delights of the flesh. Even in other domains,

either superstition, or a purely “profane”, materialistic, and fatalistic civilization. Apart from certain “anticipations” considered insignificant, it is with Christianity that the world of supernatural would be revealed for the first time, that is, the world of grace and personality, in contrast to “pagan” determinism and naturalism. With it a “catholic” ideal (in the etymological sense of universality) would be affirmed; a healthy dualism, permitting the subordination of nature to a higher law, and the triumph of the law of the spirit beyond the law of flesh, blood, and the false gods.

Here Evola identifies Naturalism as the primary trait of the neopagans. This is true for the most crude attempts at revival such as Wicca or Asatru, as well as the more sophisticated systems. To deny this, and thus to affirm supernaturalism, freedom, and personality, would draw neopaganism closer to Christianity, at least in a common metaphysical perspective. We should point out that Evola opposes Christianity on completely different grounds from those of the neopagans, who simply repeat the slogans of the Pharisees and the Enlightenment, sworn enemies of Tradition.

These are the most typical traits of the predominant conception of paganism, i.e., of everything that is not specifically the Christian worldview. Anyone who possesses any direct acquaintance with cultural and religious history, however elementary, can see how inaccurate and one-sided this attitude is. Besides, some early Church Fathers often demonstrated a greater understanding of the symbols and cults of preceding civilizations. Here we highlight just a few points.

Here Evola’s frustration is showing: even an elementary knowledge of history and religion would suffice to refute the bases of neopaganism, yet we cannot even count on that today. The Church Fathers showed a deeper understanding of the Old Religion than do our own neopagans. Regular readers of Gornahoor will find many references to this.

Posted on 2011-07-17 by Aeneas

* * *

Perennial on 2011-07-18 at 01:17 said:

Great stuff! Look forward to reading subsequent installments.

James O'Meara on 2011-07-19 at 23:42 said:

So, Evola rejected the crude "paganism" of an Alfred Rosenberg. Apart from already knowing that, what does all this effort provide me with? Even Hitler agreed "When the Greeks built temples, we were living in mud huts. Why does Himmler insist on digging all this up?" Evola collaborated with Nazi pagans, which the modern PC types will never accept, no matter what "distinctions" you can find. As far as 'racism' and 'true Christianity' go, the bottom line is that Evola would have sent M L King to a death camp without a second thought, so what have you proved about his "sophisticated" versions of racism, paganism and state power?

AS for "Evola regretted his book Pagan Imperialism," well, yes, he was unable to influence Mussolini so he turned to the Nazis, hoping to "rectify" Path of Cinnabar their crude racism and paganism. Again, Rachel Maddow isn't going to 'friend' him, so what's the point?

As for your sneers I won't call it a 'critique' against Nietzsche, Fred spoke about 'intellectual conscience.' Anyone with an intellectual conscience would point out that while Evola may have 'regretted' Pagan Imperialism, his last book, Ride the Tiger, is based on the idea that all honest modern thinkers 'intellectual conscience' again will take Nietzsche as their starting point. Since he lists Nietzsche as his most profound teenage influence, we can see that Evola was consistently Nietzschean from age 16 to his death. Now there's integrity!

BTW, my own reflections on Nietzsche, the Greeks and the function of religion can be found here:

<http://tinyurl.com/3glcsx9>

Cologero on 2011-07-20 at 00:02 said:

It takes considerable effort, James, to provide original translations and context to the masses. You could take the high road and thank us.

Perennial on 2011-07-20 at 00:36 said:

Goodness James, bit negative, are we not?

Aeneas on 2011-07-20 at 08:19 said:

Consistently a Nietzschean? Pas de tout! Evola writes in Cinnabar regarding the early influence of Nietzsche:

"He fed a basic tendency, even if in confused and partly distorted forms, therefore a mixture of positive and negative."

Evola also refers to the "ambiguous character of many view of Nietzsche".

Regarding Nietzsche's personal life, Evola attributed it to the "awakeing of the elemnt of transcendence without its conscious and active assuption." Evola refers to the ideal of the Superman as the "worst of Nietzsche."

So that is the worst of Evola, that he tries to be "hip" with references to Nietzsche, while admitting what a mixed bag he really is. Evola's position was to critique the false ideals of his time and Nietzsche served that purpose. That task having been accomplished, we at Gornahoor are delineating the characteristics a the Tradition to follow, where there is no need or room for Nietzsche. As for "intellectual integrity", a "scholar" needs to take into account the entire corpus of an author. We have access to thousands of pages of Evola that few "Evolians" bother to familiarize themselves with. Hence, we try to make them available via translations and commentaries. Those with intellectual integrity will appreciate these efforts. As for the others, perhaps we can straighten them out.

I on 2011-07-20 at 08:54 said:

"As far as 'racism' and 'true Christianity' go, the bottom line is that Evola would have sent M L King to a death camp without a second thought, so what have you proved about his "sophisticated" versions of racism, paganism and state power?"

James, this is not true. Evola was firmly and consistently against violent treatment of political enemies and ideological opponents. This is something that made him un-popular among some high ranking fascists and nazis of the social darwinist type, who believed in the "Nietzschean" myths of the blond beast of prey etc. It is true that he would have made and accepted all serious efforts to remove the kinds of ML King from places of influence and (political) power, but he would not have suggested a death camp or execution for them. This is not because he had felt any humanistic empathy for them, but he could see where such actions would inevitably and objectively lead – to disaster and ruin.

Max on 2015-04-19 at 06:24 said:

Tradition is lived in a specific time and place, but some treat it like existing in a vacuum outside real societies, humans and events, without which it becomes just another mental construct blocking our view. This is the instance of a mind that only goes backwards but not forward. A fault in the "thinking" of modern people is that they start with the effect, and then try to work out which cause lead to it which means they have to make it up, rather than to start at the beginning and align ourselves with that which is given.

Visionsofglory14 on 2011-07-22 at 04:13 said:

Perhaps he was referring to your claim that Neo-pagan critiques of Christianity parallel those of the Pharisees and the Enlightenment thinkers. Care to extrapolate?

Cologero on 2011-07-22 at 12:48 said:

Mr. Vision, is there some specific point you want to address? First of all, the neo-pagan new right, in its criticism, aligns itself with those said forces of revolution; thus it is not traditional, and not even of the right. I translated Evola's objections to Catholicism (what he and we mean by Christianity) and it is available on this web site. Unlike the crude critiques that are all too available on the www, Evola accepts the possibility of miracles, defends the concept of infallibility, and even the idea of a High Priest (or pope). Furthermore, unlike the neo-pagan new right, Evola defends Charlemagne and regards the Middle Ages as an age of tradition.

I sent out to the mailing list the next installment of the translation of Sintesi, where Evola writes:

Once all that has been established, the suggested possibility of "transcending" certain aspects of Christianity would become real. According to its strict Latin etymology, to transcend means to surpass while ascending. In principle, it is not a matter – it is good to repeat it – of rejecting Christianity or of showing the same incomprehension towards it as Christianity itself has shown, and largely continues to show, towards paganism. It would instead perhaps be a matter of integrating it into something much larger, omitting some aspects, for which it is little in accord with the spirit typical of some of the renovating forces of today, of the transalpine type, in order to accentuate instead other more essential aspects which such faith cannot contradict the general conceptions of Aryan and Nordic, pre-Christian and non-Christian spirituality.

Has anyone in the neo-pagan new right mentioned the idea of "transcending" Christianity?

Cologero on 2011-07-23 at 00:07 said:

How many times do we have to make myself clear, Eddie? Just one more time. Point 1. Evola was not at all pro-Christian ... he could not relate to its theology at all. But neither was he anti-Christian. Rather, he was non-Christian, as though it never existed for him. Point 2. When we use the word "Christian" at Gornahoor are referring specifically to the Church of the Middle Ages, especially when it was undivided. By that standard, there are precious few "Christians" around today. Let's not be confused about labels; we're trying to penetrate deeper. Even failure is worth the attempt. That is one reason that we don't write much about theology proper, which is, as you say, in its contemporary manifestations to a large extent sentimental. I can well understand that it does not appeal to many today. Nevertheless, we need to understand why it did appeal

to many a millennium ago, and was the guiding spirit to the last traditional civilization in the West.

A corollary is that we try to transcend the “us vs them” attitude, that is all too common among the neo-pagans. Any careful reader can determine that we are not distorting Evola. However, it seems to us that the neo-pagans distort him while claiming him as one of their own. I'll summarize what I see are the specific differences. If there are any wise pagans who address these issues, please point them out to us.

The real paganism is that of the Ancient City about which Gornahoor has devoted several posts. It is not the decadent form of the late Empire. The real paganism was theocratic and was led by a priest-king until its subsequent degenerations. All of life was regulated by duties and rites.

The real paganism was not a hedonistic, sensualistic, naturalism.

The Christian kings and emperors of the Middle Ages, such as Arthur, Charlemagne, Frederick II were exercised legitimate authority.

The Church of the Middle Ages (and the civilization that grew up alongside it) was not Jewish creation initiated by “Saul”. It was the creation of the Nordic-Roman spirit.

The end of Tradition in the West did not begin with Constantine. It began 1000 years later with the Renaissance, Reformation, Enlightenment, French Revolution.

The Church of the Middle Ages was hierarchical, not in the least democratic and egalitarian.

Those are some points. Evola's view is the first of each item. Every neo-pagan I've read has adopted the second. So, this is not meant to be a “court case” between Christians and pagans, if only for the reason that few Christians today would even recognize themselves in this characterization. The issue is to determine the spiritual forces at work and to understand the flow of history apart from angry and ignorant polemics.

Perennial on 2011-07-23 at 02:38 said:
Bravo!

Eumaeus on 2011-07-26 at 16:42 said:
New to this forum. Excellent conversation.

Indeed many of the early Church Fathers did have a superior understanding of the Old Religion in part because they practiced it prior to conversion. The process of integration of the new religious idiom with the old was an important part of the project of the Fathers although the work was not acknowledged as such. In Exoteric religion they generally do not give much attribution to where they have taken their ideas and indeed the official stories may conceal deeper connections outside of historical traditions. For example the Zoroastrian and Hellenistic inputs into Christianity even at the level of the Gospels are obvious but not footnoted. They are acknowledged by allusion– the appearance of the Magi at Bethlehem; references to the Lake

of Fire – and the very notion of incarnation already so well recounted for many Greek heroes. And at the core: equation of Christ as Logos.

These are also symbols and markers within the Gospel which betoken the expansion of Christian mission from tribal to universal – by reference to those two traditions that were already beyond tribal particularism at that point in time – Zoroastrianism and Hellenism.

3.3 Further Misunderstandings of the Pagan Worldview

Evola continues his critique by pointing out that the goal should be to transcend Christianity by integrating it into something more comprehensive that incorporates the essential elements of the genuine antique paganism. This is actually *analogous* to the Catholic position as described by Fr. **Heinrich Denifle**:

The Catholic Church is the religion. As the supernatural does not destroy the natural, but rather presupposes it, so the Catholic Church does not annul the natural religion but embraces it as a necessary supposition and foundation.

Thus, Christianity as understood by its ablest apologists is not averse to embracing the authentically Traditional elements of the earliest religions including the Vedanta and Western paganism.

Once all that has been established, the possibility we suggested of “transcending” certain aspects of Christianity would then become real. According to its strict Latin etymology, to transcend means to surpass while ascending. In principle, it is not a matter – it is good to repeat – of rejecting Christianity or of showing the same incomprehension towards it as Christianity itself has shown, and largely continues to show, towards paganism. It would instead perhaps be a matter of integrating it into

something much larger, omitting some aspects, for which it is little in accord with the spirit typical of some of the recent transalpine innovations in order to accentuate instead other more essential aspects by which such faiths cannot contradict the general conceptions of Aryan and Nordic, pre-Christian and non-Christian spirituality.

Unfortunately, the neo-pagans fabricate a sham spirituality that rejects the Traditional elements of Christendom while recovering little from genuine antique paganism. He points out the anti-Catholicism of the neo-pagans links them to the elements of the anti-Tradition. As for the historical references: the 1870s was the time of the unification of Italy under a secular Republic on the French model. The Fascists, on the other hand, declared Catholicism the official religion of Italy and restored religious education to the public schools. Evola seems to have moderated his view (in 1941) from the views expressed in *Pagan Imperialism* (1927), some of which he regrets. Instead of the return to the antique religion of the pagans, what he witnessed was the rise of neo-paganism. More than once, he conceded that those neo-pagans would be better off as Catholics.

Evola is in an odd position: while devoid of any faith and lacking any sympathy with Christian belief, he nevertheless defends Christendom, even referring to it as the time when well-born men held sound beliefs. In this paragraph, for example, he opposes those the Church regarded as “rebels and heretics”. I would recommend *Revolution and Counter-Revolution*¹ for a reading of history that, apart from its theological orientation, has many points in common with Evola. Specifically, they both see the Renaissance, the Reformation, the Enlightenment, Revolution, democracy, and so on, not as the Progress that most believe them to be, but rather as causes of the end of a phase of Tradition.

¹http://www.pliniocorreadeoliveira.info/UK_RCR.pdf

Unfortunately, as we pointed out, the path taken by the extremist racist neo-paganism is totally different. Falling into a snare almost deliberately set, these neo-pagans, end up by advocating and defending ideas more or less reducing them to that sham, naturalistic, particularistic paganism, lacking light and transcendence, and even pervaded by a misunderstood, pantheistic mysticism, which was created polemically from the Christian misunderstanding of the pre-Christian world, and which is based, at most, only on isolated forms of degeneration of the regressions of such a world. And as if this were not enough, they often resort to an anti-Catholic polemic which, *mutatis mutandi*, whatever its political justification, in fact drags out certain arguments and clichés of a purely modern, rationalist, protestant, and enlightenment type that were the weapons of liberalism, democracy, and freemasonry. This was already the case, to a degree, with H. S. Chamberlain. It appears again in a certain Italian racist movements, which are inspired by Gentilian philosophy, that is, the philosophy of personalism through which Fascism would be the continuation of the anti-Catholicism of the 1870s, Roman re-enactments would be a silly rhetoric, and the Italian tradition would tend to coincide more or less with the opinions of a series of rebels and heretics, Giordano Bruno until now.

Generally, what we just indicated is recognized when the new paganism gives itself up to the glorification of immanence, “Life”, “nature”, seeking to create new, superstitious mysticism, which is in the sharpest contrast to every higher Olympian and heroic ideal of the great Aryan civilizations of pre-Christian antiquity. What are we to think about assertions like this one? “Faith in a super-sensible world beyond this world of sense is something schizophrenic: only schizophrenics see double”². Or about another, according to which every distinction between spirit and body is only a product of the anti-Aryan degeneration injected by oriental races.

²E. Bergmann

Evola defends the immortality of the soul. He mocks the idea of immortality understood as a genetic continuation, an idea that today is expressed in concepts like the selfish gene or human biodiversity.

Denying this distinction, such racialsists, as a consequence, come to deny immortality itself: if the soul is inconceivable separately from the body, one cannot think of a survival in the afterlife, but only of immortality meant as self-continuation through one's descendants. An immortality, which a massacre, earthquake, or epidemic naturally enough would be sufficient to destroy.

Whatever his admiration for Nietzsche may have been, Evola shows he is a rather inconsistent Nietzschean. Evola consistently criticizes Nietzsche's incomprehension of the ascetic life.

Regarding the anti-ascetic prejudice, we already said: neo-paganism redoubles, in this regard, the incomprehension already demonstrated by Nietzsche: The Aryan would not have known asceticism in normal life: his true mysticism would have been for the afterlife: it would never have thought of a supernatural fulfillment of the personality.

Evola points out the importance of rite and ritual in the **Ancient City**. Evola points to the example of infallibility to demonstrate the untraditional nature of the neo-pagans. Many claim to be anti-egalitarian in theory, but in practice they chafe at the notion that one man's thoughts may be superior to another's.

Superstitions, residues of the "dark ages" and "Etruscan magic", lies and instruments for the tactic of temporal control by the clergy in the commerce of indulgences would be, for the others, everything that is sacrament and rite and supernatural power. Thus, they show they do not know that all life in those ancient Aryan and specifically of the Roman

pagan civilizations, always had a ritual character, the rite accompanying every form of individual and collective life, not in the sense of an empty ceremony, but as the instrument of a real connection between the human and super-sensible forces. On the other hand, Chamberlain already went to attribute to the Aryan spirit the achievements typical of so-called free enquiry and modern profane science. Naturally, when one believes that Lutheranism represented the awakening of the spirit of the Nordic race instead of representing, as it did represent, the incentive for its further spiritual involution and for its eventual semitization. Elsewhere, in the German edition of *Revolt against the modern world*, we justified this view to an incomprehension that can only be added to incomprehension. So there is something ingenuous, as Guenon correctly pointed out, in the scandal that was demonstrated among the protestants in the face of the claim of infallibility in the order of transcendent knowledge (in the West it is said: in matters of “faith”); for the ancient Aryan civilization infallibility was instead recognized as belonging not to a single man, as in Catholicism, but to every member belonging legitimately to the brahman, to the “solar caste” of spiritual leaders.

Evola mentions the possibility of a return to antique traditions. However, this poses an insurmountable obstacle even to those pagans today who understand this critique and to whom it may not apply. There is no way today to reconstruct those rites and rituals. Furthermore, their source is of divine origin and tied to their ancestors, blood, and soil. That cannot be done *di nuovo* by fiat without some divine sanction; in particular, one cannot be a pagan by oneself apart from an hierarchically organized community led by a high priest. Those “sacred and spiritual origins” are lost in time.

In the face of such confusions, we can always put very clearly the alternative: either return to the traditions and their sacred and spiritual

origins, or continue to gamble with various combinations and inclinations of modern and secular thought. Another example: what is that “nature” that in certain racist circles is so exalted? It would little suffice to notice that it is not in the least the nature that ancient man saw, but a rationalist construction of the period of French Encyclopedism. The encyclopedists created, with precise subversive and revolutionary intentions, the myth of a good, wise and provident nature in contrast with the corruption of every “culture”. Thus, we see that the optimistic naturalist myth of a Rousseau and the encyclopedists went hand in hand with “natural right”, universalism, humanitarianism, egalitarianism, and the denial of every positive form of State and hierarchy.

Evola criticizes the very notion of a return to “nature”. This applies *a fortiori* to contemporary and subtle variations based on zoological racism. The intent of Sintesi is to develop the spiritual notion of race, not to defend any biological understanding of it.

Even in regard to the natural sciences one could say the same. Every honest scientist knows that in his researches, whose goal exclusively consists of the formulation of abstract uniformities and mathematical relationships, there is no place for “nature”. As for biological research, the very science of genetics, and so on, we already emphasized the errors and the one-sidedness in which they fall, in believing definite laws that are of value only as a partial and subordinate aspect of reality. There is not a trace of what people today consider to be “nature” in the meaning that nature had for the man of the origins, for the traditional and solar man characterized essentially by his Olympic and regal distance. Since Italian racialism has not yet moved into those areas, it is therefore well to pay attention, and as we said, to value someone else’s experience.

Posted on 2011-07-27 by Aeneas

3.4 Objective and Impersonal Knowledge

Yesterday, we saw that **Julius Evola** claimed both knowledge and action as the two basic elements. Let's be clear about what is meant by knowledge. This is not the scholarly knowledge of the professors nor is it related to any discipline like comparative religion. Rather, this knowledge is a gnosis, that is, a direct, intuitive, more than personal knowing which brings absolute certainty. In the snippet translated below the horizontal line, taken from Chapter 2, Section 2, of *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, Evola begins his explication of race as based on the traditional understanding of man. It is insufficient to know that the Greeks and Scholastics taught the same view. The one thing necessary is to know oneself as a being consisting of Spirit, Soul, and Body. A man must know and be able to distinguish these parts of himself within his own consciousness. I know first hand that developing this knowledge is a difficult and arduous process, more difficult than any university class or perfecting a skill in combat or the arts. Even when this knowledge is attained, it is yet more difficult to maintain one's awareness as spirit on a consistent or permanent basis. Many speak of spirit; few are spirit. The risk of taking this path is the overturning of one's cherished beliefs. The risk of not taking it is to continue to live like an animal.

The Three Levels of the Doctrine of Race Since we want to clarify the doctrine of race from the traditional point of view, of course we will assume, as a premise, the traditional conception of the human being, according to which, man as such cannot be reduced to purely biological, instinctive, hereditary, or naturalistic determinisms: if all that has one of its parts, ignored by a dubious spiritualism, exaggerated by a myopic positivism, it still remains a fact that man is distinguished from animals insofar as he participates in a supernatural, super-biological element, by virtue of which he can be free or himself. Between the one and the other,

as an intermediate element, in a certain way he remains an animal. The distinction in the human being of three different principles, namely, the body, soul, and spirit, is fundamental for the traditional view. In a more or less complete form, it is found in the teachings of all the ancient traditions, and it continued up to the Middle Ages:

- The Aristotelian and Scholastic conception of the three souls: vegetative, sensitive, and intellectual
- In the Hellenic trinity of *soma*, *psyche*, and *nous*
- The roman conception of *mens*, *anima*, and *corpus*
- The Indo-Aryan of *sthula-sarira*, *linga-sarira* and *karana-sarira*

And so on: these are all equivalent expressions of it. It is important to emphasize that this view must not be considered as one particular philosophical interpretation among so many others, to be discussed, criticized, or debated, but as an objective and impersonal knowledge, conforming to the very nature of things.

Posted on 2011-08-11 by Aeneas

3.5 Greater and Lesser Battle

Just to give readers something to live for today.

The battle differentiates, distinguishes, and creates hierarchy, especially when — to use some traditional expressions — it is not the small battle, but the great battle. It is not the battle of man against man or against the environment, but the battle of the supernatural element of a man against everything that within him

is nature, sensation, materiality, anxiety, turmoil, a mirage of vain greatness.

Against the chaos and the anti-race that are within him, before they are outside of him.

Posted on 2011-09-01 by Cologero

* * *

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-09-01 at 13:13 said:
you may well be right about that!

3.6 Race and Death

Since we now have 50 people in the entire world interested in reading more of Evola, I am releasing another section. It may be of value to compare it to Mircea Eliade's description of the Legionary movement³, from which the following quote is taken.

Being a profoundly Christian movement, justifying its doctrine on the spiritual level above all – legionarism encourages and is built upon liberty. You adhere to legionarism because you are free, because you decided to overcome the iron circles of biological determinism (fear of death, suffering, etc.) and economic determinism (fear of becoming homeless). The first gesture a legionnaire will display is one born out of total liberty: he dares to free himself of spiritual, biological and economic enslavement. No exterior determinism can influence him. The moment he decides to be free is the moment all fears and inferiority complexes instantaneously disappear. He who enters the Legion forever dons the

³http://ia600700.us.archive.org/1/items/Liberty_7/Liberty.pdf

shirt of death. That means that the legionnaire feels so free that death itself no longer frightens him. If the Legionnaire nurtures the spirit of sacrifice with such passion, and if he has proven to be capable of making sacrifices these bear witness to the unlimited liberty a legionnaire has gained. "He who knows how to die will never be a slave." And this doesn't concern only ethnic or political enslavement – but firstly, spiritual enslavement. If you are ready to die, no fear, weakness, shyness can enslave you. Making peace with death is the most total liberty man can receive on this Earth.

The Evola text now follows. Note again that he opposes biological determinism and insists that the personality transcends all elements of race.

* * *

Given how much has now been clarified, we will now pause a moment to make precise, in particular, the limits of the personality's membership in a race. Let us immediately say what is, in this respect, the view that is unacceptable from the traditional point of view. It is that of those who, once race is conceived as a purely biological-human, historical, and only terrestrial entity, holds that in such an entity lies the purpose of every being that belongs to it, that nothing exists higher than race, since race is the wellspring of every value, and the idea of a task and a super-terrestrial destination of the individual is illusory and pernicious: "to remain faithful to the earth and to the race."

We have already dealt with this conception and criticized it more than once. In the face of it, after all, one can resort to the racist criterion for the appreciation of the "truth"; depending on the various "races of the spirit" we have, particularly, as many conceptions of the same race, and there is no doubt that only for a telluric race can that conception be "true", only the telluric man can suppose such limited horizons as

absolute. In this telluric vision of the race, the mentioned supposition of those neopagan racialists also comes back, according to whom the only conceivable immortality would be that of survival in blood, in earthly descendants.

It is true that similar positions, today, are presented less according to a theoretic value than according to a practical and political one. With it we aim to consolidate the unity of the people-race and to concentrate every spiritual energy of the individual member in the temporal and historical tasks that this being has to resolve. But it is otherwise true that the ancient Aryan civilizations, even in regard to earthly, heroic and political realizations, had their greatness without, however, perceiving the need of resorting to these myths, recognizing instead rather different truths. It is clearly evident, in fact, that our view of race carries back to the pitryana, to the “way of the South” and that it is opposed to the “divine way of the North” (devayana) that stood alone to define the highest Aryan ideal.

The theory of “double heredity” reconnects to such ideals. Personality, we said, is not exhausted in historical-biological heredity or horizontal heredity. It appears rather as a principle that, while manifesting itself in the race (here, as always, race in the restricted sense), in itself stands beyond race, therefore cannot be exhausted in it. To recognize race, as by now has been clarified in principle, does not mean to damage the personality: the personality owes the living and articulated material for its specific expression, for its self-manifesting and acting, to the race and as much as earthly heredity collects. In that there is a conditionality that however is not passive and one-sided. Every individual also reacts on race and on his heredity on the basis of his own most intimate nature, processes the substance in which he manifests himself, ultimately the form, and it is such that interracial differentiation and that diverse purity or completeness of types is realized, which we previously mentioned and now return to, in regards to its social reflexes. It is a giving rather than a receiving. In the points in which a supreme balance and a supreme

adequacy are reached (a balance, according to our tripartite view of the various components of the true race), we have as a peak, beyond which the personality has nowhere to go — it has nowhere to go on the horizontal, terrestrial line. To this line its work, its being, and, physiologically, its lineage remains and belongs. But the personality itself, if it has reached such a peak, is “free” and can now turn to a properly supernatural perfection.

This is exactly the most ancient Aryan conception, relative to which it does not belong specifically to the group of spiritual leaders, a conception that is also found again in the views and various legends of the Western Middle Ages. The dharma is established, the scrupulous observance of worldly laws of race, caste, and so on, up to a full adaptation. Such laws require also the assurance of a lineage: life, which is received at birth, before death must be returned with its own imprint to another being, and it is for this reason that the first-born son is called “the son of duty”. After that, after the “active life”, according to the Aryan law, he must withdraw to an ascetic-contemplative life. And the Ario-Iranian saying is rather expressive that recalls the true task to be, not just to procreate on the horizontal plane of terrestrial descent, but also towards the higher, on the vertical ascending direction. In the Western religion all these views were confused. Above all, what is of pertinence to the active life was separated violently from that which is the contemplative life and almost always the truly traditional solutions were forgotten, according to which the law, that in not of this earth, prolongs, completes and empowers that of this earth. But still more harmful than such confusions are the little noted telluric racist views, in case they have been taken seriously and have a future. According to the traditional teaching of the Aryan peoples, it remains instead firm that the supernatural is essentially the goal and the dignity of the personality: this goal, therefore, acts as the highest driving force and the deepest animating force in the bosom to the expression that race gives to the personality, thereby uplifting simultaneously the race, up to a limit beyond which, after having left a sign of greatness, the same force

liberates itself and tends to make it so that death is precisely a finalization, a *telos*, a new birth, the third birth of the indo-Aryan teaching.

Only the mediocre and the losers, among the beings who do not know how to realize the law and earthly duty down to their foundation, can think that they don't have an afterlife, that they have for a destiny a redissolving in the mixed vitality of the race, in the collective and earthly substance of blood and heredity, only in that way surviving (in a somewhat relative meaning of the word) the destruction of their physical individuality, and transmitting to others the task for which they were inadequate.

Posted on 2011-09-06 by Aeneas

* * *

H00 on 2011-09-06 at 22:20 said:

This translation work is appreciated.

Although this was already our doctrine, the text, e.g. because of the way it is written, enlightens our own understanding. In the superior or complete worldview there is no divorce between holistic racialism and spirituality.

Meta-physical, extraphysical, or supernatural racism is the expression of the core of the religion of the Hyperborean-derived peoples – liberty, hierarchy, personality; differentiation & unity; – and vice versa.

Jason on 2011-09-07 at 14:57 said:

Cologero, in regards to your disappointment that so few have expressed interest in reading Evola, Traditionalism as such is meant for an elite, an elite is never a large group, and in this modern world the number of elite souls is much smaller than it would ever normally have been... ..we do not know what the future will bring, and perhaps in the future there will be many who will be thankful to you for bringing out this important book in English. It is important that THE DOCTRINE OF RACE be translated if only to debunk the various "Neo-Nazi" interpretations of Evola common in many circles and to show the Baron's thoughts as they truly were. I for one, an admirer of Evola who cannot read Italiano, am very grateful for this project.

3.7 The Mystery of Birth

To allow such traditional views to act on oneself, until they awaken precise interior forces, means to progress on the way that leads to a spiritual level from which the significance of life constitutes something absolutely different from what it means for the rest of men: a significance of clarity, absolute force, and incomparable certitude.

JULIUS EVOLA

In *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, Evola addresses the mystery of birth and how it relates to one's destiny. After discussing the notions of the races of the soul and spirit, he raises the question and addresses some objections to his view:

What blame does a man have if he was born in one race and not in another? Is he perhaps responsible for the fact that his parents and ancestors are Aryans, Jews, blacks or Amerindian? Has he perhaps willed all that? With your theory of race you remain, in spite of it all, in a purely naturalistic point of view. You turn a natural event into a destiny and construct above your system, instead of bringing attention above all to those values in which it can truly enter into play, and be considered imputable, as a human responsibility.

He regards these objections not as weird or artificial, but of a real importance to avoid reverting to materialistic and collectivist degradations of the doctrine. The traditional point of view stresses the values of the person over any of its manifestations.

Evola asserts that only pre-christian conceptions of man and life can satisfy his requirements. We prefer to deal with concepts rather than labels, so we need to reformulate Evola's argument somewhat. In a subsequent post, we will show how his views challenge both the traditional

right and its modern alternatives. Evola describes the Christian solution to the mystery of birth this way:

The Church had to reject the idea of pre-existence that the preceding traditions always recognized: that is, it denied that the spiritual nucleus of the personality pre-exists terrestrial birth and, naturally, conception. In Christian theology things in this respect are not so simple, as far as this denial could be believed. Nevertheless, the fundamental Christian view is that each human soul is unique and is created by God from nothing at the moment in which it is breathed into a body or embryo read to receive it. That a man is born in one race rather than another becomes then a theological mystery: “God willed it” and, often, it is admitted that the divine will is inscrutable.

In that paragraph, there is something true, something false, and something ambiguous. It is true that the human being exists from the moment of conception, so, here, Evola is more Catholic than the pope. It is false that Catholic doctrine teaches that the soul is infused into the embryo at some point subsequent to conception. That is the Cartesian view that presumes a duality of soul and body. What is ambiguous is the meaning of the pre-existence of the soul. The common misunderstanding is that the soul exists in time prior to conception. This is the view of Plato of all systems deriving from Theosophy, and even popular views of oriental religions such as Hinduism or Buddhism.

To clear up the latter point first, Evola makes it clear that this pre-existence cannot be conceived in a temporal sense, since the human Self is transcendent to the world of space and time. The Thomist view, then, is not as dissimilar as Evola would like. The soul is the form of the body, which cannot exist without the soul. So the soul is pre-existent in the ontological sense and the physical aspects of the body are the reflection of soul qualities. This is really Evola’s point, and should be the Catholic viewpoint, had the understanding brought by Thomas Aquinas allowed

to be further developed instead of being petrified at a certain point. Evola explains his doctrine:

The view of ancient Aryan humanity was totally different and it alone permits us to overcome the objections indicated... According to that view, birth is not by chance nor a fact willed by God; neither fidelity in regards to one's own nature signifies a passivity, but rather testifies to the more or less clear knowledge of a profound connection of one's Self with something transcendental and otherworldly, to be able to act in a transfiguring way. This is the essence of the doctrine of karma and dharma, a doctrine that must not be confused with the idea of reincarnation.

It is necessary to distinguish a double heredity. That which stands before the individual in the temporal non-transcendental, sense is the heredity of parents, the gens, the race, a certain civilization, caste, etc., therefore, more or less, everything that commonly is meant when speaking of heredity. But all that does not exhaust the spiritual reality of the individual, as materialism and historicism claim: as determining and essential it must rather be considered an intervention from above, a principle assuming and utilizing, as its material of expression and incarnation, everything that this heredity has gathered with its laws and determinism. Moreover, it must be thought that the historical-biological heredity of a given line is chosen and assumed when it can be approximately worth as a type of expressions analogous to a transcendental heredity.

That is why in every being two heredities meet and join each other, the one terrestrial and historic, in good measure positively detectable i.e., known to science (tr) , the other spiritual, otherworldly. To establish the ties between the two, is therefore to determine the synthesis that defines a given human nature, and intervenes in an event represented in various traditions with various symbols... Basically, as noted, a type of law of elective affinity acts here. Wishing to clarify with some applications, we will say that a

man is not of a given gender, race, or caste because he is born that by chance or through the will of God, or through a mechanism of natural causes, but vice versa. He was born that way because he already was a man or women, of one race or another, etc., naturally in an analogical sense in the sense of an inclination of vocation or deliberation transcending use, through lack of adequate concepts, we can present only through its effects. In a certain way, one has therefore the interference of horizontal lines and vertical lines of an earthly heredity and non-earthly. At the point of crossing, according to traditional teachings, birth occurs, or better said, the conception of a new being, an incarnation.

Race, caste, etc., therefore exist in the spirit before manifesting in terrestrial and historical existence. Diversity has its origin from above, and what refers to it on earth is only a reflection and symbol. As one willed to be on the basis of a primordial nature or a transcendental decision, so one is. It is not birth that determines nature, but vice versa; it is nature, in its widest sense, because common words are inadequate, that determines birth.

It is this point of crossing that accidental, or contingent, qualities intersect with transcendent, or essential, qualities. Clearly, the modern conception ignores the transcendent, by its nominalism and denial of formal causes, hence every quality is accidental. The Aristotelian-Thomist scheme agrees in principle, yet is limited by its commitment to the genus and species distinction, so it is forced to define various types of accidents. We will address these issues subsequently, after we translate another section on the impact that Evola's conception has on ethical theory. But first we will repeat some quotes from Plotinus and Plato that Evola relies upon.

The general plane is unique, but divides itself in diverse parts, in a way that in everything there are distinct places, some more pleasant, others less so. And souls, also unequal, come to inhabit these

distinct places that correspond to their own diversity. In such a way, everything is arranged and the differences in their situations correspond to the inequality of the souls.

Plotinus

It is not the demon that chooses you, but you yourself chose your demon. You yourself choose the destiny of that life to which you are irremediably connected.

Plato

Mystery of Birth For the presentation of the directive principles of this part of race theory it is however necessary to make a few remarks related to the problem of birth, and a final clarification of what has been said about heredity.

Even when we have worked out all the principal objections against the doctrine of race that are made from an immediate, practical or intellectual point of view, whether in good or bad faith, there remains one that is insuperable but decisive. They can say: good, everything affirmed is correct. But with everything taken into account, what fault does a man have if he was born into one race and not in another? Is he perhaps responsible for the fact that his parents and ancestors are Aryans, Jews, blacks or Amerindian? Has he perhaps willed all that? With your theory of race you remain, in spite of everything, in a purely naturalistic point of view. You turn a natural event into a destiny and you build above your system, instead of paying attention above all to those values in which human responsibility can truly come into play, and be considered imputable.

This is, in some way, the *ultima ratio* of the adversaries of race theory. And it must be conceded that such an objection is not artificial and farfetched, but of a real importance, if it does not support the materialist and collectivist deterioration of the doctrine in word and is posed instead

from the traditional point of view, which always emphasizes the values of the personality. Nevertheless, to consider that objection certainly means confronting the problem of birth. From a higher, spiritual point of view, the justification of the race idea depends on the problem of birth and its solutions.

In this regard, arriving at some firm points is still rather difficult, as long as it remains in the ambit of views introduced by the coming of Christianity into the West. And that is not by chance: race and super-race, cult of blood, arianity, etc., are all concepts that were formed and affirmed essentially in pre-Christian civilizations. It is therefore necessary to look in such traditions and in their knowledge for the elements of the solution of the problems, that the recovery of those ideas today are going to raise. Every reference in more recent conceptions of man and life can only furnish us incomplete and often inadequate points of view.

Thus we must not be surprised that the problem of birth is remarkably obscure in the Christian vision of the world. For precise and certainly not arbitrary reasons, that we cannot discuss here, the Church had to reject the idea of pre-existence that earlier traditions had always recognized: that is, it has denied that the spiritual center of the personality pre-exists terrestrial birth and, certainly, even conception. In Christian theology, things in this regard are not as simple, as this denial can be believed. Nevertheless, the fundamental Christian view is that each human soul is unique and is created by God from nothing at the moment in which it is breathed into a body or human embryo ready to receive it. That a man is born into one race rather than another therefore becomes a theological mystery: "God willed it" and it is usually admitted that the divine will is inscrutable.

The view of ancient Aryan humanity was totally different and it alone can overcome the indicated objections. For a complete explanation, we must again remind the reader of our work *Revolt against the Modern World*. Recapping, here we limit ourselves to say that according to that

view, birth is never by chance, nor a fact willed by God; nor does fidelity in respect to one's own nature signify passivity, but rather it gives evidence to the more or less clear consciousness of a deep connection of one's own Self with something transcendent and otherworldly, to the extent of acting in a transfiguring way. This is the essence of the doctrines of karma and dharma, which must not be confused with the idea of reincarnation. As we have shown in other works, the theory of reincarnation is either a conception foreign to "Aryan spirituality, essentially characteristic of pre-aryan, telluric, matriarchal cycles of civilization, or it is the effect of misunderstandings and deformations that certain traditional views have undergone in some contemporary theosophical circles. And if, in the traditional world, even in the Aryan, seemingly clear evidence in favor of the belief in reincarnation, in reality, it is only about symbolic forms that a superior knowledge had to disguise in regard to the people and the uninitiated.

In any case, for the problem that concerns us here, it is necessary to refer, not to reincarnation, but to the doctrine that the human Self, as I having my own given nature, would be the effect, the production, the mode of appearance under certain conditions of existence, of a spiritual entity that preexists and transcends it. And since everything that is time, sooner or later, is just something inherent in the human condition, so strictly speaking we cannot speak of anything preexisting or antecedent in the temporal sense.

We are getting into a rather difficult field, precisely because conceptions and expressions cannot be applied to it that we are formed in the existence of this world and that, applied to a different reality, they can easily lead to distortions and deformations. We say, in any case, that It is necessary to discern a double heredity. What stands before the individual, in the temporal, non-transcendental sense, is the heredity of parents, the folk, the race, a certain civilization, caste, etc., therefore, more or less, everything that commonly is meant when speaking of heredity. But even

that does not exhaust the spiritual reality of the individual, as materialism and historicism claim: rather we must consider an intervention from above as determining and essential, a principle assuming and utilizing everything that this heredity has accumulated as its material of expression and incarnation, with its laws and its determinisms. Moreover, it must be thought that the historical and biological heredity of a given line is chosen and assumed when it can be approximately be considered as a kind of expressions analogous to transcendental heredity.

That is why two heredities meet and join each other in every being, the one terrestrial and historical, positively detectable to a great degree i.e., known to science (tr), the other spiritual and otherworldly. To establish the connection between the two, and thereby determine the synthesis that defines a given human nature, an event intervenes, represented in various traditions with various symbols, which we cannot examine here. Basically, as noted, a type of law of elective affinity operates. In order to clarify with some applications, we can say that a man is not of a given gender, race, or caste because he is born that way by chance or through the will of God, or through a mechanism of natural causes, but vice versa. He was born that way because he already was a man or women, of one race or another, etc., naturally in an analogical sense in the sense of an inclination of a transcendent vocation or deliberation, which we, because of the lack of adequate concepts, can indicate only through its effects. In a certain way, we therefore have the interference of horizontal lines and vertical lines of an earthly heredity and an otherworldly. At the point of crossing, according to traditional teachings, birth occurs, or better said, the conception of a new being, an incarnation.

Race, caste, etc., therefore exist in spirit before manifesting in terrestrial and historical existence. Diversity has its origin from above, and what relates to it on earth is only a reflection and symbol. As you have willed to be, based on a primordial nature or a transcendental decision, so you are. It is not birth that determines nature, but vice versa; it is nature, in

its widest sense, because common words are inadequate, that determines birth.⁴

The Mystery of Birth Explained

The general plane is unique, but divides itself in diverse parts, in a way that in everything there are distinct places, some more pleasant, others less so. And souls, also unequal, come to inhabit these distinct places that correspond to their own diversity. In such a way, everything is arranged and the differences in their situations correspond to the inequality of the souls.

Plotinus

It is not the demon that chooses you, but you yourself chose your demon. You yourself choose the destiny of that life to which you are irremediably connected.

Plato

After the quotes from Plotinus and Plato, **Julius Evola** next discusses various supernatural beings from Tradition, which Evola accepts as real entities and essential for his ideas on spiritual races. However, there is no reason to restrict their influence to antiquity; they are present and fully active today.

This expression “demon”, from Plato is particularly interesting for us, since here the concept of demon has nothing to do with

⁴For further reading, see “The Doctrine of the Castes” in *Revolt against the modern World*, “Man and Woman” in *Revolt against the modern World*, *Life of the Spirit* (<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2163>), *Law of Attraction* (<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1664>).

the Christian idea of a wicked entity, but instead has a close relation to the deepest forces of races, both of the soul and of the body. Even here, we cannot delve into the traditional doctrine in regards, but only to recall that, likewise, the demon, the lares, the penates, the “doppelganger” *doppio*, which is a synonym for “subtle body”, are entities that in antiquity interfered in and reflected the precise knowledge of the true roots of the differentiation of bloodlines, *gentes*, and ultimately the individuals themselves on the basis of a totalitarian vision of the world, including the invisible and the visible, and not of that mutilation of the moderns who only know material and psychological processes. From such testimonies which could be multiplied with reference to the traditions of all peoples, the idea of transcendental, or vertical, heredity therefore is confirmed, and of the choice that on the base of analogous correspondences, determines the connection of it to a horizontal, historical, biological heredity. The consequences of all the in regards to the justification of the racial ideas are clearly visible.

Since we have already discussed the notions of Angels and Demons⁵, we will move onto the other supernatural beings. The lares⁶ are protecting spirits of dead ancestors. They kept watch over the affairs of the family. Many pious people today are aware of the watchful presence of their ancestors. In addition, there are lares to protect broader domains such as neighborhoods, cities, states, livestock, and so on. Obviously, we still know these spirits, but they are now called patron saints or guardian angels. The principalities are the guardian angels for the various nations and countries, as accepted by Muslims and Traditional Christians, as well as the ancient pagans.

The penates⁷ more or less serve the same function as the lares. Since

⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2995>

⁶<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lares>

⁷https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Di_Penates

Evola accepts demons, lares, and penates as real beings, we should expect their presence to be made known, at least to those of the proper disposition and sensitivity. That they are called today the spirits of one's ancestors, patron saints, or angels makes no difference for their reality.

By “double”⁸, doppio, or doppelganger, Evola means the subtle body, i.e., the soul. In ancient Egypt this was called Ka. In the *Ancient City*, **Fustel de Coulanges** describes the state of the soul after death, as related in Hindu, Greek, and Roman traditions. Since we have previously discussed this on several occasions, and in the future we want to compare it to the state of the souls in Limbo according to Dante, we will move on.

So it should be absolutely clear now what Evola means by the “third dimension” of history. The modern mind can only see material or historical processes, which correspond to gross and subtle manifestation. However, the vertical dimension includes a whole array of beings who are involved in the creation of nations, peoples, and individuals. The actions of these beings are invisible to the modern mind which can only attribute them to material and biological causes.

Given this, we are in a position to better understand the existence of man in the light of Tradition. As Evola points out, the difference between Essence and Existence is a matter of degree. Here we understand man's Essence as who he is in himself, his Spirit, his karma (what he carries into the world) and his dharma (his task or destiny in the world). His Existence, then, is the meeting of this Essence interacting with the horizontal forces at the proper time and space suitable to him, by the Law of Elective Affinity. This is not a bipolar process between Essence and Existence, but rather an emanation involving higher beings and influences. If you look at the diagram from *Spiritual Beings*⁹, this process takes the being through the angelic influences which determine his race, nation, family, and so on, then through the astral and planetary influences, and

⁸<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Doppelg%C3%A4nger>

⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1941>

finally through the four elements. This is the birth of man in the vertical direction.

Posted on 2012-04-05 by Aeneas

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Temenus on 2012-04-06 at 06:39 said:

The Plato quote is taken from *Republic*, Book 10, 617e. Here is an other translation of the whole passage that I found (I think that the translation of greek "daimon" as divinity and deity can be misleading): 617e No divinity shall cast lots for you, but you shall choose your own deity. Let him to whom falls the first lot first select a life to which he shall cleave of necessity. But virtue has no master over her, and each shall have more or less of her as he honors her or does her despite. The blame is his who chooses: God is blameless. "So saying, the prophet flung the lots out among them all, and each took up the lot that fell by his side, except himself; him they did not permit. And whoever took up a lot saw plainly what number he had drawn."

<http://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=plat.+rep.+10.617e>

golgonooza on 2012-04-09 at 15:39 said:

In 'Lazarus, Come Forth' Valentin Tomberg discusses the second miracle of John's Gospel, the healing of the nobleman's son, and the sixth day of creation in terms of two types of heredity – 'vertical' and 'horizontal'. The Fall is seen by him as the substituting of the vertical heredity of creation in image and likeness of God for the horizontal heredity of ancestral traits, original sin etc. The healing of the nobleman's son placed him into direct relationship with Christ allowing the heredity of the father to be subsumed into the 'vertical' relationship. This seemed to me to be very similar to what Evola is saying here – am I right?

Cologero on 2012-04-09 at 17:46 said:

Thanks for reminding me of that passage. Yes, it is the same understanding although Evola would avoid using the words "God" or "Christ". Of course, Tomberg is drawing on the same tradition as Evola from Hermes to Plotinus. However, Evola is too polemical and eager to see differences, where Tomberg and Guido de Giorgio see continuity and a deeper development.

Logres on 2012-04-09 at 22:56 said:

Ortega y Gasset cites the Chinese custom of worthy deeds ennobling the ancestor. Transferred to a spiritual plane (vertical plane), is this also the same thought?

Angolmois on 2012-04-28 at 13:55 said:

Ancestors and God should be brought together in one's worship, not to separate them, but of course the Divine, the vertical should have a pre-eminence. (For the record, I'm not implying that this would be recommended here, just mentioning it.)

What is the most presumptuous and hypocritical comment one hears alot in favouring multio-racialism and multi-culturalism nowadays is that Aryans and Non-Aryans come in all colours and nationalities. This has never been in doubt anywhere in world's traditions, but somehow these modern idiot's seem to think they're wiser and that all the world Aryans should mix with each other everywhere and then we'd have the grey-black-brown globalist utopia they hunger for. Spit and shame on them.

Cologero on 2012-04-28 at 17:37 said:

Angolmois, I think you mean that as the One is manifested, it becomes more and more differentiated, not less. The modern mind, denying the supernatural *de facto*, even if they confess the opposite, believes instead that the One must appear on the material plane. Hence, they deny all differentiation and hierarchy in the face of all evidence.

40,000 Norwegians singing together a communist inspired song for peace changes nothing. Moltke said: "universal peace is only a dream, and not even a beautiful dream."

There are still some who are willing to combat; they may even have an inkling of their enemy (the negative pole). But they will not be effective unless they know precisely what they are fighting for (the positive pole).

Angolmois on 2012-04-29 at 03:08 said:

Yes, that is what I meant with my comment. The differentiation of the divine and its multiple manifestations in the form of different races, colours etc. should and could be a compliment for representatives of different races, nationalities and traditions – separate yet unified – but instead the modernists have made it an insult with their dis-honesty and linguistic / semantic plays. For example, "a negro" is a four letter curse word nowadays, whereas it was a compliment and a honorary title for the representatives of their race before. It has nothing to do with "hate speech" or anything like that for sure.

Timotheus Lutz on 2013-01-08 at 22:52 said:

Evola wrote: 'In a certain way, one has therefore the interference of horizontal lines and vertical lines of an earthly heredity and non-earthly.'

I wonder if Francis Parker Yockey, noted American Axis-sympathizer, read and was influenced by the Synthesis. The characterization of spiritual and physical race as horizontal and vertical appeared in his book *Imperium*, although if I'm remembering right, the words were switched.

3.8 Men of Destiny

Remembering oneself, discovering the true will, following one's Dharma, can all be summarized by the ancient call to *know thyself*. This is what defies every attempt to define or limit Tradition. It is not a question of reading the next book, knowing about Etruscan fertility goddesses, or adopting the very next craze. It is irrelevant to a debate about which religion is traditional or not. It is not about adhering to any particular political program. Tradition is not reducible to a formula.

There are very specific spiritual states: detachment, a calm mind, mental strength, or a feeling of deep-rooted security. That is the only standard and the necessary pre-condition to understand Tradition in any meaningful sense. If you are anxious, if your mind is scattered, if you react emotionally, then you need to follow some spiritual practice that will lead to such the state of awareness he describes. Becoming a pagan, or Buddhist, or Hindu, or thelemite is insufficient in itself, and those who convert often reveal a disheveled, superficial mind. **Julius Evola** explains:

Yet that is not enough. It is not by chance that the formula, “know thyself”, which, in its deepest meaning, refers exactly to such teachings, was itself written on the Delphic temple of Apollo, i.e., the Hyperborean God¹⁰. Letting such traditional truths act on oneself, until they awaken precise interior forces, means to proceed along the way that leads to a spiritual level at which the meaning of life constitutes something absolutely different from what the rest of men think: a sense of clarity, of absolute strength, of incomparable security.

But to have an inkling of all that, to glimpse a “character” in whom a type of indomitability is united to the feeling of detachment of “those who are joined from afar” and to an interior inaccessibility; in whom, therefore, there is simultaneously a superior

¹⁰<https://gornahoor.net/Hyperborean.htm>

calm, an aloofness, and a readiness to attack, to command, to absolute action—to have demonstrated this “character”, means also to have foreshadowed the mystery of the primordial Nordic race, or Hyperborean race, as the race of the spirit. Such is in fact the olympian and solar mode of being; the popular imagination refers to them today as the so-called “men of destiny” and yesterday referred to them as the vanished types of great leaders—in reality, in that it is now about the last echoes or flashing of what was characteristic, in general, of the great Hyperborean super race, before its dispersion and alteration. One remembers Plutarch’s expression about the members of the ancient Roman Senate: “They sit like a council of kings.”

Hence, a further consequence: if a civilization of the “classical” type, in the olympian and virile sense, not in the vulgar aesthetic and formulaic sense, reflects something of the Nordic race of the spirit, every romantic and “tragic” civilization, as opposed to it, will instead be the certain mark of the prevalence of the earlier influence by races and ethnic residues of a non-Nordic, pre-Aryan and anti-Aryan nature.

Despite all the talk about the Law of Cycles, it is poorly understood. It means that the material and historical circumstances have deteriorated to a certain level. By the Law of Elective Affinity, certain spirits will be attracted to that world and will feel very natural in it. Coincidentally, as the Wheel turns ever so slightly¹¹ to begin the next cycle, there will be attracted a smaller group. Their task is to be the spiritual elite for the next cycle, the men of destiny. To do so, these men will have to make special efforts to remember, to recall the distant past, to truly know themselves. Those who recall their Past will create the Future of Tradition.

Posted on 2012-04-12 by Cologero

¹¹<https://gornahoor.net/images/circlespirito.jpg>

* * *

Cologero on 2012-04-17 at 17:37 said:

The few readers who take this seriously may be interested in comparing this passage from *The Consolations of Philosophy*. Here, Sophia is speaking to Boethius:

Now I know the other cause, or rather the major cause of your illness: **you have forgotten your true nature**. And so I have found out in full the reason for your sickness and the way to approach the task of restoring you to health. It is because you are confused by loss of memory that you wept and claimed you you had been banished and robbed of all your possessions. And it is because you don't know the end and purpose of things that you think the wicked and the criminal have power and happiness. And because you have forgotten the means by which the world is governed you believe these ups and downs of fortune happen haphazardly. These are grave causes and they lead not only to illness but even death. Thanks, however, to the Author of all health, nature had not quite abandoned you. In your true belief about the world government—that it is subject to divine reason and not the haphazards of change—there lies our greatest hope of rekindling your health.

3.9 The Demonic Element in the Anti-Race

In this chapter from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, **Julius Evola** takes up the question of the mismatch between one's spiritual and biological race. It is hopeless to understand what Evola is saying in normal terms. "Race", for him, is a spiritual quality that seeks to be manifested. However, there are other forces in play that may impede this process. In this regard, and also in terms of the differences of historical periods, he is closer to a Rudolf Steiner than to more conventional views. Here he admits the existence of demonic spirits.

In relation to that, and to complete the argument, it is time to consider the following. As a follow-up to the preceding objection we could call attention back to the fact that, in reality, the types at this point are not

so differentiated, to be able to establish that aforesaid principle of fidelity to oneself; in the second place, the doctrine in question does not seem to give any explanation of the fact there exist types that are dilacerated and affected by serious conflicts, so much so that not all are “their own type” and not all feel themselves to be “in their own home”.

On the basis of the general principle that everything that appears here is the analogical reflection of a reality existing above; in order to explain such cases one must think of everything that the aforesaid freedom of the individual without roots can do and likewise of the action of special historical conditions and social collectives; but above all, one should suppose, for such cases, some corresponding prenatal circumstances. Close to the central force that led to a given human manifestation, lesser and divergent forces can also have influences which, nevertheless, precisely because they are weaker, were, in a manner of speaking, overwhelmed and led to create expressions corresponding to elements of a unfavorable and discordant, biológico-historical, “horizontal” heredity.

The cases in which the “race of the soul” and the “inner vocation” do not correspond to the race of the body, such as those of every romantic laceration, in the final analysis, are to be explained in such a way from the metaphysical point of view. Even modern psychology knows, at this point, about so called “split personalities”. And the more the minor forces diverge from the central direction, the more we will have, as the effect, men in whom the physical is not in accord with the soul, in whom the spirit contrasts with the body and the soul, whose vocation does not correspond to race or caste, the “personality” is in disagreement with tradition, and so on.

In similar cases, “classical” ethics, shaped by the ancient Nordic-Aryan norm of life, evident in a still more distinct way in its active and creative aspect, because it requires that the various divergent elements of these natures must obey a single, iron law on the basis of an inner decision, that cannot fail in the face of a negative example: and, as we will see, activist

race theory must arouse precisely such a decision in the greatest number of individuals of a nation, as the base for all the rest. To exalt the romantic instead, the tragic, anxious soul, always in search of new “truths”, is essentially something from a civilization sick and damaged in its race. Calmness, style, clarity, command, discipline, power and the Olympic spirit are instead the points of reference for every formation of character and life in the Nordic-Aryan sense.

But if even in the world of causes and metaphysical meanings we must presume the existence of natures and vocations manifesting a diverse degree of unitariness, we must also think that not all civilizations, and not all periods, offer the same possibilities of incarnation and expression to any of the forces that tend to an earthly form of existence. It is said that in every birth two different heredities interfere. The earthly and the historical gather, in a type of bond, certain biological, anthropological, and in part even psychological elements, a tradition, eventually also a caste, a given point in time and place in space, etc. Now, there are civilizations in which everything “is in order”, so to say, in which life, at its maximum, develops around a great unity and organicity of all these elements of “horizontal” heredity. Other civilizations are instead characterized by individualism, anarchy, the destruction of every limit, and every difference deriving from race, blood, caste, tradition, nationality. From what was said about the law of elective affinity and analogous correspondences that act in birth, obviously the civilizations of the former type are those that, in order to offer them circumstances and possibilities of adequate expression, attract unitary natures and pure and decisive forces. The chaotic civilizations of the latter type, for the same reason, will become instead, so to speak, the “exact place”, or the meeting place on earth, of every “otherworldly hysteric”.

This curious expression is the least alarming that one can use to give the meaning of the thing. In fact, on the metaphysical plane, hysteria, the internal contradiction, can appear only as the quality of those be-

ings, “who say no to being”, to a greater or lesser measure. But such a quality is exactly that which Christian theology attributes to “demonic” forces — now meant in the current sense of the term or to the “creatures of chaos”, the will to incarnation of those, wherever situations arise that, for analogous reasons, evoke them, have thus a meaning as precise as it is alarming, that cannot be developed here. Typology, physiognomy, a type of transcendental psychology in the whole of a race theory examination of the first and second degree applied to the most typical figures of revolutionary and still outer, popular leaders of the frontlines of worldwide subversion, both political-social as well as cultural and spiritual, could lead, in this regard, to some impressive results.

We are not saying however that such chaotic civilizations accommodate these forces exclusively: unitary natures in themselves can also arise, which however will be particularly at a disadvantage and, in order to hold firm and keep faithful to a vocation, which in such cases often has the sense of a true mission, are condemned to dissipate a quantity of energy to face the conflicts between soul and body, race and character, inner dignity and rank, etc., that are typical of such civilizations and that make them, in a normal way, the homeland of all other vocations. But in these cases it is necessary not to forget **Seneca**’s words, who correctly understood some unhappy circumstances in which a higher spirit can find himself involved in the discomforts and dangers to which he is exposed, or who is in a risky mission or in the line of combat: the most courageous and worthy are chosen for such tasks, while the cowardly and weak can be left to the “comfortable life”.

It is not necessary, in any case, to emphasize the importance that the preceding considerations, although unusual for the common mentality of modern man, have for the racial idea and, in general, for the philosophy of civilization, once these exceptional cases are put aside. If a destiny of millennia has led the West to circumstances in which it would be difficult to still find something truly pure, intact, differentiated and traditional,

to establish firm limits again, by any means, even with the harshest, is an endeavor whose beneficial effects perhaps at first sight may not be perceptible to everyone, but that nevertheless will not be found lacking in subsequent generations, through the effect of the secret way joining the visible with the invisible and the world with the “superworld”.

Posted on 2014-03-19 by Aeneas

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andrew on 2014-03-23 at 17:40 said:

Although I do not understand all of what is being said, nevertheless it touches me. I would appreciate some practical guidance on what can be done by those who do not feel themselves to be “in their own home”.

3.10 The Solar and the Demetrian Races

Julius Evola begins his discussion of the spiritual races in his *Sintesi di dottrina della razza* with the Solar and Demetrian races. He gives an almost Heideggerian take on the *avidya* teaching of the Vedanta. To recast it in these terms: The Hyperborean experiences a feeling of homelessness, arising from the ignorance or forgetfulness of Being, and finds himself thrown among beings.

This homeland, from the North, should be understood in a metaphysical, rather than a temporal, sense. Evola repeats the error we pointed out about the ritual between the priest and the king as described in the Brahmanas. Certainly the priesthood can decay (or has decayed) into a lunar type, but are (or were) there not sages or wizards with the solar powers described?

In order to move onto something more specific, we will say that the doctrine of the third degrees of race must essentially limit its researches to the sphere of influence of a given race of the spirit and of its primordial

tradition, following its developments, the mutations (paravariations) and also the distortions in the cycle that coincides with them and in which they act and react in the confrontation with the influences of different races or new environmental conditions. Once research is circumscribed that way, we arrive at a more limited concept of race, corresponding to that of the various differentiations or articulations of the primary element of such a cycle. It is natural that likewise we cannot think of an atomic separation of the various “races of the spirit”: their differences are not such as to exclude relationships not only of derivation, but even of different hierarchical rank.

We already outlined the typology of races of the spirit, as far as it concerns the specific human cycle of the hyperborean race, in the second part of our work *Revolt against the Modern World* (with special regard to the properly traditional and spiritual aspect), both in the choice of the writings of J. J. Bachofen, and in the related interpretation of them in a racial sense, as understood in the previously mentioned volume we edited under the title *La razza solare*. For a fuller treatment, the reader is therefore referred back to these two works. Here we will give only a brief schematic synthesis, necessarily lacking any justifying elements.

The solar or Olympic-solar race, corresponding to the hyperborean lineage and tradition, is to be considered superior and anterior to all the others in the cycle in question. It has as characteristic a type of “natural supernaturality”; spirit and power, calm dominance, and readiness for precise and absolute action, a sense of “centrality” and of “unshakeability”, and in its exterior effects, that virtue to which the ancients attributed a “numinous” quality (from *numen*), as superiority that imposes itself directly and irresistibly, that awakens simultaneously both terror and veneration, are marks of this “race of the spirit”, by means of which it is naturally predestined to command and, at the limit, to the regal function. Fire and ice are united in it as in the vague symbols of the original Nordic homeland and of the cycle in which it is eminently and primor-

dially manifested: ice, as transcendence and inaccessibility; fire, as the radiant specifically solar quality of the beings who give, who awaken life, and generate light, but always from a supreme distance and almost with indifference, as in the wake of a boat, not through zeal, inclination, or human concern.

The ancient symbol of gold always had connections with this form of spirituality. In the political forms of the origins, it acted as the substrate to sacred, or divine, regality, i.e., to the union of the two powers, of the regal and priestly function, the latter understood in a higher sense that will soon be made clear. The symbolic designations of the “divine” or “celestial” race for it must refer to the absence of the dualistic sentiment in relations to supernatural reality, something that however is quite distinct from everything that, in the modern sense, is immanence or Promethean velleity: it is not about men who believe they are gods, but of types who naturally, through a still not dim memory of origins and a condition of soul and body that do not cripple such a memory, feel they do not properly belong to the terrestrial race, to the extent of believing themselves men only by accident, or through “ignorance”, or “sleep”. The two terms *vidya* and *avidya* of the ancient Indo-Aryan teaching, that mean respectively “knowledge” (of the “supreme identity”) and “ignorance” (that leads to the self-identification with one of the forms or modes of being of the conditioned world), are to be understood exactly in this connection: when these are applied to a different human condition and a different race of the spirit, that is, when turned into “philosophical” terms, they lose every meaning and give rise to misunderstandings of various types.

The most recent “spiritual races” of the cycle, to which our contemporaries also belong, have as a prerequisite a division and a separation of the two elements of “spirituality” and “virility”—and also “transcendence” and “humanity”—that are synthetically reunited in the solar race. First of all, let’s specify the lunar race or demterian race. According to the analogous relation, while the solar element is that which has in itself its own

light and, in general, its own principle, the sun being, in such regard, the center of a given planetary system, the lunar element is that which instead receives or draws from another its light and principle. In the lunar race the sense of spiritual centrality is therefore lost, or through degeneration (the moon as the sun extinguished), or through passive crossbreeding with races of other cycles, of the “telluric” type, that have degraded its originary solar quality. The moon, as Bachofen points out, was also called the “celestial earth” by the ancients. There is therefore a sublimation of the law of the earth, the fate that is disclosed under the types of cosmic harmony and natural law: man here no longer feels himself the active center of spiritual reality: he is not this same reality, but rather the one who contemplates it, who studies its laws, who surpasses material action with contemplation and “tellurism”, but still does not reach spiritual action. The adjective “demetrian”, that we likewise give to this race, refers to a spirituality of a diffused, pantheistic, less dominating character that is pervaded by the sense of cosmic naturalistic laws and by a sacredness placed essentially under the feminine sign: spirituality that was precisely typical of the ancient demetrian cults. By extension, the priestly man is lunar in opposition to the regal man, he is the man who in the face of the spirit behaves as a normal woman facing a man, i.e., with a sense of submission and devotion. It is then interesting to note that the ancient traditions associated what today would be called cerebrality or intellectuality with the moon, labeling instead the heart with the sun and referring higher form of consciousness to this. The lunar type is in fact also intellectual, the man of passive reflection who, as the word says it, moves only among “reflections”, among shadows of ideas and of things.

Therefore the characteristics of the lunar race are varied. In the political camp, wherever a division between the temporal and priestly powers is perceived, the lunar spirit inevitably arises. The lunar is the dominator who receives the supreme consecration of its power from the other, from a distinct priestly caste, which it does not give it to itself. In gen-

eral, the lunar man has spiritually feminine traits. He lacks the feeling of centrality. In correspondence to the races of the body, he has the predominant nature of the demetrian race which is of the stock we called Atlantic-Occidental, in its prehistoric forms that lead us, e.g., up to the Pelasgic, Minoan-Mycenaean, or Etruscan civilization and to its last revival, among which Pythagoreanism returns. Such a race represents a decay of the hyperborean spirituality which appeared suddenly in the regions of Atlantis through processes of action and reaction, causing a series of other changes. Lunar elements can moreover be observed in the race of the man of the East (Alpine-Oriental) by some racialists—the psycho-anthropology of Claus designates this race as the “race of evasion” — *der Enthebungsmenschen* — something that corresponds visibly to a characteristic of the lunar man.

Posted on 2014-03-26 by Aeneas

3.II Race and Death

In this short segment on death and race from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, **Julius Evola** returns to traditional doctrines. As expected, he makes clear that personality transcends race, i.e., the person creates race, but the race does not create the person. That is because the person transcends his material and biological conditioning, and has a dual destiny. On the material plane, he continues the race with his first-born son, the “son of duty”. Yet he also has a supernatural destiny. Hence, at a certain stage of life, a man may abandon, after having fulfilled them, his family duties and dedicate himself to that spiritual destiny.

He condemns biological racism as “telluric”, since it is restricted to the material conditions of life. Furthermore, such views are associated with the denial of an afterlife. This is the path of darkness, the southern path, unlike the path of light, or northern path,

described by Evola. His last line is quite harsh: “they pass onto others the task for which they were inadequate.”

Those commenters who would dismiss us as just another “traditionalist” site saying the same things, are not very careful readers (as already has been demonstrated). On the contrary, few such sites adhere to traditional principles and promote lifestyles in conformity to Tradition, as this chapter demonstrates.

On the strength of what should be clear at this point, we would like to pause a moment to make precise the limits of the membership of personality to its race. In this regard, we will immediately point out the view that is unacceptable from the traditional perspective: it is the view of those who have conceived race as a purely biological-human, historical, and, to sum it up, only a terrestrial entity, and who now think that such an entity is the goal of every being who belongs to it, that nothing exists superior to race, since race is the origin of every value and they consider that the idea of the extraterrestrial attainment and purpose of the individual is illusory and detrimental: “to remain faithful to land and race.”

We have already encountered and criticized this conception more than once. Opposed to it, moreover, we can appeal to the racialist criterion for the evaluation of the “truth”; according to the various “races of the spirit” there are, in a particular way, similar conceptions of race itself—and there is no doubt that the conception we just pointed out can be “true” only for a telluric race, only the telluric man is able to support unconditionally such limited horizons. Furthermore in this telluric vision of race the assumption, that we have sketched out, of those “neo-pagan” racialists also comes into play, since for them the only conceivable immortality would be that of the survival in the blood, in terrestrial descendants.

It is true that similar positions, today, are presented to us less on the basis of a theoretical value than of a practical and political value—i.e.,

they seek to consolidate the unity of the race of the people and to concentrate every spiritual energy of the individual into temporal and historical tasks that this entity has to resolve. But it is likewise true that the ancient Aryan civilizations, even with respect to terrestrial, heroic, and political achievements, had their greatness without feeling the need to appeal to these myths, recognizing instead rather different truths; it is quite evident, in fact, that this view about race recalls the *pitryana*, the “way of the South”, which we previously mentioned, which is opposed the *devayana*, the “divine way of the North”, that stood alone as defining the highest Aryan ideal.

And the theory of “double hereditary” is also related to such an ideal. Personality is not fully accounted for in historical-biological or horizontal heredity: instead, it appears as a principle that, in order to manifest itself in race (race meant here in the restricted sense), stands in itself beyond race but cannot be exhausted in it. To recognize race—as has been made clear on principle—does not mean to diminish the personality: personality owes the living and articulated material for its specific expression to race and to as much as terrestrial heredity includes, through its self-manifestation and action. However, there is a conditioning that is neither passive nor one-sided in that. Every individual also reacts on race and his heredity, on the basis of his own most intimate nature; he develops the substance in which he is manifested, the form beyond, and it is in that way that interracial differentiation and that diverse purity or completeness of types are realized, things which we already mentioned and to which we will now return, with regard to its social effects: here it is a giving as much as a receiving. At the points where the highest equilibrium and adaptation are reached (equilibrium, according to our tripartite view spirit, soul, body, between the various component of the true race), there is as a culmination beyond which the personality has nowhere to go—it has nowhere to go along a horizontal or earthly line. His work remains and belongs along this line and his child is physiologically his lineage. But

personality itself, if it reached such a peak, is “free” and can approach a perfection that is now properly supernatural.

This is precisely the most ancient Aryan conception, pertaining to those who do not belong properly to the group of spiritual leaders, conceptions that can also be found in the various views and legends of the Western Middle Ages. The scrupulous observance of the earthly laws of race, caste, etc. is prescribed, i.e., *dharmā*, to the point of complete compliance. Such laws also require the assurance of a lineage: life, which is received at birth, must be given back before death, with its own mark, to another being, and it is for this reason that the firstborn son is called the “son of duty”. After the “active life”, according to Aryan law, one can retire to an ascetic-contemplative life. And the Iranian-Aryan saying is rather expressive: the true task is not only to first procreate oneself on the horizontal line of terrestrial descendants, but also upwards, in the ascending vertical direction. In Western religion all these views were confused—above all, what is pertinent to the active life was sharply disconnected from the contemplative life and almost always the truly traditional solutions were forgotten, according to which the law, which is not of this earth, prolongs, completes, and strengthens the law of the earth. But even more harmful than such confusions are the “telluric” racist views alluded to, in case they should be taken seriously and have a future. According to the traditional teaching of the Aryan peoples, the idea instead became fixed that the destiny and the dignity of the personality is essentially supernatural; this goal, however, acts as the highest motor impulse and the deepest animating force at the heart of the expression that race gives to the personality, therefore simultaneously raises race up to a limit, beyond which, after having left a sign of greatness, the same force is liberated and tends to act so that death is precisely the fulfillment—*telos*—a new birth—the third birth of the Indo-Aryan teaching.

Only the mediocre or failures among beings, i.e., those who are unable to completely fulfill the law and earthly duty, who perhaps think

that they do not have an afterlife, that they have for their destiny, the self-dissolution into the confused vitality of race, into the collective and terrestrial substance of blood and heredity, surviving only in that way—in a rather relative sense of the word—to the destruction of their physical individuality, and passing onto others the task for which they were inadequate.

Posted on 2014-03-30 by Aeneas

3.12 The Group of Aryan Races

In this section from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, **Julius Evola** describes the third migration from the Hyperborean regions. This was the incursion of the Germanic tribes into the Roman Empire. He points out that they were a degenerate remnant, and were unable to continue the civilization of the Roman Empire. It took several centuries for European civilization to re-emerge, beginning with **Charlemagne**.

Evola then sketches out the various branches that followed from the Hyperborean migrations. As we see, his understanding of “race” is more in line with the UNESCO understanding of a race as an “ethnic group”. As such, the Hyperboreans, or “Aryans”, include the inhabitants of the Indian sub-continent, ancient Egyptians, Persians, and even Amerindians and Eskimos.

By “race of the first level”, Evola refers to the race of the body, which is how most people conceive race. Of course, there are also two higher levels: the race of the soul and the race of the spirit. He rejects so-called “scientific” racism, since it deals strictly with the race of the body. For Evola, genetics cannot explain the soul and spirit of the various races.

As justification, he refers to the philosopher Emile Boutroux¹²,

¹²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/%C3%89mile_Boutroux

who denies that even the physical world is deterministic. This type of philosophizing is virtually unknown today, but was a dominant perspective among French and Italian philosophers at the time.

A fortiori, man, as a free spirit, can hardly be fixed and determined by his body or genetic makeup, despite certain tendencies or habits. Any attempt by “science” to “fix” a given race to predetermined characteristics or behaviors is ultimately deleterious.

The most recent of all is the emigration of the third voyage which followed the north-south direction. Some Nordic lineages had previously traversed this direction in prehistoric times; they are those, for example, who gave rise to the Doric-Achaean civilization and brought the cult of the Hyperborean Apollo to Greece. The last wave was that of the so-called “migration of the people” which happened at the fall of the Roman Empire and corresponds to the race of the Nordic-Germanic type. In this respect, we must make a very important observation. Those races that spread in the north-south direction descend more directly from the Hyperborean lineage who last left the Arctic regions. For that reason, they often display, from the viewpoint of the race of the body, a greater purity and conformity to the original type, having had fewer possibilities of encountering different races. The same however cannot be said from the viewpoint of their inner race and traditions. Their self-maintenance, further from the sister races, in the conditions of a climate which had become particularly harsh and unfavorable could cause in them a certain materialization, a one-sided development of certain physical qualities and especially of character, courage, resistance, tenacity and inventiveness, having, however as its counterpart, an atrophy of the truly spiritual side.

That is seen previously among the Spartans: to a greater extent, however, in the Germanic peoples of the invasions that we may continue to call “barbaric”; barbaric, however, not in relation to degenerate Roman civilization, in which those people appeared, but in relation to a higher stage, from which those races had fallen by that point. Among the proofs

of such an interior degeneration, or spiritual darkening, is the relative facility with which such races converted to Christianity and then to Protestantism. For that reason, the Germanic peoples in the first centuries after the fall of the Western Roman Empire, up to Charlemagne, were unable to oppose anything of importance in the spiritual domain to the crepuscular forms of Romanity. They were enchanted by the exterior splendor of such forms and easily fell victim to Byzantinism, they were unable to reanimate much of Nordic-Aryan existence, in spite of everything, in the Mediterranean world, that by means of a faith corrupted, in more than one aspect, by Semitic-Southern racial influences as soon as they later on gave form to the Holy Roman Empire under the Catholic sign.

Thus even some of the German racial theorists, like Gunther, had to recognize that, while trying to reconstruct the vision of the world and the type of spirituality characteristic of the Nordic race, had to refer less to the testimony included in the traditions of the Germanic peoples of the period of the invasions – fragmentary testimonies, often altered by foreign or decadent influences in the form of popular superstitions or folklore – than to the superior spiritual forms characteristic of ancient Rome, ancient Greece, Persia, and India, i.e., of the civilizations derived from the two first waves.

For the combination of the races and traditions generated by these three currents, the first transverse (Ario-Nordic lineage), the next horizontal (Nordic-Atlantic or Nordic-Occidental lineage), the last vertical (the Ario-Germanic lineage) we can apply, not so much for true conformity, but rather on the basis of a usage that has become current, the term “Aryan”. In order to take into consideration the races defined by the most noted and recognized of racial theories of the first level, we can say that the trunk of the Aryan race, having at its root the primordial Hyperborean race, is differentiated in the following way. There is first of all, as the blond race, the branch called Nordic in the strict sense, that some differentiate into Teutonic-Nordic, Dalic-Falic, and Finno-Nordic sub-

branches. The same lineage in its mixing with the aboriginal Sarmatian populations then gave rise to the so-called East-Europid and East-Baltic types. All these human groups, from the point of view of the race of the body, as was noted, preserve great fidelity or purity in respect to what can be presumed to have been the primordial Nordic, or Hyperborean, type.

In the second place, we must consider the races that are most different in relation to the original type, whether in the sense of its phenotype, or form, which the same dispositions and the same hereditary genes caused under the action of a different environment, or of mix-mutations, i.e., mutations produced by more accentuated mixing. It is a matter of predominantly brown types, of smaller stature, in which the dolicephalous is not the rule or is not too pronounced. We mention, using the terminology that is more in vogue, the so-called race of the man of the west, the Atlantic race that, as Fischer defined, is already different from it, then the Mediterranean race, from which, in its turn according to Peters, the variety of the Euro-African man, or African-Mediterranean is distinguished, where the dark component has greater prominence. Sergi's classification, according to whom these last two types more or less coincide, must be rejected and, from the point of view of practical racial theory, especially the Italian, is among the most dangerous. Equally dubious is calling the Mediterranean race, as Peters does, the Pelasgic: in conformity with the meaning that the word had in Greek civilization, it is necessary to consider the Pelasgic type, in a certain way, in itself, especially in terms of the result of a degeneration of some very ancient Atlantic-Aryan stocks established in the Mediterranean before the appearance of the Hellenes. Particularly, from the point of view of the race of the soul, this meaning of the "Pelasgics" is justified, among whom the ancient Etruscan people also are included.

In a certain way by itself is the Dinaric race because while it is very close to the Nordic type in certain aspects, in others it shows characteristics in common with the Armenoid and desert race and, like that which

some racial theorists define properly as the Alpine or the Vosgic race, is prevalently shown brachycephalous: the sign of crossing that happened along other directions. The Aryan race of the east has, again, distinct characteristics, both physical and mental, through which it is distanced substantially from the Nordic type.

There is nothing contradictory, from the traditional point of view, in assuming in the doctrine of race of the first level the clarifications that the various authors make in relation to the physical and, in part, mental, characteristics of all these branches of Aryan humanity. Only it is not necessary to create too many illusions on the importance of all that, in the sense of establishing rigid limits. Thus, although neither white nor blonde, the superior races of Iran and India, and, although not white, many ancient Egyptian types can moreover be included in the Aryan family. Not only: authors like Wirth and Kadner, who sought to utilize recent studies on blood groups for racial research, were led to believe that some North American Amerindian and Eskimo stocks were closer to the primordial Nordic type, than the greater part of the Indo-European Aryan races just noted. And in this kind of investigations, for example, it indicates moreover that the primordial Nordic blood in Italy has a percentage close to that of England, and certainly higher than that of the Germanic peoples. It is therefore necessary to not be fixated on rigid schemas and to think that, except for rather rare cases, the “form” of the original super-race, more or less latent, obstructed, overpowered, or exhausted, subsists in the depths of all these human types. Under certain conditions, it can reappear as predominant and shape a given type from itself, which proves them equivalent, even where it is least suspected, that is, where the previous races according to the schematic and static conception of race, would have instead made the appearance of a type of race, let us suppose, Mediterranean, Indo-Afghani, or Baltic-Oriental, seem probable.

Emile Boutroux, in one of his classic works *On the contingency of*

the laws of nature has compared the regularity of phenomena that permits relatively exact scientific predictions, to the course of a river, whose waters follow a riverbed that however it itself hallowed out, so that they can modify it and in exceptional circumstances even abandon it. He considered natural laws as a sort of “habit” of things: what originally was also able to be a free act, in repeating itself, automatizes and mechanizes itself and ends up appearing to be a necessity. If that is valid for the laws of so-called inanimate, physical nature, it is of greater validity in respect to races. The proper description of racial theory of the first level, that, in certain authors, leads up to distinctions of an almost scholastic pedantry, fits in the measure to which the forces of races, so to speak, follow a type of law of inertia that automatizes them and fixes them in the state in which, at a given moment, they find themselves being. In these conditions the models drawn for each of the Aryan race fit, determinisms are verified, and sciences observe. At the moment in which the most original forces begin to advance, these constructions demonstrate their relativity and an excessive attention conceded to racial theories of the first level and its “scientific” results can even end up bringing damage to the creative and evocative task of race theory.

Posted on 2015-04-15 by Aeneas

* * *

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-15 at 09:47 said:

Often with these writings on the Hyperborean Race and its various branches, I feel the need to break everything up and draw diagrams. The run-on sentences get a little too hard to follow. Its one of the troubles I had with a few of Evola's chapters. Excuse me while I go and decipher what is no doubt enlightening information that there is no way I comprehended with just one read.

Aeneas on 2015-04-15 at 12:43 said:

Please let us know of the most confusing passages. Evola does not write very pretty Italian. We've already had to break up several longer sentences into shorter ones in the translation, but perhaps that was not enough.

Bill on 2015-04-15 at 13:34 said:

Wouldn't it be more accurate to say that Evola doesn't reject scientific racism, but recognizes it as subordinate to the higher aspects of race?

Aeneas on 2015-04-15 at 17:05 said:

Bill, if you can provide some exact quotes to support your "more accurate" understanding, then we can discuss. But first of all, you'll have to explain what you mean by "subordinate". You may also want to comment on the paragraph about Emile Boutroux.

obscure on 2015-04-15 at 20:38 said:

Let us just say that the distinction between 'phenotype' and 'genotype' is, from the highest point of view, superficial since both 'types' are phenomenal. The gene is just as much a symbol as the facial structure, but it possesses a certain technical value with regard to material analysis and the overall program of techno-science. If one starts from this point of view, the real discourse begins with this question: What is the intelligible essence 'behind' the symbol? In other words, how does one really 'substantiate' the phenomena?

The materialistic racist errs especially in his individualistic viewpoint. For individuals are always understood within some holistic structure. I couldn't study a race unless I studied them as a nation and not just a nation constituted in terms of 'culture' (or what the anthropologists mean by 'culture'), but in spiritual terms. Ultimately, this leads to the understanding of a people as a spiritual corporation. If one goes far in this direction then the type of 'evolutionary psychology' which amazes the multitude and the cliques will be seen in its full vapidty. But, to take such an intellectual path requires a certain individual decision which is not in the least bit suitable for all.

Mike on 2015-04-15 at 21:06 said:

Thank you so much for this.

Since you were kind enough to offer some clarifications, I am having a difficult time with this passage:

"... that proves the corresponding even where it is least suspected, that is, where the antecedent, according to the schematic and static conception of race, would have made instead the appearance of a type of race, let us suppose, Mediterranean, Indo-Afghani, or Baltic-Oriental, seem probable."

What is the "corresponding" and the "antecedent" that Evola is referring to?

And so I know I'm on the right track, in the first half of this passage (sentence), Evola is stating that for Aryans, a return to exact Hyperborean form (race of the second and third levels)

is impossible to them, since they have all, to varying degrees, parted from the Hyperboreans in terms of race of the first level. Am I correct in this understanding?

obscure on 2015-04-15 at 22:00 said:

And to Cologero,

Thank you for publishing all of these items.

Aeneas on 2015-04-16 at 00:09 said:

Mike, I tried to clarify that passage a little bit with a re-translation. Curiously, that entire passage is missing from the German translation and replaced with a totally different one.

I believe he is saying the opposite: specifically, the qualities of the original race can reappear, often unexpectedly. We are all trying to pull too much out of one section. Evola will discuss Mendelian genetics (whose scientific validity he doesn't deny) as well the the problems with crossings, and so on.

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-16 at 14:37 said:

"They were enchanted by the exterior splendor of such forms and easily fell victim to Byzantinism, they were unable to reanimate much of Nordic-Aryan existence, in spite of everything, in the Mediterranean world, that by means of a faith corrupted, in more than one aspect, by Semitic-Southern racial influences as soon as they later on gave form to the Holy Roman Empire under the Catholic sign."

You really have to pick this apart to find out what is actually being said. I'm sure everyone appreciates all the effort you put into translation. This is invaluable stuff.

Max on 2015-04-19 at 13:52 said:

The Nordic-Germanic wave were unable to continue civilization writes Evola, however their intent was to keep civilization alive in face of roman degeneration and they managed to restore the monarchy with new northern blood. Evola says they descend more directly from the polar center than the remnants of the earlier migrations. They were physically pure, but "asleep" from long periods of dark isolation. The material conditions took its toll, a certain heaviness in the inner life of the nordics. They are sometimes prone to materialistic cults of the body or external phenomena, often a type of spiritual lethargy can be seen as counterpart to an outer activity. It is then a question of illuminating the shadow cast on the north.

Evola does not equal Hyperborean to exclusively Indo-european, so it makes one wonder if the Indo-european speakers should actually be regarded as part of the same wave to a degree, or if a classification according to language is irrelevant. In the case they are seen as the third wave spread out over several millennia, the chronology should move back in time to make the origin of the earlier waves prior to the end of the ice-age. The Germanics represent the

most northern population and consequently exhibit some tendencies developed to an extreme. One of the characteristics is a high degree of individuality, whose negative shadow manifested in northern protestantism. Individuality could be seen as a fault or virtue depending on the expression it takes and we should strive to bring out the positive quality in each “character flaw” while remedying its negative. This particular flaw actually seems to be highly developed in Evola himself, for better or worse. In a positive expression, rather than just denying authority, it could for example take the form of an inviolable accountability before God above else, the northern ideal of every man being his own King, or a healthy disregard for false authorities.

There is definitely an anarchic tendency in the northern soul, explored by Jünger for example, but it is coupled to a strong social conformity advantageous in sparsely populated areas. The modern world brings out the negative side of both, so what gives rise to a democratic leveling by “conforming” should instead be realized in a higher state by humility, a certain concealment in a calm and ordered behaviour and distaste for expressing every whim arising from below. A negative development would be to repress all impulses becoming almost mechanical as is a Germanic stereotype.

Many ethnicities and physical races contains the “higher” race latently, and contrary to earlier periods it does not express itself “naturally” and integrally. We have to distinguish various influences acting upon us and uncover some that have been obfuscated. This is a practice in ordering ourselves. We can not simply accept everything as “a part of me” indiscriminately as is the modern habit, but have to consciously explore our “parts” and choose the higher over the lower. It means that race is not something we just possess passively but have to acquire through effort and introspection. It would not be surprising if an inner change shows in outer appearance too, not necessarily in hard facts and measurements but as the subtle expression that is impossible to calculate or catalogize. It is said that initiates tend to recognize each other, supposedly not due to hair colour or the shape of the nose though.

I am wondering if the classical civilizations of the ancient world could actually be attributed to a “recombination” of different Hyperborean voyages sharing a common past to then reunify after being separated for a long period. In any case, the Germanics were those stubborn enough not to migrate much south, but stay and gradually be surrounded by darkness rather than subject themselves to the violent revolutions of the south; it has to be admitted as some form of asceticism.

3.13 The Sexes and Race

In this and in the following section, **Julius Evola** deals with the traditional view of the sexes. He will justify the notion that the

division into sexes has a corporeal, psychic, and spiritual component. His opinion is quite “politically incorrect”. Oddly, he had to deal with PC in his own time: the German translation omits all references to Germany or Germanic people.

Text On the bases of the above-mentioned ideas, it would also be necessary to return to the question of hybrids, bringing the sexes into the discussion. Even here we encounter a curious contradiction in race theory, that such questions are almost never posed. Contradicting this principle, claiming the differences of all human types as subjected in equal measure to the same biological laws that race theory considers in the same way, so it seems never to have been considered that normally the inheritance and the power of race can have a different weight according to whether it is about a man or a woman. Anyone who faced this problem had to resolve it directly in reverse, by supposing, again on the basis of simply biological considerations, a greater power of conservation of the race and the type in the woman.

From the point of view of traditional doctrine, it is exactly the opposite that is true in the case of normal humanity. This doctrine, if worthy of the rather minor attention of what today some of the most theatrical and insignificant grant to biological considerations, would furnish some rather useful suggestions for a problem of no small importance, which is the technique for the elevation of relatively inferior breeds through various cycles of heredity. Thus, in the most ancient Indo-European code, the Laws of Manu (Manava Dharmasastra), the transition of a non-Aryan into the caste of the Aryans is possible after seven generations of crosses maintained on the male line. This number seven also reappears in other traditions in analogous circumstances, while, in regard to the cycle of an individual human life, it is the number of years that are necessary for a periodic rejuvenation of all the elements of the body according to scientific research.

In this situation, the Laws of Manu stipulate what must be considered as a cornerstone for the question from the traditional point of view: male inheritance cannot be put on the same level as the female, because, in principle, the former has the “dominant” quality, as it is called in Mendelism, and the latter is “recessive”. Therefore, when the woman is of the higher race, her higher inheritance is overpowered in the mixture, while the superior male inheritance, in the opposite case, is not necessarily contaminated, except in limit-cases or exceptions, and except what we will say about being man. “Whatever are the qualities of a man with whom a woman is united by legitimate rite, she acquires them like the water of a river united to the ocean” (Laws of Manu IX, 22).

And again (IX, 33-36): “If one compares the creative power of the male with that of the female, the male must be declared superior because the ancestor of all beings is distinct from the male characteristics. Whatever type of seed that is thrown in a field prepared in the appropriate season, this seed is developed in a plant with particular qualities, which are those of the male seed.”

By sacred tradition the woman is declared to be the soil, the man is declared to be the seed; the production of all corporeal beings takes place through the union of the soil with the seed. In some cases the seed is more distinguished, and in some the womb of the female; but when both are equal, the offspring is most highly esteemed. On comparing the seed and the receptacle, the seed is declared to be more important; the offspring of all created beings is marked by the characteristics of the seed. Whatever seed is sown in a field, prepared in due season, a plant of that same kind, marked with the peculiar qualities of the seed, springs up in it.

Completing the image, all the more, we can concede that when the field is not prepared and the season is not suitable, the male quality will be obstructed in the descendants or will wilt, or certainly it will dry up,

but it could never happen that the seed of a palm might come from a juniper plant through a miraculous power of the soil or season – i.e., by analogy, of the woman and the psychic conditions of a sexual union. As we have deliberately revealed, as long as we have the normal world in view, that is always presupposed by every traditional teaching.

Thus, in order to know what one must think today in this regard, rather than consulting the biologist, it is necessary to clarify the extent to which the modern world can indeed be called normal in regard to the condition of the sexes. The answer, unfortunately, can only be negative. The modern world no longer knows what it means to be a man or a woman in the higher sense. It is moving toward a lack of differentiation of types that is already very visible on the spiritual plane and, from it, here and there it seems to be translated onto the physical and biological plane giving rise to worrisome phenomena. In the West, masculinity and femininity are considered as things simply of the body, instead of qualities, above all, of the inner being of the soul and the spirit. In this respect, in the West, little more than nothing has been known about the polarity, the gap, the different function and dignity of the two sexes for some time. And so, very important problems regarding race are today considered in their exterior and consequential aspects, rather than in their internal and substantial aspects. For example, they are very concerned with the demographic problem and they create every type of institution for hygiene and social assistance and the increase of the race in the strict sense, but they ignore the fundamental point, which is the meaning of the relationship between the sexes and the precise imperative that whoever is born a man, is a man, and woman, a woman, in everything and for everything, in the spirit and in the body, without mixing and without attenuation. Only in this case the traditional teachings have validity and open up almost unlimited possibilities for the initiatives of selection and elevation of the races through adequate crosses and hereditary processes. Certainly not in the case in which, like today, we see in regard to being man or woman,

a still more oblique mixing than in regard to being of one race or another: in which some beings are men in the body but feminine in the soul or in the spirit, and vice versa, while being silent about the spread of sexual and psychical inclinations of a really pathological character.

But at this point we have to remind the reader of what we already wrote about it in *Revolt against the Modern World*, while touching on the death of races. Since descendants are not formed through combinations of hereditary elements made in a laboratory or in appropriate state institutions, but derive from the unions of men and women, it would be logical that, as the premise to every active conception of race and every discrimination of one race or another, the race of the male and the race of the female be defined and separated, in the same corporeal, psychic, and spiritual completeness, by which we formulated the theory of the three levels of race theory.

Moreover, we note a unique circumstance which confirms the fact that races, which have biologically preserved more of the Nordic type, are sometimes found inwardly at a greater level of involution and degeneration than others of the same family: we mean that some of the Nordic peoples—Germans and Anglo-Saxons—are those in which the traditional relationships between the two sexes have been greatly subverted. So-called woman's emancipation—which only means her mutilation and degradation in reality—has in fact begun from those peoples and has had the greatest hold in them, where in the Roman peoples, even if only due to bourgeois and conventional reflexes, something of the normal and traditional way of relating is still preserved, in this regard. The height then is reached when some foreign theorists exalt the triviality of terms like *compagno* and *compagna* and so-called “respect for woman” as an alleged characteristic of the Nordic race, not suspecting in the least that by doing so, they simply echo an abnormal state of a relatively recent date, while they assume every conception based on the proper distance, polarity, and different dignity of the two sexes as the Asiatic prejudices of

the inferior races of the South. It is necessary to recognize that if such distortions are assumed as principles, the path taken would lead not to the reawakening and the reintegration of the pure Nordic type, but to a further involution—in the direction of a trivialization of an inner leveling of the types—of what still remains in the Germanic peoples.

Posted on 2015-04-23 by Aeneas

* * *

Cologero on 2015-04-24 at 08:03 said:

*Feminism in Norway*¹³ confirms what Evola wrote in regard to the feminist movement in the Scandinavian countries.

argusandphoenix on 2015-04-24 at 21:23 said:

It's interesting that the British Empire had its two "greatest" sovereigns, Queen Elizabeth & Queen Victoria, as the apex of their monarchy. The males seem to have been largely forgotten or vilified. I remember coming across a reference to this, vis a vis Evola and "race", and will try to find it. Contrast this with the Middle Ages, in which "Good King Richard" or Henry II are far more important figures. The ancient sources I'm familiar with do indicate that the Teutonic races, when encountered by Rome, had differing conceptions of male-female relationships. I think Caesar remarked on the power and influence held by women among the Celts, as well. It's troubling that the roots of this stretch back almost to pre-history. For what it's worth, Caesar in the Gallic Wars comes across as mild and even-handed and "frank" by comparison with the perfidious Celtic tribes which were migrating around Western Europe.

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-25 at 15:53 said:

"In this situation, the Laws of Manu stipulate what must be considered as a cornerstone for the question from the traditional point of view: male inheritance cannot be put on the same level as the female, because, in principle, the former has the "dominant" quality, as it is called in Mendelism, and the latter is "recessive". Therefore, when the woman is of the higher race, her higher inheritance is overpowered in the mixture, while the superior male inheritance, in the opposite case, is not necessarily contaminated, except in limit-cases or exceptions, and except what we will say about being man."

¹³http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Feminism_in_Norway

Fascinating. So even during miscegenation, the male genes overpower regardless of race. This presents an interesting study for the various combinations of miscegenaic birth.

@Cologero – Say it ain't so that you're actually throwing in the towel on Gornahoor! May I ask why? Have you simply run out of material to work with, or just a general moving on. I've found your analysis of Evola's work to be invaluable to my own.

Cologero on 2015-04-26 at 00:28 said:

Mark, I don't believe Evola is referring to biological heredity through "genes", but rather the inherited soul and spirit of the race. The next section of Sintesi might expand on that idea.

There is no lack of material, quite the contrary. I'll make clear soon why it is necessary to end one phase and begin another. Moreover, the actual personal work with the Gnosis group is much more important, so it needs to be expanded.

Nexist418 on 2015-04-26 at 23:55 said:

Will these be collected together? Were they released in order? If not, will a table of contents be provided?

Cologero on 2015-04-27 at 07:54 said:

Yes, Nexist418, the chapters will be collected together and published as a book. They are not being released in order, and there is a table of contents online if you bother to look for it.

Can you tell us what value this work has for you?

Nexist418 on 2015-04-27 at 13:31 said:

I wanted to read it in order. I did not find the TOC when I looked, but I will look again.

Lu Dongbin on 2015-04-28 at 09:36 said:

Strange situation regarding the Germanic relationship between man and women and the overall masculinity and heroism of the Germanic people in relation to that of Southern Europe, Italians, etc. which Evola himself commented on in many places. From his writing on Disraeli and the British Empire:

"England possesses a monarchy, an almost feudal nobility, and a military caste which, at least up until very recent years, showed remarkable qualities of character and of sang-froid."

Or from Seyyed Hossein Nasr recounting his meeting with Evola:

"While he extolled the ancient Romans and their virtues, he spoke pejoratively about his contemporary Italians. When I asked him what happened to those Roman virtues, he said they traveled north to Germany and we were left with Italian waiters singing o sole mio!"

So how is it that the masculinity, heroism, and Roman virtues Evola admired are at once concentrated to a greater degree among the Germanic people since the Fall of Rome, and yet

these same people have a degenerated relationship between the sexes in comparison? What would be spiritual source or cause of this odd state of affairs?

It seems that Evola was certainly correct about his overall view on the matter, especially regarding “further involution” when we take a look at the current state of affairs in the Western world today and especially in Germanic and Nordic countries regarding feminism, etc.

3.14 **The Masculine and Feminine Races**

In this chapter of *Sintesi*, **Julius Evola** demonstrates that the male and female are equivalent to different races. This is not simply the obvious corporeal differences, but extends also the the soul and the spirit. The female spirit is undifferentiated whereas the male spirit is differentiated.

He appeals to **J J Bachofen**’s writings on ancient gynocentric civilizations which had “promiscuity, communism, mother right, general equality as their characteristics”. He mentions two possible outcomes:

- an awakening, a reaffirmation, and a vivification
- dissolution and debasement

From this perspective, the Western nations are moving toward a more gynocratic form. This is not *imposed*, but rather accepted and even chosen, by a race in decline, that is, those who have followed the second possibility. There is still the first possibility.

The Masculine and Feminine Races The notion of the “race of man” and the “race of woman” is not a totally gratuitous extension of the concept. We believe, in fact, that in order to truly take these things into account one should not disregard at all the observations made in Otto Weininger’s notable work¹⁴, especially in two points. The first is in the

¹⁴<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/SexAndCharacter.pdf>

determination of the type of the pure man or pure woman, as the basis for measuring the “quantities” of one or the other that are found in each individual and then to govern oneself in a compliant way. The second is in the daring idea that the existing relations between true man and true woman correspond analogically to those that exist between the Aryan and Semitic races. For Weininger, man is to the woman as the Aryan to the Semite. Weininger did the research on feminine qualities that appear as an exact match to those typical of the Semite and the Jew. One such research is tendentious to a great degree. Weininger, being half-Jewish, was began especially to lose heart and degrade even without wishing it—he did not find the true value of the woman where he should have found it. Nevertheless, his views are still valid; the idea that, from the point of view of a normal and differentiated conception of the sexes, man and woman almost manifest as the expression of two different races, if not pure opposites. It is therefore a serious defect of descriptive and typological racial theory to not take that into account when making the effort to identify and describe the characteristics of each race, while not asking if certain qualities, normal for the masculine type of a given race, continue to be so regarded when applied instead to its feminine type.

In order to remedy this defect, naturally we need to consider the sexes also in their psychical and spiritual aspect. From that point of view, it is certainly absurd to conceive, for example, as normal that the “Nordic” woman embodies the same values typical of the pure Nordic man—that is to say, everything that is calm and dominating superiority, solarly, sense of distance, active detachment, connected to a readiness to attack and whatever else we find out. Without directly referring to the Semitic people (unlike Weininger), if we do not want to end up at leveling and therefore mongrelization, it is instead desirable and normal that the same Nordic woman has her own psychical and spiritual qualities, which have a central position in different, non-Nordic races.

Moreover, once the race of the body, or anthropological race, where

the female racial differences are well-known and obvious, is omitted, the distinctive characteristics of the women of the various races are much less pronounced on the level of the race of the soul than in the case of the male. In fact, then, at the level of race of the spirit, there is often a true undifferentiation. The real support of the race of the soul and, especially of the spirit, is the man. It is especially in him that the principle of differentiation falls, while the principle of equality is reflected more in the feminine element. Not by accident did the ancient traditions associate, in cosmic analogy, the feminine element with that of matter or unformed power, hylé, dynamis, and the masculine, instead, with the celestial principal of order and individualization. Still less is it an accident that the ancient gynocratic and matriarchal civilizations, as an immediate consequence of the preeminence accorded to the feminine principle in its various, maternal or aphroditic forms, had promiscuity, communism, mother right, general equality as their characteristics. See *The Solar Race* by Bachofen. Strictly speaking, opposite to every man worthy of this name, the true woman that our ancestors considered significantly as “woman of race”, had to present herself as something dangerous, as a foreign principle that attracts, insinuates herself, and demands an inner action: almost the same type of reaction of which we said speaking of cross-breedings, where foreign blood puts the type to the test and gives rise to two possibilities: either to an awakening, a reaffirmation, and a vivification, or else to dissolution and debasement. In the first case, the man maintains himself at the peak of his purpose and, according to traditional teachings, his qualities permeate and persist intact in his progeny, as the “dominant” character. In the second case, in a form more or less disguised, he will undergo at least an internal degeneration of the type. Uncontrollable forces will take the upper hand in the processes of heredity, the protection of the race will become something problematic, until the limit-case is realized, that is, the return, in new forms, to the spirit and promiscuity of the gynocratic civilizations formed by the anti-Nordic races and from the degeneration

of the Nordic race.

Posted on 2015-04-29 by Aeneas

* * *

Boreas on 2015-04-30 at 10:04 said:

The Gornahoor wordpress site seems to have been made private; what do I need to do to be able to read the article?

Cologero on 2015-04-30 at 12:12 said:

Boreas, we plan to leave it open for certain windows. Eventually, it will probably be made private for those interested. Since only 20% of readers are clicking through, it really doesn't matter.

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-30 at 18:11 said:

Correct me if I'm wrong, is Evola saying here that a 'race of the sex' dichotomy is spiritually present during the procreation event and that in Modernity a feminine, degenerative descent is occurring rather than a masculine, heroic descent (that being proper to Tradition.)

If so, what is the solution to this problem, which is obviously not medical or genetic? Will this simply return to the old masculine sexo-racial line of descent once the World of Tradition is restored, or does something active have to be done as it pertains to child-bearing and conception?

Átila on 2015-05-15 at 11:38 said:

Read the book "The Myth of Matriarchal Prehistory" By CYNTHIA ELLER

Cologero on 2015-05-15 at 12:35 said:

Sorry to have to make a public example of you, Atila, but that is not how to write an intelligent comment. If you want to help your fellow human beings, you would have mentioned specific points from the book and then applied them to the post you are commenting on.

I read the amazon page for the book as well as some comments by those who actually read the book. As one reviewer wrote:

"Firstly, it must be understood that Dr. Eller was not out to prove that prehistory was in any way universally patriarchal. Dr. Eller is certainly aware of the many matriarchal, matrilineal and matrifocal prehistorical societies."

This more or less confirms, or at least is consistent with, Evola's thesis.

3.15 Race of the Soul

There are many cases of people who are exactly of the same race of the body, of the same tribe, sometimes even, brothers or fathers and sons, of the same blood in the most real sense, but who nevertheless fail to understand each other. A barrier separates their souls, their way of feeling and seeing is different, and the common race of the body and common blood can do nothing about that. A possibility of comprehension exists, and therefore of true solidarity, of deep unity, only where a common “race of the soul” exists.

Since man is an ensouled body, his outward physical characteristics, or race of the body, are insufficient to determine him. That is, the body is neither a chunk of matter, nor an animal, so DNA will fail to define him. Keep in mind that by “race”, **Julius Evola** does not mean how it is understood in the USA, with its emotionally charged history of slavery, apartheid, and civil rights. Rather, it is much more specific, so he can speak of a Nordic race, an Italic race, and so on. This is more obvious in languages like Italian or German, since the word for “race” in those languages is also used to refer to “breeds” of animals.

Applying phenomenology to the experience of race, we see, as did Evola, that sharp and deep divisions separate even those of the same physical race. These are not merely accidental qualities, but are constitutive of the person. These divisions often make mutual intelligibility impossible, without the effort to transcend such differences on a higher plane. There are two all too obvious consequences to this. First of all, any attempt to appeal to some racial solidarity of the first level will necessarily fail. Secondly, these divisions at the soul level will not be resolved by discussions or “debates”. **Fabre d’Olivet** confirms this:

Nature does not make men equal; souls differ still more than bodies.

From the esoteric perspective, what is of interest is why people hold certain views, not the views themselves. For example, a convinced materialist or atheist holds his view with a passionate intensity, since he is unable to conceive of, or experience interiorly, any other possibility that makes sense to him. Bracketing out for the moment the possibility of a spiritual or intellectual conversion, people remain locked into certain fixed patterns of soul life.

Evola also provides a different understanding of “purity”. Physical purity is impossible, or at least, undesirable. There is a small, but not negligible, mutation rate in any population. Since most mutations are deleterious, an endogamous population will decline over the centuries. Purity, then, can only mean the adequation of corporeal and psychic qualities. Thus for example, on the one hand he can praise certain Nordic qualities, while also mentioning the degeneration of the Nordic race. Note that these qualities are all on the plane of the soul and spirit, not the body.

The takeaway is that successful movements depend on a core group of “like-minded” people, if that is your goal; great leaders instinctively understand this. As Evola explains,

A possibility of comprehension, and therefore of true solidarity, of deep unity, exists only where a common “race of the soul” exists.

For example, desirable qualities may include “calm and dominating superiority, solarly, sense of distance, active detachment”. Those that have such qualities actively can then identify those who may have them virtually. However, an indiscriminate mixing, a “big tent”, won’t come to much beyond putting some people in positions of power for its own sake. The telltale sign of degeneration is the failure to differentiate, which is also the hallmark of the Kali Yuga. Differentiation at the level of the soul is more important than the body. Evola concludes:

it may happen that a person gives us the clear impression by his way of acting that he “is of another race” and, then, there is no longer anything to do with him; relationships of a various nature can exist with him, but always with an inner reservation and inner distance. He “is no longer ours”.

A leader needs to make that determination. Of course, the most fundamental differentiation is that between a man and a woman, who relate to each other not just physically, but more importantly at the soul and spirit level. Nowadays, even that differentiation is losing force. Many, today, even fail to differentiate between humans and animals. The text follows.

Let’s now return to the clarification of the three levels of the doctrine of race. We consider a theory of the race of the soul and a typology of the soul of the races as the doctrine of the second level. Such a doctrine needs to identify the elements, in their primary and irreducible modes, that act from the inside, causing groups of individuals to manifest a consistent mode of being or “style” as far as acting, thinking, and feeling are concerned. With this we arrive at a new concept of racial purity of a given type: it is no longer about, as in racial doctrine of the first level, seeing if a given individual manifests a specific group of physical characteristics or even character traits, that makes him conform to the inherited type, but it is about establishing if a given individual’s race of the body is the adequate expression or confirmation of his race of the soul, and vice versa. If that is confirmed, the type is pure also in the sense of the investigations of the second level.

That then complements the results of the of the first level, because it no longer considers the various corporeal characteristics in the abstract, in a simple classification, which could even be disguised, instead of in living faces and individuals. It seeks instead to understand their secret, that is to say, what they express, the function for which they are used and by way of which, from case to case, they might even mean something

different. As we already noted, a nose of a given form and an elongated, dolicephalous skull can meet both in a type of the races derived from the Nordic stock, or in an exemplar of the African race: but it is obvious that the two cases do not have the same significance. Besides, it is quite possible that a given type has predominant characteristics, e.g., Mediterranean in the anthropological race of the body – so much so that the racial doctrine of the first level would assign him precisely to the Mediterranean race of the man of the West: nevertheless the latest research may notice that these Mediterranean traits, in the type in question, are assumed in a different function from what would normally be expected. The type that we are talking about uses them instead to express a soul, an internal attitude that is not Mediterranean, but, for example, Nordic or Near Eastern. That gives an absolutely different expressive value to the same traits and leads sometimes to certain distortions or alterations of the exterior Mediterranean element that are almost imperceptible in the research of the first level or are considered irrelevant and unimportant, while for the research of the second level they represent many ways to understand the “inner race”. Here physiognomy, the study of the meaning of the human face, has an important role: it will however develop in a different direction from the preceding, which conceived each individual separately instead of as a member of a given superbiological community, of a given race of the soul.

On this higher plane, anthropology and paleoanthropology become valuable aids for the research into the original racial elements that entered into composition, were superimposed, or clashed at the dawn of civilizations. For the highest tasks of the race theory, it is insufficient to have considered the presence, for example in Italic origins, of a given number of typical skeletons and skulls and, integrating such researches with the archeological ones, to be able to affirm fundamentally the existence of an ancient pure Nordico-Aryan Italic human type. That would not get beyond an area of a museum. It is necessary, furthermore, to make this

type speak, to penetrate into what a given corporeal form expresses, or what a given human structure is the symbol of. This is impossible without taking into account the field of the racial doctrine of the second level, and even to a certain extent the third level, disciplines that work with other methods of research and utilize another order of documents and evidence.

We can consider the so-called *Rassenseelekunde* or psychoanthropology of L. F. Clauss as racial theories of the second level, insofar as it concerns his methods and general criteria. The necessity of such research was made clear by Clauss with convincing examples. For example, he considered the phenomena of comprehension. Actually, there are too many cases of people who are exactly of the same race of the body, of the same tribe, sometimes even, brothers or fathers and sons, of the same blood in the most real sense, but who nevertheless fail to understand each other. A barrier separates their souls, their way of feeling and seeing is different, and the common race of the body and common blood can do nothing about that.

A possibility of comprehension, and therefore of true solidarity, of deep unity, exists only where a common "race of the soul" exists. Subtle elements of an instinctive sensitivity come into question at this point. While for many years nothing was suspected, in a given circumstance it may happen that a person gives us the clear impression by his way of acting that he "is of another race" and, then, there is no longer anything to do with him; relationships of a various nature can exist with him, but always with an inner reservation and inner distance. He "is no longer ours". Usually, they spoke of character in this case. The expression is vague. There is not, in fact, a "character" in general but there are different modes of appearing of the dispositions of character conditioned by the inner race. For example, the way of being "faithful" of a Near Eastern people is different from that of a man of the Nordic or Dinaric race. The way of conceiving heroism by a Mediterranean man is different from

that of a Japanese or a Russian, to use generic expressions and while not getting into precise classifications inherent to a doctrine of the race of the soul.

Posted on 2015-05-10 by Aeneas

* * *

Alistair Fraser on 2015-05-11 at 06:38 said:

“it may happen that a person gives us the clear impression by his way of acting that he “is of another race” and, then, there is no longer anything to do with him; relationships of a various nature can exist with him, but always with an inner reservation and inner distance. He “is no longer ours.”

Is it possible that by the power of early conditioning , the impulse that exists to express the genuine race of ones soul can be hindered greatly , so some people appear to be one type but are actually a repressed other type imprisoned withing their societal cage , but yet even as their true expression has been overwritten, blocked and given little room to sprout, still there may be signs of it that seep out through gesture and energy presence perceivable by others of similar ilk and so the “virtually quality ” confirms

Paulo on 2015-05-11 at 15:49 said:

well being born and raised in brasil,the eye of the hurricane kali yuga

i cant fail to notice the effects of this kind of mix

mix of the body,mix of the soul and mix of the sexes really,destiny had put me in a position were the chalenges will not give up on me!!!

3.16 Origin of the Race of the Soul

In formulating a theory of the origin of the race of the soul, Julius Evola points out that “soul” (or psyche) does not mean “subjective activities” in the mind as contemporary psychology understands it. Rather, it is a distinct entity, which he relates to the traditional teachings of the “subtle body”. In other words, it is not reducible to material, physical, or biological factors. Hence, scientific methods cannot be applied to understand the race of the soul.

At its origins, the soul and the body may have been in harmony, but that is seldom the case today. Hence, there are really two levels of heredity: the biological and the psychical. Moreover, psychical heredity is non-deterministic since the factor of elective affinity comes into play.

Addendum A commenter mentioned that this chapter seemed “arbitrary and even dangerous.” However, I believe this chapter is significant, at least in some aspects, if not in toto. For example, I believe it offers an explanation for the transmission of what is called “original sin”. In times past, the method of transmission was debated, e.g., whether it came through semen, etc. However, such biological and material explanations make no sense to anyone today. Were that true, there would be an “original sin” gene. Then, presumably, gene therapy could someday reverse the effects of original sin.

On the other hand, Joseph Ratzinger’s description of original sin as more like a psychological matrix that we are unavoidably born into makes more sense to people today. It can be understood and even observed. Nevertheless, it is still weak since a means of transmission is never specified. The notion that there is a psychical heredity, therefore, answers the question of transmission. Moreover, psychical deformations even spill over onto the body, with ill effects. This is just a starting point for understanding that doctrine.

Postscript The German translation has some interesting additions. In it, Evola refers to the “Nordic-Roman” race rather than the “Nordic” race.

He also quotes Alfred Rosenberg, with whom he otherwise had significant disagreements:

The body is the externality of the soul and the soul is the race seen from the inside.

Origin of the Races of the Soul Where do the races of the soul come from? Clearly, in the limit-case of completely pure races from a single stream, if one could assume it, they represent the psychological expression of the same particular formative power that is expressed on the physical plane by the specific and typical characteristics of the anthropological race of the body which forms the base of their inseparable unity, while belonging in itself to a still higher plane. According to the ancient traditional teachings, the soul is not simply what modern psychology believes, that is to say, an ensemble of phenomena and “subjective” activities, unfolding on a physico-biological base. For that teaching, the soul is rather a type of being in itself; as the *linga sharira*, or “subtle body”, it has its own existence, its real forces, its laws, its own heredity, distinct from the purely physico-biological.

From such a point of view, it is necessary to consider that the races of the soul are subject to vicissitudes similar the race of the body, except that, to indicate such vicissitudes, and therefore in order to know about the genesis of the races of the soul, about their essence and laws as conditioning their development and their integrity, it would necessarily be by means of immaterial research previously known by the ancient traditional sciences, but now unknown to modern culture. Although a deformed recollection of it is found in certain theosophical and occultist circles, there is however not even a suspicion of it in so-called “scientific” research. So as things stand today, it is necessary to proceed in an inductive or intuitive way, rather than from a clear body of knowledge.

In any case, bear in mind the important methodological foundation of the principle that two distinct lines of heredity exist, one of the body and the other of the soul, lines which may even diverge after races and traditions have lost their original purity from prehistoric times. While the line of biological heredity has a visible and identifiable continuity because it is based on the process of natural generation, we have to assume that the line of the heredity of the soul instead has its continuity only on

another, no longer visible, plane and can therefore connect individuals who might have nothing in common in space and time. We will return to this point in discussing the problem of birth. Here we observe the complexity that previously the problem of physical heredity itself presents in these terms, even if it not is considered as positivistic myopia. In fact, since the soul has a relationship of reciprocal action with the body, in the case of the divergence of the two heredities, there will arise in physical heredity, through the influence of the other, modifications insusceptible to explanations that biological and anthropological research will never be able to ascertain within its domain.

However, this is not the suitable place to discuss such topics, because it presupposes knowledge of the traditional conception of the multiple states of being, that substitute for the way that all the greatest problems related to man, life, death, and the world are considered today. Let's return to the point from which we started in order to say that, when you are faced with a state of racial mixing, the races of the soul should be considered as the result of three factors. The first, which is essential for it, is precisely the race of the soul as a distinct entity. The second is the influence that a mismatched body of race may have exercised over it and, through this body, which is the positive center of the relations with the outer world, an unsuitable environment. The third is the influence that a still higher element, i.e., the race of the spirit, may have exercised in the case of a new divergence between the soul and spirit, beyond that between the soul and body.

Since the unity of the various elements does not happen by chance and automatic laws, but on the basis of analogous and "elective" connections (this will also be clarified later), in spite of the divergences, we can admit, as a working hypothesis and a likely criterion, a certain equivalence. For example, out of the hundred types that demonstrate racial purity as race of the body, let us suppose, of the Nordic type, we can presume that a greater number of cases are found where, a psycho-spiritual congruent

qualification also virtually corresponds to it, than between a hundred types whose race of the body is neither Nordic, nor of Nordic origin. The misgivings of making such assumptions follow. First of all, the one just made by saying “virtually”, since, as we saw, there were cases of pure races that are half-extinguished or have declined in terms of the race of the soul. In the second place, because it is necessary to consider the cases of “propensity” – the law of affinity may have made the manifestation of a given type of personality prefer a certain race of the soul, however in accordance with such a circumstance, made to pay for this choice with the reception of a non-matching race of the body (for example, in cases of reanimation of the race in the second of the forms considered in part 2, chapter II, the elective affinities would even lead to a manifestation in mixed forms more so than in pure, but interiorly decadent, forms). In the third place, because “analogy” and “elective affinity” are terms that refer to not simply human states of existence, so that through it criteria apply which may not match the way the common mind has been led to suppose and to believe natural, logical, and desirable.

Posted on 2015-05-17 by Aeneas

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Paulo on 2015-05-17 at 23:08 said:

Other important aspect that should be demonstrated, is the influence of the land that we are born. In Carl Jung's book, "civilization in transition" in chapter XXII he mentions a certain professor Boas, that has made studies that shows that the sons of European immigrants born in the United States, had a different anatomy than their ancestors. Later in the same chapter, Jung mentions some primitive people that believe that the children born in the land usurped by their fathers from native Americans, Africans or whatever be the case, should inherit the spirits of the land. He sees some truth in that!!!

In the same chapter Jung writes extensively about the psychological differences between Americans and their European counterparts!!!

Jacob on 2015-05-18 at 13:26 said:

Thank you for the translations.

How does this relate to Tomberg's reincarnation as psychological fact or does it?

Cologero on 2015-05-18 at 16:35 said:

That's a good point, Jacob. The two Hermetists agree that there is biological and psychic heredity (bracketing out spiritual heredity for the moment). Tomberg discusses this in Letter X. However, Tomberg relates psychic continuity to "reincarnation", while Evola denies reincarnation. It probably comes down to a verbal disagreement. Tomberg denies the crude teaching of reincarnation in which "I" am being punished for something "I" did in the past.

What he is asking is that if "I" am Peter and "I" have a memory of Paul, does that mean I am both Peter and Paul? It can't mean that Paul reincarnated as Peter, since the "I" is transcendent to the experience of either one.

Nevertheless, Tomberg wants to call that an "identity" of some sort. Evola expresses it differently: Peter has an "affinity" with Paul, so Peter is born within the psychic current that included Paul. In other words, the experience may be the same, but the concept of affinity explains it better than the concept of identity. Guenon objects that an "identity" means that two things are the same in every aspect, but clearly Peter and Paul are different.

Coomaraswamy's essay on the One and Only Transmigrant may be helpful. Ultimately, there is the One I, manifesting in different ways.

3.17 The Eternal Race

In *The Eternal Race*, **Julius Evola** explains the doctrine of the "**race of the spirit**". Unlike the race of the soul, which is contingent and changeable, the race of the spirit is transhistorical. The way to access it is through the originary symbols and myths of a people. Evola describes the method, dangers, and value of this type of research.

Although the context is much different, this is not essentially much different from methods described by **Valentin Tomberg**; this undoubtedly arises from their deep and comprehensive knowledge of Hermetism. Remarkably, it is not unlike the "phenomenology" of **John Paul II** in the *Theology of the Body*. The latter treats the first chapters of Genesis as the myth of the origins of the entire human race.

For Evola, however, the goal is to determine the spiritual roots of specific peoples. He expects a “super race” to arise, which is really Guenon’s “elite” who, by recovering the original spiritual impulse of a people, will inaugurate a new civilization.

What follows is some background information for understanding the text.

Evolutionism Evola rejects “evolutionism” because it assumes that man evolved from a lower state to a higher state. This is a false metaphysical claim, although most people today assume it as a biological fact. What is too often called the “theory of evolution” is a misnomer; “neo-Darwinism” is a more accurate term (although there are alternatives), since it is based on the addition of Mendel’s work on genes as the mechanism to explain heredity in Darwinism. However, strictly as science, there is no direction or aim to it. Humans can arise from apes just as readily as an ape from a human (and the latter is more observable.) There is only a problem when science oversteps its bounds.

Klages and Jung **Carl Jung** is easily misunderstood. In his autobiography, he explains that qua scientist, he can only make psychological claims. This is what Evola objects to. However, Jung also said that the archetypes have more than a psychological significance.

Ludwig Klages is a different story. **Lucian Tudor** describes Klages’ philosophy of biocentrism in this way:

Biocentrism posited an essential distinction between Seele (Soul?) and Geist (Spirit), which conflict each other in human life. The Geist is the nous, the pneuma, or the logos ... what we would call in ordinary speech the intellect, the reason, the spirit, the mind... . The Seele corresponds to the Greek psyche. It is the living principle, the vital spark ... and one with the body, soma. Biocentrism is a romanticist and anti-rationalist philosophy which poses the

Soul as positive and the Spirit as negative. According to Biocentric theory, human beings had originally – in primordial, ancient times – lived ecstatically in accordance to the principle of *Leben* (Life, which is held as the ultimate value, to be distinguished from mere existence) and in a harmonious relation to the cosmos and the sensual world of images.

In Biocentric theory, at some point in history the force of the Spirit intruded into life and caused humans to use abstract, conceptual (as opposed to symbolic) thought and rational intellect, thus beginning the severing of body and Soul ... Biocentric philosophy also attacked Judeo-Christianity as a Logocentric religion opposed to Life and upheld ancient Paganism (which has a Dionysian character centered around vitalistic, feminine values) as the Biocentric religion of Life.

Obviously, Biocentrism is absurd from a Traditional point of view, so, for Evola, it is not only false but dangerous. However, it is implicit in much of neopagan reconstructions, which seeks to live in immediacy with no sense of the truly transcendent.

Positive Sources Evola mentions **Fustel de Coulanges** and **Bachofen** as being of fundamental importance. Evola's work will be understood better by those who have read those authors.

Text Let's now say something about research into the third grade of race, having the races of the spirit as its object. This is really the research of race at its ultimate root, wherever it is a question of normal civilizations and higher human lineages; the root, already connected to superpersonal, super-ethnic, metaphysical forces. For such research, the specific mode of conceiving both the sacred and the supernatural, as well as the relationship of man in respect to it, the vision of life in the highest sense, moreover, the entire world of symbols and myths constitute material as

positive and objective as that of the racial features of the first degree such as facial features and cranial structures. Essentially in this area, the “signs” of “vertical”, super-historical heredity are perceivable, which we said earlier; the special importance of this new research is confirmed from that point of view.

This, on the other hand, has more vast and precise possibilities of exploration of the origins and therefore of indicating the primary elements of races, than the other two degrees of race. The documents on which it is based can actually date back to the most distant prehistory, to that period which is precisely called “mythical” and which for this reason, is erroneously considered uncertain and deprived of importance by “positive” history. Furthermore, while the anthropological, archeological, and paleontological materials in themselves are mute, and while those of the research of the second degree are particularly subject to change, the myth and the symbol, in their atemporal and ahistorical nature, instead have an essential character of immutability, and therefore can often transmit elements conserving their original purity to a great extent. But naturally to reach that point, the entire trunk of prehistoric researches and whatever is connected to it, is to be sketched out by the new doctrine of race on a basis absolutely different from what applies to the older: on a pure, sacred, and no longer profane basis. It is necessary to proceed therefore to a complete revolution in the order of criteria and preconceptions that predominate in such a field, which, according to the usual trick, claim to be the measure of everything that may be considered “serious” and “scientific”. And for the first thing, we repeat, it is necessary to get rid of the evolutionistic myth in all its forms, since it is evident that if one continues to believe that the further one goes back in time, the more one sinks into the horror of a bestial barbarity, the presumption of obtaining the points of reference valid for the present from the investigations of prehistory and of the mythical periods of origins, would be something insane. Wherever any evolutionistic premise is in use, to investigate the

origins and to give prominence to the principle of heredity would lead fatally to aberrations like those of certain psychoanalytic exegetes such as Freud's *Totem and Taboo*.

From the point of view here considered, we must say that the domain of the symbol and the myth, among us, is almost virgin territory. Giambattista Vico certainly did not create a school in Italy: rather, only secondary and often minor aspects of his theories have been adopted. Our official and unofficial culture, the one that calls itself "serious" and "critical" and that unfortunately is also largely represented in general education, considers symbol and myth to this day either as an arbitrary creation of prephilosophical knowledge, or as something pertinent to inferior religious forms, or as a figurative and superstitious interpretation of merely natural phenomena, or, finally, as the formation of folklore—not to mention the discoveries of psychoanalysis and so called sociological schools, both typical creations of Judaism, that were introduced to us.

All these limitations and preconceptions must be overcome; otherwise, one must give up the fruits of the most fecund research in regard to race and primordial traditions. It is necessary to go back to conceiving myth and symbol as ancient, traditional man conceived it, i.e., as the characteristic expressions of a super-rational reality, objective in its own way, and almost as the sign, recognizable through every expert eye, of metaphysical forces that act in the depth of races, traditions, religions, and historical and prehistorical civilizations. Penetrating into the world of origins, while assuming such a point of view, is—we willingly concede—something not immune from dangers, because such a domain eludes the common means of control and criticism and, given the general lack of preparation in the field, every arbitrary and fantastic interpretation could have the right of citizenship in it. Germany has not failed to provide some examples of that. Without the armor of solid traditional principles and special qualification, quite different from that required for a "critical" research or for "philosophical" interpretation, move evil than good can

come from the exploration into the question through deformations and corruptions.

In regard to general principles, if we want to profit from other people's experience in this aspect of research of the third degree, we must prevent an error, of which Klages and, in a certain measure, even Jung, can be considered the most significant proponents, which, by only recognizing the value of the symbol and myth as the object of a "deep science", it sees in them only a type of projection of the soul of the race, conceived irrationally as an expression of simple "vital" forces: "Life" (with the capital L) or the "Collective Unconscious" would be manifested in symbol and myth. That is false. And it is dangerous because it implies a romantic-naturalistic and rather one-sided conception of what race is, and must mean, for us. When it is a question of superior races, we repeat that the notion of race must be strictly joined to that of tradition, and in tradition, in its turn, the presence and the efficiency of meta-biological, metaphysical, not sub-rational but super-rational, forces must actually be recognized, acting formatively on purely physical and "vital" evidence and constituting the mystery of everything that, through race, assumes a fixed, unmistakable nature. Symbol and myth are signs of such deep forces of race, of which we just spoke, not of a type of irrational, instinctive and unconscious substrate of the ethnic group conceived in itself, a substrate that would be really make us think of the "spirits" or the *totems* of primitive communities. In the face of confusions of this type, it is appropriate to recognize that some accusations against racial doctrine manifested as a type of new "totemism", a return to the spirit of the primordial horde, harmful for every true value of the personality, have a certain degree of justification.

Symbol and myth in our doctrine of race instead have the merit of documentary evidence through their capacity to lead us into the primary super-rational spiritual element of the races, to what is truly elemental in the world of origins. This element constitutes the leading thread for

complementary investigations of various types. Custom, ethics, ancient law, and language certainly furnish other signs for the investigation of the third degree of race and for the racial interpretation of the history of civilization. But, even here, in order to obtain valid results it is necessary to remove the limitations of the modern mentality and to recognize that, in the ancient world, ethics, law, and customs were only chapters dependent on “religion”: i.e., they reflect meanings and principles characteristic of a super-rational and sacred order. It is necessary to pick out the central point in this order, capable of conferring on everything else its own correct significance. When the investigation is closed to those forms taken in themselves, i.e., ethics, customs, law, language itself and art in the abstract, rather than as expressions above all of a given race of the body and the soul, then, by means of this, as applications or reflections of general meanings typical of tradition, the spiritual and animating force of race—when it is closed to that, again, it would remain in the are not of the original, but of the derived, not of the essential, but of the ancillary. In the face of so many of today’s works, discouraged and losing themselves in the labyrinth of specialism and criticism without principles, the fundamental work of Fustel de Coulanges, like others of the same period and those of Bachofen, maintain, in this regard, in spite of all the imperfections dependent on the period in which they were written, a fundamental importance and are worth indicating the right direction for a series of studies that integrate them with the specific consideration of the race element.

Let us point out right now that to emphasize this original, spiritual element hidden in traditional myth and symbol, that, in races, goes beyond their merely biological, material and, fundamentally, even human, aspect, is very important even from the practical point of view. With it, actually, from what is conditioned by time and history and that, therefore, could only give rise to never experienced re-exhumations, almost “commemorations”, one moves into the order of what, as essentially atemporal, is not

to be considered of “yesterday”, of a given “history” or “prehistory”, but of a perennial relevance: to the eternal race. And it is exactly this race that can be converted to an *idée-force*, capable of facilitating, through an awakening, by means of the law of attraction that attracts the similar to itself, the practical and creative tasks of applied doctrine of race, which is: the actualization of the “super-race” in the heart of the “race” as people, as the common type defined by a certain ethnic mixture, the re-emergence of the higher elements to the pure state and their formative reaffirmation, repeating the same mystery of the origins, in a new cycle of civilization.

Posted on 2015-05-24 by Cologero

* * *

ja on 2015-05-25 at 13:44 said:

Klages philosophy is clearly derived from Nietzsche. ...a lot of neopaganism is just Nietzscheanism as opposed to a revival of Greco Roman thought.

Lucian Tudor on 2015-05-26 at 18:50 said:

A more complete and effective exposition of Klages's thought can be found in the essays (available online) by Joseph Pryce and Lydia Baer. While I believe that authors like Ludwig Klages (or Jan Stachniuk, to cite a somewhat similar thinker) are useful for understanding Paganism as well as *Lebensphilosophie*, I think it is invalid to view their thought as the only representative form of Pagan philosophy. It is quite clear from Pryce's work, for example, that Stefan George and Klages had differing focal points for their Paganisms. Furthermore, I believe that more academic authors, historians of religion, such as Mircea Eliade provide the most true understanding of Paganism and its approach to the Sacred. However, it is best to compare and balance out a variety of viewpoints.

Cologero on 2015-05-27 at 07:38 said:

Mr Tudor, we would certainly include Bachofen and Fustel de Coulanges as primary sources to understand the pagan mind and spirit. I disagree with your encyclopedic approach of comparing and balancing a variety of viewpoints. Either there is a standard of truth or there is not. Our primary interest, therefore, is whether a particular viewpoint adheres to or opposes that standard.

Lucian Tudor on 2015-05-27 at 08:57 said:

Cologero, I definitely agree that there should be a standard of Paganism; a clear definition of what truly defines Paganism in all of its various forms across the world, which allows one to properly separate it from non-Pagan ideas and religions. What I meant by my remark is that to actually ascertain what Paganism truly is is not a simple task and can only be attained by reading a variety of authors' works, and attaining the ability to distinguish what is valid and invalid in each author after attaining an understanding of the essence of Paganism.

I believe that the more Biocentrist authors (Klages, Stachniuk, D.H. Lawrence, etc.) all grasped some truths about Paganism's defining characteristics, but Biocentrism misunderstands Paganism because it condemns all transcendence in favor of pure Life, whereas, by contrast, at the essence of Paganism is a complex, merged valuing of Life and Transcendence. Therefore, it can help to read authors like Klages to understand Paganism, but just reading these authors ultimately leads to an invalid understanding. Sure, Bachofen and Fustel de Coulanges should be included in our list of authors that should be read in the study of Paganism, but recall that these are both academics from the 19th Century (and it is always proper to compare the works of different academics who have disagreements on the facts, as opposed to only reading one academic perspective on a subject) and they are also imperfect because different studies and facts have emerged since that time. It is necessary to include in one's study of Paganism modern intellectuals/scholars such as Eliade, Gilbert Durand, Nigel Pennick, Christopher Gérard, Alain de Benoist, etc. I cannot imagine a proper understanding of Paganism in the global sense being achieved without studying several different authors to some extent.

Mark Citadel on 2015-05-27 at 17:08 said:

I am unsure as to how completely Evola rejects Evolution. Does he contend that the entire theory and its evidences are junk science, or is his claim more nuanced, positing his own historiography on the eternal race as a more purely metaphysical account rather than one rooted in what scientists would call 'evidence'?

I'm leaning towards the former, that Evola considers the theory of evolution to be absolute junk, and affirms man created in present form.

Cologero on 2015-05-27 at 21:24 said:

This is Evola's alternative to evolution: *Esoteric Origin of the Species*¹⁵.

As we pointed out, the "Theory of Evolution" is a poor choice of words, since it implies a "direction" of evolution, from more primitive to more advanced. That is NOT what science qua science can show. Nevertheless, that is how it is viewed in the popular mind. Obviously, the

¹⁵<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6261>

Traditional viewpoint is that there is a degeneration over time, not a progression. Moreover, science has not proved, nor will it prove, a material cause for the human spirit.

mleow on 2015-05-30 at 17:36 said:

Of interest i believe, the lost/last interview of Evola from french television has been published here:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiCtdi5nCoA>

Cologero on 2015-05-31 at 12:45 said:

Here is an interesting experiment to see if a contemporary political movement can be based on Traditional principles: *The Esoteric Voice of Gabor Vona's Spiritual Mentor*¹⁶

3.18 Fire and Ice: The Solar Race

This is the first of several posts about the various races of the spirit described by **Julius Evola**: The Solar Race. Evola owes his typology of spirits of the race to **J J Bachofen**'s study of **Mother Right**, although with a creative misreading of the text, Evola extracts a deeper meaning from it.

Bachofen delineated a historical process of cultures from haeterism to matriarchy, culminating in patriarchy, which he admitted was

the highest calling, the sublimation of earthly existence to the purity of the divine father principle.

Bachofen traces the patriarchal system in the ancient world to Athens and to the Roman Imperium. In them, there was Solarity.

As we have seen, however, Evola rejects any notion of "progress" in history. Rather he sees a degeneration. Certain ancient peoples were feminine in nature, and hence endured various matriarchal systems as described by Bachofen. On the other hand, the Hyperborean, or Nordic,

¹⁶<http://budapesttimes.hu/2015/05/29/the-esoteric-voice-of-gabor-vonas-spiritual-mentor>

peoples, were originally masculine, or equivalently Solar. Subsequent racial degeneration has led to the situation of the present era.

Although Evola gives us a very brief outline, he entire oeuvre is dedicated to the description of the Solar race. Fire and Ice are the paradoxically conjoined symbols of the Solar qualities. The Solar beings are described by Evola as being in this world, but not of it: they feel themselves as strangers in a strange land. Only ignorance or a waking “sleep” keep them bound to specific modes of being in the world. Gnosis, or awakening, what Guenon calls the Supreme Identity, liberates them from attachment to the world. Evola claims that such doctrines of awakening can only apply to the Solar race; attempts to extend such ideas as universal can lead only to misunderstandings.

This series, we hope, should make clear that the problem of the modern world is not a problem of thinking but rather of being. The error of the intellectual type is the belief that thinking the correct thoughts will somehow rectify things. Hence, there is incessant chatter and debate, which, apart from a few random conversions, always ends up in aporia.

The fundamental thing that matters is a change in the level of being.

Text The doctrine of the third degree of race must fundamentally limit its researches to the sphere of influence of a given race of the spirit and of its primordial tradition, following its developments, mutations (paravariations), and also distortions in the cycle that coincide with them and in which they act and react in the confrontation with the influences of different races or new environmental conditions. Once research is circumscribed that way, we arrive at a more limited concept of race, corresponding to that of the various differentiations or articulations of the primary element of such a cycle. Along the same lines, we cannot of course conceive of an atomic separation of the various “races of the spirit”: their differences do not exclude relationships of descent or even of different hierarchical rank.

We previously sketched out the typology of races of the spirit, as far as it concerns the specific human cycle of the hyperborean race, in the second part of our work *Revolt against the Modern World* (with special regard to the properly traditional and spiritual aspect), and in the selection of the writings of J. J. Bachofen, and in a re-interpretation of them in a racial sense, included in the volume we edited under the title *La razza solare*. For a fuller treatment, the reader is therefore referred back to these two works. Here we will give only a brief schematic synthesis, necessarily lacking any justifying elements.

The solar or Olympic-solar race, corresponding to the hyperborean lineage and tradition, is to be considered superior and anterior to all the others in the cycle in question. It has as characteristic a type of “natural supernaturalism”; spirit and power, calm dominance, and readiness for precise and absolute action, a sense of “centrality” and of “firmness”, and in its exterior effects, that virtue to which the ancients attributed a “numinous” quality (from *numen*), as superiority that imposes itself directly and irresistibly, that awakens simultaneously both fear and admiration, are marks of this “race of the spirit”, by means of which it is naturally predestined to command and, at the limit, to the regal function. Fire and ice are united in it as in the ambiguous symbols of the original Nordic homeland and of the cycle in which it is eminently and primordially manifested: ice, as transcendence and inaccessibility; fire, as the specifically radiant solar quality of the men who give life, who awaken life, and generate light, but always from a supreme distance and almost with indifference, like the wake of a boat, not through enthusiasm, inclination, or human concern.

The ancient symbol of gold has always had connections with this form of spirituality. In the political forms of the origins, it acted as the substrate to sacred, or divine, regality, i.e., to the union of the two powers, of the regal and priestly function, the latter understood in a higher sense that will soon be made clear. The symbolic designations of the “divine” or “celestial” race must refer to the absence of the dualistic sentiment in

relations to supernatural reality, something that however is quite distinct from everything that is immanence or Promethean arrogance in the modern sense: it is not about men who believe they are gods, but of the type of men who naturally, through a not yet dim memory of origins and a condition of soul and body that do not cripple such a memory, feel they do not properly belong to the terrestrial race, to the extent of believing themselves men only by accident, or through “ignorance”, or “sleep”. The two terms *vidya* and *avidya* of the ancient Indo-Aryan teaching, that mean respectively “knowledge” (of the “supreme identity”) and “ignorance” (that leads to the self-identification with one of the forms or modes of being of the conditioned world), are to be understood exactly in this context. When these terms are attributed to a different human condition and a different race of the spirit, that is, when turned into “philosophical” terms, they lose all meaning and give rise to misunderstandings of various types.

Posted on 2015-05-31 by Cologero

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Mark Citadel on 2015-06-03 at 11:20 said:

Interesting how today's Nordics are some of the most spiritually degenerated in the world. Does the fish rot from the head, or is there a special historical sociohistorical reason for the total implosion in Tradition for countries like Sweden and Norway?

obscure on 2015-06-03 at 18:18 said:

Mark,

One the one hand, there is the Protestant tendency against any established authority or hierarchy; a tendency which prevents a community from being more than incidental. On the other hand, there is the current incidental cause operating on Northern Europeans in general i.e. post-WW2 race-guilt. These are the two general causes which are readily conceivable. One may also note how easily a certain self-concept may be diffused throughout a sparse population.

Lastly, wherever a hierarchy cannot be established which actualizes otherwise abstract principles, then there will be a tendency towards some form of political hedonism. Such hedonism may be quasi-moral and egalitarian or individualistic and egoistic, but it certainly won't be

representative of true principles except accidentally i.e. insofar as all reality is dependent upon some degree of truth. This last observation should mean that there are in fact 'seeds' present in the North even though the ground appears barren.

aegishjalmer on 2015-06-19 at 23:14 said:

Also, let's not forget that the Nordics were the last to be Christianised generally in Europe (c. 1000 in Iceland) and this was of limited success and depth. Hence they were quick to embrace an outlook that was anti Roman (Protestantism) and eventually, modern paganism in various ways, such as Asatru and general modern hedonism. The Nordics also have a strong culture of individualism in many ways, and are very transparent and open to other cultures historically, both in their exploration and contact, and in allowing others in. I don't think these ideas cover all there is to it, but national culture is one aspect.

Aleksandar Gueric on 2015-10-16 at 11:18 said:

I just received a book "Among the Hyperboreans" by Miloš Crnjanski. This interesting autobiography consists of a series of ruminations and meditations clothed in multiform melancholy on Europe at the end of 1930s and early 1940s, when he worked as a diplomat in Rome.

When Miloš Crnjanski, one of the greatest Serbian poets and authors of the last century, visited Nordic countries hoping to see a miracle of mid 20th century Socialism – in Denmark, Sweden and Norway, he realized that there was all along something else which brought him there. It was the North itself. So he headed further, to the shores of the North sea, wanting to dissolve in its waters. In his own words, 'something' changed all those who searched for the North, and he wants to discover it's secrets.

His life embodied that 'stranger in a strange land' concept. Exiled from communist Yugoslavia after the war, he spent life journeying through Europe, examining events, people and his own beliefs – finding errors in general ideas of civil rights, liberalism and democracy, who only began to take forms in that time, while carefully waiting his return to Ithaca. Little known fact is that he supported Musolini.

After the fall into despair and melancholy caused by the sickness of every day reality, what is left for us than to search for that Ideal, where Love, Death, Life, Dream and Hope unite? Will you struggle in the mud, and, if you are animal in human clothing, you certainly will enjoy it, or will you reach for the stars? For the Absolute, Sacred Center?

Milos' travels gravitated around two poles – Rome and Scandinavia, horizontally; vertically – between Hyperborea and Sumatra, which I, mythologically, recognize as Lemuria. This is Solar and Lunar dichotomy expressed often in poet's tendencies towards abstract Lunar spheres of the mind. He was, afterall, still a Romanticist, thus all the Moon, autumn and death imagery in his writings. But behind poetic expressionism, his was of a Solar race. Many Solar individuals mantle different personas. Romanticism and it's ideals, for example, often lie at the beginning

of a path in those born within a Solar race. It's an early, raw stage of awakened Primordial Man. Ecstasis of war, death and Platonic love is truly titanic, but not Olympic, so it often entraps those desperate souls at the very beginning of their search for a way out of the Mundane into the Golden. This is why so many Romantics celebrated war and even took part in some of them, from Spain to Greece, seeking heroic death in the Age when heroic death (or life) is almost unknown. This is the echo of their Solar origin. Even Novalis, archetypal Romantic, who venerated Sofia and Mother Night, once said that 'Man is a Sun'. Little did he know (or perhaps he did), that this Man is quite rare. Solar Man is a man of Tradition, one and Perennial, and Novalis, as a man of Tradition, saw in French Revolution death of Europe.

Friedrich Hölderlin was a priest of Helios. This is a common Romantic naivette. If only he went further along the path of Solar Man, he would ascend to a priesthood of Apollo.

Crnjanski, like Evola, felt at home both in Rome and in Nordic countries. Eternal Mother Amor, the ever nourishing Fountain and distant North, Solar and Virile heroic coldness, parents of the European, Aryan Soul. Evola, on the other hand, felt no affection (unlike Guenon) with the Sumatran – or Lunar center.

A symptom each Solar Man, a 'stranger in a strange land' will share is subtle Melancholy, expressed through a desire, deep rooted yearning towards the Absolute, while world is seen through the eyes of mono no aware. This isn't some pathetic sadness and infantile escapism but (supra)natural effect of a Soul awareness elevated from the Animal and connected to the Higher Center. It pulls towards the Transcendental, above the mass and material. Gravity of this Higher Center can break the Promethean chains, but only through the endeavor worthy of Herakle himself, meaning we must already have a divine potentiality. What happens when Olympian Fire is shared with everyone, both worthy and unworthy, we know through the myth of Prometheus. Sadly, modern Europeans, even some calling themselves Traditionalist or 'of the Right', follow the Promethean path.

Heraklean labors, just like Odysseus' journey, are part of the Heroic, Solar Path. I don't share common opinion that we all inherently have our own, personal Odyssey, or, carry our own cross or hang from Yggdrasil. Or, that we are all immortal souls. That comes later, after accepting a call and undergoing a path. Most people don't follow any path but just pave a road.

In the end, all that's left is to wander these mysterious roads and gravitate towards different spiritual centers, according to our current inner balance of psychic energies.

Tyler on 2018-05-22 at 12:59 said:

Why is the moon masculine and the sun feminine in Germanic mythology?

Dark Worship on 2020-01-14 at 18:51 said:

I believe the "high culture of individualism" is when people seek easy going and mediocre life (for example, think in this way). It's not every person that has enough will to go to a war,

a guerrilla warfare etc People will die on the same way, being killed by migrants on street or being killed in war. There's no escape, i dont believe in superhumans. Maybe the individualists just want peace being locked in home.

Alice on 2021-11-05 at 08:10 said:

While Evola tries to differentiate the concept of the Promethean and the Solar Race, the latter comes across as the Anti-Christ and the epitome of what Dostoevsky calls Man-Godism. Human beings can never approach God's level because God is the Supreme Person and we exist as His servants, whereas Evola derides Bhakti as inferior and "lunar." This doesn't seem any different from Theosophy or other New Age religions.

S.P. on 2021-11-05 at 10:54 said:

I disagree, although it is a common confusion. What Evola mentions does not consist in the identification of the human being as an individual man with the supreme God, but rather the self-knowledge / realization of the I, which implies the overcoming of the human state and therefore of the egoic individuality.

3.19 Shadows and Reflections: The Lunar Race

Julius Evola begins the topic of the Lunar Races with *The Demetrian Race*¹⁷. First, let's clarify Evola's method and its relationship to Mother Right by **J J Bachofen**.

Bachofen's book is a diachronic study of various cultures over time: their origin and evolution. Each one is guided by a different spiritual type; Bachofen is heavily dependent on the use of myth. Evola converts that to a synchronic study. That is, he recognizes each type as active and manifesting at the same time. The myths, then, describe the characteristics of various types of people, which Evola identifies as the "races of the spirit". As such, the specific historical and pre-historical manifestations of societies of a given type are not the major concern, except for purposes of illustration.

¹⁷See Section 3.20 in this book.

The Demetrian race does not recognize transcendent spirituality. Its focus is on the earth, matter. It lacks a spiritual center, so is prone to pantheism and universalism. Its concern is with the laws of nature, agricultural cycles, and cosmic harmony of the “we are all one” type. Since, for it, everything is “natural”, it fails to recognize anything as deviant.

The Lunar Race is not self-effulgent. That is, it can only reflect the light from an external source. This is characteristic of the intellectual type who can only study or contemplate nature. This is also the Hermetic teaching. **Valentin Tomberg** identifies the 18th Arcanum, “The Moon” with “materialistic intellectuality”. This then eclipses the “creative light of consciousness” for human intelligence.

In Arcanum XIX, The Sun, Tomberg goes on to say that the “task of human intelligence is to liberate itself from the magical enchantment which separates it from spontaneous wisdom ... to arrive at *intuition*.” This intuition is the spontaneous wisdom of the heart, as Evola also points out.

You can take this as a warning, if you like, against incessant chatter and infinite discussion. What is necessary is a higher realization, not to waste your time among the “**shadows of ideas and things**”.

Posted on 2015-06-07 by Aeneas

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aegishjalmer on 2015-06-08 at 03:15 said:

Thank you, this is something I needed to hear

3.20 The Demetrian Race

The other “spiritual races” of the cycle, to which our contemporaries belong, have as their premise a division and a separation of the two elements of “spirituality” and “virility”, and also “transcendence” and “humanity”,

that are synthetically united in the solar race. First of all, we point to the lunar race or Demetrian race. As to the analogous relationship, while the solar element is that which has in itself its own light and, in general, its own principle, the sun being, in such regard, the center of a given planetary system, the lunar element is that which instead receives or draws its light and principle from another. The sense of spiritual centrality is therefore lost in the lunar race, whether through degeneration (the moon as the extinguished sun), or through passive mixing with “telluric” type races of other cycles, that have degraded its original solar quality. The moon, as Bachofen points out, was also called the “celestial earth” by the ancients. There is therefore a sublimation of the law of the earth, the fate that is manifested under the forms of cosmic harmony and law of nature. Lunar man no longer feels himself to be the active center of spiritual reality: he is not even this reality, but rather the one who contemplates it, who studies its laws, who surpasses material action with contemplation and “tellurism”, but still has not reached spiritual action.

The adjective “Demetrian”, that we also give to this race, refers to a diffused, pantheistic, less dominating spirituality that is imbued with the sense of cosmic naturalistic laws and by a sacredness placed essentially under the feminine symbol: a spirituality that was precisely typical of the ancient Demetrian cults.

By extension, the priestly man is lunar in comparison to the regal man, he is the man who in the face of the spirit behaves like a normal woman facing a man, i.e., with a sense of submission and devotion. It is then interesting to note that the ancient traditions associated what today would be called cerebrality or intellectuality with the moon, instead associating the heart with the sun and attributing higher forms of knowledge to it. The intellectual is indeed also the lunar type, the man of passive reflection who, as the word indicates, moves only among “reflections”, among the shadows of ideas and of things.

Thus the lunar race has varied characteristics. In the political field,

wherever there is a division between the temporal and spiritual powers, the lunar spirit inevitably arises. The lunar ruler receives the highest consecration of his power from someone else, from a different non-regal priestly caste. In general, the lunar man has spiritually feminine traits. He lacks the feeling of centrality. In correspondence to the races of the body, he has the predominant nature of the Demetrian race which is that of the nations we called Atlantic-Occidental, in their prehistoric forms that led up to the Pelasgic, Minoan-Mycenaean, or Etruscan civilizations and to its further revival, Pythagoreanism. Such a race represents a decay of the hyperborean spirituality which appeared suddenly in the Atlantean regions through processes of action and reaction, causing a series of other changes. Lunar elements can moreover be observed in the race called the man of the East (Alpine-Oriental) by some race theorists—the psycho-anthropology of Claus designates this race as the “race of evasion”—*der Enthebungsmenschen*—something that corresponds visibly to a characteristic of the lunar man.

Posted on 2015-06-07 by Aeneas

3.21 Impulse and Instinct: The Earth Race

Prior to the lunar or Demetrian cultural stage and the patriarchal, or solar, cultural stage, **JJ Bachofen** identified, through the study of ancient myths, and even earlier stage which he called “hetaerism”. **Julius Evola** gives the name “Telluric Race” in the *Sintesi* to the guiding spirit of that age. (Full text follows below)

In such periods, marriage is unknown and women held in common. Bachofen explains:

Woman is not endowed with all her charms in order to grow old in the arms of one man: the law of matter rejects all restrictions,

abhors all fetters, and regards exclusivity as an offense against its divinity.

Unlike the Demetrians, who developed agriculture, the Tellurians were associated with the natural flora and fauna of the marshy lowlands, as well as swamp cults. This life is represented by witches, who were involved with herb collecting and concoctions using lower life forms like toads and lizards. The battle between the Telluric and Solar impulses is demonstrated, for example, in the Nordic legend of the Virgin Spring¹⁸, with Ingeri as the exemplar of the former and Karin of the latter.

The struggle between the Titans and the Olympic gods can also be understood in this context. The mlecchas were a degraded Telluric warrior caste, which the avatar Parashurama¹⁹ came to destroy.

The Telluric Race The third race of the spirit that can be identified on the basis of ancient traditional symbols is the “telluric” or “titanic” race. It is a way of being that reveals itself by the adherence to life in all its immediacy, instinctiveness, and irrationality. The mind is today instinctively led to think of seismic phenomena by the term “telluric”, more than recalling its etymology (from the Latin *tellus*, which means the earth), an assimilation that, in some respect, could even have some justification. The telluric race is that of an explosive impulsivity, from sudden changes or from absolute identifications. As intensive as it is, it is equally gloomy, however without the depth and detachment necessary to also be tragic. Sexuality has a considerable part in it in its most elementary aspect: naturally, not just phallic, virile sexuality. In this regard, apart from truly inferior races, it can actually be said that it can rather more easily appear in a woman than in a man, in accordance with an entirely telluric nature. The feeling of the personality in the telluric man is poorly

¹⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1416>

¹⁹<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Parashurama>

developed, the collective element predominates, in the sense that the ties of blood are always manifested in him in a material, atavistic, fatalistic form, something that can be clearly recognized in some typical aspects of the feeling of race and blood characteristic of the Hebraic people. In its appearance, not in primitivistic stages, but within a civilization previously formed by other human types, tellurism bears witness to the phase of the final decomposition of this civilization: it corresponds to the liberation and the unleashing, in a state of new freedom, of forces previously restrained by a higher law.

Through the appearance of sudden upheavals, one can recognize a telluric element in the race called “desert” by some race theorists, and also of a particular inner instability in the “East Baltic” race,. Through its gloomy and fatalistic side, the telluric man is then recognizable in the Etruscan race, in light of Bachofen’s masterful description of it. Of course, the Mediterranean man generally, where he wants to form his own life according to a Nordic-Aryan style, has much to combat against this telluric possibility, even today. We then note that the telluric attribute was used by Keyserling, and not wrongly, to indicate an indisputable aspect of the so-called contemporary “world revolution”.

In the cycles of primordial traditions, the titanic race appears as the natural antithesis to the race of Demetrian man, at the point where the original solar synthesis was lost. There we must then consider, above all, the degradation of the virile quality that now appears in a terrestrial form and makes its own not only the forms of a savage and violent assertion, but likewise some elemental forces of lower nature, tied, in times past, to the symbolism and the cult of Poseidon, for example. And one could in this regard, speak even of the promethean race, in as much as another distinctive trait of certain characteristics of such a race of the spirit is the attempt to usurp the dignity originally possessed by the solar race: from this arise the well-known myths of the battle of the Titans against the Olympic forces, or the memories contained in the Indo-Aryan tradition

in regard to the mlecchas, the warrior race humiliated in the immense revolt by Parashurama, the representative of the oldest and highest spirituality when the ancestors of the Aryan conquerors of prehistoric India were still inhabiting the Hyperborean region.

Posted on 2015-06-14 by Aeneas

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Mark Citadel on 2015-06-30 at 10:30 said:

Would these societies have been highly primitive? I cant imagine any kind of actual civilization emerging from this.

Cologero on 2015-07-02 at 07:30 said:

Yes, they are degenerate versions of Demetrian societies. What sort of “civilization” do you think will arise from movements like Femen or FreeTheNipple?

3.22 The Telluric Race

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personality in the telluric man is poorly developed, the collective element predominates, in the sense that the ties of blood are always manifested in him in a material, atavistic, fatalistic form, something that can be clearly recognized in some typical aspects of the feeling of race and blood characteristic of the Hebraic people. In its appearance, not in primitivistic stages, but within a civilization previously formed by other human types, tellurism bears witness to the phase of the final decomposition of this civilization: it corresponds to the liberation and the unleashing, in a state of new freedom, of forces previously restrained by a higher law.

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Posted on 2015-10-05 by Cologero

3.23 Civilizations of Space and Civilizations of Time

The remaining traces, often still only in stone, of some of the great civilizations of the origins often contain a rarely noticed meaning. In the face of what remains of the most ancient Greco-Roman world and then that of Egypt, Persia, China, eventually reaching the mysterious and mute megalithic monuments scattered among deserts, lands, and forests as the final emergent and immobile vestiges of submerged and hidden worlds—and, as the boundary in the direction opposite to the course of history, including some forms of Medieval Europe: in the face of everything that comes from asking if the miraculous resistance to time of such civilizations, due to a favorable concourse of exterior circumstances, does not also include a symbolic meaning.

This feeling is reinforced if we focus primarily on the general character of the life of the civilizations to which in a great part such traces belong, that is on the general character of life called “traditional”. It is a life that has maintained the same through centuries and generations, in an essential fidelity to the same principles, to the same type of institutions, to the same vision of the world; in the face of calamitous events, also susceptible to adaption and external modifications, but unalterable in its nucleus, in its animating principle, in its spirit, in its unanimity.

Such a world seems to bring us back especially to the Orient. If you think of what China and India were up until relatively recent times, and

even the Japanese up to recently. But, in general, the more you recede back in time, the more you feel that living, universal, and powerful type of civilization, so that the Orient must be considered only as the part of the world where, through fortuitous circumstances, it was able to subsist longer and develop better than elsewhere. In such a type of civilization the law of time seems to be, in part, suspended. More than in time, these civilizations seem to have had life in *space*. They had a “timeless” character.

These, according to the formulation current today, would therefore be the “stable”, “static” or ultraconservative civilizations. In reality, they are the civilizations whose material vestiges even seem destined to live longer than all the monuments or all the ideal creations of the modern world that appear powerless to endure more than a half century and within which the words “progressive” or “dynamism” mean only a compliance to contingency, to the movement of an incessant change, of a rapid ascent and a likewise rapid, vertiginous decline. Processes that do not obey a true internal organic law, that are not contained within boundaries, that atomize themselves and take the hand of those from whom they were favoured: that is the characteristic of this different world, in all its sectors. That does not prevent it being made a criterion of the measure for everything which in the eminent sense should be called “civilization”, in the field of a historiography for which the other types are judged to have arrogant and pejorative values.

In this regard, the misunderstanding is typical that confuses immobility with something that had a rather different meaning in traditional civilizations: unchangeability. These civilizations were civilizations of *being*. Their strength was manifested precisely in their identity, in the victory they achieved over becoming, over “history”, over change, over unformed flow. They are the civilizations that descended into the depths, beyond the fickle and treacherous waters, and established solid roots in those depths.

The opposition between modern and traditional civilizations can be expressed this way: *modern civilizations are devourers of space, traditional civilizations were devourers of time.*

The former, or modern civilizations, are vertiginous from their frenzy of motion and spatial conquest, generators of an inexhaustible arsenal of mechanical means capable of reducing every distance, shortening every interval, contracting everything that is scattered in a multitude of places into a feeling of ubiquity. The excitement of a need to possess; dark anguish in the face of everything that is detached, isolated, deep, or distant; the impulse to self-expansion, to circulate, and to be associated and to find itself in every place, outside as well as inside. Science and technology, promoted by this irrational existential impulse, in their turn reinforce it, feed it, exacerbate it: trade, communications, ultrasonic speeds, radio, television, standardization, cosmopolitanism, internationalism, unlimited production, the American spirit, the “modern” spirit.

Quickly the matrix extends itself, reinforces itself, perfects itself. Terrestrial space has hardly any more mysteries. The pathways through the earth, water, sky are opened up. The human gaze has probed the most remote heavens, the infinitely great and the infinitesimally small. One no longer speaks of other lands but of other planets. On ours, action is carried like lightening far and wide. The tumultuous confusion of a thousand voices blend little by little into a uniform, atonal, impersonal rhythm. They are the latest effects of what was called Western “Faus-tianism”, which is not unlike the same revolutionary myth in its various aspects including that technocratic formulation in the field of a decadent messianism.

In contrast, traditional civilizations were vertiginous precisely in their stability, their identity, their unstoppable and immutable existence in the midst of the current of time and history: so that they became capable of expressing a shadow of eternity even in sensible and tangible forms. They were islands in time, bastions in time; they acted as forces consum-

ing time and history. Precisely because of this characteristic, it is imprecise to say that they “were”—it would be more correct to say that they simply *are*. If they seem to draw back and almost vanish in the distance of a past which sometimes has even mythical traits, that is only the mirage to which anyone is necessarily subject, when he is transported by an irresistible current that increasingly distances him from the places of spiritual stability. Moreover, this idea corresponds exactly to the image of the “double perspective” given by an ancient traditional teaching: the “immobile lands” retreat and move for those who go with the waters, the waters move and retreat for those who reside solidly in the “immobile lands”.

To understand this image, relating it not the physical plane but the spiritual plane, means to perceive also the right hierarchy of values, wherever our gaze is carried beyond the horizon which encloses our contemporaries. What seemed to be the past makes itself present, through its essential relation of historical forms (contingent as such) to metahistorical contents. What was qualified as “static” is seen to be saturated with enormous life. *The others*, they are the fallen, the decentered. The philosophy of becoming, historicism, evolutionism, and so on appear as the intoxications of castaways, like the truth typical of those who flee (“*where are you fleeing to, idiots?*” Bernanos), and of those who do not have inner consistency and who do not know what inner consistency is and not even the source of every true height and every actual achievement—of the same achievement that cannot be limited to the intangible and the often invisible spiritual heights but were in fact expressed equally in epics, in cycles of civilizations that, precisely, even in their mute and dispersed vestiges of stone, seem to conceal something supertemporal and eternal. To which are also added traditional artistic, monolithic, rough, and powerful creations, alien from everything that is subjectivistic, often anonymous, almost extensions of the same elementary forces.

Finally we must recall what the conception of the time itself was in

traditional civilizations: not an irreversible linear conception, but cyclic, in periods. From a combination of customs, rites and institutions characteristic both of higher civilizations and of echoes existing in some peoples described as “primitive” (in such regard, we recommend the same material gathered from the history of religions by Huber, Mauss, Eliade, and others) the firm intention is to bring time back to the origins (whence the cycle), in the sense of destroying what in it that is simply becoming, of restraining it, of making it express or reflect metahistorical, sacred, or metaphysical structures, often connected to myth. In such terms—as a “moving image of eternity”—time acquired a value and a direction, not as “history”. Returning to the origins meant a restoration, drawn to the fountain of perpetual youth, confirming spiritual stability, against temporality. The great cycles of nature evoked this attitude. “Historical consciousness”, inseparable from the situation of “modern” civilizations, only sealed the fracture, the fall of man into temporality. But it is presented as an achievement of the last man, that is, of crepuscular man.

It is not unusual that, even within the field of presumed scientific objectivity, certain discoveries, the origins of general conceptions destined to revolutionize an epoch, have the character of a sign, so that their happening in a given period, and not in another, should not be considered accidental. Referring, for example, to the science of nature, it is more or less known to anyone, according to the latest vogueish theories of Einstein and his disciples, that it is an indifferent thing to affirm that the Earth moves around the sun, or the opposite: it is only a question of preferring a greater or lesser complication of astrophysical calculations in the fixing the relational systems. Now, it seems rather significant that the Copernican discovery, with which it ceased to be “true” that the Earth is the solid and immobile center of the celestial entities, and it becomes “true” instead that it moves itself, and through its law is wandering in the cosmic space, as an irrelevant part of a dispersed system of expansion into the indefinite. It seems, let’s say, rather significant that this discovery hap-

pened more or less at the time of the Renaissance and humanism, that is, at the time of the most decisive upheaval for the coming of the new civilization, in which the individual lost little by little every connection with that which “is”, he degenerated from every spiritual centrality to the point of making his own the point of view of becoming, of history, of change, of the irrepressible and unpredictable current of life. The most remarkable upheaval was instead the pretense—the illusion—of having finally discovered, of affirming and glorifying “man”, hence the term “humanism”. In fact this was reduced to that which is “only human” with the impoverishment of the possibility of an opening and an integration into the “more than human”.

This is not the only one of the symbolic revolutions that could be mentioned in this matter. Using the example we made, one point must be made precise about the “Copernican revolution”: in the traditional world no so-called “objective” truth was important. Truths of that type could be also be incidentally considered, in the sense of their actual relativity on one hand, and of their human value on the other hand, bearing in mind the criteria of opportunities in regards to the general mode of feeling. A traditional theory of nature could therefore be also “incorrect” from the point of view of modern science (in one of its stages). But its value, the reason for which it was superior lay in its susceptibility to act as a means of expression of something true on a different and more interesting plane. For example, the geocentric theory was that the world of sensible appearances grasped an aspect suitable to act as a support for a truth of a different and unassailable type, to the truth regarding “being”, the spiritual centrality, as principle of the true essence of man.

This will suffice to clarify morphologically the contrast between the civilizations of space and the civilizations of time. From that, it would also be easy to deduce the corresponding typological and existential contrast between the man of one civilization and the man of another. And if we are to move on to the problem of the crisis of the present epoch on the

basis of what was already said, the uselessness of any criticism whatsoever, of any reaction, of any velleity of rectifying actions should appear in a rather clear way before an internal change of polarity, a metanoia, to use the ancient term, in man himself or, at least, in a determinate number of men in positions of exercising a decisive influence, is produced: in the sense of a shift toward the dimension of “being”, of “that which is”, a dimension gone missing and dissolved in modern man so that very little is any longer known about what internal stability and centrality are, and therefore also calm and higher security while instead a hidden sense of anxiety, of restlessness, and of emptiness is diffused ever more in spite of the systematic use on a large scale and in all the domains of the anesthetic spirituality recently invented. From the sense of “being”, of stability, also that of the limit, as principle, it could not originate in a natural way, even in a more external domain, for the reaffirmation of forces and processes which have become stronger than those that put them recklessly into a movement of temporality.

But to consider the civilization in its entirety, it remains absolutely problematic where solid points of leverage can be found in a civilization like the modern one that is in every way, to an extent unprecedented in the past, a civilization of time. On the other hand, it appears quite obvious that, more than a correction, there would be the end of a form, the origination of a new form. Thus, logically, at best, we can think only of different orientations in some particular domain and especially in that which, almost like an awakening, a few differentiated men can still propose and implement invisibly.²⁰

Posted on 2019-08-25 by Aeneas

²⁰The differentiated type, defined by the possession of the dimension of being, is contrasted to the existential orientations suitable to a period of dissolution, like the current one, as we formulated in *Ride the Tiger*.

4.1 Deification of Man

In **Guido de Giorgio**, we often find the best from **Rene Guenon** and **Julius Evola**. Yet, the “personal equation” is qualitatively different. Guenon is cold and logical, the path of the jnani whose goal is the Truth. Evola sometimes writes with a deep passion, but is often wordy; his is the path of action, with the Good as its goal. De Giorgio, on the other hand, seems to speak as a man of conviction, arising from an inner knowing, while avoiding the sentimental and the merely personal. He is a poet and mystic, following the highest path, that of Absolute Beauty¹.

Guenon and Evola, for all their virtues, are ultimately escapists, Guenon to the “traditional” East and Evola to the long forgotten Ancient Rome. But De Giorgio offers a different way. Unlike Guenon who seems to regard the various Traditions as discrete and independent, Evola and De Giorgio see a continuity in the Traditions of the West, from the Hyperboreans to the Medieval era. Yet Evola wants to stop part way, and even

¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3537>

to reverse it, while De Giorgio wants to continue and complete the rectification that Evola described.

Taking Guenon's claim seriously that **Dante's** Divine Comedy is a blueprint of the path for initiates, he describes a vision for the reconstitution of Tradition in his *La Tradizione Romana*, under the aspects of the Divine Cycle, the roles of the castes, the role of the Leader, the spirit of the Roman tradition, and its fulfillment in the Comedy.

In the following passage from *Aforismi e Poesie* (Archè Milano, 1999), De Giorgio describes the process of Deification, drawing on Traditional notions. From Guenon, we see that “man” is just one of the states of being, but does not exhaust all the states. From Evola, we see the theme of transcending man as such, and the way to know God is to be God². But we suspect, however, that De Giorgio is saying the same thing, not as an abstract theory, but rather from his own interiority. Readers can judge for themselves. De Giorgio's text follows:

To lose consciousness of oneself, to become conscious of God. To become conscious of the nothing that I am in order to have consciousness of everything that is God. One does not take a step toward God without this preliminary negative. What I am not, God is.

Man makes himself God in the measure in which he is no longer man, that is, when his transparency, in the absolute sense, is such that God passes through him. This is the deification of man, not human imperfection arrogantly divinized—a haughtiness absolutely outside the place in life that leads to God—but man annulled, abolished, dissipated, so that God alone is because God alone is God and no god is god except God.

Posted on 2012-05-03 by Cologero

* * *

²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1875>

Farid Othman al Deenari on 2012-05-04 at 02:50 said:

"Guenon and Evola, for all their virtues, are ultimately escapists..."

We object to this characterization. In fact, it is the world around us that is 'escapist', whilst we, in such a milieu, are automatically faulted for being anchored in the realm of knowledge. This realm, being ever present and not subject to temporal conditions, namely space and time, does not allow one to escape from it; nor could we escape to it, for it is all that exists, both theoretically, and practically to those who possess effective consciousness of it.

Insofar as the West deviates, the defender of truth can and will be misrepresented as an 'escapist' by simply holding his ground.

Cologero on 2012-05-04 at 05:23 said:

Farid, I did not intend "escapist" as a personal insult to those men, but rather in the sense that, on a personal level, they abandoned (i.e., "escaped" from) the West. Whatever you may think about not being subject to temporal conditions, as a stark matter of fact, Guenon did indeed translate himself in Space, and Evola was nostalgic for a different Time.

Those of us who choose to hold our ground – in the West at this historical moment – cannot limit ourselves to their choices.

Angolmois on 2012-05-04 at 13:53 said:

De Giorgio quote reminded me about the initiatic experience of being a complete human personality with all traits intact while witnessing also at the same time the universal consciousness.

Astrologically speaking this would mean the dual experience of Leo (integrated personality) and Aquarius (universal consciousness). De Giorgio seems to be taking a stance for the universal consciousness ('pratyeka'), while Evola was more of an alchemist and a hermetist in this regard, since he "remained in the cosmos and got back to it" instead of choosing to escape from it through the Capricornian gate.

Cologero: I find it hard to see either Guénon and Evola as escapists, yet I understand what you mean with it. And after all, did not Evola describe the way you mention in your last post in his 'Ride the Tiger' with unfathomable precision? "A way out, further in" etc.?

Charlotte on 2012-05-04 at 19:09 said:

woah, rewind, Capricorn gate, say more bro – I've been there!! It's in Atlantis, it's scary, at least I was scared... .panic stations, password, aaarrggg!!

Charlotte on 2012-05-04 at 19:58 said:

deep at the bottom of de-nial!!

Angolmois on 2012-05-05 at 04:39 said:

Concerning Atlantis and escapism, did not the Masters of Light leave the degenerated Atlantis when they saw that it is too late and futile to save it wholly; the preservation of the core of the primordial tradition clearly outweighed the saving of a few souls who do not even recognise the need to be saved.

Charlotte: I've been in the temples Atlantis also in my dreams. Finely arranged beautiful temples and amazing surroundings, that's all I can say. The water was in a very important role in the surrounding gardens, and the whole scene was very beautiful. Although this is my personal fantasy, it certainly reflects the stories told about the Atlantean tradition.

Charlotte on 2012-05-05 at 06:44 said:

well that's kind of right, but an essential factor is missing there. The Atlanteans, as you probably know, were of one mind – not of 'scattered' consciousness such as humanity experienced after the destruction of the Tower of Babel. This enabled them to do extraordinary things in terms of building, for instance, and the manifestation of 'gods' in what is perhaps best understood in terms of the literary myths we now have. They were also very 'in tune' (understatement) with the forces of nature, which is what led ultimately to their downfall. The power they had access to became corruptive within their souls and they began performing ever more extreme feats of power to do with the weather, for instance, and fire – the discovery of nuclear energy, in particular. They also became very interested in sex and started to enhance their bodies in order to maximise sexual pleasure (hence their association now with the dolphin race, which is the most sexual creature on earth, humans included). This is why there are such uncanny resonances with the modern world, which is staring into its mirror at Atlantis – a magical future prophecy as much as a past 'legend', or buried memory (for 'weather modification', read 'HAARP'). As far as I'm aware the memory of the flood and all that went with it was so traumatic that humanity collectively wiped it out of its consciousness, leading to the state of 'slumber' experienced by the mass of humankind. And yes of course it was the 'elite', as ever, who largely escaped the consequences of the group actions, of which they – as the ones in power – were must culpable. Another parallel with modern life in which the 'elites' – all that means now is those with money – are more able than most to escape the horrific consequences of 'the fall'... .to a point... .there's only so far one – even a privileged one – can go along that road, be sure of it. There's more than one reason why the princes Buddha and Jesus renounced their wealth. The escape of the elites is a plan that has once again been activated, but this time around more people are aware of the situation – more people whose memories of Atlantis are NOT buried. The priests weren't quite the only ones who escaped. They planned their exodus, but others simply survived and were washed up on other shores. A lot of these have ended up as 'new agers' because of their resentment at the way the priestcraft handled the catastrophe – causing the problem then saving themselves. So even though they 'know' the hierarchy holds truths about God and man,

there is a reaction against the hierarchy and a drive to make known what was formerly kept secret, so that everyone has a chance to survive. A lot of those who imagine themselves to be elite now are not really 'in the club'. They have been given a certain amount of information and this in itself is so monumental that for the most part they are content to simply indulge their password potential, opening of the magical doors and access to the other world. In this way are some of the greatest minds and initiates kept a degree lower than they are really able to achieve, because if they were to attain to the highest orders they would then understand the terrible side of the truth and comprehend the extent to which they have been fooled. The key at that point is to break open the closed circle by invoking the name of Jesus Christ and through love and compassion (Happy Birthday Buddha!) throwing one's lot in to help the children in the nursery to survive, to awaken, in other words. Tangentially, the swastika goes back to at least Atlantean times. It is still possible to go there in the astral so your dreams, if lucid, are most likely to be true. I've pestered Cologero about this so many times I see no reason to break the habit and hold back now – here is my story :-)

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/atlantis>

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/half-man-half-fish>

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/swastika>

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/ancient-script>

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/pisces-capricorn>

Charlotte on 2012-05-05 at 06:55 said:

this isn't just 'altruism', by the way. Humanity is bound together by its collective karma, so it's essential that the 'weight' of this is light as a feather, that the balance is tipped towards ascension not sinking. United we'll stand and divided we fall...

mleow on 2012-05-05 at 09:52 said:

I also find the notion that "Evola was nostalgic for a different Time" is misleading. At least that is not the sense and understanding I get of the man and his writing, as Angolmois said "Ride the tiger" is perhaps the best example that Evola was in fact the one from the "traditionalist school" with the least escapist/nostalgic notions trying to cope with the modern reality as it is and all its destructive tendencies as incitements to inner awakening, instead of trying to conjure up artificial paradises, medieval, roman or whatever. The word "Good" in this regard also seems a bit strange, he always mentions the "Unconditioned" as the highest goal to steer one's compass to. Would you care to elaborate or refer to parts of his writing as regarding claims for this goal towards the "Good"?

That said, im hoping to see more of these Giorgio translations. In what form has his writings survived is it merely texts from various correspondences or has he also written books on esoteric topics?

Cologero on 2012-05-05 at 10:28 said:

The object of Action is the Good, otherwise action would be purposeless. Please think of it in the Traditional sense as a transcendental. For Plato, the Good itself was the ultimate. But as transcendentals, the Good, the True, and the Beautiful are ultimately unconditioned and One. How else could Action “lead” to the Unconditioned?

How is “riding the tiger” not passive? You are basing your judgment of Evola only on what has been made available to you. We have undertaken the effort to show the Evola of the 30s and 40s to demonstrate that he was decidedly not “riding the tiger”, but engaged in the political situation of the time. A man may have to ride the tiger, when historico-material conditions are unsuited to him. But our position here is that conditions have changed, so to ride the tiger is no longer an option. *A fortiori*, the time is come for the elite to arise and create the proper conditions. It is your option to *cope* with conditions, and continue to whine about the modern world, but the point is, as someone once said, to change it.

De Giorgio published nothing while he was alive. *La Tradizione Romana* existed in manuscript form in the 30s, presumably a copy was sent to Mussolini. It is systematic and describes the lineaments of the constitution of a future Traditional society. At that time he was associated with Evola and presumably they were trying to influence the political situation in the early 1930s toward a more Traditional direction.

At some point, De Giorgio withdrew, living a solitary life in the mountainous part of Italy, where he traveled a more mystical path. He left behind notebooks of poems and short essays, but nothing systematic; these have been gradually published after his death. I will translate more of the Roman Tradition on Gornahoor to show that Tradition is more than nostalgia. I will translate the more mystical and devotional texts elsewhere, since they may not be suited to the more analytical tone of Gornahoor. For example:

Woman: <http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/woman>, from *Aphorisms and Poems*.

Charlotte on 2012-05-05 at 11:08 said:

So what course will the ‘elite’ take in trying to improve conditions in the present world for one and all, because a political party or philosophical school won’t achieve this? What is required is positive practical action, of that there can be no doubt. Who is prepared to give up home comforts, abandon the supermarket in favour of small stores, cut out food additives, quit supporting big businesses, to cease buying into the system, to desist from believing the lies of politicians, to understand that the corporate tapeworm economy is strangling the world – who

can and WILL break free of the matrix-net surrounding us, be they elite or otherwise? Acknowledging with searing honesty who the desposynic heirs really are – and what it really takes to partake of the promised spiritual truths – is a difficult but necessary first step to achieving the desirable goal of saving the world. A leap of faith is required by almost everyone, plus individual determination to reform the self as a microcosmic alchemical procedure that brings about the cosmic renewal. Really there is no point denying it!

Angolmois on 2012-05-05 at 15:06 said:

I have personally understood Evola's 'Ride the Tiger' precisely as a path of action and positive change in-side the modern world. In Evola's own words it is meant for "the elite", but only as a handbook and a manual for individuals who may perhaps have no apparent connexion between each other. If this is out of the question for you Cologero and "not enough", I think that Gornahoor and websites / blogs like this one are one of the best way for the eventual organisation and appearance of the spiritual hierarchy of the earth that will change the world "in an instant" when the time is ready. Right now "we" are still scattered around and largely unorganised, not the least because of petty infighting among those who should first and foremost have a mutual understanding and the spirit of co-operation in their hearts.

mleow on 2012-05-06 at 04:11 said:

That makes it more clear.

I have read all of Evola's work that are available in english and the few snippets of translations made available on Gornahoor has not made any drastic revelation or revaluation about him or his work on my part. Well please remember that "ride the tiger" was one of his later books so its quite natural that he did not pursued that path of apoletia etc under the war and fascist years, where at least the possibility and "humanmaterial" existed to change and influence the milieu in a traditional direction. I don't whine much really anymore about being born in this declining world. I accept my situation and embrace it as Evola would say, as a spiritual test, try to see things according to truth and don't succumb or waste my life trying to cut off hydraheads ie spend my time on any vain action, as a spiritual master once said "Who has improved the world? People have improved themselves and then gone."

You say that the conditions have changed and yet in your next sentence you say that an elite will arise to create the new conditions? Sounds paradoxical to me. From my point of view I don't see it as realistic that a spiritual elite will spring up and take control, could you please specify as concretely as possible and not merely in the abstract how the current conditions seems apt for such an event to occur? How will this legion of beeromongering footballcrazed pursuit of pleaurist sentimentalist secular cynical rationalist people ever recognise ,not to mention obey or need such an elite??

Charlotte on 2012-05-06 at 04:34 said:

Let's keep it real shall we? the actual spiritual elite are out there right now saving lives, with no time to sit around chit-chatting, hampered mainly by the refusal of the super-rich and super-powerful to either offer support to the solution or cease working against God and for themselves only

Cologero on 2012-05-06 at 12:56 said:

Evola's subtitle for *Ride the Tiger* was this: "orientamenti esistenziali per un'epoca di dissoluzione". Apparently, it was the American publishers who added: *A Survival Manual for the Aristocrats of the Soul*. Does anyone suppose that aristocrats of the soul publish "how to" manuals in mass market paperback editions? As the real Marcuse wrote, everything is co-opted by the system.

No, mleow, I cannot describe in detail, because it involves a singularity, the end of one world and the beginning of another. However, *contra factum non est disputandum*, and the facts point to traditional civilizations, or new spiritual movements, arising seemingly out of nothing. But I agree with you about avoiding vain action, or disputing with the ignorant.

Charlotte, you do true religion a disservice by trying to restrict it to moralism and humanism. That has never been the case.

Charlotte on 2012-05-06 at 15:09 said:

Since when did keeping it real mean doing 'true religion' a disservice – maybe the truth hurts? I thought works were the ultimate proof of faith – the royal road is one we all love to tread, but the greatest Masters preach and practice poverty – how can this be denied? I'd be the last one to discount the power of prayer but I'm not seeing much of that either and I don't like hypocrisy – talk about 'élites' makes me cringe and like it or not, it IS the humble practioners who tend to be the most touched by God's grace, you can see it shining from them. Not that I'm counting myself amongst this saintly group, just pointing out basic facts – we are looong past the theoretical stage of forming the 'new world', Utopia was good enough. Now it's time for implementation and in my opinion it's beyond urgent, but people are wholly resistant to change for the better if it means disrupting their own comfortable lives even by one iota. And I'm not a humanist, you know I am not, there is no need to be bitchy – something about not shooting the messenger? Apologies, however, if I've over-moralising, I know that can be very annoying... .chit chat is fine, I'll butt out :-)

Cologero on 2012-05-06 at 18:51 said:

I sense a severe communications breakdown here, but I'm not sure what it is. You speak of "Masters", who are, I believe, what we mean by *spiritual elite*. Didn't Tomberg say somewhere

that at the necessary moment, someone will appear to right things? I believe he mentioned by name St. Francis and St. Ignatius. Do you cringe because we single them out as “saints”?

We have no objection to spiritual and corporal works, but please keep in mind the story of Martha and Mary. The present danger is a man-centred religion, when it needs to be God-centred. The contemplative life has always been primary and everything else flows therefrom.

Angolmois on 2012-05-07 at 03:17 said:

I believe there is no need to despair if things seem to be currently out of hands concerning making things right again. The world will dissolve and break apart, that's the very promise of all scriptures, and then the “elite” or “the masters” – who are preparing themselves as we speak – will come out of the hermetic closet and reveal the real “new world order” and the new age “in the spirit of Lif and Lifhtrasil”; life, light and breath of the spirit(ual hierarchy).

Having battled with this issue for years in desperation and in the dark night of the soul I simply some day realised that it actually requires quite little in reality for things to change for the better again. It requires the change in the hearts and minds of men, and for this we all must aim our prayers and deeds. The Good One is still in charge no matter how it looks like right now.

Blessings of The High One for you all.

Charlotte on 2012-05-07 at 05:10 said:

Well I think it's the focus on Rome I'm finding difficult, but I accept that this is a large part of what Gornahoor is about so fair enough because it is your website. I certainly never said mention of 'saints' made me cringe, the opposite in fact, I said mention of 'elite', I don't like the connotations of that word, it reminds me of the nazis. I accept, however, that it may not be meant in the way I'm reading it. I believe true 'Masters', like St Francis, practice poverty and love humanity, the notion of a superstructure of 'more brilliant' minds and people controlling the ignorant masses is what 'elitism' speaks of. I also think I make a valid point about works – the 'Masters' of the ilk of St Francis literally went out and healed people, as did the ultimate Master, Jesus. Perhaps I sense my own 'lack', for want of a better word, in the face of people who are able to put into practice more of what they know, or who know 'less' but do more to help humanity. Put it this way, a starving child needs prayers for sure, but also something else, right? Maybe I'm just reaching the stage of my spiritual journey where I'd like to put the food into their mouths more often, rather than 'just' praying. Which again, is not to discount the power of prayer, more collective positive thinking in the world could work miracles, but in the meantime there are multiple crises that need tackling on multiple fronts. Another example of a 'humble' soul of the kind I was referring to might be America's own George Washington Carver – having read something of his life for the first time quite recently he certainly emerges as a 'Master' initiate of sorts, so in this respect truly 'elite'. Perhaps the real issue, then, is one of defining precisely what constitutes this 'elite'. Maybe I've been misunderstanding by thinking that people here are

singled out as being 'elite' simply for having adopted a certain political/religious philosophy and going on to write about it? And yes, I do believe there is a Messiah who rights things, ultimately there is only one Master, the great leveller... I agree the change must come in the hearts and minds of all humans, this is what I'm meaning by 'grass roots' level action, whereby all individuals take responsibility. The time of teaching has been going on for a long while, it's time to put these things into practice. As for 'New World Order'... well, we had a recent discussion about the Georgia Guidestones. Unfortunately most of those who might think of themselves as 'elite' in this context are simply rich and powerful. Any esoteric knowledge they might have gleaned has come from decidedly suspect angles, OTO, etc – and all mixed in with the influx of nazism into America following WWII. They never really lost the war, you know?

Charlotte on 2012-05-07 at 05:13 said:

I also refer to Einstein: 'those who know have a duty to act'

Cologero on 2012-05-07 at 08:19 said:

Perhaps, Charlotte, you could read *The Second Precept of Love*³, particularly what he says about the prehension of the All or Unity. We tend to experience the world in discrete pieces rather than in its totality. This applies to Time as well as Space; in other words, the panorama of History is also the unfolding of a divine Plan, not just the work of men.

Guenon complained about the change in the word "elite" from the way he first used it. It may be better to think of it as the "elect", as in "many are called, few are chosen (electus)". So, it is not something a person may claim for himself, but rather something that is assigned to him from above. Your Master also speaks of the leaven in the bread, so we are entirely faithful to that message. The change must come from the elect, long before it comes "in the hearts and minds of all humans".

Who are you, Charlotte, Martha or Mary?

Cologero on 2012-05-07 at 08:36 said:

As for the focus on Rome, that is due to its central place in the history of Europe, a fortiori, the very creation and self-understanding of Europe, not once, but twice. Aeneas, the spiritual founder of Rome, brought the Wisdom of the East to the West, of which Rome was the center. Dante, in *De Monarchia*, points out the Divine Plan for Ancient Rome, and I assume everyone is familiar with that.

Then we see the central place of Rome in the Tarot, in the Arcana of the High Priest of Rome and the Emperor of Rome. As their influence wanes, the world falls apart.

³<http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-second-precept-of-love>

By the way, there are no Nazis in USA, quite the contrary. USA is the heir to Cromwell's England and the British Freemasons. OTO is a British, not a Nazi, organization.

Charlotte on 2012-05-07 at 09:04 said:

Yes I know, from Crowley, but a lot of the 'magick' employed is similar to the way the nazis achieved their dark spiritual aims. A lot of nazi scientists, as you know, escaped to America, they were taken on board by the government. When I say 'they won', I mean in terms of the technological/material emphasis in the world today, in particular the warcraft. Hitler took heart to some extent – for his racial theories, at least – from the American wars against the Indian, and he was also fairly admiring of the English, it's all tied up together as I'm sure you're aware. What is helpful, however, is a clarification of what is meant by 'elite', thank you – as this is a term that's often bandied about these days in a very negative sense. This is an open website so who knows what casual readers might think? (To some extent I'm one of those, if also regular). I still maintain, however, that the change has already come from the minds of the 'elect', the forerunners, and it is up to us now to implement this in some way. To bring it out of the world of formation and into the world in a way that is recognisable to all. The way of salvation. Rome, well, I'm 'Greek', as I think you also know – my tutor was very snooty about Roman history in comparison and I agree with him almost entirely on this point! The answer is to revive the Mysteries, drink from the lake of memory – here! <http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/lake-of-memory-2>

Angolmois on 2012-05-07 at 10:52 said:

For the sake of clarification, Charlotte & others, what I meant by 'the new world order' has certainly nothing to do with what is meant by it today. I used it simply to refer to the emerging Tradition in the ruins of the current world, a transcendental order and a new golden age, the age of Saturn.

The Elite defines itself and *shines*, its activity is salvific in all orders of life according to the dharma of the particular practitioner or order. The crown and the sceptre, on the other hand, always move only further away from those who seek and yearn for them.

4.2 The Constitution of a Traditional Society: The Capo

The Supreme Leader

This is the concluding section of **Guido De Giorgio**'s description of the establishment of a traditional society. Here, he develops the idea of the supreme leader, above the three castes, whose primary duty is the maintenance of Tradition.

This section, as a whole, needs to be compared to the similar efforts by Guenon, Coomaraswamy, and Evola to describe the respective roles of Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power. However, De Giorgio's work comes from a completely different place, from a deep understanding of the principles involved. The other three try to make an "argument", by referring to various scriptures or historical situations. Guido De Giorgio speaks from the heart, from what he knows; he can be judged on that basis. That is how Tradition is to be recovered.

Interspersed within the main topic, as always there are various spiritual gems to be recovered. We can call attention in particular to the notion that a man creates his own life. Also, pace those who want to create a superman, De Giorgio believes that man qua man must vanish in order for something higher to appear.

We could repeat at this point the exhortation that Homer put into the mouth of wise Ulysses when the Greeks appeared to abandon the Trojan adventure and that even Aristotle cited at the end of Book XII of the *Metaphysics*: "let there be one ruler." There is first of all the great law of analogy according to which the only leader in time must correspond to the supreme unity in eternity and since God is pure contemplation and only the cognitive fruition of aseity can be conceived in Him, so the Leader inversely will make a pure activity of his life dedicated to the maintenance of his command on the earth.

He holds temporal power, exercises it uncontested, and is the supreme authority whose domain embraces all the active life in its multiple aspects and over which he is the regulator and judge. His function is therefore integrative and his work is strictly dependent on Justice, the highest of

the virtues.

If on the one hand, while being the supreme leader, he is above all the prince of the Warriors, his power is exercised over all indiscriminately in the temporal environment because he could not go beyond it without failing in his task and his purpose.

Although he arose from the Warrior caste, in order to carry out his task he is above the three castes and so must, while remaining strictly within the scope of the active life, serve as the harmonious base of the development of the first two castes, from the first receiving consecration, and serving for the protection and the maintenance of the traditional order of the second. In order to preserve inviolate his sovereignty, he will have to guard the Temple that is the foundation of every tradition and defend the Priests who nourish with their spiritual influence the body of the truths accessible only to the contemplatives. While depending spiritually on them, he is absolutely autonomous in his domain and the Priests in this owe him obedience as all men belonging to the other two castes, nor can or should the spiritual insert itself into the temporal and compromise the pure sphere of contemplation which does not have to undergo profanation of that sort.

The unity of command represents the centralizing equilibrium of the active life that loses in the Leader its particularistic and widespread character in order to rise to a level analogous to the Edenic state where everything is put before man who is truly the king of creation. Therefore the Leader vanishes only before God where his sovereignty is annulled in the Lordship of all the lords: everything in this life, he will be in the other that which he will have merited according to the meaning it will have had from God. "Caesar I was, Justinian I am..." [Dante, *Paradise* vii]. In the face of God the greatest victory will be that which he will have been able to bring back on himself and on what he will have accomplished on earth, nothing will matter for him except the works of justice, rectification, equilibrium, and peace. Since the Leader must always seek peace

for his subjects in analogy with that same thing that in the contemplative order is the foundation of every realization and all aspire to that type of activity that develops them. The maintenance of this equilibrium is reserved to the Warriors who will always make war an instrument of peace and not of pure and simple conquest. The unity of the empire avoids the unproductive diffusions of the active life concentrating its energies toward a single end where all disparities and partial imbalances are evened out, therefore if in the Warriors, as was said, inner asceticism is the necessary base for the development of their activity, this is even more strict in the Leader who must annul in himself any individuality whatsoever in order to make justice triumph and the rule secure the empire.

He knows that he is the supreme ruler of the active life and that the active vibration emanates from him that, in analogy with the divine, is extended to all the branches of humanity of which he constitutes the propelling and purifying center through which the backward wave [*onda di ritorno*] obtains new energy for new possibilities of development in a perpetually mobile and fecund circle of flux and reflux.

We are purely in the sphere of action in which all men necessarily live and to which none are exempt except those who can and must dedicate themselves to the contemplative life: what each man accomplishes in it, and the way in which he accomplishes it, has a very great importance for the equilibrium of human perfection that would be maimed and amputated if an element is removed from that current of active homogeneity that constitutes temporal modality.

All traditions in fact reserve the contemplative life to those for whom it is appropriate and who are worthy of it, while they condemn asceticism and separation from the world for those who lie outside it obeying a sense of inadmissible egoism: those are the weak and the lifeless and they avoid the responsibility of worldly life through real insufficiency. It will be well to insist on that: everyone brings and creates, so to speak, his environment and by this word we do not mean only the closest circle, but the

entire temporal extent of human life with everything which is positive and negative in it for the individual. Making use here of an image, we could say that every man has a passage of existence that is not only his world, but all the world that is for him what he is for the world itself: in this passage that starts from the center of a circumference and is contained between two divergent rays which, having as base a segment of the circumference itself, form a cone, there is everything that man wants and that he does not want, his fortune, his misfortune, his battle, his dispute, his victory or his downfall. The essential thing for him is to rise up in ascending planes from the circumference to the center, from the base of the cone to the vertex that represents the greatest of the minimum, i.e., God, while reassimilating all multiplicity gradually into a point only in which he is annulled, because he, dispelling ignorance, will recognize himself in everything, even and above all, in that to which he is most opposite and will recompose in a perfect equilibrium all the antagonisms up to the point of extinguishing them in the highest vortex of his asceticism, or better said, of his recovery, which is God.

When we employ this term, we mean everything that is truly of God in God, truly and not fallaciously, i.e., all the superhuman states of union with God that man can realize only starting from himself in order to reach that which is no longer himself, man before, no longer man afterwards.

The terrestrial level is one experience and not another, that is necessary to start from a base of disablement in order to reach an apex of absolute immutability: these are the two greatest terms in the sphere of that which appears in the seat of human relativity: a fallacious reality, man, a genuine reality, God, the former only illusory, the latter, supreme certainty. But placing oneself at an integrative point of view, one is reality, God, who is no longer a goal which one reaches except through a dissipation of ignorance, as whoever believes real the phantasms of the fog that are non-existent provided the sun dispels and dissolves it.

The Role of the Leader

In this second of three parts, **Guido De Giorgio** expands on the role of the Leader in a traditional society. It is instructive to compare De Giorgio's point of view with Evola's idea of the state; De Giorgio includes the spiritual or contemplative aspect which brings in some subtle changes. Nevertheless, Di Giorgio also recognizes that the active life can also be a path to realization.

The emphasis on the law is also important, such Guenon pointed out that the western medieval tradition did not have a sacred law. There was, and is, canon law, but that is at a lesser level. What De Giorgio is describing is more akin to sharia law in Islam, or the complex rituals and requirements required of Hindu castes, and even the ancient Romans whose daily lives were regulated by rites and taboos. Abandoning such laws, in his view, does not lead to more freedom, but rather to is opposite: it leads to servitude to one's passions and lower nature.

On the other hand, by not knowing himself man does not know God because only the knowledge of his illusory existence permits him to realize the essential truth of God in a process that moves from negation to affirmation, from human nothingness to divine wholeness, not from a fragment to a totality, but from a non-totality to totality, from illusory human unity to real divine unity, not from duality to unity, but from non-duality to unity. This knowledge entails an effective realization that in its turn annuls the earthly sphere, the environment in which man lives, putting all its elements on a plane of absolute equivalence, i.e., neutralizing, dissipating the sense of otherness that derives from the possessive conceit concluding in the ontological absurdity "I am I".

The process of realization instead denies the first person, affirms the second, unifies the first and third, and definitively puts itself beyond this union, in what we could call the Fourth Sublime, the Fourth Absolute.

This is the ideal plan of transhumanization presented as a *feri* while it is an *esse*, and it is the decisive model of everything in principle and therefore also and above all of the Leader who is not such if he does not take on the experience of his subjects in the purity of the distributive standard and in the unification of sovereign power. Therefore his function is, so to say, the restoration of hierarchy, the consecration of the human body whose members are the subjects while he is the vivifying center that accomodates the innumerable expressions of the active life, purifies them in the renovating power of traditional principles whose deposit the Priests hold and returns them almost equipped with a more intense rhythm and clad with the united seal.

In this sense he the first and the last of his subjects because his subordination to divine principles is dependent on his capacity to centralize the forms of active life while expending his personality in a decisive totalization. The relationship between the Leader and his subjects consists in this, that he is in all and all are in him with an absolute reciprocity that makes of the entire active life a veritable sacrifice, i.e., an imperfection made sacred through the gift that is made of it to God in the person of the Leader. He accepts and gives, and what he offers is always himself: he is responsible for how much his subjects accomplish because in him everything merges in order to receive the supreme consecration. The asceticism of the Leader is in a sense superior to that of the Warriors because it is vaster and more integral, accomodating in himself all the developments of the active life in order to maintain them within the traditional ambit with the spiritual authority of the Priests and the power of the Warriors, from the former, the conscience, and from the latter, the personality so that ascetically the last in front of God is the first in front of men. His activity, obeying the law of justice, is thus purged of any personal motives whatsoever because, by becoming Leader, he consecrated himself to the coming of peace on earth and governs in order to make it respected and he provides the harmony of traditional society with a constant effort

of rectification. As God is the ruler of all the worlds, he is the ruler of the earth and of the men who inhabit it, the supreme regulator of their activity without passing beyond his domain which is that of the active life, without which he could be in open conflict with his function and purpose as temporal leader occupying the contemplative sphere that is to the Priests reserved. Harmony must precisely consist in the separation of the two powers that, on earth, and on earth alone, where activity is in force, conserving two distinct spheres while it no longer exists in an ultra-worldly stage that is the starting point for the integral realization of the divine.

The subjects owe the Leader obedience and respect; obedience because he directs human affairs, analogously with God who rules the creative universality, and respect because his function is the application of justice, i.e., the rectification of the disparities produced by the multiformity of men's actions and protects them and guides them to the realization of happiness in whose terminal and plenary stage is Edenic perfection.

Human activity when brought back to the purpose of rite is purified from every contaminating egoism and the man who has fulfilled his temporal stage in perfect adherence to the norm of justice, regains the absolute preeminence over the other beings of whom he becomes again lord and he enjoys the Great Peace in the exercise of his liberty released from every abuse. It is the Leader's precise function to tend to this reintegration of the divine state, directing all the forms of earthly activity toward a progressive purgation and acting so that man can fulfill what is granted to him on earth without actions limiting and precluding contemplation but, regulated and ordered, more than a snag and a chain, is itself a mode of liberation. And he can become it only if conducted according to justice which is the greatest of the virtues, especially for the Leader who must prefer it more than any other virtue because his action neutralizes the will leading every form of activity back into its channel,

preventing abuses of power and giving true liberty to the subjects, i.e., the spiritual practice that is gained with obedience to the law.

Here man is liberated by obeying and not otherwise: whoever does not understand that will always be subjugated. In fact, in order to obey it is necessary to understand the value of the law that is placed to redeem men from the appetites that enslave and to make him able to exercise his freedom effectively. The Leader must be vigilant in respect to the law in order to facilitate the gaining of freedom and he himself will be liberated to the extent he maintains the limits of his temporal function without ever passing beyond them. The law in itself does not know how to nor can it make itself respected, but it needs whoever establishes it, and since it is a pure norm higher than men, it must be imposed: in this sense strength accompanies justice, nor can it be separated and the Leader must make the law respected with strength. But from submission to the law, freedom is born that, being purely of the spiritual order and belonging to the contemplative life, arises only from the perfection of this, like a crowning achievement, an apical stage that is the triumph of man over himself.

Man calls himself free only when he again becomes the son of truth and does not recognize subjection other than this to the point of confusing himself, identifying with a further state which will be that of pure unity. But in the domain of the active life, it is not possible to be liberated other than by obeying the law personified in the Leader who must make it respected with strength, not through an affirmation of supremacy—which is to be excluded in a traditional society—but to prevent the subjects from falling into servitude by breaking the law. The temporal power is inclined to the achievement of freedom and is established for this, so that, by imposing the law, the immoderate will is avoid, the bestial part in man is restrained, and it is started precisely to be free. To regulate the active life can signify nothing other that is positively fertile than to permit contemplative practice in the measure conceded to each one by his

spirit. In civil life, freedom is therefore obedience and in the contemplative life it is liberation: up to this point it is understood that man is not so much born free as he becomes free, and better said, born free, he can maintain his freedom or fall into servitude: most men, by forgetting freedom, which is a divine gift, prefer servitude to their passions, and this they call freedom and are opposed to the monarchical regime because they see in the Leader a man like them and not a model who, in order to make himself respected, must necessarily personify himself: one is not liberated, but becomes liberated, and naturally he becomes it because he is it, but ignorance prevents him from knowing why man is born free: only for the fulfillment of his earthly experience and not for the exaltation of that which is least human in him. He was free at his birth as the son of God, but, straying in order to follow his impulse, which he fallaciously calls freedom, he has become again a slave: in order to become free again, i.e., a son of God, he must put himself under the regulative norm of the active life and to regain the freedom of the contemplative life.

Conclusion

This is the conclusion to the role of the Leader in a traditional society. It needs to be read meditatively, and not with the intent to refute or falsify it. If read in silence, without the infusion of personal opinions, something very different may be heard.

We said that man first denies himself and then affirms himself: he denies himself in the law and affirms himself in love, which is only the supplementary knowledge of the truth. Now the active life cannot be abandoned to the disordered will of the appetites which would make it an end in itself, while it is only a means whose purpose is clearly determined by the temporal power embodied in the Leader. In order to be truly such, it is necessary that this power be employed by a single man so that every subject contemplates himself in his sovereign, his better part, to whom he

must submit himself, the reason that regulates every activity restraining them within their limits and preventing them from gravely obstructing the attainment of the pure values of the spirit.

If the natural end of man is heaven, the starting point is the earth, so that the necessity for making its foundation organized by a liberating action that acts especially on the obstructing element, the body, which abandoned to itself, precludes every possibility of overcoming and attainment. That which is corporeal remains subordinated to the psychic element that is transparently vague through its elusiveness and diffusivity: the virtues inherent in the active life, that the Leader rules and directs, have as their field of action the psychic complex that must be contained and limited by reason as if by a supreme command. But reason is in a certain sense two-edged to the extent that on the one hand it dominates and restrains the lower faculties and on the other, it inserts into a higher order of reality where the intellect extends and, while being human, is the mediator between the human and the divine: likewise the Leader rules in the sign of justice so that a higher stage becomes a reality, whose domain belongs more specially to the Priests, but it is necessary for the Warriors to facilitate this perfection.

Given that, it indicates that war is the condition of peace as long as it is truly conducted by those for whom it is their only given mission and within the limits that make it justifiable and necessary.

In the earthly and human domain, law must make use of force and the symbol and the means of justice is two-edged sword, one of which strikes and points toward the lower, which the other points higher and is bloodless, the point representing the peak of unification of the higher and the lower, the supreme acme, death, or resolution. Thus what seemingly appears cruel, is not always so in reality, and the justice that imposes itself with force is often the necessary vestibule of the highest sphere of love. The activity of the Leader in human and earthly life is analogous to that of God, whose direct instrument he is, in order to coordinate the modes

of activity pursuant to justice, truth, and love. No one more than the Leader knows that by punishing others he punishes himself and that with an act of justice he fulfills an achievement of love and truth: if he does not know this, if he ignores his purpose, he is not truly a leader, but a slave of his own cupidity, since he cannot command if he is not aware of the *raison d'être* of his authority, of the divine character of his mission.

A Warrior among the Warriors he must be an ascetic among the ascetics: so he will reach the point to rule others by how much more he will rule himself and to defeat his enemies by defeating himself, and to fight the small wars by fighting the Great War, and to achieve external peace by how much more profoundly and perfectly he will have achieved interior peace, knowing that earthly life is only a stage, but the most important of all, of which he is the orderer. His responsibility is very great before men but especially before God since by betraying his creatures he betrays his Creator and by neglecting justice in order to follow his own impulse he contradicts the nobility of the position that he occupies and abuses the power that is given to him: then he will truly be last among men and servant among the servants. Since there is no justice without a judge, so the Leader is also judge among men and here his task is still more serious and difficult: he must be very attentive and not exceed the scope in which his activity unfolds, since as judge he can affect the case, but not the knowledge of those who have accomplished it. He knows in fact that everything that happens may not happen and that there is nothing open to censure that others accomplish that he himself cannot accomplish, since men are the mirror of man and he, as Leader, is the mirror of the time in which he lives and is also the supreme responsible man for it.

His more or less great adherence to tradition is measured by the degree of greater or lesser spirituality of the era in which he lives and of which he is the judge. He must dematerialize the world, bring active life back within its normal limits, to make action a means and not an end, and

contemplation an end and not a means, and force the pure expression of law and power, the assertion of his humility before God, and justice the implacable rectification, and the gift of himself the constant offering.

He is in the world to redeem it, to purify it in the name of God, for the love of God, because he, with the Warriors, is the protector of the Temple and his mission is the respect of the sacred law to which he is subject and through which he is the Leader, since everything that comes from God must return to God, and what is accomplished on earth is only for the dignity of the true man who is a son of God. His true glory, his true conquest will have facilitated it, prepared it, realized the coming of the kingdom of God, having transformed life in a rite redeeming man from his state of servitude, leading him to liberty through to liberation, making of the active life a connecting bridge to the beatitude of contemplation where the divine is only realized, ransoming not oppressing, spiritualizing not materializing.

Only in that way will he be the God's chosen and his power will receive that consecration from which all authority comes. He knows that man and the world are of God and that everything must flow into the great traditional axis that is sustained by sacred knowledge of which he is the most pious and aware supporter. The active life that he rules and normalizes must be contained within the limits that permit each man to rise to the sphere of contemplation where true life begins, the divine life, and his mission unfolds in the temporal sphere for eternity, on earth for heaven, the center of the innumerable efforts that flows from every point into a single wave, in a single rhythm, for the glory of the one before Whom everything is nothing and the nothing is all.

Supreme bundler of fasces [Fascificatore], the Leader redeems the transience of man and the world with the vivifying rhythm of tradition of which he must be the most intransigent defender in order to establish the constitutive unity of castes, the harmony of principles, the respect of standards, the convergence of all the efforts in the fulfillment of his very

high mission, so that the world is truly the mark, the crown, and the sign of God.

Posted on 2013-07-21 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2013-07-21 at 12:26 said:

In the Christian tradition, the capo existed in the form of the Byzantine Emperor, and later the Russian Tsar who was the absolute ruler over both spiritual and temporal realms.....in the East the Emperor protected defended the church but the church was still subject to his laws. In the West the Capo never emerged due to conflicts between the Popes and the Emperors.....

Cologero on 2013-07-22 at 13:07 said:

J-A, do you suppose that Guido De Giorgio is proposing a thought experiment along the lines of Plato's Republic? Although the domain of the Capo is activity, unlike God, he can never be pure act, so there is always non-being or privation associated with his rule. The stronger Leaders can come closer to the ideal.

JA on 2013-07-23 at 12:16 said:

Of course de Giorgio is discussing an ideal, but it is our task to make the ideal real...if not now then when the time is right.....

It is also a good question whether or not the Capo could ever actually exist, perhaps Justinian or Charlemagne came close ?

JA on 2013-07-29 at 10:42 said:

From my first readings de Giorgio's ideas read very much like that of the Byzantine-Russian practice of symphonia where church and state were separate but linked in that the Tsar was anointed by the patriarch and expected to be a good Christian at the risk of losing his legitimacy from God, but while subject to the church in spiritual matters the Emperor was ruler of the church in temporal realms.

In the western history I'm trying to understand if Roman Catholic doctrine would allow for a Capo or would the Pope claim too much power in temporal affairs that an absolute monarch would never be able to exist ?

Cologero on 2013-07-29 at 12:39 said:

Tomberg addresses this very question, as it is enshrined in the arcana of the Pope and the Emperor.

For example:

"The authors of the Middle Ages could not imagine Christianity without an Emperor."

JA on 2013-07-29 at 14:17 said:

Tomberg follows the Catholic conception but is his vision of the Emperor the same as de Giorgio's ? I'll have to read this essay several more times before I am able to conclude for sure but now it's seeming to me that the Capo has more power than the Holy Roman Emperor (for example the priests are subject to him in the temporal sphere, whereas the Church claimed that a King or and Emperor had no power over a clergyman, the clergy answer to the Pope alone, hence no state could be absolute because the clergy constituted a caste that was not in service to the monarch) – later on the arrangement changed more in the Kings favour (Spanish Baroque period, France under Louis XIV) but that was the decline of Catholicism already....

basically my worry about the Catholic system of government is that the duality of heads is unstable (Pope vs Emperor) and allows for rebellions of kings (as what happened with protestantism). The Orthodox model seems more stable but then its problem is that it become too national (greek church, russian church all under their own Tsars) and fails to create an Imperium as Rome was meant to do...

Logres on 2013-07-30 at 10:27 said:

The Orthodox apparently have a tradition that St. Feodor of Tomsk was Alexander I, who staged his own assassination.

<http://www.johnsanidopoulos.com/2012/11/was-saint-feodor-of-tomsk-really.html>

Logres on 2013-07-30 at 10:53 said:

Would de Giorgio's doctrine imply that, even in our time, such a person necessarily exists, however hidden or concealed? It seems to me that it would – God would be sustaining his link to the world through the sacred body of the King. King Alfred seems like a close approximation to the ideal, in the West.

scardanelli on 2013-07-30 at 11:57 said:

Logres,

You jogged my memory, and I recalled that I read of this same concept in the introduction to Sedir's Initiations:

"There is a Prince of this Earth –delegate of Lucifer; and there is also the Lord of this Earth –delegate of Christ...[T]he Lord of the Earth is the one among the servants, soldiers or friends

of

Christ who possesses the qualities and the right quantity of Lights most suited to link our terrestrial life to the Word directly. He receives the orders of Christ, executes them, then transmits the hopeful aspirations of the earth's inhabitants to Him."

Ash on 2013-08-02 at 01:58 said:

An essential question to ask here must be, who judges the Capo? Or rather, can anyone decide when he has failed in his role? Presumably it would be the duty of the Contemplative caste to make these judgements and of the Active (warrior) caste to carry them out and replace the Leader. We might think of what happened during the Empire when Emperors such as Caligula, Nero, and Elagabalus were killed by the Praetorian guard (admittedly, money and preservation of power had more to do with those than concern for Traditional principles). A troublesome situation arises when the Capo begins to feud with the other two higher castes, such as Henry VIII and the Catholic Church. While it is obviously not de Giorgio's principle, I must admit to some unease as much of the language used here could easily be hijacked to justify totalitarian and decidedly anti-Traditional forms of ideology and tyranny. There are many out there eager to grab the reigns of power and ignore the voices of those who remind them that this power is meant to be exercised within its proper dominion and no further.

Cologero on 2013-08-03 at 14:01 said:

Perhaps, Ash, tomorrow's conclusion will clarify some things. However, it seems you are thinking in terms of the modern mind and the examples you give are hardly traditional. It's true, there is literally no one to judge the Capo since he is God's representative and no one can judge God. Of course, the modern mind regards that as a trick, some kind of ruse to keep the people under control, the opiate of the masses. The modern mind denies the very possibility of God manifesting through some particular man, whereas the traditional mind can see things no other way: the cosmic order is in continuity and harmony with the social order.

Jung made an interesting point, for example, that the Pharaoh was the only individuated person and the mass was undifferentiated. The latter state would have been more like that described by Julian Jaynes and thoughts would have seemed to them to originate from the outside, from "gods". Hence, the command of the Pharaoh would have had the same force. We may suppose that the consciousnesses of the scribes and priest were similar to the Pharaoh's to some extent. Jung and Serrano claim that the "persona" is more marked in the West and that may account for the turmoil.

In the Ancient City, the leader was a priest-king with divine authority. Unfortunately, we don't have sufficient documentation, but Fustel de Coulanges claims that at some point the function of the Chief Priest and King got separated as the Warrior caste asserted more control. The relevant period for Rome was the Kingdom. For example, the second king Numa also led

the Priests. It is interesting that the way the King was selected is nearly identical to the way Popes are selected today. Again, that documentation was lost, to the extent that in the Republic and the Empire, the ancient laws became incomprehensible.

I guess the point is that the traditional system is not simply one alternative among many, as some sort of political party among many others. It would require an intellectual conversion, a real change in consciousness.

Ash on 2013-08-03 at 18:51 said:

Cologero, would you not say there is a concern to address in terms of the abuse of such authority? Clearly the boundaries of the Capo are defined and as such the truly differentiated man would be following them, but we also have accounts of corrupt Emperors and Pharaohs. I suppose in some ways this question is very cart-before-the-horse, since presumably a traditional force in society would establish itself before the question of a Capo ever arose. But if, as de Giorgio says, the priests consecrate the Capo even as he comes from the warriors, that would seem to mean that they can prevent unworthy individuals from attaining such position, and would it not simply be a further fulfillment of this role that they act as a check on the Capo (if ideally an unnecessary one). To put it more plainly, I think we are all generally suspicious of individuals claiming that they are God's representative and that they must be followed as His own voice, precisely because they are generally scammers and anti-Traditional. We, as students of Tradition, must strive more than anyone to be sure that those who guide and teach are authentic and acting in accordance with their duties and the Truth.

On the point of the King I can provide some assistance, as I did some in depth studying on the religious heritage of Rome for university papers last year. My main secondary source was a book called *Religions of Rome* (Beard, North, and Price). It makes the case that the political Rex and the Rex Sacrocum were always separate positions in the regal era. During the early Republic and onward, the Rex Sacrocum was a member of the Pontifical college and as such himself under the authority of the Pontifex Maximus. This is however a new development, as it was previously assumed by many that the Rex Sacrocum at some point simply took over the religious duties of the King. Your example of Numa is ideal though: assuming separate functions, Numa would seem to fulfill the role of Capo and thus the Rex Sacrocum would be subordinate to him, being the head priest.

Cologero on 2013-08-03 at 19:34 said:

If the Capo has the qualities that De Giorgio describes, then there is no abuse. The Roman king selection followed an interesting process. The Senate elected the King from among them, so presumably they should know him well. He was presented to the people who could refuse him. Finally, the priest had to wait for the omen to indicate the new king had divine authority. So the king required approval from the three castes. Is that not sufficient for you? In your studies

on the Roman Kingdom, why did it eventually fail and get replaced by the Republic?

Ash on 2013-08-03 at 21:12 said:

That would seem more than sufficient for choosing the ruler, yes. I am thinking more about degeneration over time (as the castes themselves face as well). Perhaps it would be useful to reflect on past incidences of this degeneration. Keeping Rome as our example, the last King was remembered as a tyrant who forever swore the city off that system of government.

As to why the Kingdom fell...the simple answer is that historians are left in many ways to guesswork. We know of the story of the rape of Lucretia and the fall of Tarquinius Superbus, but I would personally think that the "other" myth of Romulus' death may provide insight. In this account, Romulus is murdered by the Patres, the body which became the Senate. They then dismember his body and attempt to hide the murder by claiming that he became a god, who was worshiped as Quirinus. We know that the Kings were generally chosen from outside the Curiae, the collections of families from the Roman population. Thus the six legendary Kings consist of Latins, Sabines, and Etruscans, none of whom directly succeed fathers. This suggests that conflict always existed at some level between the Patres/Senators and the Kings who were meant to deliberate among them as outsiders, as would be expected. As an aside, we also know that the senatorial and priestly bodies were overlapping to a great extent, and that the major priests would often also be major political figures, particularly in the later Republic.

Having derived these points, and knowing that the Republic was established following a rebellion of the Senatorial class against a King who had become considered tyrannical, we may conclude that this conflict came to a head. History being written by the winners, we may assume that the Senatorial patrician classes decided that they were better off with the familial competition than regal moderation. If we are to examine this with de Giorgio's vocabulary, this means that the warriors (the Senators and Equestrians alone had the property and wealth to be able to train and arm themselves to protect Rome) overthrew the Capo who had been previously approved by them. We do not know who the "people" (the plebs and plebeians) supported in this struggle, though later generations remembered the overthrow as a great event and shared the Senate's hatred of Kings. Perhaps the previously mentioned defeat of the rebellion of the Kshatriyas in the Hindu epics is an example of a similar conflict which was won by the other side.

Saladin on 2013-08-03 at 22:28 said:

Ash@ "We do not know who the "people" (the plebs and plebeians) supported in this struggle"

Ash, I am sure you meant Plebs and Proletariat, right?

As you said, it's not too much of a stretch to think that "Senatorial patrician classes decided that they were better off with the familial competition than regal moderation" and they replaced

a degenerate king with a Republic. As for the masses, I don't think their taking side would have made that much of a difference at that period of time. Even though "bread and circus" was invented for them much later, during the Empirical period, a different version of "bread and circus" was enough to keep them preoccupied during those early Republican period.

Ash on 2013-08-04 at 00:24 said:

Saladin, I did mean pleb and plebeian. The two words are not wholly interchangeable, as pleb and proletarian would probably be. Pleb means a labourer and man without property who is working in labour or perhaps a trade, whereas plebeian simply denotes one who is not part of the original patrician families. The patrician/plebeian distinction actually lost importance rather early during the Republic, when the "nobiles"/new man distinction between those who had held consulships and those who had not gained importance. Many major figures during the Republic and almost all of those in the Empire were plebeian, but not plebs as they had attained high standing. Augustus' familial links with the Julians aside, there were no real patrician Emperors. It's just a distinction between terms and sometimes gets confused with catchalls like nobility or aristocracy, and for here I wouldn't worry too much about it.

Avery Morrow on 2013-08-04 at 05:09 said:

Ash, Fustel de Coulanges distinguishes the concept of rex from tyrannus, a king who rules without religious affirmation. All Emperors were tyranni because their authority came from the secularized SPQR and not the patrician faith. (They weren't categorized that way by their contemporaries but they would have been recognized as such in the preclassical city – a great demonstration of how much Rome changed over the centuries.) Regardless of whether rex and rex sacrocum were different positions, it should go without saying that they both had the symbolic quality of rex.

A comparison to the Far East is interesting.

4.3 The Establishment of a Traditional Society: Priests

In *La Tradizione Romana*⁴, **Guido De Giorgio** dedicates a section to the question of the reestablishment of a traditional society. It includes four chapters: *The Priests*, *The Warriors*, *The Workers*,

⁴*The Roman Tradition*

and *The King*. This is the first part of the chapter on the priests. De Giorgio provides some very precise indications which are very demanding and ought to be taken with some seriousness.

Introduction

The general lines that are given here about a society established along the norms of a tradition truly such, can serve as the model and example for leading the current West to a normality that it has lacked for quite some time, which could, however, be gradually and prudently restored without great difficulties by the return to those principles and to that spirituality of thought and life that are indispensable to the very existence of men. Therefore it is a question of a general type according to which Europe could be oriented and hence the world with the necessary adaptations to change conditions of life while avoiding a violent and radical dissolution that would jeopardize, through its rapidity, the reintegration of a normal state.

If a return is possible, if a rectification is still possible to save the world from spiritual and material ruin, it entails a change of direction that must absolutely proceed from the inner to the outer and not otherwise. First of all, spiritual conviction of a similar change is necessary, and this conviction must be founded on a *purely intellectual realization*, i.e., without any sentimental infiltration whatsoever, of principles that rule a traditional society, and, since it would be useless and childish to believe that the entire people and the masses can achieve it through an instant process, it would be sufficient that a few at the beginning would constitute a formative nucleus with an increasingly more efficient operative irradiation leading up to the reintegration of a nearly perfect form. These few would be animated by a single force, that of truth, and guided by a single goal, that of making it triumph, and not to give in to any concession toward oneself or others, but to become true and proper centers of salvation for men misled and corrupted by centuries-old errors. If such

men do exist, the return to normality would again be possible and the truth could still triumph over ignorance.

A change of this type entails the pure and simple rejection of all the prejudices that have debased Europe for centuries, of all the errors that the Anti-tradition has been amassing for hundreds of years to corrupt thought and life, impoverishing the mind and paralyzing those spiritual forces promoting the true and only good, the fruition of the Truth in a superhuman order where it alone resides and where it is necessary to have the courage and the strength to maintain it. These men could save Europe and the world, leading the people back into the great traditional channel, toward the light of those principles that are the very basis of existence. But a great energy is necessary to conquer pessimism and skepticism which are opposed to any reestablishment on the one hand, and superficial optimism, on the other, that considers apically reached that which is a simple degree of transition. Above all, great detachment is necessary, strict intellectuality, the absolute absence of that pseudo-mysticism so much in style at the present time where spirituality and sentimentality are equivalent, where enthusiasm and faith are placed on the same level, where the darkest and murkiest impulsiveness is believed to be an expression of strength, where the external is not only excessive, but tends to destroy the internal, where agenda kills true development, where finally all that is inferior and illegitimate is affirmed with an immodesty which the world has never known before now even in the most acute periods of decadence.

But above all, great courage would be necessary in these men and a great faith to conquer so much darkness of ignorance, to break up so many false bridges, to facilitate the return to the comprehension of the truth, to give back to thought its dignity and to life, its justification. Many currently in Europe are aware of the mud the world gets mired in every day, but their conviction is half-hearted and imperfect: it is more about a pessimistic and skeptical attitude than a true and proper conviction. None of those would be able to indicate the remedy or to show the way to

return to true life, which, before all else, reconfirms the values of the spirit that are divine, but do not neglect the necessities of existence, orienting them along the purely traditional axis.

Every traditional society entails the organic allocation of labor and the assignment of tasks to various categories of men adapted to their nature and their possibilities. Even currently, in the agonal state of Europe and the world, this allocation exists, but it is false, arbitrary, unnatural, temporary, not founded on traditional norms, i.e., according to a strictly and purely hierarchical order that derives from the very meaning of the term *hierarkhia* = high priest in Greek, whose sacred character should not elude anyone. Since every tradition is sacred, the allocation of labor must be imposed only from deference to the truth that is the divine order; therefore, the priests would stand at the apex of a traditional society, who are the bearers of the divine order, the divine knowledge. We could say Ascetics, but we prefer to preceding term because it better highlights the precise character of the nature and the office assigned to the bearers of supernatural truth. This caste includes those who do not participate in active life, who lack every responsibility of the profane, temporal order and are the leaders of traditional society, but in reality, through the very character of their mission, occupy a marginal place in respect to the practical act of existences, but one that is central, determinative and indicative for the maintenance and the development of traditional society. They are the poor of God, the voluntary renouncers of the world, the truth givers, the Spirit lovers, the last because the first, whose life is devoted to the realization of the great divine norms that constitute the traditional body. No confusion is possible regarding their nature and their missions which are of a purely spiritual order, without any worldliness, extending into the pure regions of the Spirit of God who governs the world invisibly.

Process of Degeneration

This is the second installment from **Guido De Giorgio's** chapter on the priestly caste from *La Tradizione Romana* **The Roman Tradition**. He sees the process of the degeneration of the castes as beginning, not from the revolt of the Kshatriya, but rather from the failure of the Priests to fulfill their divine mission. Nevertheless, Tradition may be forgotten, but never lost, so there are always some solitary men who continue to maintain that sacred knowledge. De Giorgio moves on to the topic of faith which, he says, is necessary because a man must believe before he knows.

Therefore, they constitute the caste of the invisible ones because their continuous, untiring, hidden action is of the sacred spiritual order and is spontaneously fulfilled through the very force of the soul, the purity of their life that must be a rite, an offering, a sacrifice. We insist particularly on the character of the priestly caste to determine the modality of the hierarchic power and the efficacy of the revelatory mission entrusted to them. They are the leaders of traditional society, but invisible leaders because the sacred knowledge of which they are the depositaries is not a purely dogmatic system nor a dead body, but a living, perennial fire that they must nourish, living continuously in communion with the spirit of God, acting so that His truth is towering at its peak, in isolation from His profound virtue, in the active and effective development that only the contemplative life allows to be realized.

They are the great hermits and they descend among men, the bearers of the graces of the truth, but, even if living in the world, they are really on the outside and dominate while not dominating, act while not acting, illuminating with their light, they save with their presence, strengthen with their example. Their hierarchy and their organization, the traditional type to which they are tied, the value of the character of their mission are absolutely determined by their having freely and consciously chosen not a career, not a profession, not a job, but the way of God, that by leaving

from God leads back to God, and of having chosen it not only for itself, but rather with the precise task of showing it to all. They sacrifice themselves and they sacrifice: it is reflected carefully in the value and in the immense importance of these two expressions when led back to the precision of their etymological meaning sacrifice=make sacred. The Priests cannot not be sacred themselves, they cannot not make sacred everything that they touch and go near because they were born for that, they were destined to that and their choice, in embracing the holy ministry, is an absolute match with the inherent possibilities of their nature.

They cannot deviate if they are truly priests, they cannot, if they deviate, not fall into the lowest abjection because they have betrayed God, they failed in their vows, and by abjuring, they contaminated themselves and men. If the value and the height of the task entrusted to the Priests is fixed and well understood, one will reach some conclusions to which the modern world, having become anti-traditional, is no longer capable of elevating itself. Let us outline one of them.

Since the Priests are the holders of sacred knowledge and constitute the insuppressible base of a truly traditional foundation, they are to secure its normality, they are to maintain the unity with their invisible spiritual hidden work and therefore are responsible for the general defection of the traditional spirit, because no one can fall if the priests themselves do not fall, no one can fail if the priests themselves do not fail, no one can be banned against the truth of God if the priests do not betray it first, no one can corrupt the world if they do not corrupt it first, abandoning their sacred mission for the concerns of the temporal order, passing from the contemplative life for which they are destined, to the active life that is not absolutely the place of the development of their activity, with falling short of their caste, their obligations, and especially the divine principles whose radiating virtue they must keep intact. How many are capable of understanding how *the current state of abjection is due to the defection of the priestly caste who are responsible for it* because they alone, the Priests,

maintaining contact with the divine not only by means of their action over men, but above all with the constant realization and efficacy of their interior ascesis? Just as God's strength is mysterious and invisible, so is the Priest's occult and hidden: contemplating they act, fulfilled in God, they work in the world, sacrificing themselves they sacrifice, praying they save, although their mission is genuine and not the unholy profanation of God's laws.

If one can with absolute certainty impute to them the state of current Europe, whatever defection of this caste, whatever decadence of humanity is not attributable to the traditional form to which they are reconnected and of which they could be the authentic representatives. Tradition is invulnerable, inviolable, unassailable, it is God's truth and is kept intact because, even if betrayed by His ministers, He always finds those who preserve its sacred character, those who, among men not belonging to the priestly caste, become its legitimate and authorized carrier. And almost always those, priests among men, carry out their mission more dangerously than if they belonged to the officially recognized caste, because they have to fight against a profane force that tends to suppress them, that of those who have betrayed the faith, repudiated tradition, abandoning the divine for the human and the sacred for the profane: those are the false priests who are no longer such, i.e., holders of sacred knowledge. Reflect on the importance of what we say, and you will be able to understand how the solitary Ascetics, those who we will be able to call "hoi exo" the outside, in all the periods of decadence of the priestly caste, have kept alive the perennial fire of tradition against the deceit, the hatred, calumny of those who failed in their mission.

The self-establishment of ascetic groups outside the priestly caste, the presence of Masters, i.e., of solitary Ascetics, in all the period of decadence is explained precisely by the abandonment of tradition by parts of those to whom its deposit was entrusted, and the necessity—of the divine order, we insist—that others seek to keep contact between man and

God, purging the sacred ways of the profane dross that the false priests amassed, i.e., the most ungodly deniers of the supernatural world. Dante *docet*... It is necessary, to avoid misunderstanding, to insist on the nature and character of this definition, of this contamination that takes place in the ambit of the priestly caste in the periods of decadence. The divine truths that constitute the sacred body of tradition has a purely metaphysical, or transcendent, character: they are superhuman, eternal, and to approach them, it is therefore absolutely necessary to pass beyond the human condition and bring oneself with the intellect into that sphere of pure actuality where the divine reality is developed beyond the domain of Forms and Rhythms in the silence of its ineffability. Faith prepares this transition from the human to the divine, in fact, it is its essential condition, that which cannot elude anyone through the elementary analogy with so many human and contingent situations. It is necessary to believe that one knows, because one knows only by knowing that one can one know before knowing, i.e., before having acquired the wisdom and having already completed the passage from the human to the divine in order to do so that only the divine is.

Faith in whom? In God, in the Master, so say all traditions that insist on this absolutely necessary condition for the effective realization of the divine. One believes in the truth before reaching it, i.e., before being there and being it, and the intensity of faith is in direct relation with the efficacy of the achievement.

Faith is therefore the rail, the bridge, the isthmus between the human and the divine, between what man is not and what he really is when he is no longer, when he surpassed and passed over forever the human condition. But since this is the fruit of ignorance, faith is the necessary condition for the dispersal of ignorance and the reaching of wisdom.

It annuls every human limitation in man, abolishes individuality, opens all the passages of Infinite possibility, considers the chains as untied so that they are really so, it works a type of preparatory radiation of indi-

vidual faculties, because one believes in things other than oneself, in the sacred text, in the hidden value of the rite, in the minister, in the master, in other words, in whatever passes beyond quotidian reality, the illusion of the world ordinarily experienced in the ambit of all sensible and rational limitations, it denies resolutely the tangible whole and affirms an invisible reality.

To have faith means to believe in what one does not yet know, one does not know, it is the most noble and desperate attempt to bring oneself face to face with the threshold of mystery and to affirm that beyond it there is an unspeakable reality, that which is revealed. Even for those who cannot pass over this threshold, it is enormously positive that they succeed in bringing themselves to the extreme limit connected to their strengths with an act of faith that leaps over error, the visible presence, the world and things, in one stroke, to genuflect in the face of the Invisible Presence, God and His Names still concealed precisely because they are absent, asserted, and believed and not known. Faith is therefore superior to any human knowledge whatsoever, to any conquering activity of the human alone, because it passes beyond it, considers it as ancillary, negligible, negotiable, even nothing in the face of the divine that it recognizes as the invisible venerable root through its invisibility, real through its apparent unreality, divine exactly because not human, not tangible, not discernible with the senses, and analyzable by reason, placed in a sphere of this the good ones, those who believe, will be able to enjoy, if it will be pleasing to God, only after the dissolution of the human compound, i.e., *post mortem*.

Faith works this miracle that those who cannot reach by an operational effort and aware of the threshold of the divine, attain it with the rapid and direct contact that can be fecund with greater results: compared to those who know, that are beyond the threshold, they find themselves very far, but compared to those who do not believe, to the small men of the small world, the affirmers of the minimum in the minimum and

lovers of the shadows, they are in a clearly privileged position because they are distant from just as far as the spirit surpasses the flesh and intelligence surpasses imbecility.

Conclusion

This is the third and final installment from **Guido De Giorgio**'s chapter on the priestly caste from *La Tradizione Romana* **The Roman Tradition**. He continues the discussion on faith. He points out that when the priesthood deteriorates, it gives rise to priesthood of solitary Ascetics. Although they maintain traditional teachings, these solitary men do not have the authority to maintain traditional society. Furthermore, they find themselves opposed by the decadent priests. The priests who go astray need to be punished in order to prevent scandal. In the contemplative life, one's own thoughts and desires are emptied and the Invisible Presence begins to manifest in one's center in an endless number of stages. By losing his life in this way, his life becomes more real and more fulfilled.

Those who are called "geniuses" by men of today, so tied to the human to see them through the greatest irony, even the superhuman, enclosed as they are in human and terrestrial limitations, are greatly inferior to the most humble of believers because they hypertrophy a nothing, man and the world, and they make everything from this nothing, while the believers deny the nothing, man and the world, and reaffirm it only putting it back on God, i.e., in the supreme cause. Those who do not believe see the effect separated from the cause, which is absurd, while those who believe see the effect in the cause, which is conformed to truth: those who know even abolish the effect and this is the truth. Deepening this last point, one will be able to come to understand, first of all, the triple attitude of man in the face of the truth in accordance to what is subhuman, human or superhuman, and consequently the way in which the

principle of causality must be considered in the transition from the profane to the sacred, from the human to the divine, according to what the schema of death, life, and liberation makes of it. This triple schema can be more crudely formulated in connection to these possibilities: *without God, with God, God*.

Faith is therefore the traditional base for excellence since it is the necessary anticipation of the means through which the path begins from the human to the divine and it resolutely builds a bridge that is fixed on the other shore without seeing it but only knowing it as revealed: tradition works this fixation in the divine that constitutes for the believers the invisible *ubi consistam* place to stand, the fulcrum of its elevation to the threshold of mystery.

We note that God, precisely because He is believed but not known, is affirmed in His deepest reality, that of the Unmanifested Principle, and that simple faith pronounces itself more positively than what would appear to a superficial examination, since by affirming the unknowability of the destination, it admits implicitly that only a realizing knowledge can attain it with an effective becoming. This knowledge follows faith, it passes over the threshold of the divine to carry oneself into the same mystery.

It is the most interior part of the Temple where the sacrifice is performed, that altar where the Priest resides.

So if the whole temple constitutes the domain of the sacred and we have the profane only outside of it, in the temple itself among the altar and the rest, there is a clean separation, and while the altar constitutes the active realization of the divine and therefore it is the true domain of the sacred, the rest of the church is reserved to those who are present at the sacrifice, they participate in it, *but do not perform it themselves*, therefore they are always only the profane because there is a barrier between them and the divine truth. This is the relationship between faith and knowledge, between the faithful and the Priests, between those who only believe

and those who know and should know, between the throng of the *called* and the and the rank of the *elect*, between passive love that genuflects and pulls back outside of the sacred threshold and the active love that performs the sacrifice directly with a gesture that is a benediction, a voice that is of God, an altar that is the very throne of the Eternal.

From all that it is easy to reach this conclusion that the Priests, as the bearers of sacred knowledge, must really possess it by means of a realizing knowledge in order to be able to perform on the altar the highest of the sacrifices, the divine sacrifice, through which they strengthen the faith, reconfirm it in its strength, and reach the hope that it can, by crossing the threshold, reach the sphere of *charitas*, of divine love.

If the Priests do not attain this realizing knowledge, they are not such, they cannot be the sustainers of Tradition, the princes of a traditional society, those who maintain the contact between the human and the divine in a permanent current, who secure life and the justification of life itself, placing it back in God. This is the true sin which a Priest can incur, of not having attained the realizing knowledge, of performing a rite with knowing its value, efficacy, and meaning, of not knowing, in other words, the sacred knowledge and of reducing it to a simple babbling of the lips or to an idle formulation that, in the scope of realizing knowledge which should be that of the Priest, is an absurdity because the one falling short puts himself beneath the believers, the profane among the profane and the profaner among the profaners.

Tradition remains untouched however, even in such a case, the intangible rite does not diminish the efficacy that it had on believers, on the faithful, some of whom can even substitute, if not in fact, in a reality that even leaps over the fact, the Priest, performing for them the rite and becoming for them the transient or permanent deposits of God's truth. If this defection does not harm Tradition in itself, it harms enormously the basis of a traditional society, it invalidates the principle of authority that is absolutely necessary to the maintenance of the two orders, the

human and the divine, the profane and the sacred, that of faith and of knowledge, of those who believe and those who know, but what is more serious, it gives rise to the *priesthood of solitary Ascetics* who, by God's will, maintain the traditional secret with their work reserved to a minority, they safeguard it, they protect it against profanations, and they end up being opposed by the priestly class that fears in then its same knowledge, that which they themselves abandoned and betrayed. These deplorable clashes always occurred at the expense of sacred knowledge, giving rise to upheavals and conflicts of every type contrary to the maintenance of traditional order.

In making the Priests the depositaries of sacred science in in considering so these various questions, we thinking of a traditional form that more is adapted to nature and the spirit of the West where the sole ascetics should be the Priests, where they along should truly safeguard the traditional body realizing effectively in itself the doctrine with the deep knowledge of everything that constitutes the divine truth.

The Priests besides being deprived of real knowledge of sacred things can also come up short of the decorum that is imposed on their caste. The accusation of immorality is too noted and too usual because one has to insist there, instead of this were derived incomprehensible devaluations of tradition itself, which is truly absurd, giving rise to the sect, schism, heterodoxy. We will immediately and clearly say that the morality is for knowledge and not the inverse and the purely moral side of a question of any fact is the least act for make it comprehend and valued its meaning. The first and only sin is ignorance and one is responsible more for not knowing or poorly knowing than to act evil. As to judge conscience, we do not believe that his is not only a very arduous and insolvable task, but directly a sacrilege, because from God alone and in the name of God consciences are judged and where it never than the so called more judgments are given in God and in the name of God? One reflects attentively that and one will see that only the facts can be judged in the customary place

as the condition capable of determining others and therefore, if harmful, condemnable.

Therefore what must be judged, condemned, and punished is the deed when it is visible, it is “active”, it leads to imitation, it is the example, the seed of other deeds, it corrupts: what must be condemned is scandal in all forms, in all classes, and this is the healthy principle of a truly traditional ethic that maintains the privilege of the conscience in action as God’s privilege, and represses the infraction not because the motives are condemned, but to prevent the repetition, the example.

And since there is a vast range in the intensity of the propagation of an offense, i.e., in the immortality of a deed, a truly civil society should adopt all those natural, external, brutal, repressive measures that punish, from the death penalty up to the torture and flogging, but *they do not judge*, in beating the man, what he has that is the most external, i.e., the flesh.

A truly civil society, readopting all the old measures of physical, outward coercion, returns to the truth of the traditional river-bed, obeys scrupulously God’s truth, and at the same time enriches the number of true, real reasons for action, creating a game, an alternation, a reciprocity between the crime and the punishment, fruitful in sensations beneficial to life, fertile in expansions and the surpassing of the brutal fact. Capital punishment, the various types of torture publicly inflicted with their tragedy, are always considerably effective and instructive and they can even determine true sources of purification, positive complexes, whose importance does not elude those who are equipped with sense and truly constructive imagination and not esthetically and softly deviators. But there is another consideration of a deeper order: the crime has degrees integrally subordinated to human passionate nature, i.e. to the darkest complex that dominates ordinary men undisputedly: it is therefore necessary that hierarchically or analogously proportionate penalties correspond to these levels, penalties determinate by an impersonal justice that

strikes in the flesh, abstracting from any experimental character: thus only a reward and a rectification reaching a balance is established; this is the indicator of a true and proper traditional society.

The Priests can and must be blamed only if they fail at their task through total or partial incomprehension of traditional truths: their existence, on the purely exterior side, i.e., from the moral point of view, is reprehensible when it offers matter for scandal and then only if they submit to a tribunal that can be constituted only by men belonging to their caste. In fact from what has been said thus far, it results that real knowledge, i.e., integrative and realizing, belongs to the contemplative, and not the active life. The relationship between contemplation and action is of the greatest importance for the maintenance of the traditional idea because their imbalance constitutes a rupture, a hierarchical inversion, a veritable deviation that, prolonged for centuries, was the origin of the current abjection of the West. Contemplation stands to action in the same relationship as the divine to the human, the sacred to the profane, the eternal to the ephemeral, since their range is distinct and cleanly circumscribed by the two different types of activity. In contemplation there is an activity of a special order that is accomplished in the eternal place, beyond time and space in the sphere of transcendent truths, in an apparent retreat and in an interiorization that in reality are a veritable translation from the human to the divine and a cancellation of the human so that only the divine remains in its absolute autonomy.

In this sense, contemplation and revelation are synonyms because the divine truth can be revealed only in man becoming a temple, i.e., the refuge itself of the truth, the empty temple of humanity founded on earth and elevated to heaven in a verticality symbolically reflecting the lifting up of all being to the totalization of the higher states for their inclusive and intensive integration.

If in the Primordial Tradition the world itself was the temple, with the successive degeneration of humanity, the sacred enclosure was established

to separate the sacred from the profane and maintain the distinction between the two orders in the way that the higher directs and guides the lower. The temple is the symbol and more than a symbol, it is the place of peace, of absolute interiority where, every individuality is denied, annulled, or distanced from every human dross, the realization of the divine is accomplished, the theophanic cycle of all its effective fullness.

Whoever contemplates—and contemplation is only of the divine order, therefore it must be judged absolutely inappropriate to any order, especially to the esthetic order which is visibly inferior—not only separates himself from others, but from himself, that which is the essential, and it empties his heart making it the center of his being where the Invisible Presence is manifested in a progressive irradiation whose levels are without end and constitute the hierarchy of divine stages. This term therefore cannot be, nor must be, applied to another that is not the real, effective achievement of higher states not passively glimpsed as though from the outside, but actively realized in one's interiority of the great temple which is the purified heart, cleansed, made a receptacle of light, the holy chalice where the divine mystery is completed. Everything that is purely and clearly human—like art in the profane sense and philosophy especially in the modern meaning—is excluded from the contemplative field that is the divine and not human life, reality and not illusion, truth and not ignorance. Philosophy that is an impaired wisdom and art that is a purely exterior infatuation for their very degeneration, are excluded from contemplative life and represent an artificial interstructure that the current abjection established between contemplation and action, small spurious world where weakness and imbecility produced by the ignorance of external things is depleted.

If contemplation is therefore reserved to the Priests who are the bearers of divine wisdom, what will be the relationship between the contemplative and active life? It is identical to that which rules the divine order and the human order: the active life must be oriented in accordance with

a vision that can be determined only by those who live contemplatively. In fact, if man and the world in themselves are nothing when separated from their cause and not put back in it, i.e., in God, they acquire instead quite another meaning when they are integrated in the real order because they represent the same place where one of the divine possibilities is fulfilled. Reflect attentively on this: the contemplative life is a larger circle that includes in it a smaller one, the active life, the integration of these two modes constitute the traditional unity. Affirming the superiority of the contemplative life, we postulate the necessity of the active life provided that the latter is included in it, i.e., it remains hierarchically subordinated in order to shape it and procure for it all its operative efficacy. One, contemplation, works in the eternal, the other, action, works in the ephemeral, which is the symbol of the eternal: one, contemplation, is the domain of the sacred, the other, action, is the domain of the profane that becomes sacred only if it receives light from the former. To be more explicit: the contemplative returning to life properly called, i.e., to external existence, sees it under another aspect, different from that of the common man, therefore it is logical and natural that he seeks to consider it not as separate from the divine truth, but as effective preparation for that, the vestibule, the pre-position that rules and determines a final development realized only in the place of pure contemplation.

The harmony between contemplation and action is necessary for the complete integration of human possibilities so that man could be truly such, rich in every development, judge of his own destiny, capable of elevating himself from earth to heaven in a progressive expansion of all his faculties. But that is possible only if contemplation dominates action: in the reverse case we have the hierarchical revolution, the annulment of the traditional axis, the impoverishment of man demasculinized, made ugly, victim of all those inferior forces on which he can have the upper hand only if he is guided by the spirit of God.

It is up to the Priests, besides, to act so that the spirit of God reigns

in the world and sustains the forces of man and truly dignifies him because man is everything with God, nothing without God, and his action deprived of any traditional content is a groping in the lower darkness, a wicked shadow among wicked shadows, sterile bedroom activities *fornicatoria* that impels him from illusion to illusion, from error to error in the great detrital riverbed, the hellish, subhuman, ghostly, and lemuric world.

But if instead the active life is regulated along the traditional axis, as a rite, then all the apparent imbalances are annulled while counterbalancing each other, all the varieties of human expression and deviations are arranged and are resolved in an integrative homogeneity. It is necessary to insist on what men have completely forgotten in the collapse of all traditional values: the active life is so much richer the more it is subordinated to the contemplative life, because in a truly traditional society there is an amplification of human possibilities, an infinitely more fertile development of their most various activities, in the modern world, they are completely wasted. For a law of analogy that regulates the parallelism of the two orders, we will say that the more intense the contemplative life is, the richer is the active life, as much as God is exalted, so much more is man valued, and that in a truly traditional society, everything profane is something sacred *in fieri* pending and all aberrations are recomposed in the equilibrium between the divine and the human, love and hate, wisdom and ignorance, war and peace, virtue and vice, good and evil, in a full, integral, oceanic confluence, are harmonized, surpassed, and twinned, in the great traditional river-bed.

But because this takes place, it is necessary for the Priests to truly be the supreme club-bearers and that their life be purely contemplative, as the bearers of divine truths, the great fee men of the eternity that they keep watch on the bastions of time, intermediaries between the higher and lower waters, between the divine and the human, between the cosmic and the hyperuranium where the Platonic ideas reside, knowers of the

light that is the only light emanating from God.

* * *

Janus on 2013-02-10 at 21:53 said:

This is essential, and something many “political” traditionalists should read. There is an unfortunate trend toward restoring the forms of Tradition before its essence. Seeking out a spiritual or religious discipline would probably be the most important thing for those of a contemplative (brahminic) nature to do at the current time. Providence may yet provide teachers in surprising places.

That said, the essence is gaining more ground in surprising places. While being aware of the somewhat ambivalent attitude of many on this board to Dugin, it would be worthwhile to look at the Against the Postmodern World conference held in Moscow some time ago. No national bolshevik rally this; Shaykh ‘Abd al Wāhid Pallavicini was among those who saw fit to attend. Behind the petty racialists, neopagans without understanding, new right and national revolutionaries seems to be a stirring of some who are ready to look beyond the political form and see the inner life it is meant to reflect, be they of a contemplative or active nature. I’m especially interested in seeing what follows here. For those interested, here is an article from Dugin’s conference: it is by Claudio Mutti and entitled “The Doctrine of Divine Unity in the Hellenic Tradition”. Cologero, I’d love to hear your thoughts on it. <http://against-postmodern.org/node/127>

Logres on 2013-02-11 at 11:40 said:

Iamblichus would say that “courage” or “daring” is the Dyad – the warrior – the feminine principle: hence, the purely “political” is the Dyad without the Monad, doomed to futility. Very lucid article!

David on 2013-02-11 at 22:44 said:

«A Christianity that is largely without doctrine and sacrament is a Christianity of slogan and extravaganza. A “Churchless” Christianity is simply, a heresy. It is a strange reading of the New Testament with conclusions as novel as they are effective. It is also destructive of the long term health of the Christian faith. Many who grow tired of its slogans and extravaganza do not turn elsewhere – they turn nowhere. The fastest growing religious group in America is the unchurched.

The truth and richness of the Christian faith is only found in the deep-woven fibers of the historic Church. The life of sacrament, rooted in a thoroughly Christianized network of families, parishes and monasteries, is the normative existence of the Christian faith. This is the faith that converted the Roman Empire and the barbarian ancestors of people like myself. From it grew a

great civilization, one that has been challenged and dismantled at many points, but which has yet to disappear.»

– Ft Stephen. <http://glory2godforallthings.com/>

I.e., the Church is Tradition. Priest are part of a tradition and we need it back.

This author is very interesting for those who are Christians.

Jason-Adam on 2013-02-12 at 14:46 said:

Guido de Giorgio's book is amazing and I wish a full translation of it existed. Cologero, do you know of a link to the full text in Italian online ?

As for Dugin, I know the man personally and can say that he does not act like an aristocrat – meaning that he does not discuss and debate logically and cordially, the way that Cologero, Avery, Logres and all the folks at Gornahoor do, instead he expects one to accept his words without question and obey them, if one raises an objection or merely asks for further clarification of what he means, he gets angry and then starts calling names like “reactionary” “CIA agent” and down the line..... I ultimately broke with the Dugin camp after I realised that, at least in the west, he is totally uninterested at all in monarchy, Catholicism, anything from the west's past, he only wants to talk to communists, neo-nazis and those ilk.....

Senkosmos on 2013-02-12 at 21:00 said:

I need to agree with all of you: Cologero, David, Logres and Janus. Priests are the backbone (so to speak) for the preserving of tradition, and an instrumental tool to the intellectual elite (if they are not the elite themselves) to put the West back in the right track. Today, most agents of tradition are more concerned with political action than individual/local action, and more important, contemplation, spiritual non-acting action. All attempts to a “back to roots” without a “back to the Absolute source” is futile and ridiculous. Great post!

caseydeann on 2013-02-12 at 23:13 said:

Great comment, David. Thank you.

Logres on 2013-02-18 at 11:07 said:

This is an immensely penetrating article – I can see why Guenon regarded him as a peer. It's interesting that, like Kukai (the Japanese master), he places those of “faith” far above the secularists and agnostics, as pilgrims on the ladder up to heaven who have begun the ascent, which will bear fruit in time, or out of it. Did Giorgio consider himself part of the priest caste?

Cologero on 2013-02-18 at 12:26 said:

I suspect he sees himself this way, as he described:

Reflect on the importance of what we say, and you will be able to understand

how the **solitary Ascetics**, those who we will be able to call “hoi exo” the *outside*, in all the periods of decadence of the priestly caste, have kept alive the perennial fire of tradition against the deceit, the hatred, calumny of those who failed in their mission.

Certainly, he understands the nature of the priestly caste. When we get to the warrior caste, we will see that he describes them in terms very much like Evola. However, Evola was tone deaf to the contemplative caste and never understood it or its true role. That is why he saw the Ascetic and the Warrior on the same level. De Giorgio, on the other hand, will make their real relationship very clear.

Tosti on 2013-02-18 at 14:59 said:

As was intimated in your earlier posting passion is clearly evident. Can this passional orientation lead one astray? You are privy to the full work, as yet unrepresented so we will have to wait and see but a question arises in dealing with a pure faith as mentioned with regard to the solitary ascetics: are we to assume that Evola's concept of Initiation is superior to Guenon's? Will we assume that a solitary ascetic(whose practice may reflect either the exterior or the interior-without the discernment of a traditional caste we can never know) can preserve Tradition without any other reference? How are we to make a determination. And is it possible that there has been a continuity so subtle that those of the second function will have difficulty determining its existence in an extant structure without the help of the first function(who may be already embedded within such an expression)?

Cologero on 2013-02-18 at 15:58 said:

I don't see where he is saying anything of a sentimental nature or advocating the “passions” as somehow superior to intellectuality. On the contrary he writes:

Above all, great detachment is necessary, strict intellectuality, the absolute absence of that pseudo-mysticism so much in style at the present time where spirituality and sentimentality are equivalent, where enthusiasm and faith are placed on the same level, where the darkest and murkiest impulsiveness is believed to be an expression of strength, where the external is not only excessive, but tends to destroy the internal, where agenda kills true development, where finally all that is inferior and illegitimate is affirmed with an immodesty which the world has never known before now, even in the most acute periods of decadence.

The unassailable “reference point” would be the “truths of God” or Traditional teachings; that is the standard to judge by.

Tosti on 2013-02-18 at 16:11 said:

Perhaps it was just the general tone. That may be subjective on my part...my Anglo-saxon temperament.

Janus on 2013-02-18 at 22:44 said:

I can see what de Giorgio is saying when he speaks about the central importance of faith. However, I don't understand how he can say that faith is superior to knowledge. He begins by saying (as I understand it) that faith is good because it allows the one without knowledge as yet to move forward in the path, giving him strength and courage. But surely that means that, when knowledge is attained, then faith has fulfilled its purpose? And this seems to imply that knowledge of that which faith led us to pursue is superior, though no less essential, than faith itself.

It also makes me wonder how many priests or ascetics need to arise before a turning of orders can begin. Surely there are some left in Europe, in the old monasteries or as hermits who fulfill this role. But apparently, these few have not prevented the decline, any more than did the Russian hermits in the early 20th century before Bolshevism. Does that mean there was a decline or betrayal among these priests? Who knows... but apparently this function must be fulfilled in a specific function or grow to a certain size before its affects are more generally recognizable. Perhaps this is the distinction between Ascetic and Priests proper? "Lord, if there is but one righteous man in the city...?"

David on 2013-02-18 at 22:57 said:

@Janus : I cannot answer for De Giorgio, but I don't think we can ever attain perfect knowledge of Reality without being in perfect union with Reality, i.e. God. That is, faith will always be there, because there will always be knowledge. Someone can correct me if I'm wrong.

Cologero on 2013-02-19 at 00:13 said:

Janus, please show me where you think De Giorgio says that faith is superior to knowledge... it means I need to make the translation clearer. Here is a quote I have in mind, which says the opposite of the impression you have:

Faith works this miracle that those who cannot reach by an operational effort and aware of the threshold of the divine, attain it with the rapid and direct contact that can be fecund with greater results: compared to those who know, that are beyond the threshold, they find themselves very far, but compared to those who do not believe, to the small men

of the small world, the affirmers of the minimum in the minimum and lovers of the shadows, they are in a clearly privileged position because they are distant from just as far as the spirit surpasses the flesh and intelligence surpasses imbecility.

Specifically, *compared to those who know, that are beyond the threshold, they find themselves very far* means those who believe are far from those who know, but those who believe are superior to those who neither know nor believe.

As for your other question, let's wait until I get the final part up which addresses some of those issues.

David, perfect knowledge is perfect union as you point out. But I don't understand the other point: where there is knowledge, there is no need for faith.

Janus on 2013-02-19 at 03:25 said:

This is the passage:

"Faith is therefore superior to any human knowledge whatsoever, to any conquering activity of the human alone, because it passes beyond it, considers it as ancillary, negligible, negotiable, even nothing in the face of the divine that it recognizes as the invisible venerable root through its invisibility, real through its apparent unreality, divine exactly because not human, not tangible, not discernible with the senses, and analyzable by reason, placed in a sphere of this the good ones, those who believe, will be able to enjoy, if it will be pleasing to God, only after the dissolution of the human compound, i.e., post mortem."

Perhaps I'm not understanding it correctly. Is he saying here that faith is superior to human knowledge in terms of "merely human" ideas about the Divine (it might be useful here to think of the Orthodox doctrine that all human attempts to describe God, while they may be good enough for Man, are ultimately lacking)? I doubt he means the higher Knowledge of gnosis, as that contradicts the passage you mentioned and your point about union and perfect knowledge. The passage you mentioned says what I would have expected, that gnosis is greater than faith, which itself is greater than ignorance.

Cologero on 2013-02-19 at 08:20 said:

Not specifically human knowledge about the divine (if there can even be such a thing), but in general. Human knowledge is never more than opinion or a likely story. It does not survive death, as De Giorgio points out, whereas faith certainly does.

David on 2013-02-19 at 18:47 said:

My question can be rephrased : how can we attain perfect knowledge if not for perfect being, that is, God, while still here, in the temporal and therefore imperfect realm (on a dualistic

gnostic view, or a monistic one) ? I'm just trying to understand, thank you. To me, union with God can be but partial. Or maybe I'm mistaken ?

Janus on 2013-02-19 at 19:49 said:

Well, it might help to remember that this unity is in many ways a process of realization of a reality which already is. "Thou art That"... the singularity of Atman and Brahman. The true Self is the Atman realizing its manifestation and source of being. Thus, a complete awakening, difficult as this might be, should constitute a unity that is total and conscious, and that seems to be whole instead of partial.

Cologero on 2013-02-20 at 08:11 said:

David, the rephrasing of the question is better since a response can be split. First of all, there is the question of the possibility of "perfect knowledge" or union with God. To that the answer is "yes", since what the Intellect knows is ideas or possibilities. That possibility has been described over and over, as there is no shortage of literature. Here on Gornahoor, we try to summarize that literature and re-express it contemporary terms.

Nevertheless, that does not conclude the story, since what you are interested in is the "actuality" of the union (theosis), i.e., its realization, not merely its possibility. But that is a question for the Will, not solely the Intellect. Apart from the various claims, there is no scientific way to determine someone's "state of realization". We have the testimony of St John Climacos who says in his Ladder of Divine Ascent that theosis is not complete in this life. So perhaps your opinion is aligned with his. Even De Giorgio admits that the steps on the ladder are infinite, so a finite life cannot achieve it.

However, if you are called on that path, that is no excuse to not begin. St Mark the Ascetic in the Philokalia mentions three great enemies:

1. Ignorance
2. Forgetfulness
3. Sloth

Ignorance is the first thing to overcome, and obviously Gornahoor readers probably have subdued, or are subduing, that enemy, if they refer to the text we write about. We have addressed the topic of forgetfulness over and over. Never forget who you are, why you were born, what you need to accomplish, what your real life is. For the several hundred daily readers here, we hope, if nothing else, to be their reminders to stay on track, although there are many other resources. Of course, most humans prefer to drink from Lethe, the river in Hell that causes them to forget.

The third enemy is sloth, and in that regard everyone is on his own. No matter how much you know, you cannot expect George⁵ to do it for you. So you will never really know what is possible unless and until the right efforts are made.

David on 2013-02-20 at 16:58 said:

That answers it. I will look into St John Climacos to see if I can clarify my mind on the matter. Thank you.

Saladin on 2013-02-20 at 20:18 said:

Excellent piece! Loved it! Thanks Cologero! I think De Giorgio is very clear so I don't know why some people are confused. He never says that "Passions are superior to intellectuality" (Per Tosti) and neither does he declare the superiority of Faith over TRUE Knowledge (as claimed by Janus). He says Faith is infinitely (Guenon would object to my choice of word here) superior than any worldly (read Philosophical and Scientific) knowledge but at the same time miles away from True Knowledge (i.e. Gnosis). That's what he says, and it's all clear.

I really loved the passage where he lays the blame for degeneration on the Priestly caste. That's a simple fact and needs to be acknowledged. Just as blaming women for Feminism is completely inaccurate: For it is the duty of the Best to insure everything is according to Order (and where the teaching is different, there the Best is lacking!

Olavsson on 2016-04-05 at 11:24 said:

Yes, the degeneration of the First Caste of contemplatives is at the origin of the regression of the castes. So if one's true nature, function, purpose and providential destiny (completely without regard for a relative and conditioned, illusory self-will based on forgetfulness) can only be perfectly realized by giving oneself heart and soul, with all one's might, to this path, and even still one chooses to ignore the call in order to invest one's energies in false interests and desires, one is failing in one's true task and responsibility and consequently a serious part of the problem. Too many who potentially (hence not actually) belong to the spiritual caste waste away their lives within profane domains at best producing bourgeois triviality, or at the very worst leading to catastrophic and demonic scientific "advances." My advice can only be: Leave that to the fallen ones—they are many and have no need for you. IF you do in truth have the nature of a contemplative, your true path should already be mapped out clearly: The example to follow is the sages of old, not the profane functions honoured, respected and admired most highly by the modern system. How many more of us can we afford losing to such games falling short of the unworldly super-caste's true principles and agenda? The spiritual conquerors of the contemplative life who uphold the bridge between time and Eternity are fewer with each

⁵[http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Let_George_Do_It_\(radio\)](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Let_George_Do_It_(radio))

passing year, whereas the profane classes from high to low have a never-ending supply of new recruits ready to feed the monstrous machine of modernity in whatever way. So it should be obvious enough which task is the most important one for our kind, not only in view of our own spiritual destiny, but in view of the needs of humanity as well.

Indeed, dear De Giorgio is utterly correct regarding Faith. Even a quintessential jnanin-ascetic like Buddha Shakyamuni, founder of a tradition which is as known for its emphasis on Gnosis as any other, many times stressed the great importance of faith, and the superiority of the man possessing unswerving faith as compared to the one who doesn't. Likewise, he listed DOUBT among the most serious obstacles to progress on the Path. In our absurdly degenerate postmodern world, doubt is not seldom glorified almost as if it were a sign of intelligence. But if one lacks the ability to have complete, unfailing and permanent faith as strong as diamond in the truths that are derived from the very Divine Wisdom of the sagely masters, prophets, and avatars, we will never have sufficient determination to go all the way and attain direct and illuminating Knowledge. As far as orthodox essential principles are concerned, starting with sacred metaphysics, there should be no room for doubt if we are serious about our sacred endeavour—such doubt is nothing but a profane weakness hindering absolute resolve on the upward path, and you hardly need complete illumination in order to attain absolute certainty as to the impossibility of every modernist, profane and materialist worldview, upon which the profanely skeptical scientist unbelief-ideology is based, when recognizing its fundamentally flawed principal assumptions. Doubt must be conquered and destroyed long before we can attain complete integral Knowledge. Without perfect faith, we cannot even begin the journey. And without perfect faith in God, in the Supreme, there is only unreality, not even a distant reflection of light.

reader on 2013-02-20 at 13:09 said:

"Those who are called "geniuses" by men of today so tied to the human to see them through the greatest irony, also the superhuman..."

"also the superhuman" = "as the superhuman"?

Cologero on 2013-02-20 at 13:26 said:

I opted for "even the superhuman"... the phrasing is a little awkward. If anyone else wants to give it a shot:

Coloro che sono chiamati "geni" dagli uomini attuali così legati all'umano da scorgervi per suprema ironia, anche il superumano, chiusi come sono nell'ambito umano e terrestre, si trovano di gran lunga inferiori al più umile dei credenti perché essi ipertrofizzano un nulla, l'uomo e il mondo...

4.4 The Constitution of a Traditional Society: Warriors

The Role of the Warrior Caste

This is part I on the role of the Warrior caste in a Traditional Society. Here Guido De Giorgio describes the role of the warrior caste and its relationship to the priestly caste. He then relates that to the Great War and the Lesser War.

In the active life, they are the bearers of power and therefore constitute the second caste of traditional society whose duty is the maintenance of activity guided by virtue. We say power only in the arena of the active life because in the contemplative life, true power is manifested in its highest reality, from the invisible to the visible, from the divine to the human, and thus represents the supreme authority that belongs to the priestly caste. Power in the active life is realized by giving a sacred character to every manifestation; hierarchically organized, the Warriors sacrifice themselves in order to remove the purely contingent aspect from human activity and to make it a kind of need that is accepted by consciously sacrificing themselves for the fulfillment of divine reality. They are the hosts of the earth and choose the most difficult path in it, keeping the sanctity of the intent unbroken in the pang of the most intense activity by virtue of a continual asceticism that is a purification and a preparation for glory. Since the Warriors reach glory that makes them the victors of the time in perpetuity that is immortalized for ages and their name is preserved as the constant example of sacrifice. They choose to be victims to affirm the victory of man over death even where death reigns: voluntary and active victims, arbiters of their destiny, aware of the transience of the flesh and the perpetuity of their example. As everything pivots on the contemplative life for the Priests, so for the Warriors everything is based on the active life because they constitute its summit and its law. In fact, the active cycle

reflects the contemplative, and as the death of the human is the prelude necessary to the fruition of higher states, so the Warrior lives in order to die in the awareness that everything is vanity except victory over death, which is also the seal of glory.

They obey a purely interior discipline that purifies the passions, exalts them, and directs them toward a single end, the affirmation of power in the intensive deployment of a force that acts materially, but has its origin in the world of Rhythms. As the spiritual and the noetic dominate in the Priests, in the Warriors the psychic dominates, the hidden network of Rhythms that heighten human possibilities creating the heroic turmoil which, like a flame, nurtures the great warrior virtues.

No one, more than the Warrior, is averse to Silence, to the world of the Spirit, because he voluntarily chose the active life in its most violent form to set his strength against it, to defeat it with his own violence, exalting his hidden energies and carrying the Rhythms to such a high tonality that it encroaches on the Forms and bends them integrally, surpassing them. We observe that this overflowing of strength cannot be absolutely effective without a true and proper ascesis, a self-denial in every moment for self-assertion only in victories, unless this assertion has the aspect of rhetorical jubilation, but rather it is like the blossoming of now equalized warrior virtues, recognized in the flower of all the activity precisely because surpassed and triumphant. While all other men compromise, they are the intransigents, those who make the obstacle the prize of their strength, for which the cement is the sanctification of man: they know that only death can placate them, so in confronting it, they escape it, and in escaping it, they confront it because it comes only when the peak of power is reached in the peak of abandonment.

In this sense, peace is their war and war is their peace. They are appointed by the Priests who sanction them the sacred character of their activity with the rite, which is uniquely directed to self-sacrifice as an offering of all of the active life on the threshold of contemplation, a sacri-

ficial purge of the existence that is continued even after death, and even after death. While the contemplative death that is faced by the Priests can neither be seen nor understood by the masses of men who, as we said, believe but do not know, they do get a glimpse of, but do not understand, the degrees of integrative knowledge, while the death faced by the Warriors is visible to all; it reflects, in an active place, the former and is carried out, analogically like the former, with a sacrifice whose value for men is as much higher as it is more apparent. But while this sacrifice is fixed plastically for the masses that relive it in its most conspicuous phases, its secret rhythm and intimate character elude them. In the Warrior the active life asserts itself by exalting itself and in the fierce heroic heat, it denies itself: in fact, the force that animates the Warrior is love in its most destructive capacity and devotion in its most constructive form: love and devotion constitute the warrior cycle which is that of triumphant virility. While knowledge dominates for the Priests, for the Warriors, love dominates, because all their strength is a type of offering in a continuous dissatisfaction that is satisfied only with death. While they cannot know the divine world, they love it and tend to it, climbing over human limitations with a constant overcoming of Rhythms over Form, of the psychic over the organic that it sustains, it increases a hundredfold the resistance to the obstacle and the force that surpass it, establishing a formidable aura of secret flashes that the ancients symbolized with the real, but invisible, divine assistance of the heroes.

The Forms, in heroic action, undergo a greater or lesser inflection in accordance with the intensity of the Rhythms that make them jump, by encroaching on them, replacing them, fringing them, so to say, with an imprecision that makes them more indefinable, while the Warrior himself is dragged, aware only of the sanctify of his sacrifice, in an always more overwhelming turmoil that is crowned, while filling up with death. But we can say here that love defeats death as glory defeats time, not in the absolute sense that is realized only through the knowledge and in the

knowledge which dissolves every duality in the integral fulfillment of the divine.

It is necessary now to speak of the great and the small war to make precise the two fields of active contemplation and heroic activity.

The Great War is the development of the being in the surpassing of human conditions that are first confronted and then surpassed, destroyed, transformed, and resolved only in the divine sphere: the enemy to defeat is the man who must be struck centrally in himself: the field of action is his own heart that must be emptied of every dross: victory is that of truth over ignorance, of divine reality over cosmic and human illusion that is dispersed with the realizing knowledge just as the fog breaks up in the sun without residue, and that which disappears had never existed in reality. Victory in the Great War is Divine Solitude, the decisive summit of every ascesis where nothing remains except pure aseity and what in Him is absolute ineffability. The starting point of the Great War is the non-duality of the human and the divine: the destination is divine unity: but since what vanishes is not a reality but only ignorance, once this is dispersed, only what always was remains, that cannot be said of the transient, but only and uniquely of the eternal.

Now this victory, which is the only real and definitive victory of Life over death, which, for simplification, we say call the resolute peak, while in the reality of its development it is manifested as a difficult complexity of states, it requires such a concentrated force, a task so resolute of the whole being who must be transfigured in a succession of progressive realizations, from being able to be produced only in externally favorable conditions, not that these are the necessary principle, but practically they become so. Hence, the isolation of the Temple for the priest, of the remote place for the ascetic, the hermitage and finally an ensemble of conditions that favor and facilitate this which is the highest and the holiest of all rites, the most heroic of all actions, and the most perfect of all tasks, the killing of man in the Law of God, the real abandonment of Rhythms and

Forms dissolving in the allness of Silence. Now evidently whatever type of action is contrary to a similar achievement, and every rhythm must be recomposed, every whirlwind assuaged for the achievement of the Great Peace that is the true Victory of the Great War. The enemies to defeat in fact are so numerous, so terrifying, the dangers to avoid, the states to revive so repetitive and successive, that only the integral cessation of every activity can make victory possible. It is about surpassing the human and the cosmic in all their forms and in all their rhythms, to remake the creative process in the reverse path, to lead to where God formed man with His breath, to be able to initiate the paradisiacal cycle. This is the model barely noticed for the Great War that constitutes the traditional secret, the sacred deposit held in trust by those who know, i.e., the Priests.

One can understand from that how much this caste surpasses all the others and is not, almost the truth, a caste, but a true and proper super-caste, because of its absolute preeminence. Thus its supreme authority, its consecrating, legitimating power, the dependence of the three castes on it, the justification of their existence, because nothing that is accomplished by men has value in reality if it is not sealed by the divine spirit.

Now the Warriors themselves are consecrated by the Priests, nor can they not be, without ceasing to belong to their caste since the war that they fight must represent a reduced version of the Great War in order to be legitimate, it must lose, i.e., the external character and conquer a deep meaning that justifies its attainment. The Warriors therefore submit themselves to an inner discipline, to a true and proper ascesis that will consist in their depassionalization so that by killing, they know how to kill themselves, by defeating, to defeat one themselves self, by considering the enemies as victims, in the sacred sense, and not as flesh from the slaughterhouse, by respecting them as themselves, by passing over the carnage with the love that redeems, over the contaminations with the purity that justifies, over death, and over atrocity of death with the consciousness that nothing can die because nothing can be born, only

the eternal existing in its inaccessible reality.

The Devotion of a Warrior

It seems to me that **Guido De Giorgio** and **Julius Evola** agree on the role of the Warrior caste, with some fundamental disagreements. The first obviously is that Evola fails to understand the relationship of the warrior caste to the priestly class. The second is more difficult to express. Evola is “cold”, i.e., for him, the warrior is cold and detached. We could say that for De Giorgio, the warrior is hot: he loves, he is devoted, he is faithful. For Evola, the warrior fights as it is in his nature. For De Giorgio, too, it is in his nature, but he fights for his family, his land, his Temple, his lord. We can note here how the notion of bhakti yoga has been sentimentalized and the understanding of devotion trivialized. There is something else, more subtle, to consider, but since it is not part of De Giorgio’s purpose, I’ll save it for another time.

The Small War acquires a deep ascetic significance and imposes on the caste, only to which it is reserved, not slight surpassings that have, as we said, love and devotion for its foundation. The Warrior is guided by his love for the Divine Principle that is close to him, almost accessible and even distinct, in which he centers himself when the heroic peak happens and the confluence of Rhythms generates the supreme passion, that of dedication to God of the carnage: then a super-action of the normal human faculties operates, that adapt, raising himself in the highest development of the consuming fire and the Warrior becomes the great sacrificer, the *victimarius*⁶,

and the baptism of blood is a catharsis that renews him, freeing him with his violence from human brutality, redeeming him as in a purifying

⁶<http://referenceworks.brillonline.com/entries/brill-s-new-paully/victimarius-e12204070?s.num=0>

basin Ex 30:18 that cleanses horror with piety at every death. Piety in fact pushes him to sacrifice of himself and of the enemies in each one of which he catches sight of his own effigy; in the clash of a fight, he seeks to beat back the resurgent duality, the terrible “thou”, the shadow of himself, the eye that looks askance at him, the hand and the arm that threaten him, the love in which his own love is mirrored, the “other” who blocks his vision of the Supreme Unity. He kills and gets killed in the name of God, in the name of God he defends his lord and his land since his weapons are blessed and he is invested just as his lord is, and his country is the place fixed by God for the conquest of heaven, the support, the base of his ascension, and he must defend it in order to keep God’s law in the world, as long as the enemy does not deprive him of God by snatching his land, home, temple. His caste is the guardian of sovereign power in which the virtues are combined, that when entirely followed, lead man to the Edenic fruition, restoring his eternal and original country to him, whose necessary starting point is this land. The king and the country are made sacred by the radiant vision of divine Glory since in loving it, the warrior loves God, and in protecting it, he defends God’s possession.

Note that the realization by means of warrior asceticism is always indirect, while the priestly asceticism is direct or final: the former is accomplished through the world of Rhythms, the latter in the Silence, the former remains in duality, the latter reaching unity from non-duality. This difference is essential and eliminates whatever arbitrary reduction that would subvert the traditional order. The warrior caste obeys its own law that is justified only through a higher law which, originating in the divine, extends it. In fact, if the Primordial Tradition is taken as the starting point, the castes are reduced to just one, that of the Priests, nor is it put there for others because in this stage only the contemplative way exists which excludes any action: there is no caste in reality in the Primordial Tradition in which *human unity* is realized in its most absolute expression. The King here is the high priest and one can speak of regality only in

the sense of cognitive absoluteness. But in successive traditional forms, the distribution of human possibilities is necessarily carried out, because we are already in a greater state of decadence and complexity through which life assumes a internal and external double aspect; in this stage, the priestly class assumes an absolute position that puts it back in the Primordial Tradition, that of the Warriors is internal in respect to the purely exterior Workers but, considering the whole tradition in its triple aspect of Silence, Rhythm, and Forms which correspond to the Priests, Warriors, and Workers, the second caste occupies an intermediate position of equilibrium between the two extremes and serves to maintain the traditional unity because its attribute is power.

Representing the traditional boundary circularly like a fortified city, we will say that the center, the Temple, corresponds to the priestly caste, the periphery, i.e., the ramparts, to the Warrior Caste, while the workers remain in the middle. Considering such relationship, the Warrior caste occupies the most dangerous place in the traditional defense, the one most exposed and, if one understands the value of this depiction in relation with what has been said, the Warriors are the lords of Rhythms and the art that is most appropriate to them is Magic.

Whoever is capable of reflection will understand without difficulty how, this caste living in the paroxysm of action, must necessarily be involved in the wave of hidden forces that are unleashed especially when the rhythm of the active life is intense, so that the warrior asceticism has as its principle goal the knowledge of the world of Rhythms, of the laws that govern it, and the defense from the traps of the field of shadows. That appears more clearly to those who consider with attention life and the work of the great conquerors where one easily sees how materially infinitesimal elements have engendered inevitable imbalances. What is true for every man is doubly so for the Warriors who live intensely in order to confront the most terrible enemies, those who are invisibly close to us and of which the visible enemies represent a type of material duplicate.

Speaking of this caste we implicitly asserted the necessity of war, but not less implicitly we asserted the need that it is uniquely entrusted to the true and proper Warriors that they have the legitimate use of it. Now as one does not become a priest, so one does not become a warrior, and the contamination of castes has unfortunately produced the current degradation since, with democratic leveling, introductions of every type have taken place, distorting the traditional order and engendering the fall of a truly civil society. A return to normality worked with discernment, progression, and measure would permit the restoration of the sole and true hierarchy in the attributions of caste conformed to the nature of man, to his possibilities, and to the effective development of his more specifically productive activities.

The warrior is the ascetic of the active life and his discipline is purely interior: whoever cannot kill himself will never be able to kill or, better said, in killing he will profane life and death because his cause is not holy. Now a man kills himself by his own hand or with the sanctified arm in a way that the enemy is visible and close, otherwise a true assassination is accomplished and not an act of purification. If war, as we said, is justified only as the symbol of the Great War, it is inconceivable that the battle be not focused, faithful, open, frontal, because only by knowing oneself can one dominate himself and only in seeing his own enemy can he be surpassed without the battle and the carnage having the bestial character of the battle and anonymous, unholy, and sacrilegious carnage. If one is capable of developing all the aspects of the question when placed in its true light, one understands that war must be made by warriors and not by the entire democratically leveled people and violently carried back in great conflicts to the state of savage desperation: it follows from it that war must be normally conducted man to man and, in its most typical expression, brought back to the preliminary dispute, to the duel.

We said that the Warrior caste is founded on a dualistic base that the Latin term *duellum*, the ancient form of *bellum*, expresses with per-

fect obviousness: war is the expression of this fundamental duality of which love and hate—the latter reducible, if you reflect on it well, to love—represent two extremes: in the event a traditional restoration is produced, which is difficult but not impossible, and which, in every way, only modern devirilization can gravely obstruct with its two most typical expressions, pessimism and skepticism, war should be led back to its fixed normalizing function, i.e., to exist permanently for the single caste of the Warriors. The duel that so called civil society of the West, barbarous in reality, repudiated with satanic thoughtlessness while they turn current conflicts into a hellish game of machines that work the foolish and most ungodly destruction, would be the essential condition of the return to normality in case it was led back to its natural, spontaneous, i.e., effective, form and not to that modern parody that stands to the duel as the courtier stands to the knight.

If normal arms were only in the hands of the Warriors, the duel would take back its traditional value and would constitute the customary standard training of the caste, developing the sense of honor that has now faded in the heart of men. The duel with cold weapons⁷ *arma bianca* is the most noble, the purest, the highest expression of the warrior caste because it establishes a reciprocity of force, honor, and love in two men confronting each other, who are saved by killing each other and sanctify themselves by being killed. One observes that duality remains before and after: before life against life, after life in the face of death. And this duality is precisely the permanent indication of the warrior caste and is the basis of its purpose. War in a traditional society is the amplification of the duel, but other factors intervene: family, country, lord. It should have led back to normality, limited to the only caste that can do it without involving entire peoples, working that chaos that compromises the very existence of a civilization. Brought back to clarity, to the brutality of the ancient wars, although circumscribed and delimited, it should be, if not

⁷http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cold_weapon

permanent at least frequent, giving in that way the acceleration necessary to the rhythm of life that makes it deeper and more fertile for revelation.

Modern wars—and for us, this “modernity” lasts for centuries—are the products of the democratic degeneration that has leveled humanity substituting for the Warrior caste a fictitious hierarchy in times of peace, even chaotic in times of conflict when every citizen must become what he never was, i.e., a soldier. The soldier obeys external discipline while the warrior obeys the inner: the warrior is always a warrior, the soldier can occasionally become a warrior through force, not by choice or by natural inclination. But there is a more important consideration. The Warrior is the refusal of sentimentality and among the ancients it did not exist: only modern degeneration has created through the monstrosity of democratic conflicts the romanticism of war, because in these conflicts in which all the people participate, there are only mediocre warriors, while the mass is constituted by a type of human gelatin that trembles with pathetic oscillations at every twisting that violates his nature. Instead, war reduced to lesser proportions, but with a more intense and more frequent rhythm, because it is entrusted only to men and not to machines, to Warriors and not to other castes, would be an indispensable element of a full and fecund life if led back to the traditional type, i.e., sanctified by the rectitude of causes that would give rise to it. Its delimitation would constitute a permanent and normal base of the activity to paralyze by no means all the people, but to intensify the rhythm of the active life with a continual contribution of strong and decisive reflexes.

Conclusion

This is the final segment on the role of the Warrior caste in a Traditional Society. Here we see that the point of war is to establish peace. The respective spheres of influence of the priests and warriors are made clear, although caste conflicts can still break out for the reasons specified. **Guido De Giorgio** then relates the roles of

the castes to contemporary events circa 1940 : when priests are no longer the bearers of the holy science, there is a state of perpetual war and democratic leveling, then spiritual ruin results, as man is left to his own devices.

The return to normality restores the people's strength established of the Warrior caste which abides by love and whose sacrifice, different from that of the Priests, comprises an ascent of psychic energies oriented in the direction of heroic glorification. As action is subordinated to contemplation, so the warrior is subordinated to the priest, without however this subordination equalizing or confusing the two domains that are autonomous and separated and which constitute the spiritual authority and temporal power. These two jurisdictions are as cleanly separated and distinct as eternity is from time, therefore the two domains are unmistakable through the impossibility of reducing the first to the second or of extending the second to make it correspond to the first, since the eternal cannot be contained in the transient, nor can the transient cease to be such and to coincide with the eternal. This only consideration suffices to show that the temporal regiment is independent of the spiritual without however opposing it in any way, but rather in parallel turning to itself up to what is the maintenance of traditional unity that contains the both together and harmonizes them.

If in the primitive phase of perfection, with life being only contemplative, we can acknowledge a true unity of development oriented toward purely spiritual ends, this is not possible in the subsequent traditional forms where action appears immediately next to contemplation, temporal activity next to the spiritual, from which arises the separation of the two domains.

But this separation is necessary for the purity of the ends to which activity and contemplation tend: a fusion or an overpowering in part by one of these jurisdictions would constitute a true anomaly because it would confuse the divine with the human, the spiritual with the tempo-

ral, the sacred with the profane without reaching any profitable result. When we spoke of subordination we meant it only hierarchically, i.e., from the unique, traditional point of view that embraces and contains the contemplative life and the active life: in this sense one cannot escape anyone that the temporal is subordinated to the spiritual as and in the same measure that the human is subordinated to the divine from which it derives, and the existence and the justification of existence.

The Priest consecrates the Warrior and arranges that his action returns to the traditional sphere, but in his sphere the Warrior is autonomous and he neither can nor must collide with the Priest since his activity does not oppose the spiritual activity carried out in the bosom of the first caste. In a traditional society every dispute between the temporal and the spiritual is resolved in the unity the encompasses them; if, in fact, there is conflict, this must uniquely be ascribed to the temporary deviation of one or two domains due to essentially individual, and therefore unimportant, factors.

As long as the Priest remains priest and the Warrior, warrior, no conflict is possible because each one of them will understand he belongs to a sphere whose activity is clearly separated and distinct: this knowledge, this awareness, must guarantee the harmony between the temporal and the spiritual. But whenever, through complex circumstances that are not always easily discernible, a serious conflict between the two powers may happen, it is necessary to come back to the principles that safeguard traditional unity and then they will be resolved hierarchically in the seat of pure spirituality to rectify the deviations and annul the deflections that can be produced by one side or the other, with leading the two castes and therefore the two powers each back to its own domain.

The elimination of the purely individual factors will produce the placation of the dispute, because unfortunately these will take place only through the surpassing of certain personalities who respectively break the law and the norm which regulate activity and establish the limits of

the two castes. The relationship between the two powers is very delicate and the development of Europe shows how often the disputes between the spiritual and the temporal have assumed immense proportions up to the point of becoming outright hostility. There is a reason for all that: the imperfect realization of the traditional unity, that must be ascribed to the defection of the priestly class which can always make its authority matter, with well understood spiritual means, provided they don't distance themselves from sacred knowledge and in this, it only demands the defense of the highest values of the spirit. The temporal cannot undermine and diminish the eternal, and therefore the temporal power, in any way whatsoever and by whatever means, will not be able to harm the spiritual authority which will always know how, when it wishes, to withdraw from the world and allow it to deteriorate because it is deprived of divine help. Reflect very attentively on that in order to understand what is happening in Europe and in the world.

Nevertheless the bearers of sacred knowledge must at all cost maintain contact with traditional principles and undergo whatever duress, submit to any violation, in order to continue to save men by getting them back in touch with the eternal. The spiritual authority asserts itself with quite other means than those with which the temporal power asserts itself and we think that, in case of conflict, through oppressive or destructive that is the deviation and the overpowering of the temporal power, the spiritual authority will always have the upper hand, if it obstinately remains in its domain and does not descend into open battle with the temporal on the terrain of activity properly assigned that is not absolutely of its sphere.

We think instead that as much as it will stay in its domain, so much more effective will its own work be because therefore, as was said with the greatest absoluteness, it assumes its authority from God and not from the world, and its strength, nourishing itself fervently on the divine, will not be able to triumph over hidden dangers, incomprehensions, suppres-

sions, and apparent collapse. Because if in addition the deviation of the temporal power assumes such proportions by becoming absolutely anti-traditional and sacrilegious and the Warriors, forgetting themselves, insulting the principle of love, which is the foundation of their existence, were exceeding their deplorable actions, compressive of every traditional spirituality, know that nothing can touch, profane, and be admitted to God's Truth that is not God himself and that also the ruin of the world would leave perpetually together the Silence or where the divine mystery unfolds.

But we are convinced that the dispute between the two powers is almost always due to a remote deviation in the very heart of traditional unity and above all in the priestly caste whose members have often forgotten what is their only and great strength: sanctity. Whenever the spiritual authority, without any concession to the profane, takes up its true function, the maintenance of God's truth in the world for its salvation, and the Priests, who are its bearers, may not fail in their task which is contemplation and not action, effective realizing knowledge and not pure external, literal science of holy things, the traditional unity would harmoniously include the two distinct powers, but in parallel tending toward a single end, the return of man to God, through time, into eternity.

The temporal power in fact, of which the Warriors are the bearers, offers as terms the realization of the divine through time, in a concert of all the faculties tuned by their own equilibrium. Until now, in regard to this caste, we have spoken of war, but it is now necessary to consider the positive aspect of war, i.e., peace. War is an imbalance that produces a balance which in its turn is broken through the intermittent character of human affairs: but if one considers that in analogy with the spirit whose domain is eternity, war appears as a renewal, a purification, radical emendation, followed by the achievement of a state of absolute and permanent pacification that represents the fruition of beatitude.

As much as equilibrium is superior to disequilibrium, so peace is su-

perior to war of which it is the crowning achievement. No consideration of aesthetic order may contaminate the vision of the truth in the seat of pure spirituality. The Warrior yearns for peace since his war is holy only if it leads to a permanent and definitive peace. War represents the germinative suffering, and peace, the flower and the coronal fruit. If intermittence is a type of destiny of human and temporal affairs, it must never be considered as a cyclic law on the part of the Warriors and the Leader, meaning to say by that, that each war must be completed for the end of the disequilibrium and the realization of peace. That intermittence exists, but it does not make law, this is the foundation of the right and healthy development of temporal power. If, as we said, war is in analogy with the Great War that represents the permanent conquest of the divine, it must tend to peace and this must be the true and holy goal of the Warriors: only a soft and superficial esthetic, ignorant of the profound truths of certain analogies and the symbolic relationship between the temporal and the eternal can consider war as the end in itself, a spastic state, fascinating for its own anomaly; only when true peace is not realized, can the nostalgia of war be felt, this very dubious sentiment of order because it belongs to the purely sentimental sphere.

In order to prevent this anomaly, it would be necessary to avoid, above all else, the wars that are not decisive, considering them as imperfect actions, true and proper permanent crises that contribute to the crumbling of traditional societies.

What has happened and is happening in Europe must be considered under this light and then one will understand the gravity of the current situation in which, through the confusion of castes, through consenting to an absolutely bestial democratic leveling, the detachment of the human from the divine takes place and therefore the very end of man is prepared. When we speak of the end, we mean the true and proper end that is certainly not that of the flesh, as every person gifted with the most elementary good sense can comprehend, but the spiritual ruin, the col-

lapse of those bridge that connect the world to the Superworld, of which follows the instantaneous formation of the hidden ways that connect the earth to the darkness of the Underworld. If humanity does not want to become an immense and sterile hell, it is necessary that it brings back the great traditional ways by which only will new bases be found for new developments.

The Warriors must participate with the Priests for the restoration of order because these two castes are the bases of traditional unity: from their concordant action everything can be made smooth, the one being the bearers of sacred knowledge, i.e., of wisdom, the other the judges of power; the one, if you will, the club bearers, the others the fasces bearers. The harmony of the spiritual and the temporal can rebalance the world against all pessimisms and skepticism so acute and stupidly brayers of the current times; in no mode will be realized a permanent arrangement of the world without the cooperation of the spiritual authority and the temporal power because the return to normality must be effectuated from above to below, from the higher to the lower, and not the other way around.

For centuries the masses flounder in bestial tumults and will still flounder as long as the Priests and the Warriors permit it: that if these two castes feel the enormous weight of their responsibility and have the awareness of their respective domains and their true obligations, no one could prevent the restoration of traditional unity, the new equilibrium that would reopen the great passageway to eternity for the glory of God in heaven and the peace of men on earth.

Posted on 2013-03-04 by Cologero

* * *

Saladin on 2013-03-04 at 22:19 said:

Wow! That was intense! Cologero, you mentioned in your earlier post that comments have declined by 50% since you started posting translations of de Giorgio. If everyone is like me, it

may be due to being awestruck after reading materials like this. Thank you for making these translations available!

Logres on 2013-03-05 at 12:45 said:

Seconded – I believe there is not much to add, and the meditation may take a lifetime. The Trinity is partially ordered after caste, with the Father as the archetype, or Person without which Godhood does not exist, the Son as the executor or warrior (this is more clear in Revelation), and the Spirit as the silent partner who upholds everything. A case could be made for switching Spirit and Son, depending on how you view it. If God has caste-like orderings, what hope do mortals have to escape from it?

This was a beautiful translation.

Pickman on 2013-03-05 at 18:07 said:

Ever since reading that brief introduction to De Giorgio in Evolas' "Road of Cinnabar" (under "My Explorations of Origin and Tradition") I have hungered for De Giorgio translations of "outraged and aggressive letters, strewn with brilliant insights". My praise extends to Cologero for his selfless task in making these works a possibility.

I get that sense of magic once more when reading this mans work, whose absolutist spirit is most congenial to my own character.

David on 2013-03-05 at 18:42 said:

Di Giorgio is a genius, and those translation are a gift from the Holy Spirit. Thank you.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-06 at 01:04 said:

Personally, I find little reason to comment on De Giorgio's writings because they are so full of wisdom I have nothing more to add than to just nod my head and learn from him.

Max on 2016-04-01 at 07:14 said:

Gandalf in a powerful scene that was not included in the final movie adaption of "The Return of the King":

"A thousand years this city has stood. Now at the whim of a madman it will fall. And the White Tree, the tree of the king, will never bloom again."

"Why are they still guarding it?"

"They guard it because they have hope. A faint and fading hope that one day it will flower. That a king will come and this city will be as it once was before it fell into decay. The old wisdom borne out of the West was forsaken. Kings made tombs more splendid than the houses of the living and counted the old names of their descent dearer than the names of their sons. Childless lords sat in aged halls musing on heraldry or in high, cold towers asking questions of the stars.

And so the people of Gondor fell into ruin. The line of kings failed. The White Tree withered. The rule of Gondor was given over to lesser men.”

In Tolkien’s world the race of Men represents the warrior caste, and the Elves the priestly caste. As the end of the world approaches, many men become corrupted by their own mortality which would have otherwise been a source of great heroism and glory, and the Elves do not wish to take action but prefers to withdraw and isolate themselves contemplating what is eternal as if no external events concerns them. The Elves come to believe that the worlds destiny is inevitable and that resisting it is pointless, however man at the brink of destruction, by remembering the meaning of death as a gift of men, sees that there is nothing to loose and everything to win, with the fate of men’s souls unknown even to the wisest. There are no shortages of battles, and even the “living dead” – believing in nothing – out of the despair of what they have become, are bound to answer the call of the Emperor where he to return. A role of the still remaining Elves includes awakening the King to his quest and to help provide the sign and means by which to conquer, reforging the broken sword that they have safe kept throughout the ages.

Aryayana on 2016-04-07 at 15:19 said:

I think there are some good scenes dealing with the relationship between the First (spiritual elite) and Second (warrior nobility) castes in the Japanese movie ‘Zen’ about Master Dogen. See, for example, the part starting from 1:28:24 and lasting until Dogen returns to his temple.

<https://youtu.be/8s5Uz8XSc-Y>

Notice how the Zen master’s non-acting spiritual power prevails over the Shogun. The warrior-leader had the power even to kill the master if he so desired, but in the end it is the latter who wields the purest authority and who, indeed, is the true master of the former in terms of the essential hierarchy, and who may save him when he goes astray.

J on 2018-05-11 at 20:09 said:

What would a Warrior in today’s world do, given that there’s (seemingly) no legitimate path for them to fulfill their destiny, and they can’t just withdraw from the world like a Priest? Asking for a friend.

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-07 at 11:12 said:

“ The brutality, although circumscribed and delimited, of the ancient wars, it should be, if not permanent at least frequent...”

Guido De Giorgio seems to be gunning for Evola’s role as “greatest comic book supervillain of all time”. Too bad he looks more like Richard Feynman in the few photos available of him online.

Cologero on 2013-03-07 at 13:03 said:

Yes, and it may discourage some warriors if they think they could be called out on a duel at any moment. Do you think his justification is incorrect? ("giving that acceleration necessary to the rhythm of life that makes it deeper and more fertile for revelation") In other words, to live without the thought or awareness of death: does that also hide the rhythm of life and diminish the possibility of revelation? He is getting at something ... he may be right or wrong.

Does it relate to this: *Noble Savages*⁸.

graham on 2013-03-08 at 14:45 said:

As a woodworking apprentice nowadays, I'm looking forward to the part on workers and forms, it may be helpful in the task of discernment.

Logres on 2013-03-08 at 21:58 said:

There is an interesting tale, here, about "Deadwood Lighter", a Cherokee medicine man who used dream magic to win against a deadly raid from a neighboring tribe. Would this be an instance of magic employed by a warrior culture (even though these tribes had "degenerated")? http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Townsend,_Tennessee

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-08 at 23:58 said:

Of course, the crux of his argument is that modern, conscripted life gives a different meaning to war than traditional gentleman's duel, and it's hard to argue. But to use the concept of *war* itself instead of valor and a readiness to duel more generally, and then putting it in the imperative form, can't help but arouse amusement.

Cologero on 2013-03-09 at 01:23 said:

The final segment will make things clearer, I presume. De Giorgio is not promoting war for its own sake, unlike others.

Caleb Cooper on 2013-03-09 at 11:25 said:

I tend to favor an expansive use of the term magic (I perturbed my RCIA deacon by insisting that the Mass was a magic ritual and the Eucharist Blood Magic), but this sounds more like the guardian Archangel of the community initiating communication with it's representative before heaven. Magic to me seems to imply some intent or desire in the operant setting subtle forces in motion.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-10 at 21:00 said:

⁸<http://www.nytimes.com/2013/02/19/science/napoleon-chagnons-war-stories-in-the-amazon-and-at-home.html>

I am interested to know how de Giorgio would have explained the conflicts between the Popes and the Emperors in the Middle Ages... ..

also, if the spiritual and temporal realms are autonomous of each other, does that mean the two swords (spiritual and temporal power) that Boniface VIII claimed the church had is a wrong idea ?

Cologero on 2013-03-10 at 21:58 said:

Didn't De Giorgio explain the conflicts in this segment? He certainly alluded to them. The causes may be the weakness of the Priests who no longer are the bearers of sacred knowledge, or occasionally individualistic or egoistic factors.

De Giorgio is not refuting Boniface VIII. He emphasizes that the Warriors are subordinated to and consecrated by the priests; that is how they derive their power. The doctrine of the two swords does not mean that the priests are actively engaged in temporal affairs, just the opposite. In *Unam Sanctam*, Boniface VIII wrote:

Both, therefore, are in the power of the Church, that is to say, the spiritual and the material sword, but the former is to be administered for the Church but the latter by the Church; the former in the hands of the priest; the **latter by the hands of kings and soldiers, but at the will and sufferance of the priest**. ... one sword ought to be subordinated to the other and temporal authority, subjected to spiritual power

So the temporal power is indirect, not directly controlled by the spiritual authority. But bring this up in the chapter on the Capo.

The question is does Vatican II reject *Unam Sanctam*, which it certainly seems to have done.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-10 at 23:00 said:

Ah, you've cleared some things up – so far De Giorgio's thoughts are in quite exact agreement with the teachings of the Church. I eagerly await the chapter on the Capo as I think it's the most important one in the book.

I am currently trying to understand the decline of Christendom – we all know the events of history – but I am more interested in the whys... .. so essentially the decline began in the Church, I suppose de Giorgio means, which is why Boniface was not able to control Phillippe ? but what caused the qulaity of the priests to descend from their former level ?

Cologero on 2013-03-10 at 23:32 said:

De Giorgio gives his interesting take on it in one very telling paragraph (beginning with "The elimination of the purely individual factors ... "). Certain personalities (e.g. Phillipe) will bring in individual factors. He ends with a cryptic claim, if anyone has any thoughts on it.

To wit, the priestly class may choose to defect, since the priests should always be able to control the temporal power through spiritual means. Obviously, actions in time cannot affect the spiritual ("gates of hell"), which can also be found in Guenon. That is why the latter objects to Evola's raising of action to the same level as contemplation. So the priests may "withdraw from the world and allow it to deteriorate". De Giorgio concludes with this:

"Reflect very attentively on that in order to understand what is happening in Europe and in the world."

How do you deal with that, Jason-Adam? Is the Church self-destructing as the secular media believes, or is there a deliberate withdrawal? Didn't Benedict XVI says there will be a contraction in the church? And De Giorgio mentioned the "apparent collapse"; is that true or is the collapse real? And who are those "solitary ascetics"?

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-11 at 00:06 said:

If I understand him correctly, De Giorgio is saying that the spiritual centre has not degenerated but is voluntarily withdrawn from the world allowing the tides of history to take their courses ?

The solitary ascetics are the priests... .. whose true nature is hidden... ..

Cologero on 2013-03-11 at 00:59 said:

That is the way I read him. Of course, many structures have indeed degenerated, but no material action can destroy the spiritual center. It may be forgotten by many, but it can never be lost. Some day I'll have to tell the story of the book's publication. The manuscript was found several years after his death. The original editor had to use a pseudonym, although the book seems pretty tame today.

Synodius on 2013-03-11 at 06:45 said:

Interesting, I just finished reading Rama Coomaraswamy's *Destruction of the Christian Tradition* where he mentions a quote of Paul VI about 'auto-demotition' and the whole book favors the version of destruction. Also it seems they are not only dismantling the Church but actively pushing for NWO. Doesn't look 'apparent' to me, but what do I know? Can you please provide some context to what Benedict said about contraction?

Saladin on 2013-03-13 at 22:39 said:

The Spiritual Center(s) never degenerate. It is only castes (and before all others the Priestly caste) that degenerate. There is little doubt that the priestly caste in Christendom has declined

to the point of non-existence. Therefore it is only the solitary ascetics who carry the flame and enlighten humanity (albeit in a subliminal manner) in this darkest of ages.

And, no! The solitary ascetics are not priests, although priests can be solitary ascetics. Guenon, De Giorgio, ... are fine examples of solitary ascetics but there are many more whom we have never heard of!

scardanelli on 2013-03-14 at 13:42 said:

This seems also to relate to the post on Evola and the initiatic centers of Tibet falling to the communists. The church retracts materially in the face of the modern world just as the Tibetan Lamas would not act to safeguard sacred centers against communist invasion. Yet perhaps what seems like a loss only appears so from the perspective of action, for "the spiritual authority asserts itself with quite other means than those with which the temporal power asserts itself."

Perhaps this retraction is what leaves so many dumbfounded and bemoaning the lack of a spiritual path in the west. They are looking without, rather than within. As De Giorgio states, the bridges to the superhuman may be crumbling, but the way remains open for those with the eyes to see.

So what looks like a retreat is actually a safeguarding, an attempt to "maintain contact with traditional principles and undergo whatever duress, submit to any violation, in order to continue to save men by getting them back in touch with the eternal."

If I am not misunderstanding Tomberg in this regard, would this be a retraction of the church of St. Peter in order to safeguard the church of St. John?

Max on 2015-02-16 at 15:35 said:

De Giorgio states that what provides meaning and legitimacy to war is peace. If the situation is such as that can not be achieved the only viable option is withdrawal to prepare and await the conditions that allow victory since we can not aim for anything other than the Greatest Peace. The Romans never fought any battles if the signs were not auspicious -corresponding to the will of the gods. Continuing the thought of "the roman": when is the tiger tired? The Augurs silently gazed into the heavens.

When anti-reality fought reality it became increasingly unreal while reality stayed the same. The separation widened until un-reality could no longer recognize what is real or not, starting to fight its own shadow. For unreality every sky became cloudy, but Reality will make itself known like a lightning from the eternal clear sky.

4.5 The Establishment of a Traditional Society: Workers

Metaphysics of Castes. Workers

This is the chapter on the workers from *La Tradizione Romana* [The Roman Tradition] by **Guido De Giorgio**. In this part, De Giorgio reviews the metaphysical foundations of the notion of castes and prepares the groundwork for the discussion of the specific functions of the workers. In his understanding of the degeneration of castes, De Giorgio says here what Nietzsche should have said, had he had the proper background. What De Giorgio describes as the “principle of freedom” is an essential point to understand.

They constitute the third and final caste that corresponds to the domain of Forms in the sphere of the active life. They should really form the penultimate caste, the last begin the Servile workers, but from the median and reconciliatory point of view in regards to a true and proper return to the spirit and traditional form most easily realizable in the current conditions of humanity, we adopted the threefold formula while knowing that in a more perfect traditional society the number of castes must be raised to four in analogous correspondence with the full realization that, as we pointed out, beyond Silence, it includes a state, the supreme, absolutely undefinable, state designated, in the most complete tradition, with the name of “Fourth” and that is the domain of Absolute Ineffability.

This state comprises and resolves the threefold formula—Silence, Rhythms, Forms—in an integrative indistinction that distinguishes it precisely from them as the mystery of the irreducible unity in its ineffable essentiality. In it the divine cycle is completed totally and integrally. From here the analogous necessity of a fourth caste that would include the Servile workers whose activity assumes the most austere, most elementary, most terminal form.

The constitution of castes must be understood in this way, according to the great law of analogy, i.e., in relation with the divine cycle and not from a purely human and partitive point of view that would have no reason to exist through its fragility and inadequateness to the truth. It is not despotism that creates the castes and especially the servile caste, but rather a necessity of development inherent to the mirroring in the human world of a divine complex that is the one and only reality. The current state of humanity, the apparent abolition of castes, corresponds to the erroneous and confused vision that men make themselves of the divine world: the Divine Principle is currently for men everything they want it to be, i.e., an indecisive and vaguely imminent fog, as men, having abolished caste distinctions, are likewise everything that they want.

The vision of a divine chaotic level corresponds to the leveling human chaos where all pseudo-mysticisms, philosophies, and nontraditional currents flow together, constituting the impure bundle of solidified forms.

But the abolition of castes is unrealizable and they exist even if not explicitly admitted and recognized: their hidden, invisible existence, over which democratism has stratified a leveling haze, creates an incongruence that should strike every person equipped only with good sense. Everyone knows that men are not currently in their place and that the division of the active life is arbitrary and unjustified, because everyone is pushed, constrained by circumstances, by his own impulse and not by a conscious force of order, of the state, and of duty. Everyone knows that there are servile workers who dominate and masters who serve, and that even in the two first castes there are atrocious anomalies and that in the third caste these are furthermore still more remarkable: that is due to the absence of the traditional spirit, to democratic leveling which believes it can enslave those who cannot be enslaved, the determinative characteristic of the inalienable and indivertible human person.

This lasts for centuries and the current confusion is only the result of a slow and progressive degeneration due to the purely apparent superior-

ity of man over the divine, of servitude over freedom, of confusion over order, and disorder over true hierarchy. What determined this fall must be ascribed to the incomprehension of that which constitutes the nature and the form of freedom, confuses with the arbitrary, and forces on everything the humanizations of reality that is actually of an absolutely divine order. Now the constitution of castes is based on the true concept of liberty considered in its four essential forms: absolute liberty in the Priests, conditioned liberty in the Warriors, conditionality in the Workers, servitude in the Servile workers. The two extremes are represented by the first and last caste in as much that what is affirmed in the first is denied in the last and vice versa: they constitute the alpha and omega between which the distinctive qualification exist. Reuniting the two extremes in the unification of the absolute principle that is God, one reaches the integral equalization that cannot be realized unless in the divine place, which is definitely affirmed by all traditions. One will easily understand that by reflecting on the true purpose of castes, to arrange the imbalances in a hierarchy where every element is contained in its own sphere in a way to constitute a homogeneous whole in which nothing introduced disturbs the traditional linearity. Seen from above, the constitution of castes is not presented as a scale that goes from the higher to the lower, by as a system of concentric circles around an absolute point that is the traditional unity.

All the castes are therefore to be considered on the same level and is unfortunately the incomprehension of this elementary truth that has produced the democratic illusion and error. Instead of putting themselves at the higher point of view that is the divine order, men have descended into the human level that has no value when it is cut off from the divine and thus the revolt has happened in the sense of the same caste which, going beyond its limits, has flooded like a river that runs over the banks and violently levels what it floods. Then, after having cut off the human from the divine, with a logic of free will whose unconsciousness is truly

stupefying, the divine plane is confused with the human and what is equal in the eyes of God, they want to transform to equality in the eyes of man, not knowing that equalization is possible only through a being who is beyond the plane considered and, as such, through His own summit, glimpses a unique level while this level does not exist below. They even go back to the sacred texts in order to justify this error of perspective, interpreting it in the most absurd way, overturning every traditional order, abandoning the true God to create a god in man's own image and likeness. It is seen in the abolition of true order, that distinctive, determinative and determined order of castes, the affirmation of the principle of liberty, not knowing that this in the absolute sense exists only in God, while in man it is conformity to the law of God. According to which every element of creation must remain absolutely in its place in order to be the normal element of nature. But since this democratic leveling was unnatural and restrictive, the castes were transformed into classes and the activity generally understood as a complementary way in the unity of tradition and contemplation, was transformed into work, i.e., into pain, coercion, since such is the meaning of the Latin word.

That explains the class warfare that is the degenerate form of disputes between the castes, which, as we said, is always limited to the first two for reasons of quite another order than those who fuel the claims of the current lower classes. Now "work", properly called, can be applied only to the caste of Workers if this is considered as the last for the reason already mentioned, and not to the Warriors and Priests whose activity is absolutely of a totally different order. The latter are tutelary of the divine constitution, the former protectors of the human constitution, and neither of the two castes therefore leads by its activity to the satisfaction of its own needs: therefore in a truly traditional society, it is necessary that the last caste provides the maintenance of the first two, neither the Priest nor the Warrior, being able to work, and that in an absolute way, since work would impede the fulfillment of their very difficult task, the

maintenance of the traditional order.

Referring to the circular symbolism which we just mentioned, if this represents the traditional world as a circle whose center is constituted by the Priests and the circumference by the Warriors, the very close relationship of these two castes in a perfectly organized society will appear: the Warriors represent the centripetal convergence that binds all the points determining them in the univocal axis. They, with their power, defend the traditional purity, which cannot be accomplished materially by the Priests who are contemplatives and who must be protected in the external order by the Warriors. In the convergence resulting from the harmony between these two powers, the two greatest energies of the traditional world, true, integrally solid, power is achieved, the forest of swords that protect God's enclosure. We recommend to everyone to achieve in its fullness the results that would be obtained from the harmony and the cooperation between the spiritual authority and temporal power through the true destinies of humanity brought back into the great traditional riverbed.

Divine Nature of work and art The Worker⁹ caste includes every assignment operative in the individuals who do not belong to the two preceding castes which constitute the base of traditional society: authority and power. When we speak of activity, for this last caste, we mean every type of labor both of the strictly material order like the crafts and of those seemingly more elevated like the professions, since both are remunerated individually. In the two higher castes, we do not speak of truly individual activity since their members work constitutively for the maintenance of the two higher powers, while here, in the last caste, it is a question of an active personal determination whose fruit, however, remains limited to the individual order, while contributing to the general order. We are in the domain of Forms, the last determination of visible

⁹I have translated the root *lavor-* as labor and *oper-* as work to be consistent.

reality whose essential characteristic is individualization. In this caste, as in the two higher castes, persons can be included who in reality should not belong to it, which is the indication of the current disorder due precisely to the lack of traditional unity whose most obvious characteristic is the arbitrary distribution of wealth. But in a truly traditional society in which the castes are rigorously established, remunerated labor should be limited to the majority, i.e., to those who neither know how to nor can do otherwise, incapable of the pure contemplation of the Priests and the pure activity of the Warriors.

It is therefore necessary to insist on the analogy between the various castes and the three degrees of reality, i.e., Silence, Rhythms, and Forms, in order to understand their true purpose. If the Forms constitute the most exterior part, that does not mean that their determination does not reflect, in a thousand aspects, the invariable unity that is the one true reality. Every form is a symbol and every symbol is the vehicle of a profound truth whose importance must never be forgotten. So-called objects, things, are likewise mirrors that variously reflect the unity of the creative rhythm in multiple aspects. Man, in ordinary life, makes use of tools that he himself constructs but whose symbolic meaning is currently unknown, while in a traditional society this meaning is precisely what is more important because it provides all the value to the thing without which it would be deprived of universal purpose. Hence, the necessity that the tool be patiently constructed and not serially, with an individual labor that itself is the symbol of the effort through which it is elevated to a higher reality of an absolutely spiritual order.

It will be easy for everyone to distinguish the value of an object, the fruit of patient and assiduous work, quite different from that accomplished by a brutal, external, artificial, and sterile process like an assembly line. Hence, the artistic beauty of the most humble tools of an era and the banality of what is produced in modern times by the machine. Previously, there was art, the profound meaning of symbolic correspondence, and

the indicator of this was exactly the care, the commitment with which every object was constructed by the strictly personal work of the craftsman with a diligent technique, in strict analogy with the spiritual renewal wrought in the contemplative and ascetic domain. Every craft then symbolically represented the fixation, in Forms, of a process of an absolutely spiritual order related to a higher reality of which the material world is an appearance, in the strictly etymological sense: man, the creator, makes use precisely of so-called matter—not neglecting the etymology of this word—that is the last, final concretion of reality, in order to redeem it from its apparent blindness and lead it to the transparency of an analogical correspondence with a higher world. So that while in the already made Forms among which man lives, that are the patterns of the Rhythms, are likewise found mirrors of the higher reality, the objects, the things, the tools that man constructs are new forms and represent the work that he must undertake laboriously in order to liberate himself from his humanity and restore in himself the divine state. *Ars et labor*: art is the knowledge of the analogical relationships that govern Forms, by means of Rhythms, and achieve them, i.e., make them porous, transparent, to the breath of God who expresses them, while labor is exactly this effort of enucleation of the deep, hidden, veiled reality, protected in matter from which it must shine through to reveal itself to man. There is thus a contact between the interior—man—and the exterior—nature—which is resolved in a single reality of realized and experienced expression, therefore abolished in its crude materiality and restored to its true origin and purpose.

Thus understood in its profound meaning that justifies it and makes it necessary, art is a redeeming purification that reestablishes the creative rhythm obfuscated and neglected by the preoccupations of ordinary life. This life, in an absolute way, is a death, not a life, i.e., the avulsion of the world and man from the true reality of the world and of man realizable only if hidden in divine reality whose origin it symbolically expresses.

Tools, the most common objects of use, were not created for the satisfaction of our needs, but only to express the analogical relations between appearance and reality, between what appears and what is, between the world and God: their practical efficiency is of the second order and is of value only for true serfs, i.e., for those whose intellectual myopia is so widespread that it results in the exclusion of every truth beyond the environment of their terrestrial life. If, in a state of primitive perfection, it is necessary to think of the exclusion of every order in order to reach or extend what was already given, if man, in this state, gathered the fruits of the earth and fed himself with them and did not complete, with his work, what naturally surrounded him, in later stages, distancing himself from this original standard, he had to reconstruct the access to the divine from which he had fallen and thus a new necessity: art.

To those who know how to examine in depth what we said, the relationship between art and life will appear evident, initially unified so that art was the life itself considered as a rite, then increasingly more discordant, life was reduced to its lowest function and art limited to those who cannot decide to reject truth, up until the current time in which life is really death and art, deprived of every sacred and realizing character, is an expressive monstrosity wherein all the misery of the world and man is reflected.

Art is not redeemed by making of it a need of the spirit: the spirit, and in an absolute way, is nothing if not the Spirit of God, i.e., the breath that is in life, that penetrates and informs the whole man, that makes him feel, act, think according to God, not according to his own humanity. What is human remains human, therefore purely bestial and inferior, which is the level of this humanity, just as everything that is iron remains iron from the most common utensil to the most refined artistic product, both able to lead back to the unity of origin when their exteriority is removed. In fact, what constitutes art for modern men is precisely exteriority instead of the sacred, symbolic content, what this exteriority expresses by relating

to a reality of a transcendent order in the absolute meaning of the word and to a truth of divine order.

Man, in the development of his human faculties, remains man, i.e., nothing: what he feels, lives, accomplishes, thinks, if not beyond the human environment, is destined to perish because it cannot extend beyond time that is succession and beyond space that is materiality.

He remains closed in this prison that he adorns with the most lavish funereal pictures, so that to the extent he embellishes it, so much more will the tomb will exist for him as long as he lives: but, after the dissolution of the body, who is there to take care to lead him into the place of truth, dooming him eternally to that death that he had already experienced in life by rejecting every effort for the surpassing of human limitations. *Homo humus*: as long as he remains earthbound, he will be doomed to fecundate the earth and to perpetuate the lucifugous illusion that is the detrital, lower world: it is necessary that he clear up the illusory obscurity, due to ignorance, in the light of truth and that he expresses from himself what is hidden, i.e., the other half, which could mean the passage from the archaic word *hemi*, referring to the general meaning of half, to *homo*, where the circularity of the *o* represents the realizing universalization of all the human faculties transposed into the divine and integrated in a essentially superhuman plane. Art is the expression of this transposition that is a true and proper transformation, i.e., a surpassing of the form that is obtained by replacing it in the plane of its normal purpose as symbol of a higher truth. But it is necessary that art is in everything and not in part, that it is not exiled from life and that it does not represent only what we could call the kingdom of fringe utopias, but rather it imprints on the most humble of objects, tools, the seal of its symbolic purpose.

This is craftsmanship, these are the crafts: to depict in every material substance, with a labor of diligent understanding, the intimate, symbolic value, expressing a truth of a higher order, from agricultural instruments and those of the weaving mill, from the most common objects of wood

and earth to the construction of house and temple. They are various modes of expression of a unique reality that signify as all the ways lead to God if truly it is God who is sought and not a simple derivative human more or less dressed up and idealized for the use that one wants to make of it.

How Science Displaces Work and Tradition Hence, the corporations also originally represented modes of realization of the divine organized in a regulatory body that established its purpose. This is the real and deep significance of art, craftsmanship, professions, corporations, and let us not pretend that they all come to fathom it, but what is important is that the *pauci optimi* [the few of the best], who ought to participate in restoration of tradition, understand what is hidden under the appearances of “utility” and “activity”, expressions so dear to those who understand nothing because they realize nothing beyond the illusion of the world and man, both considered without relationship to divine reality. If man is one half, he has to search for the other in order to be made whole, i.e., to be truly man—*homo homo*—and one could say, without making a game of words, that he then will truly be man when he ceases to be so. Likewise the world—if it concludes its etymology—that is attired, ornamented, under which the truth of God is hidden, then it will truly be the world, i.e., the place of purification and resurrection, when it is the world, purified from every ignorance, likewise it also will become—the *lapis manalis*¹⁰ removed—the wide abyss for the precipitation in the spectral kingdom.

From everything that we have mentioned, one easily understands how and why—not for simple purely aesthetic reasons, therefore negligible in themselves—the machine, in all its forms, represents a veritable profanation of labor, because it removes every sacred character, every profound meaning, violating its secret, denaturizing its purpose, suppressing

¹⁰http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lapis_manalis

all those seeds of redemption that constitute the *raison d'être* of manual work and of art.

The return to a traditional society would entail a prudent progressive normalization that would be, for the ignorant mass, a true and proper regression but which could be accomplished gradually without creating catastrophes. It is enough that the *pauci optimi* understand, to their full extent, the absolutely positive consequences that would result from a comparable return to normality: it is a question here, more precisely, of the human dignity that would be restored and reintegrated in all its hierarchical development, in all its expressions, in all its aspects, in all its fields, in all the castes, in all men.

In order to become sacred, labor must be accomplished by man and not by the machine that, as is clearly observed, takes revenge on man, destroying him in the most blind, bestial and inhuman way, violently and fatally. A renovation worthy of the name entails the return to the norm of human labor, a restitution of those conditions of existence suitable for the development of the great energies that lie buried in man and that can permit him to reach and truly integrate the divine world of reality.

Labor, once connected to its necessary base of meditative concentration, of patient meticulous contact with the world of Forms, in order to perceive the Rhythms and realize the Silence, would again become sacred for all men and each one could, according to his possibilities, accomplish what he is destined to do and that he is strongly removed from that outrageously superficial and profaning modernity.

May the earth, the sea, the sky be restored to their elementary purity, returned to their symbolic purpose, the earth in order to construct house and temple, the base point for the elevation from the human to the divine, the sea to the navigation between the two shores that separate the transient from the divine, the sky to the penetrative flight into the reality of God that is the only reality, and that the machines are gradually, prudently reduced and eliminated in order to make a place for man and

put him visibly, without intermediaries, in the face of the difficulties of his celestial task on the earth. Because he cannot escape from the earth if he does not know it, if he does not penetrate it, if he does not make it transparent, letting the holy spirit of the real achievement pass there, returning to labor and art, enriching again the impoverished world, mutilated and profaned by the machine. This was created by the lowest part of man, from what in man is the negation of man because it is the negation of God. We allude to profane science, to that which for so many centuries gives itself the false privilege of redeeming humanity from the chains of materiality.

Here a position of the absolute level that does not admit subterfuge and loopholes is necessary. There is only a single science, sacred science, in an absolute way, i.e., the knowledge of true man restored to his elementary function, to his base, to his centre, to his reason to exist, to his life; to his being, to his purpose, to his perfection, to his universality, to God. This is the only science, the only power derived from the knowledge of his own limitations—it is well established—and of exceeding the limits of terrestriality for the effective realization of the divine possibilities: in this sense only *scire est posse* [to know is to be able] and not otherwise.

One goes to God with and in the spirit of God, becoming again sons of God, be it formulated in the integrative fullness that does not admit secondary residues and disturbances. All traditions affirm it, with different expressions, in various forms, but with an intentional unity that no one can misunderstand and confuse. *Ars una species mille*. What is sacred remains such in every tradition of truly divine order and every race is given a tradition conformed to its possibilities, to which it must remain faithful in order to not make the task of traditional integration difficult, while it is permitted only to very few to return to the Primordial Tradition that is in direct contact with the divine plane.

The true science is therefore that contained in the traditional body and has as its goal the return of man to God in all the forms, through

all the levels, and according to all the possibilities. Sacred science is the true absolute and definitive knowledge of man and the world in God and comprises various planes of development according to the domain to which it is applied, each one of these planes, however, not able to, nor ever having to, be considered in itself, but all in convergence, in accordance with the unity of the traditional axis, into a single point. This was maintained in antiquity and in the Middle Ages. Science instead is of the exclusively profane order and considers visible reality exteriorly, as it appears not as it is, by integrating itself in such a case in the invisible reality and, taking as the base point exteriority itself, it determines laws.

Therefore, while sacred science is fixed, immutable, eternally constituted and causes stable and permanent traditional societies, profane science is mutable, unstable, progressive and, with its development, gives origin to anti-traditional, precarious, and transient societies.

The domain of sciences is the visible, i.e., therefore, the superficial that, as such, separated from the body to which it belongs, is illusory and as nonexistent; the successive development of scientific hypotheses shows the inanity of an effort destined to remain sterile, unproductive, since truth indefinitely postponed into the future, i.e., never realized, is not a truth. What is concrete and positive for science is truly the ephemeral and the negative, i.e., the phenomenal appearance considered in itself, because as we said, when brought back to its invisible root, it reacquired another meaning, another attribution, and another reality.

This sign in the theoretical field can suffice: how much then is the development of the so-called western civilizations the most conclusive demonstration of the practical advantage derived from the applications of science? One thinks of the misery, the precariousness, the frivolity of current existence and one will understand what results science applied to life can lead to. It is not allowed to insist on that without falling into the realization that every reasonable man can currently make, considering the shortness of the duration of life, its sussultatory character, the

rising devirilization of humanity, the precariousness of everything, the spasmodicity of every bond, the insecurity of every system, finally the instability that is the indicator of a permanent abortive process due to the absence of traditional fixity.

Science, having become secular, i.e., popular, became the dominion of everything because it is accessible to everyone through its exteriority, superficiality, and facility and was the principle stimulus to the so-called servile awakening, to the progressive democratization of Europe since, after eliminating every true traditional knowledge and excluding every spiritual surpassing, it leveled hierarchy and, with its practical industrial applications, it amazed the foolish and caused libertarian unrest in the masses, of which the current world is the strongest and most authentic expression. Humanity let itself deviate by easy explanations, by immediate practical applications and has forgotten to ask itself up to what point could it reach such a pronounced deviation from the traditional axis. First of all, science has infinitized so-called nature, divinizing it and exalting its mysteries as if there could be other mysteries outside the divine, then it made a stir on a problematic god who follows with his benevolent eye, approving, the progressive contaminations, and finally, acting autonomous, was proclaimed the guide of research and master of life. Man, destitute of all his power, i.e., the very surpassing of his own humanity in order to reach higher and decisive states, was given instead a false creativity in the world of exteriority that lasts as long as his life and is prolonged as long as he is ignorant.

Conclusion Even those who say and believe they adhere to a tradition have accepted science as the expression of an achievement that, according to them, would not collide with the truths of the divine order; more impure and blind than the others, they implicitly repudiate every spirituality and show they do not know the fundamentals of sacred science: this is exclusive of every knowledge that does not replace the elements of creation

in the circularity of dependence by a unique center of which they are only appearances. Men, accustomed to the separative visions of things, in considering elements and forces, distanced themselves from integrative contemplation for which everything loses precisely that material and determined consistency that is the foundation of scientific investigation. Science rises when traditional knowledge no longer succeeds in maintaining supremacy through the disintegration of its own unity: philosophy, also secular, has substituted for sacred wisdom.

It is a fateful cycle that is fulfilled and whose origins must be traced back to the very nature and the frame of mind of the people of the West incapable of maintaining intact the traditional solidarity in order for them to be brought to the exteriority of the active life. With the progressive dimming of sacred motifs secular motifs arose and the attainments that man was no longer able to accomplish in the domain of the supersensible were limited to those that were easy and exterior for a childish craving for visible concreteness. While the creative process starts from the internal to the external, the scientific process comes from the external, which does not exist as such, to a purely nonexistent and ideal internal subordinated to that which does not exist except as depending on appearance: hence the scientific hypothesis claims to be the standard of method.

The current condition of humanity and antitraditional blooming are due in great part to science, to the scientific spirit, but also to philosophy that, with science, has substituted for sacred science. Philosophy, subordinated to Revelation, is a preparatory and necessary stage to higher truths that must be integrated, experienced, in order to be known: without revelation, it is sterile and false and is transformed into veritable diverting nonsense. Philosophy is based exclusively on reason, which presupposes a revelatory light in order to be guided to truly decisive ends be it only in the theoretical sense: isolated from this, it cannot find any absolute point of reference, because the absolute is beyond reason and beyond man in the sense that these cannot approach it unless ceasing to be it,

which does not prevent them from passing through his terrestrial existence, as everyone will easily be able to convince himself considering that Ascetics and the Saints, those, i.e., those who from this life have reached a permanent state of beatific vision that is fulfilled in eternity, certainly not able to be realized within the limits of time and space. Philosophy is a preparation to sacred science and can constitute its theoretic side only if it is subordinated to it, because otherwise it is nothing: it would not even be of interest to show how and why, from the Renaissance on, modern thought unwound following a direction that is ever more antitraditional in order to be liberated from sacred science that necessarily must precede it because it is focused and productive.

To what extent can Pascal's famous phrase¹¹ suffice to denounce the incongruity and inadequacy of the god of the philosophers and poets. Divine reality is revealed and no philosophy, if it remains such, can realize it: this possibility is to be excluded in an absolute way: all the acrobatics of human reason will never succeed in grasping that which, being simple, original, and absolute, offers itself from itself through direct realization and cannot actualize itself through a discursive process that is only direct and mediated. Moreover, after what has been said, in the domain of divine unity there is only divine unity itself and what is human is not excluded from it as simply nonexistent, or, better said, as existing only as long as ignorance lasts: this dispelled, and sacred science tends precisely to that, true and proper realization is initiated that, as unitary and passing beyond what is produced and generated, can rigorously be called metaphysical and metarational. We could also call it "intuition" although no psychological quality is given to this term: the psyche in fact is below the spirit, the intellect, the heart—these three terms denoting, under three aspects, the same type of integrative activity of the divine. The spirit expresses the direct integration whose absolute type is the di-

¹¹God of Abraham, God of Isaac, God of Jacob — not of the philosophers and scholars.

vine breath, the intellect expresses the cognitive permeation, the heart expresses radiant receptivity: by means of the first, one is elevated, with the second, absorbed, in the third, one is welcomed and realizes himself. Representing here a vertical axis, the spirit is the peak, the intellect the base, the heart the center that gathers the two extreme points and extends them, prolonging them horizontally, hence the Cross as radiant symbol of universality and unifying centrality.

No one will dare assert that philosophy can be elevated to this sphere which is of an integrally revelatory order because it is superhuman in the absolute sense of the word. These truths constitute exactly the traditional body, the sacred science, whose transmission happened in a divine way: this knowledge is the true knowledge for the absoluteness and legitimacy of the efforts accomplished in the same axis of truth.

If the Priests are the depositories of it, all men, even the Workers, must extend themselves by giving to their activity a sacred intention and not considering it as the pure satisfaction of their needs and desires. These cannot be, in the seat the truth, distinct in the lower and higher, material or spiritual, in the absolutely erroneous meaning that the moderns give to the last term when they apply it to that which is called the cultural environment. Culture is a profane thing and does not come close to true spirituality: we admit that it perfects the sensibility and develops the intelligence, but it rests completely outside of that which is sacred and real precisely because it is sacred. It is something empty and superficial and is reduced to a vision of life where all the prejudices of the modern era flow into each other, from so-called historicity to linguistics, all exterior sciences that leave intact the domain of the true reality which evades any separative analysis and false constructive synthesis. As behind the Forms there are Rhythms, so behind the visible there is the invisible and as modern sciences stop only at what is expressed but not at that which expresses. Actually, cultural prejudice contributed to the current decline with a dense network of loci communes [commonplaces] which is ap-

plied indiscriminately to the present and the past, all being considered *sub specie alteritatis* in its own function and not as the reflection of a quid that eludes exterior analysis. This is not the place to insist on modern deviations which have behind them a centuries-old preparation which led to the current madness. Nevertheless many symptoms of nausea, fatigue, and glut bring hope that a radical change can still be produced in a progressive way and without too violent perturbations. This rectification can and must happen from the inside to the outside, i.e., it is necessary that the orientation of thought changes and determines the progressive return to normality: let us say "return" meaning especially a restoration of the traditional spirit because the exterior forms can never be reproduced; the cycles do not renew themselves and do not return backwards, repeating developments already accomplished. Nor is it possible to predict how this traditional return will happen if first it is not really initiated with stable foundations and with roots that sink into the very core of the integrally restored traditional unity.

The sad anomalies of current life, the discomfort of individuals and peoples, all the previous misunderstandings serious in themselves but fueled by freedom granted with impunity to those who are not worthy of it, the impoverishment, the progressive cover-up of existence, the vanity of facts, the lack of a secure direction capable of satisfying not only the small needs of small men, but above all the needs of integral man in his true revelatory function of the divine essence—all that brings hope that an awakening can and must be accomplished provided that the *pauci optimi*, conscious of this necessity, does not let itself be submerged by the ignorance of the anonymous and profane crowd.

But if we start from the divine truth as the basis of orientation and we restore the axis of convergence integrally, an endeavor to which the Priests and the Warriors must contribute to, consciously united as being truly the sustainers of tradition, it unites them because the former contemplate and by contemplating realize, the latter because they liberate

activity from its contingent utilitarian character developing it in protective adherence to what is sanctified in the Temple through the maintenance of the sacred deposit, then truly the last caste, which is the most numerous and constitutes the great mass, will also reclaim the Sacred Path where every feeling, symbol of a higher purpose, is established in a single direction like a river from a thousand ripples contained within the same banks, and will be reconstituted, with the fascification of all the energies turned to a single end, the new trunk on the old roots which are still alive and ready to regerminate because revived from the eternal breath of God.

Posted on 2013-06-30 by Cologero

* * *

Graham on 2013-07-02 at 00:12 said:

There are three points somewhat unclear to me.

(1) He speaks of a 'Fourth' state which unifies the others in ineffability, and of an analogous 'fourth' state of Servile Workers. Am I correct in understanding that they comprise those who are 'outside' the caste system, the former by being above it, the latter by being beneath it?

(2) Later he speaks of work versus activity. Am I right in taking this distinction to have some relationship to the principle of freedom? With respect to the circular symbolism he employs, do the rings nearer the centre 'act' in a higher degree, while those approaching the periphery 'work'. It is unclear to me. AK Coomaraswamy writes that the artisan's activity is composed of both contemplation (in conceiving the work) and servile labour (in executing it). Personally, I have found that purely intellectual endeavours feel more nearly like work (in the sense of pain and toil) than do endeavours where 'theory' flows into manual activity.

(3) The meaning of the principle of liberty escapes me. Man's liberty is conformity to the law of God – so far so good. Caste forms a part of this law, self-evidently, so we can say that far from being oppressive, it is most free – a man is most free when he occupies the station conforming to his nature. But can we still say that the upper castes, insofar as they are closer to the centre, have 'more freedom' than the lower castes? There is something quantitative about this thought, and which is incongruent with my experience of being more free when operating within my natural capacities.

I do hope that the next installment will have more to say about the role and possibilities of the Workers. As an aside, for those who may have forgotten, Guenon's *Reign of Quantity* has several excellent chapters bearing on the crafts and their spiritual possibilities.

Avery on 2013-07-03 at 21:41 said:

Graham:

(1) By analogy of India, the fourth caste is part of the initial caste system and is not outside it. Arguably the creation of outcastes is unbalancing and therefore undesirable in Tradition.

I wonder if this missing fourth has anything to do with Plato's *Timaeus* and *Critias*, where the fourth is a necessary part of stability in three dimensional geometry, even though fourths constantly seem to go missing in those dialogues.

(2) Can we get the original word Giorgio is using here? He doesn't seem to be talking about work (*opus*) but labor. Labor, in both its masculine and feminine meanings, is a necessary task but one that requires less intellect than work.

Now some writers claim that work is supposed to be inferior to philosophy. Hannah Arendt places both contemplation and politics above work in classical civilization, and only contemplation in medieval civilization. In my opinion, though, an *opus* is something that, despite being physical, rises above the animal need for labor, as reflected in the ornate work put into all physical objects at the height of great civilizations.

Jacob on 2013-07-03 at 22:26 said:

This discussion reminds me of Josef Pieper's "Leisure, the basis of culture". If you guys have time it's worth picking up. Fairly short, but very good.

Cologero on 2013-07-03 at 23:54 said:

RE (2), this is the sentence: "le caste si sono trasformate in classi e l'attivit  generalment intesa come via complementare, nell'unit  tradizionale, di quella contemplative, si e' trasformata in lavoro, cioe' in pena, in costrizione, poiche' tale e' il senso del termine latino"

Rather than the normal word "lavoratore", he calls this class the "operarii", a neologism.

Why would Arendt put the nobility with the workers in the medieval era? They didn't think so.

The worker's freedom is conditioned since he works with forms as an individual, unlike the Priests and Warriors (although the difference between "conditioned" and "conditionality" is unclear, at least in English.) The Priests tries to transcend form, and the freedom of the warriors is conditioned by his necessary activity in the world, but not by individual forms, they deal with the whole. That does not mean the worker is not free.

The labor of the animal is always natural. The work of man is transcendent and is the reflection of a supernatural reality.

Avery on 2013-07-04 at 01:09 said:

Thank you for the original quotation. Giorgio's creation of a neologism shows that he understands and maintains the essential distinction between labor and opus.

"Why would Arendt put the nobility with the workers in the medieval era? They didn't think so."

If the caste system functions as an order then no part can be disregarded; the whole thing is equally traditional and must remain in balance. I made a very bad summary of Arendt on the way to that point. She was not trying to lump workers and nobility together, but rather show how politics was degraded from a formerly sacred status. Classical politics was seen as part of the pursuit of the sacred, while medieval secular power became distinct from spiritual authority, although it aimed for harmony between the two. (Modern politics, of course, is even worse!) The classical philosophers focused much of their efforts on trying to perfect the earthly city, but Augustine told us to abandon the earthly city and seek the divine. Obviously Arendt's argument was way more complex than this but my memory works best with concrete examples.

Michael on 2013-07-04 at 20:29 said:

Has there ever been a culture that has gone from being like ours to having castes? I can't think of one in recorded history, but there might be something in mythology that speaks to moving from a dark age to a traditional society.

Cologero on 2013-07-05 at 09:18 said:

Following the dissolution of the Roman Empire, there was a concerted effort (documented in Georges Duby's "The Three Orders") to re-establish society on the basis of the three functions described by Georges Dumezil.

Logres on 2013-07-14 at 22:23 said:

This is fabulous; particularly the passage on the cross being the symbol of heart, intellect, & spirit united. I think there are many "workers" who know something is wrong, & are working, with the hope that the Priests & Warriors will begin to act in time.

Michael on 2013-07-17 at 21:13 said:

This is a bit off topic but related since de Giorgio is talking the three orders. To what extent is membership in one of the orders by birth? Evola talks about the priestly caste being twice born, but that would mean that some of the upper caste (or the priests or nobility) are not really of that order if they are not initiates. I think of the nobility of today and it does not seem that they are particularly noble except for birth.

If being twice born is the criteria, then who makes the call?

I apologize if this has already been answered elsewhere.

Cologero on 2013-07-18 at 23:39 said:

Michael, the three castes that Guido De Giorgio wrote about should be "twice born" as they still are in India AFAIK. Not so long ago in Europe, the priests obviously had their orders, the nobility would probably belong to some order of chivalry, and the workers had their guilds.

Mes idées politiques, by Charles Maurras

5.1 His Political Ideas

Ideas belong to no one; they are what they are.

CHARLES MAURRAS, *My Political Ideas*

Tonight, I'm outlining the plan for translating a series of essays by Charles Maurras. This fulfills a promise and responds to a challenge. The promise was made in the comments section of Taki's Magazine¹ a few years ago when it used to be a conservative resource instead of the journal of choice for hip urban racists that it is today. The challenge is from **Alain de Benoist** to compare and contrast the ideas of Evola and Maurras. It appears no one has the will or the talent to accomplish that.

That still does not fully answer the question of "Why bother?" In his prime, Mauras was highly influential, not just in France, but also on the Iberian peninsula and across Latin America. Echoes of his thought still

¹<http://takimag.com/#axzz27L592q87>

reverberate in Traditional Catholic circles through the SSPX² and TFP³, although they are far from the mainstream. Yet for the modern world, his ideas are not only irrelevant today, they are positively distasteful. Nevertheless, there may still be salvageable concepts if we leave aside the more contentious parts of his writings.

The French Republic prides itself on its secularism, but Maurras himself was a secularist. The difference is that Maurras includes the entire history of France in his vision, while the Republic looks is concerned with the moment. Like the liberals, he also claims to base his worldview on science. However, for the liberal, the individual is the atom, and family, culture, and nation are the results of his will which he may freely choose or reject. For Maurras, family, culture, and nation come first, they are the source of the individual's identity and hence demand his allegiance. For the liberal, there is no fixed human nature since he creates his own identity. Maurras, on the other hand, based his understanding of a fixed human nature on the philosophy of Thomas Aquinas.

There is no compromise possible here. To the modern mind, Maurras' ideas are necessarily restrictive, as they limit his freedom in the present, and they are reactionary since they tie him to the actual past whereas he wants to be liberated for the possible future. For them, this exercise can serve as a museum for discarded ideas, useful for pedagogy, but not much else. The real challenge, then, is for the so-called New Right. This will serve as a touchstone to evaluate its doctrines which hardly differ from liberalism considering its commitment to a functional polytheism and its tolerance for the aesthetically ugly and the unnatural. We hope there may still be those looking for ideas on the Right that derive from traditional sources rather than from foraging in the weeds of postmodern thought for imaginary gems as does the New Right.

Maurras was a poet and a member of the prestigious **Académie française**

²<http://www.sspix.org/>

³<http://www.tfp.org/>

until his postwar conviction of collaborating with the enemy. Hence, his prose is written in beautifully expressive French so it is a shame to have to translate him as I will be unable to capture that.

Maurras was not often a systematic writer, so it is difficult to find a representative sample of his work despite his voluminous output. We considered two works. One was written late in his life, *Order and Disorder*, which fits into a theme we have been exploring recently. However, it is not broken up into sections so it is not so suitable for a blog. The other is *My Political Ideas* which does attempt to lay out his ideas somewhat systematically. Next Sunday, we will start with the chapter titled "Principles" and then decide if it is worthwhile to continue. These can and should be compared to some of the metaphysical principles we have been writing about. Like Abraham, I am hoping for ten good men to be able to provide insightful and relevant commentary on these essays, although in reality I would be satisfied with one. The forthcoming principles are:

1. Truth
2. Strength
3. Order
4. Authority
5. Liberty
6. Right and Law
7. Property
8. Heritage
9. Duty of Heritage
10. Tradition

Posted on 2012-09-23 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2012-09-23 at 23:37 said:

Excellent. The translation of Maurras' writing on Comte you provided a couple of years earlier was great so I'll be looking forward to this.

Both Maurras and Comte remain quite unique in their defense of traditional social-political structures while respectfully remaining non-committed to affirming the spiritual reality that the structures are intended to reflect. Though even then, Maurras became a committed Catholic near the end of his life, and Comte appeared to take a quasi-mystical outlook in his outlook with venerating the great predecessors that came before us.

Hope your health has improved.

Avery Morrow on 2012-09-24 at 00:52 said:

"Tradition means giving votes to the most obscure of all classes, our ancestors. It is the democracy of the dead." – Chesterton

Drieu on 2012-09-24 at 17:17 said:

"However, for the liberal, the individual is the atom, and family, culture, and nation are the results of his will which he may freely choose or reject."

This is inaccurate and flat out stupid to anyone who has actually bothered to research the history of ideas. Not all liberals and leftists hold the same views, just like not all rightists hold the same views.

Immanuel Kant and Denis Diderot, both radicals in their time, did not see individuals as atoms but as "cultural agents", i.e. that man was unavoidably shaped by his culture. The same applies to Johann Gottfried Herder, the philosophical founder of nationalism, who supported the French Revolution.

The anarchist Mikhail Bakunin wrote that "Nationality is not a principle; it is a legitimate fact, just as individuality is. Every nationality, great or small, has the incontestable right to be itself, to live according to its own nature. This right is simply the corollary of the general principle of freedom."

Even among economic liberals, Milton Friedman explicitly states in *Capitalism and Freedom* that the basic component of society is not the individual, but the family.

Hell, Maurras's own ideas on nationalism (as well as Maurice Barrès's) were primarily shaped by Hippolyte Taine and Ernest Renan, both agnostic liberals (though of a conservative bent more akin to British Toryism).

There are many more examples, but those are just some prominent ones off the top of my head. You need to drop the inane traditionalist platitudes and straw men about some monolithic "Enlightenment" or "liberalism" and actually figure out what the other side thinks. Especially since most of the ideas attributed to the "Enlightenment" (secularism, republicanism, written constitutions, equality before the law, civil liberties) were organically developed well before then in the religious sphere by devout Christians, not by deists or skeptics.

"We hope there may still be those looking for ideas on the Right that derive from traditional sources rather than from foraging in the weeds of postmodern thought for imaginary gems as does the New Right."

Except that the right, including *La Vera Destra* to which your dear Evola refers, has always incorporated the latest philosophical trends into its thought. By absorbing some postmodern currents, the *Nouvelle Droite* has not at all betrayed the legacy of people like Joseph de Maistre or Juan Donoso Cortés. And considering that postmodernism thought aligns with certain motifs of the right, such as a suspicion of the Enlightenment narrative, disdain for rationalism, and rejection of an historical telos, I don't even see it as a necessarily corrupting element.

For the record, I'm not a leftist or liberal, but someone who is tired of seeing people who are nominally on my side repeat the same nonsense again and again and make themselves look like idiots in the process.

As for Maurras, I'd go for one of the early works like *Enquete sur la monarchie*. You forgot to mention that his views changed a bit after WWI. In the early period, he advocated decentralization, regionalism, and flirted with unorthodox economic doctrines such as syndicalism. After the war, he shifted towards support for centralization while still retaining some affection for the provinces, and became more reconciled with capitalism and less interested in activism. The latter two changes ended up driving away many of his most talented disciples who were much more dedicated to the earlier radicalism, such as Georges Bernanos, Lucien Rebatet, Robert Brasillach, and Thierry Maulnier.

Andrew on 2012-09-24 at 18:10 said:

And that is not the tradition we are talking about.

Cologero on 2012-09-24 at 19:03 said:

Drieu, I'm afraid we differ in method. In order to understand "liberalism" or any "ism", it requires an understanding of the principles that govern it. Hence, we here reject out of hand the empirical approach of asking those who call themselves "liberal" what their positions are on various issues. This fails for two reasons. The first is that focus turns to secondary issues. The second, and more important, is that few men are really aware of the principles and motives that drive their thought. In our language, we are interested in the "thesis" rather than the "hypothesis". Although I have hinted at that distinction previously, I will have to expand on it at a later time.

The sign of a great thinker is that he knows and can express his first principle. These are the men we need to focus on, not a hodge podge of random quotes. For example, Francis Bacon explicitly rejected "formal causes", which is antithetical to any Traditional understanding of the world. This has consequences in what you call the "history of ideas" even if later developments were not apparent to Bacon himself. Yet, this rejection is considered normal today even to the extent that very few men even realize that it underlies their entire worldview. We will deal with this again soon, probably on Wednesday.

Kant took this further by denying knowledge itself. Given Bacon's premise, Kant's conclusion absolutely follows. Yet this is opposed to any Traditional world view. So for Kant "culture" is an empirical reality that "shapes" an individual; unfortunately, that is not a very profound observation. The Traditional worldview is that a culture is a transcendental reality, something Kant denies necessarily as unknowable. It more than "shapes" the individual; rather the individual is unthinkable without it.

So, yes, Drieu, we try to "figure out" not just "what" they think, but rather "how" they think. And that is very often not exactly how they see themselves. In other words, what are the presuppositions of their thought? And, of course, we mean consistent thought since very few men are able to think consistently.

If this project has no appeal to you, you are welcome to leave and hang out wherever there are no stupid people or idiots. Traditional thought is always considered stupid, superstitious, and ignorant by the modern mind. Since you appear to have a modern mind, I don't see how we are on the "same" side, not even nominally.

I am always amused by readers who want to tell me what to write on this blog, or what to translate, or what I omitted. Obviously, I omit quite a bit, since my contention is that a single blog post needs to be narrowly focused. If you prefer that I translate *Enquete sur la monarchie* for you, cut me a check for all the time required and I will move it to the very top of my priorities. Otherwise, I will select texts based on my own purposes and interests.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-24 at 19:31 said:

As someone whose life has been influenced by Maurras' ideas himself, I will gladly do what I can to assist in this project.

Let me ask Cologero, we know already the distinction between the traditional and modern minds. The new right seems to think the postmodern mind is something else and an improvement upon the modern that can lead back to traditional thinking. Do you agree and if not why?

Izak on 2012-09-24 at 23:02 said:

I'm not really seeing the willingness to discourse with postmodern theorists as any indication that the New Right is *eo ipso* postmodern, or informed by liberal values, or even definable

in any meaningful way as of now.

The medieval Catholic justification for glossing heretics like Origen was that “even in a heap of dung one can find a nugget of gold.”

Like most intellectual movements, the New Right will be defined by whatever influence it manages to concretely produce. Because that’s what politics is all about.

Cologero on 2012-09-25 at 00:17 said:

Jason-Adam, what I will be looking for are comments on the texts, either explicating the text, relating it to other ideas, or putting it into a broader context. I don’t plan to “debate” the New Right. I really do understand the allure of postmodernism; I have experienced it firsthand. The fundamental point is that if the knowledge of ultimate reality is already known, has been known since ancient times, and is handed down as tradition, then why the quest for novelty?

I suggest to the advocates here of the new right that they explain why Benoist ultimately rejected Maurras ... that would be useful and would add to the store of knowledge.

The other part of the project is to compare and contrast Maurras and Evola; comments in that regard are welcome. Moreover, I am curious why Benoist thinks it a worthwhile project as well as the reason neither he nor anyone else has followed through with it.

Avery on 2012-09-25 at 01:33 said:

I employ vulgar sources wherever they may help people understand, and resort to fleshing out the Guenonian depths only when there has been a clear disruption of our common sense.

In this case, I see a clear connection between Chesterton’s romantic definition and Cologero’s statement, “Maurras himself was a secularist. The difference is that Maurras includes the entire history of France in his vision, while the Republic looks is concerned with the moment.”

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-25 at 20:25 said:

I could write an essay explaining clearly the exact differences between Evola and Maurras so I will gladly comment when the texts appear. Let me just say one thing for now – that ultimately Maurras and de Benoist are looking to different pasts, one to the Middle Ages, the other to ancient Greece. I conjecture de Benoist has not gone through with the project because he would have to explicitly state then that he does admire mediaeval civilisation.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-25 at 20:26 said:

forgive me, it should say de Benoist does NOT admire mediaeval civilisation.

Dominion on 2012-09-26 at 00:50 said:

The issue is one of form rather than essence, in my understanding. While it is true that the ultimate principles already exist, the way in which they manifest are not. This differs between

Traditional civilizations; Christendom did not look identical to the Caliphate, which did not look identical to old Rome, and so on. Traditionalists in the New Right, particularly Dugin, use postmodern thought to critique the basic principles of Liberal civilization and thought, which is similar to what Maurras sought to do with positivist philosophy ("What our fathers did through custom and feeling, we ourselves pursue it through reason and will, with the assurance and clarity of science.") When Faye (who is admittedly not a Traditionalist) talks about reconciling Evola and Marinetti, I interpret this as taking the ultimate principles which we already know and seeing how we can live by them in our current, temporal and changing world. Tradition of principle must not be made equivocal to traditionalism of form. As Guido de Giorgio once said:

"Tradition is absolutely different from traditionalism: one is an eternally fecund living patrimony, rich with infinite potentialities in all times and circumstances . . . the other is but sterile residue, an inefficient, self-enclosing concreteness impossible to adapt and lacking all energetic and creative force. Tradition is clearly opposed to traditionalism, just as truth is opposed to commonplaces."

Cologero on 2012-09-26 at 07:29 said:

Well put, Dominion. The phrase you quoted also explains my own interest in the thought of Maurras and Comte. So are you saying that the Maurrasian critique of liberalism is no longer effective and that the postmodern critique may be more fruitful?

Dominion on 2012-09-26 at 14:46 said:

Considering the influential role that positivism plays in the current order, particularly in the scientific sphere and even to a great extent in the social sciences, I think that both the Maurrasian and postmodern critiques of liberalism would prove useful. Personally, although I find the postmodern critiques interesting and useful, I am more inclined towards rational and scientific perspectives and might thus find Maurras more rewarding. I don't have much background in his thought, however, and thus await your translation.

5.2 Principle I: Truth

From Chapter II, "Principles", of *Mes Idées Politiques*, by **Charles Maurras**.

Yes sir, yes ma'am, because "speech is hard", its efficacy will be sweet; because the book is "bitter to the tongue", it will be invigorating and healing.

The signposts raised up on the road don't show their direction in a sweet and florid style: they flaunt the style of their utility. Clear, direct, insistent, and authoritarian, they don't say: "if I am mistaken", they don't doubt themselves, they do not excuse themselves from roughly throwing the direction arrows and the mile markers into the eyes of the people who pass. But does the traveler complain about it? As long as he has the heart of a philosopher, he gives thank to the author of profitable brutalities which he does not even feel tyrannized by.

It is his choice to slow down or step on the gas, to follow to change his direction. The milestone says what it is in clear terms, and what is necessary to take into account. The more that precise facts limit thought and, because of that narrow limit, the more that fantasies of the heart, wishes of the imagination, the needs, the amenities and personal interests will obtain safety and will be able to give themselves a career. An uncertain direction, a fact, whether vague or false, while appearing to flatter the arbitrariness of the walker, will restrict the freedom of his movements, of his rest, they will diminish his real powers, for the risks attached to the consequences of an indifferent or capricious itinerary will be increased by the insufficiency of his knowledge.

It is a great error to think that *contingencies*, as they say, accommodate themselves more easily to a lax and vacillating principle: to the contrary, all indecision of principles complicates the study of the facts, as well as their treatment; uncertainty thus is inserted at the sole point from where a little light could come to them, to the complexities of the earth shadows in the sky will be added.

Truth, a harsh but clear sun, is content to establish from above what is necessary to know and think before acting. It shows the good, it marks out the bad; it distinguishes the proportions following which the one and the other confront each other and mix in the infinite variety of our human events. Once so enlightened, man is far from having resolved the problems of practical life, but he has something to resolve them and if, as

happens to him too frequently, he can choose only between evils, he will better discern which will be the least, his effort can be applied to avoiding the worst; that makes perhaps the greatest point of the government of oneself and others.

Not only is truth defended by what it has that is naturally general, elevated, abstract, and foreign to man, but in order to decide to ascend to it, a general impulse [*élan*] of thought beyond the present, a full calculation of the future, is necessary. In order to adhere to this truth that veils everything, in addition an effort of will imposing silence on many instincts is necessary.

Truth (I do not say sincerity, I say the whole truth, the agreement of language and thought with external realities), can still be something besides the highest delight of intelligence: it is the empowered sovereign, it is all powerful force.

Sincerity is not the truth. The most correct intention and the firmest will cannot create what it is not.

Let us not underestimate any virtue, but let us give justice to the obvious virtues. There is no smile, grimace, or chattering of beautiful spirits that can stand against them. The decisions that they lead to are serious, sometimes painful, in the life of the spirit; exterior life doesn't always accommodate them, but the service that they render is such that they prevail over everything.

Truth is of value in itself. But there are bitter truths and sweet truths. There are useful and dangerous truths. There are those that are necessary to reserve only for the wise, and others which are suitable for the nourishment of all.

Some purely oratorical and mystical revolutionaries can believe that, fable or truth, it is always good enough for the people! We believe that the people have no needs less demanding than the elite. Truth is as necessary as bread. The historico-political lie poisons a people as absolutely as potassium cyanide.

A disdain which is not expressed does not take effect. To the contrary, an error and a lie that one does not take the trouble to unmask acquire little by little the authority of the true.

Complete text: <http://www.royaliste.org/spip.php?article520>

Posted on 2012-09-30 by Cologero

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Dominion on 2012-09-30 at 14:45 said:

"Sincerity is not the truth. The most correct intention and the firmest will cannot create what it is not."

"To the contrary, an error and a lie that one does not take the trouble to unmask acquire little by little the authority of the true."

With those two statements Maurras has unveiled the secret to every victorious lie and legend's success and the key to its power. If a single man or an entire people cannot bring itself to tear the pretty mask off the lies which keep them entranced and captive, they cannot progress. Indeed, they may well fall deeper into the mire.

Jason-Adam on 2012-10-01 at 17:52 said:

This text, written in the flowery French style of which Maurras was a master of, is not something easily grasped by those used to modern Joe Friday "just the facts ma'am" styles of writing. What Maurras is saying here though is just exactly that – before we can figure the world out we need to begin with facts, things we are certain of through proveable means, to avoid being trapped by the lies of the power hungry.

Attila on 2012-10-21 at 02:24 said:

I disagree with the characterization of "flowery French style"—Maurras' writing is highly nuanced, and not reductionist—unlike so much coming from Anglo-Saxon circles.

5.3 Principle II: Force

To the principle of Truth, Mr. Maurras adds the principle of Force, without which the former is impotent. Yet, Force must be guided by sound judgment.

There are despotic weaknesses, malicious stupidities, and losers worthy of being so, as there are beneficent winners, heroes of energy and power to whom humanity owes immense progress, giants of health and strength who have merited the blessing of the past and the future. Force in itself, bared of its adventitious and incidental characteristics, force which is still in the service of neither good nor evil, naked force and by itself a good, and very precious and very great since it is the expression of the activity of being. It is idiotic to want to ignore its benefits.

In order to deter harmful sophism, one cannot grow tired of repeating it: force by itself, reduced to itself, is a good. That does not mean that it always does good or there is not a greater good.

Good in itself, it is also capable of the greatest benefits like defending the country, punishing crime, avenging honor, or protecting innocence.

But as it is capable of everything, it needs a rule as the primary guaranty and, put into the service of the best cause, an order. Order contributes to render it entirely and completely effective. But order also restrains it in the service of what it claims to serve; order prevents it from turning against what is dear to it in spite of itself. All disordered force is exposed to this peril.

It is up to Reason to moderate force, that is to say, the sense of measure and intellectual proportions, there is this civic sense which adds to the higher orders of the spirit I don't know what principle of cordiality, bonhomie, I would dare to say, of charity which does not desire the death of the guilty, but which desires, and very much desires, his rectification.

There remains also that clarity, that sincerity, the natural continuation of the rectitude of the spirit which permits neither hypocrisy nor disguise, but which marches straight ahead of itself, head high and chest bare, this tranquil serenity which belongs to those who have freely assumed noble missions.

The theories of force are not at all in contradiction with the doctrine of solidarity and, anyway, human mutual aid needs to be strong to protect

itself or to be protected against violence.

If there may be in the world force which is of value, it appears indispensable for it to be strong; if there is something else, if, as we think, there is something better, and much better, it is still more necessary to be strong and powerful to save or to develop these true goods.

Posted on 2012-10-07 by Cologero

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Audrey on 2012-10-07 at 23:02 said:

I do find your posts to be a good mirror of self-reflection, contributing to the 'educatedness' of my self-observations and regulations of behavior. I would say, that real education should approach, at least in part, a similar mode, as opposed to stuffing slots in people's heads with ideas and fighting for intellectual real estate. Namely, paragraph #4 from the bottom, I have always wondered why every time I am asked about punishment under UCMJ, such as rank degradation, or jail, I always request instead rectification measures. However, in the Army, this is considered a weakness. I guess their idea of teamwork, is more about pulling like a donkey, and not about actual collaboration.

Logres on 2012-10-08 at 05:22 said:

Bishop Joubert (as quoted by M. Arnold): "Force & Right rule the world – Force till Right is ready". Maurras' style and manner of thought comes across very strongly, even in translation. Thank you.

Sati Shankar on 2012-10-11 at 22:48 said:

Force, is in fact a double edge sword, neutral in itself as such, in the hands of some one capable in using it. Now it depends on the its user that it is used to protect or induce Good. History has enough to cite its misuses. The question is, whether to engineer (by force) a society where corrections will not be needed which depends, dangerously upon the user of force, Or to let the Tradition work so that no engineering is needed at all. Force kills spontaneity and freedom, most often.

The second point relates to the Force as inner energy, that is indispensable for an individual to attain his goal.

Graham on 2012-10-14 at 01:21 said:

"... neutral in itself ..."

Maurras says that force is good in itself. That makes sense, since “it is the expression of the activity of being”. This closely parallels Evola’s remarks about virtue and power which are discussed elsewhere on Gornahoor.

5.4 Principle III: Order

Although he described himself as a pagan, the influence of Thomism on **Charles Maurras** is quite clear. Being and Order, for him, are coterminous. I don’t know the extent of Donoso Cortes’ influence on Maurras, but Maurras also rejects endless discussion, claiming that to debate order, which has a mathematical-like certainty, is a waste of time. To choose disorder (or chaos) is to choose death and annihilation. Man, such as he is, needs to hold firm to his fixed reference points (or road signs?); modernity, on the other hand, wants to knock over every one of them. Who is left to still remember them and celebrate them on the calendar?

As no face could exist without the features that surround it and the line which contains it, as soon as the Being begins to move away from its opposite, as soon as the Being is, it has its form, it has its order, and it is that same thing from which it is limited that forms it. What existence is without essence? What is Being without law? In all the degrees of the scale, the Being weakens when order diminishes; it dissolves as soon as order no longer holds.

Order is only a means. It is a point of departure. To reestablish order restores an atmosphere favorable to the action of the spirit as well as that of the body. That order makes work possible or better. It guarantees it duration, supplies it with assistants or protectors.

Humane rule does not consist in killing, destroying, nor annihilating the subject whom it must, on the contrary, develop while maintaining him on his path.

The necessity to *subordinate* in order to coordinate and order, there is no rhetorical nonsense that can go against that mathematics!

To be conformed to order shortens and facilitates work. To contradict or debate order is to waste time.

Order, they say, is a higher justice.

For historical and political order, *to have* it is nothing, *to hold* it is nothing, if one is not also in a position *to keep* it.

In war as in peace, order is precious among all the goods. With its fake hardness, with its apparent strictness, it saves lives, as it measures and makes use of efforts.

The soldier who complains about the order is the enemy of himself. The blind kindness that joins in with this soldier is an enemy of the soldier. An unconscious and involuntary enemy; what does the intention matter if it sends him to his death?

Precisely because he is ungrateful and weak, because forgetfulness and fickleness are normal for him, man notices early on that it is necessary for him to look again, in Time that is constantly changing, for some points of fixed reference, for invariable points of support, whenever he wants to realize a plan of any importance, or he wants to be faithful to his goal and his love.

I deliberately write this last word, which only expresses the sentiment of persons; for if strong passions have their anniversary rites, if a return of certain dates leads to a natural return of thought to the joyful or sorrowful mysteries of the life of the heart, or even more so, when it is no longer a question of a sole being, but of a society, a religion, a cause, then will it be necessary to immortalize happy or gloomy memories on their dates.

Do not forget: this is the starting point of all order and all law.

Posted on 2012-10-14 by Cologero

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Jason-Adam on 2012-10-16 at 00:10 said:

Indeed, order is the basis of all life. Without a basis there is no society, as we see in our days as all forms of collective identity are in decline.

Cologero on 2012-10-16 at 17:08 said:

It is important to not that, for Maurras, order not only determines what a being is, but also what it is not. This is important for his subsequent analysis.

Lucius Cornelius Sulla on 2017-05-22 at 18:47 said:

How is Charles Maurras pagan? He was pagan after he lost faith, but he was then involved in politics it is only after Dreyfus affair, that he become engaged in political affairs, but I never i read anywhere that he considers himself pagan when he was defending church and become monarchist, or can some point me to were I can find that sentence?

Cologero on 2017-05-22 at 19:09 said:

Obviously, dude, you read it here. Unless you consider here to be Nowhere⁴.

Lucius Cornelius Sulla on 2017-05-25 at 19:17 said:

you misinterpreted my question: how charles maurras is pagan?.It is last thing I could call him, he clear would describe himself as positivist and classicist.

Cologero on 2017-05-25 at 21:12 said:

OK, Sulla, from the OED definition of pagan⁵, the most reliable source:

A person holding religious beliefs other than those of the main world religions.

So that is the sense I used the word. You are correct; he would have described himself as a positivist, at least after his youth. His first book, *Anthinéa*, about his visit to Athens, was originally titled "Pagan promenades". Eventually, however, he embraced Positivism and achieved a rapprochement with Catholicism.

At that time, he became coy about the designation "pagan" or even "atheist", but that need not concern us. Yet if he was a classicist, then he was a pagan in the same sense that Plato was a pagan.

Since the book under discussion was written much later in his life, I will change to text to read: "he was often described as a pagan", or something like that.

But I hope that excessive pedantry does not obscure the main point. To wit, the recognition of a cosmic order, i.e., "natural law", is possible for pagans, so it is not solely a Christian dogma.

⁴<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pesIGuV9DDk>

⁵<https://en.oxforddictionaries.com/definition/pagan>

5.5 Principle IV: Authority

From Chapter II, "Principles", *L'Autorité*, of *Mes Idées Politiques*,
by Charles Maurras.

Nature of Authority The idea that authority can be constructed from below would not have come into the head of our grandparents who were wise.

It is not made, in truth, from below nor from above.

Authority is *born*. In individuals, families, peoples, it is a gift which the will of men has very little to see.

The most vulgar observation is totally in accord here with the Catholic text *omnis potestas a Deo*⁶. In one of the oldest "Letters to Françoise", Mr. Marcel Prevost reminds his niece how, after having passed her baccalauréate, she knew she was obliged to show the secretary of the Faculty her notes, regardless of the rules of the University and the laws of the State. "You have a great gift, Françoise, it is authority," observed Uncle Marcel sententiously. Did he believe so well what he observed. Did he follow through what he observed?

Authority, seized thus at its birth, is something simple and pure. Certain human types possess it, the others are devoid of it.

In leaving aside those who know only how to submit, the man of liberty, recognizable in the pride of a heart that nothing crushes, differs from the one who is characterized by dignity and inspires above all respect: the man of authority differs from the other two. His liberty imposes itself naturally on the liberty of others, his dignity is radiant, it leads and carries. It is neither respect nor admiration—inert feelings—it is an enthusiastic submissiveness which responds to him.

Far from being irrational, instinctive wishes move more quickly than conscious reason, and perceptive logic is not more lacking than the pas-

⁶All power comes from God.

sions of a great love. The author of *La Vita Nuova* tells us that at his first sight of Beatrice his heart begins to beat in him impetuously, which **Dante** develops and explains in these terms:

The spirit of life that reside in the most secret vault of the heart begins to tremble with so much force that the movement is made to be felt again in my smallest veins and, trembling, it says these words: '*Ecce deus fortiori me, qui veniens dominabitur me.*' Here is that God stronger than I, he is going to dominate me. Then, the animal spirit, which is hidden in its high vault where all sensitive spirits go to carry their perception, began to be greatly surprised and, addressing itself particularly to the spirits of the sight, says these words: '*Apparuit jam beatitudo nostra.*' Our bliss has appeared.

It is necessary to reread all that penetrating and poetic analysis which is of an age where the laziest sophisms from Germany and the Jews [Freud] had not imposed on the European West a ridiculous philosophy of the unconscious. What was unconscious, one brought it to consciousness. What eludes the first grasp of reason, a more subtle reason pulls out in the night.

This explanation of the strong premonitions of a loving heart, such as Dante gives us, can be applied to the instinctive transports of an obedient soul before the authority that he judges to suit him: a quick judgment grants him to conceive that it will be good for him to serve that force conceived as useful and beneficial, whose order presages protection, justice, or victory. There is a taste in it of the beginning of a mysterious good. By what sign is it known? That is the great difficulty. Certain military leaders make themselves obeyed by genius, others by bravery, others by a type of mystical faith. The exterior and brilliant gifts of a Condé can add the magic of the example to it, but some generals carried on litters have radiated the same prestige.

Henry Fouquier, who was part of the *Thousand* [who conquered Sicily as part of the unification of Italy], loved to tell that the aging Garibaldi inflamed his band by saying to them in a whisper, from the base of his carriage where rheumatism confined him, a simple: "Gentlemen, move ahead!" So many passions of hope and confidence sleep in the human soul! Little suffices a little in order to make them rise from it, but this nothing is indispensable and no convention, no arrangement, no artifice of will can take the place of the first natural gift.

Authority is of the same order as virtue or genius or beauty.

The most learned cogs have never replaced authority *born* . . .

The French of the tenth century had settled down around the race which, for a hundred years or more, had always defended them effectively. Where did that race come from, from what heaven had it fallen on the country? Immigrant Saxons or native rural lords or even descendants of bourgeois Parisians, scholarship does not stop discussing it. They do not discuss the authority acquired little by little by their fortuitous power nor the benefit of their dynasty nor its constant happiness.

It expresses for centuries a power or protection and increase, it represents everything that the heart and spirit of men, isolated or reunited, wait for, hope for, and believe about a true authority.

True authority is naturally wise; an insane authority is not conceivable. The idea of authority does not mean, indeed, only the power and the great power exercised by a man or a group of men, but all the more, it confines the knowledge of the object on which this power is exercised and applied. The more the authority believes, the more this knowledge itself is developed. The more authority is perfect, the more it assumes the clarity and the exactitude of that knowledge, and the more it proportions itself in it.

Authority would not be an eternal political necessity if, at the same time as that guiding instinct which constitutes the bottom of the soul of the leaders, there did not exist in the soul of the subjects and the citizens

an instinct of obedience, "spirit of following," said Richelieu, who is the living expression of the greatest interest of the crowds: to be governed and well governed, in a good sense, with firmness.

The Conditions of True Authority: the Education of the Leaders

The development of what is called modern civilization tends increasingly favour material forces over moral forces.

If we rely on it in order to achieve social justice or the improvement of morals, we set ourselves up for considerable deceptions! That civilization equalizes neither wealth nor conditions: on the contrary, its complexity never ceases increasing the differences between men. It does not liberate: the authority of science and industry will tend instead to establish new races of slaves. Finally, far from pacifying and reconciling, its needs are so demanding that they seem to intersect at a right angle, to destroy or deny everything that is human.

Neither the game of supply and demand which continues capitalism, nor the principle of nationalities which created our armed peace, nor class warfare, by which the insurgent masses respond to the starvation brought by capitalism, would know how to spread in the modern world an ambiance of a sheepfold. We would be rather be pushed back among the antisocial wolves and pressured to live, by categories of class or race, according to the custom of the wolves. The inherited veneer of customs peels off little by little, the vestiges of general traditions disappear, and the statistics of criminality show what inevitably results from it.

Consider the progress of athletics (which could make, in a well ruled society, an admirable school of discipline and elegance), the passion (otherwise excellent in itself) of winning and prevailing in violent games, the new instruments created by science and those who apply them: this proliferation of ancient forces and these new means put in the service of powers without restraint only have to give their lessons: the moralist, with a thousand signs, sees brutality reborn.

As to the language of our contemporaries, I speak of the best, of those who are elevated, if not highly elevated, men and women, that it comes back to primitive onomatopoeia, if we “let come to grips with life”, forces, destinies.

In the regime of brutality, there are neither leaders nor orders, nor even order, without its necessary hierarchy which is lacking. The massacres of September had leaders. It is not orders that the executioner lacked from the Duke of Enghien or Bishop Darboy. It is not necessary to complain about our times in this regard.

Class differences are more marked than they have been for a half century, the arrogance and despotism of the authorities would rather be on the way to grandeur. What is lacking in the directing spirits is that light which is the sign of the right to lead. The leaders remain and their power increases, but those are barbaric leaders left to the impulses of passion or interest. They command, they lead, because their troops will it, but they command poorly and lead wrongly, the mistake being learned.

They themselves also are, still more than these proletarian masses for which they feign a very vivid interest, the really underprivileged.

The intellectual and moral treasure, whose task of collecting that inheritance belongs to them, was disdained and finally lost. Thus the spirit of liberal democracy used it, which disorganized the country from above; borrowing the language of progress, pretending to possess the promises of the future, it abandoned the sole instrument of progress, which is tradition, and the only seed of the future, which is the past.

The history of the Third Republic can suffice to show the harm that there can be to surrender legislation, armies, the economy, diplomacy, and all the forms of authority and influence to those spirits without direction and without culture, to those hearts without self-mastery and without dignity.

The symmetric history of conservative England, where everyone who governed and served in the top jobs had undergone the hard and long

intellectual and moral preparation in the old universities, with a lot of Greek verses and Latin discourses, confirms how certain it is that the real happiness of the people depends on the good training of their leaders. The sword of the conqueror, the baton of the founder, even the pencil of the stockbroker, all these modalities of strength and cunning can and must bring about great benefits to the condition of having passed the necessary time under the strict rule of the educator. Everything that they take away from the rule, is not taken away from the rule nor from the authority which holds it: that is entrenched in the entire mass of the people; it is the nation and the human race who are the first dispossessed.

The lessening of the common intellectual and moral assets is a loss for everyone: the least will lose as much as the great.

They will even lose much more than the great, because that which perfects, refines, elevates the great, constitutes, to the profit of the others, the most precious, and often the only, guarantee against the abuses of power which greatness is precisely exposed to. Certain nuances of virtue and honor, certain beautiful persuasive accents of the voice which commands are the direct fruits of the sole education.

It is like that of religion.

Whoever said that a religion was necessary for the people spoke complete nonsense. Religion is necessary, education is necessary, a set of powerful brakes is necessary for the leaders of the people, for is advisors, its chiefs, due to the very function of direction and restraint that they are called to keep from it: if the passions of the human beast are to be feared for all, it will be to dread in the proportion that the beast will play with stronger powers and will be able to devastate a more extended field of action.

All liberty is not suitable in every State; each State depends on its historic antecedents and its geographic position like each man on his ancestors and his country. Salutory and tutelary dependencies, since they gave life, sustain it, and conserve it, and whoever rejects it, dies. Liberty

varies with time and place, but this is no State which can last without a sovereign authority.

Therefore, if we want to speak with exactitude, it is not liberty which is general and necessary, an ecumenical, basic, and human right; it is authority.

The Exercise of Authority The property of power resembles other properties; it results from work, from work done and “done well”. Totally naked force can be applied for good and for evil, for construction, for destruction. When it did the good, when it constructed, it has merit from it, it has prestige and glory from it, it also sees the birth from it of this product which is called authority.

A power vacuum resembles the vacancy of a field. Whoever wants it, takes it; whoever is able to, holds onto it.

When there is a power vacuum it is, as Joan of Arc said, a great pity for the kingdom. And it is a great misfortune. To seize power in that case, if one has the strength, is simply an act of charity and humanity. A people needs a leader like a man needs bread. Not only, in such a hypothetical situation, is the right of first occupancy established, but there is a rigorous duty, a strict obligation for those who *can* occupy. When citizens are threatened by the enemy, it is necessary to command them if one can do it. When disorder is in the street, it is necessary to restore it back to order if one has the means.

Power is not an idea, it is a fact, and one believes in this fact when it makes itself felt; all criticism by the world can do nothing against the strength of a conqueror.

Most moralizers, who have confused minds, judged that power corrupted the heart of man. When power is elevated and lasts, when it lasts a little, the effect is totally the opposite; the learning of responsibilities matures and their experience perfects, rather than ruins, them.

Posted on 2012-10-21 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-02 at 15:02 said:

Here is an interview deBenoist gave where he discusses Maurras in depth.

A case could be made from an Evolian perspective that Maurras did not go back far enough i.e. he defended l'ancien regime while forgetting that the actions of the French monarchy against the empire and papacy are what began the slide to destruction. Evola did say that the French monarchy brought on their own doom by their absolutist, anti-feudal and anti-Empire policies.

Dante was also opposed to the entire Capetian house and saw them as nearly usurpers. (see Purgatorio)

Does anyone know if Evola actually wrote about Maurras ?

Cologero on 2012-11-02 at 22:22 said:

I don't have time myself to find that passage. Where did Evola write that "the actions of the French monarchy against the empire and papacy are what began the slide to destruction"? Then we will be in a position to discuss it.

When specifically did those actions occur? I will be making a case soon that the "ancien regime" defined Feudal society through its understanding of the tri-functional division of society as pointed out by Dumézil. If the monarchy rebelled against the spiritual authority at some point then, yes, that would be indicative of the "degeneration of castes". However, I just translated a text where Maurras explicitly said that the temporal leaders were to undergo a religious education (i.e., the spiritual authority).

Evola did say that he believed what well-bred men believed to be healthy and normal prior to the French Revolution, i.e., the "ancien regime". That is the motivation behind the Maurras translations, viz., to highlight those healthy and normal beliefs.

Given this, I think Benoist's case falls apart.

I have just one complete article by Evola on Maurras from *La Vita Italiana*: "The defeat and future of France according to Action Française". I'll try to get it translated before the end of the year.

In other books, there are some references in passing . I'll gather them together at some point in the near future.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-03 at 01:47 said:

1. I foolishly forgot to post the link to the interview, here it is

http://www.alaindebenoist.com/pdf/entretien_charles_maurras.pdf

2. Evola's anti French remarks are all throughout part II of *Revolt against the Modern World*. He specifically attacks Phillipe IV's attack of Pope Boniface VIII, also Francois I warring with Emperor Charles to the point of even allying with the anti-Christian Turks, Cardinal Richelieu's

centralising policy which destroyed the independence of the local aristocracy, and then Louis XIV's continuing wars against Austria and the empire.

Also in *Men among the Ruins* Evola said Italy should move away from France and closer to Germany.

These are not my opinions, I am merely trying to provide Evola's thoughts as I understand them.

Cologero on 2012-11-04 at 11:23 said:

Yes, Jason-Adam, that is the interview that "inspired" the series on Maurras. Unfortunately, there are too many elements for a comment box: the diverse views of Maurras, Evola, and Benoist himself, not to mention the view from Tradition.

As you point out, discrete historical events over the course of centuries can be pointed out, as Evola did. Or else, we can look at these events from the point of view of Tradition: which were informed by a sense of order, and which by an opposition to order. To make things manageable, we therefore reject out of hand the notion of an "Evolian" critique; we are only concerned about the critique of Tradition.

Specifically, then, a fundamental point is the degeneration of castes: how do Evola and Maurras see that. Of course, Evola was explicit about that, and he did not see the "ancien regime" as disordered; quite to the contrary, as we have pointed out numerous times, Evola himself claimed his views were in harmony with those of well-bred men of that ancien regime. I would say the same for Maurras.

Benoist, on the other hand, rejects outright that regime, placing himself in opposition both to Evola and Maurras.

You do point out an important difference between Evola and Maurras, viz., their relationship to German thought. The latter was appalled by it. Maurras actually proposed a sort of greater Romanity, among all the nations speaking Romance languages. Hence, he hoped for a closer cooperation between France and Italy, leaving Germany out of it. Maurras saw a direct line from Athens to Rome to Paris. Evola, on the other hand, was obsessed with Germany and its philosophers.

So what next?

P.S. To those who don't read French: that interview is by a living writer under copyright protection; otherwise I would make it available in English for you.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-04 at 22:13 said:

Our discussion has reached an important highmark – Evola and Maurras are agreed upon which system of rule is best. We can also agree that restoring l'ancien regime, if it could be done, would result in restoring the Traditional form of western society. The major difference between Evola and Maurass is indeed the nature of Germany.

The question I have now is : on the matter of Germany and German philosophy, who is correct – Evola or Maurras ?

Cologero on 2012-11-04 at 23:52 said:

Coincidentally, I have a post planned on German philosophy for mid-week. Ironically, Maurras ended up liking the Germans a bit too much, and that cost him his reputation and his freedom after WW II.

There is an important difference, also, in fundamental orientation. Evola and Maurras were both pagans enamoured of ancient Greece and Rome—although Maurras was more influenced by its classical aspects—and both had high regard for the Medieval period. Evola accepted Tradition as a metaphysical, supra-historical, given. Maurras was a Positivist and historian; his view of tradition was simply as an historical reality and his understanding of it came indirectly from his knowledge of Catholic France.

Logres on 2012-11-04 at 15:39 said:

<http://distributistreview.com/mag/2012/08/lord-acton-tends-to-o-corrupt/>

Lord Acton's dictum has lead to a great deal of mischief in the Anglo ghetto.

Cologero on 2012-11-05 at 13:19 said:

Judging from personal correspondence, there seems to be some confusion about this section. They seem to think that this is a justification for "fascism". I responded that to me, it seems descriptive, not prescriptive. Actually, it can be read as the program for revolution as we wrote about recently. Revolutionary forces deliberately provoke public disorder precisely in order to create a power vacuum which they will attempt to fill. Since the public prefers order to chaos, they are usually welcomed ... at first.

In the light of the previous section, remember that Maurras insisted that the temporal powers needed to be under the influence of religion. This is not true of modernity, following the American, French, and Russian revolutions which were overtly anti-religion to various degrees. That people who consider themselves pious or spiritual would favor modernity over the traditional thinkers who acknowledge the priority of the spiritual over the temporal, absolutely baffles me. They believe that modernity is the only "loving" and sane system.

This should also be read in the context of the "Social Contract" theories. Obviously, Maurras cannot accept that. The social contract theorists postulate that free individuals gather together to work out the mechanisms of power in their social group. Clearly that is not consistent with Maurras' understanding, since he claims that some group will assert power rather than wait for a social contract. The contract theorists presume the individual is supreme, whereas the traditional view is that society is prior to the individual.

Dominion on 2012-11-05 at 13:56 said:

It should be noted, though, that not all religions are equal in this regard. Many people who subscribe to some religious principle or order have felt themselves justified to do great damage to their societies and others, to destroy a Traditional order and heritage (Ansar Dine in the great city of Timbuktu), and so on. If the religion is not grounded in Truth, then it can be as destructive as any "atheist Stalinist."

The social contract can also be read in terms of different groups in society coming together, which is far closer to the way things really work (force isn't discounted). Preferably, the 'contract' would then allow each member of each group the best way to self-development in their respective contexts and according to their abilities.

5.6 Principle V: Freedom

Freedom is not at the beginning, but at the end. It is not at the root, but in the flowers and the fruits of human nature or, better said, human virtue. A man is freer in the proportion that he is better. This evolution is necessary. Our men believed they credited themselves with the prize of the effort by a Declaration of their famous rights, by displaying in their city halls and their schools, in their ministries and churches that that prize is acquired without effort. But to display everywhere that that everyone is born a millionaire, would everyone earn a shadow of a million?

Will you say that it is a right to freedom? The right to the million would not be more futile.

Freedom, a metaphysical principle, is one thing: freedoms are something else. The will of the people, the sum of individual wills, is one thing; the general will, the expression of the general interest of a nation, a race, a country is another thing, totally different.

The freedom of the crowd is called folly, that of a stupid person, stupidity, that of the crook, crime, that of the traitor, treason, and so forth. To say that freedoms limit each other is totally correct in the savage state or the state of anarchy: that simply means that the strong oppress or ex-

ploit the weak as long as the weak do not revolt against the strong and that potential victims did not find a sure process to snipe at and strafe their tormenters at will. Freedom conceived as regime or as principle, is a generally painful chaos.

Citizens who have reflected a little therefore do not let themselves be intimidated by the effects of words. They define freedom as a power or a force, a force or power that is worth what its subjects and its object are worth. The eternal ridicule of the 18th and 19th century consists in taking freedom for a rule or for a goal when it is only a means or the material.

Freedom lives in few men.

Whoever says real freedom says authority. Testamentary freedom creates the authority of the head of the family. Communal or provincial freedom creates the real power of the social authorities who live and reside in the place. Religious freedom recognizes the authority of spiritual laws and the internal hierarchy of a religion. Trade union and professional freedom devotes the authority of the disciplines and rules to the interior of corporations and professional organizations.

These are the observable facts.

If, however, in place of observing, one withdraws into himself to reflect, he realizes that the very nature of positive freedom—that which is not conceived by the relationship to an obstacle to surmount—freedom is the power.

Social issues are exercised in society and have as their point of application not marble, as the power of a sculptor, nor the machine, as the power of a mechanic, but by men engaged with us in social life.

What then is a freedom? A power.

Whoever can do nothing at all is not free at all. Whoever can do rather poorly is poorly free. Whoever can do infinitely is also infinitely free. One of the forms of power is wealth. Another of its forms is influence, it is physical force, it is intellectual and moral force. On what are these various powers exercised in various ways? On men. And that power, to whom

does it belong? To men. When human freedom is found at its highest point and it met human objects to which to apply and impose itself, what name does it take? Authority. An authority is therefore only a freedom reaching its perfection.

Far from the idea that authority contradicts the idea of freedom, it is, on the contrary, its completion and complement. The freedom of a father of a family is an authority. The freedom of a religious confession is an authority. There are still the authorities as freedom of an association, the freedom of a commune, of a given province.

When one wishes that the State respects private initiative in the economic order, one fundamentally demands that it respects what Le Play named with a beautiful expression: the social authorities. All real freedoms, defined and practical, are of authorities. Freedom opposed to authority; freedom which consists in not being *affected* by others, but also to not *affect* them, that neutral freedom is not compatible with nature nor with the order of life.

Posted on 2012-11-11 by Cologero

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Cologero on 2012-11-11 at 19:05 said:

Once again, the intent of this piece is a counter-argument to Rousseau's claim that "men are born free". On the contrary, Maurras asserts that freedom is an achievement, that it comes with maturity. Ironically, Maurras is close to Fichte's claim that a man is free to the extent that he can submit to the laws of Reason. The relationship between freedom and authority brings to mind Evola's claim that only the king can be said to be totally free.

Avery on 2012-11-11 at 23:39 said:

It appears that by restating freedom as a product of power, rather than something necessarily tied up with the kshatriya revolt, Maurras corrects Rousseau better than the Perennialists do, and is rewarded with a definition more meaningful both for historical societies and modern political purposes.

The Roman Senators were always "free" to believe and do what they wanted, and "freemen" or franklins had their power recognized even in the most Traditional society.

5.7 Principle VI: Rights and Laws

I always believed that the privilege of rights also represents the privilege of duties.

The experience of the nature of things established that the domain of common law is very limited and that there is, on the contrary, a multitude of private rights. Each group of men, which has its distinctive life, deserves a distinctive treatment. Whoever “favors” himself wants to be treated for his own benefit, and when this wish is not granted, the subject suffers, first of all, in the body which he is a part of, and secondarily in himself, due to the disrepute and the slackening which, by all necessity, affects that body.

Right, in order to be imposed and even to subsist, requires that it be exercised, that it be sustained, that it be published. It presupposes activity or it fades, little by little, in the blood and ashes of massacred men and burnt buildings, then in the sublime cold of these empty spaces where the raised voice of the most passionate of the rhetors is going to die out.

That is what the rhetors will never understand. They spend their life personifying “the right”. But men of action and men of analysis ask themselves what this person without subject, this right without a living substrate, can be; in their turn, by not understanding the antithesis that lingers everywhere, this right that they oppose to force, this force that they want to make the opposite of the right! It makes as much sense to put the triangle and a color in opposition. There are colored triangles, there can be colors spread on triangular surfaces. I do not conceive a right that would be abstract, which would be separated from a moral or material person in whom it exists, and that is to say, from a force.

There is force, more or less strong, which is right; there is force, more or less strong, which is wrong. But a rational being who, without any force, would be the right or would have the right: that is what I cannot conceive.

The right, which needs force in order to be recognized, needs it even more in order to be.

Legal reasoning starts from the principles of the Just and the Unjust, its first notions already represent the second or the third power of a high abstraction, and its definitions, if extensive, are necessarily fluctuating when it is about adapting their generality to practical life: among the multitude of particular facts, often very different, and which sometimes contradict each other, the spirit is more or less inevitably induced to lose sight of the impersonal reasons to stop its choice or even to lead its attention. It is then that, for lack of impersonal reasons, others appear: the personal motive suddenly appears, active and vigilant, and the idea of the right no longer remains clarified and guided except by the idea of the "*me*", by this "*me*" which is not without rights, but which claims to have them all and which instinctively steers the processes of thought towards its sole interest, sometimes understood in a tyrannical sense but always, to some degree, unconcerned with a good order, unconsciously favorable to some anarchy.

May the heavens protect me from saying that the Right leads to anarchy, he who wants, on the contrary, to rule it and pacify it! But he is a born warrior. In my opinion, the preference given to the legal method over the empirical method must belong to flourishing societies, strongly based on the principles which erupt from all sides and are obeyed by everyone.

Separate man from his family, his nation, his trade, tell him that he is king, tell him that he is God, and intoxicate him with the idea of Justice, you will see from what heart he will count the wrongs which will be done to him and what will be able to be his leniencies for the wrongs that he will come to do to others! This judge is too partial, a party too interested and too impassioned for it to be reasonable of him to remand theoretically all litigation. The one who recognizes all rights begins by imposing on the entire world all duties, without forgetting the penalties which correspond to all negligence.

That is the true folly of revolutionary individualism, whether it is political, social, or moral. It is impossible that an animal as sensible, as sad, as vulnerable as man, once placed on the interior altar that the dogmatic liberal erects on him, does not believe, nine times out of ten, himself to be the creditor of his fellow men and of the universe, in the place that the most miserable is on the contrary their debtor to the infinite!

This illusion of the creditor on society can only be only encouraged by the absurd metaphysics of Rights.

Clarifications on the Nature of Law According to a venerable [the Middle Ages] maxim⁷, the law is made by the action of the sovereign (*constitutione regis*) and by the acceptance of the subject (*consensus populi*). Without doubt our jurists poorly translate these words. They figure that consensus, this must be understood as the agreement of fact, as noisy as the acclamation which follows the coronation of kings, as the simple approving whisper which Homer had follow the word of the leaders, *Epeythymesan axaioi*. But, in the great majority of cases, in the case on which we do not make little stories about, the agreement consists in the fact of raising no important contradiction, of understanding, of carrying out.

To go on to say: “Mister Subject, here is a law that will legally bind you. Do you really want it? Are you sure you want it? We need your signature,” that is exactly to want to inspire him to say “no”, to argue endlessly in order not to agree. The hatred of the new and the spirit of contradiction are so strong in men that we do not put the public good at their mercy.

Yet it remains true that the law must be made to be easily obeyed. A law must be acceptable. The law is not the law when its pronouncement suffices to provoke the people to fear it. It needs a natural and prompt consent.

⁷From the Middle Ages: *lex consensus populi et constitutione regis fit*.

The party which attacks a law which no one defends can be wrong or right, that is not the question: the author of such a law will not have less committed that political fault of not waiting for the best conditions and most favorable arrangements of the public spirit. Its law is only a decree of a state of siege that it will have to support, arms in hand, without having the right to complain or be surprised.

The spirit of modern laws is far from the spirit of the laws which govern the deeds of real life, and these real deeds, unable to worry about the scraps of paper which distort them or the spider which weaves its web in the legislative mind, continued to develop following the weights, measures, and numbers which compose them.

It is said: "But the deed can be the crime! The deed can be the atrocity! The deed can be the error!"

Definitely: realistic politics and morals do not provide bare facts and beliefs as the types and models of life. But they recommend two points:

First of all, to consider laws depending on which real deeds are chained, for if deeds can be vicious or criminal, the laws of vice and crime are not; the order of causes and effects which preside over realities themselves flawed are not the least flawed in the world, it is even excellent to know and to calculate, knowledge and calculation which alone permit action.

Secondly, action has the chance to be serious and useful only on the condition of aiming for a definite and just goal. It is neither sufficient to have an "ideal" in mind, nor to make a second-rate idea of "right" and "duty": this moralism, this legalism, this idealism must conform to the ideal, moral, and legal truth. In other words, it is first necessary to be right.

A false idea is a false idea. The will to impose on the world under the pretext that the world must be governed by ideas is an absurd pretence whose application will be forcibly criminal or fatal. Ideas are not equal to each other. All the claimed rights are not valuable. And not all ways of arranging mores are worthy of respect. The modern error comes from that sudden assimilation of contrary systems dreamed by the human mind. It

is definitely an easy error for orators and litigants. It allows the latter to support all causes. It lets the former please all audiences. But the people who trust in them pay the price.

Posted on 2012-11-18 by Cologero

* * *

Avery Morrow on 2012-11-20 at 05:17 said:

Although it's written as a general principle, I've found that this is an extremely pertinent post in the light of the current Israel-Hamas war (where a lot of claims of one side being "in the right" are being thrown around), and every time I quote it people get very confused.

5.8 Principle VII: Property

Property is the natural safeguard of man, an industrious animal still more than reasonable, for whom his needs, his weakness, the dissatisfaction that he brings from the cradle make a narrow duty of transforming what surrounds him. Pascal is wrong to scoff at those poor children who say: this coin is mine.

One would not say "me", without saying "mine". Without property, man is condemned to death.

To possess is to command, it is to dispose of oneself, it is to be able to resist others, it is to exercise an influence, were it only by reaction.

Property emancipates existence and confers an authority at least on the goods of the earth and the fruits of labor.

Posted on 2012-12-02 by Cologero

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Jason-Adam on 2012-12-03 at 17:57 said:

Very direct and to the point.

It does create a dilemma for those "Traditionalists" so-called who see hope in communism.

Saladin on 2012-12-03 at 19:14 said:

lol! "Traditionalists who see hope in communism"!!! You must be joking, right?

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-03 at 19:34 said:

I wish I were but I am not...

There are men who claim to be both followers of Rene Guenon and Karl Marx. Alexandr Dugin's writings are a prime example of this tendency....

The person who first introduced me to Baron Evola's books was a National Communist....

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-03 at 19:37 said:

Read this to see how Dugin tries to mix Evolian-ism with Marxism.

<http://against-postmodern.org/section-iv-mission-julius-evola>

I can only imagine what the Baron would say if he could read this....

More and more, I am starting to see Dugin as the prophesied counter-initiation that Guenon mentioned in *Reign of Quantity*....

Cologero on 2012-12-03 at 21:02 said:

It seems that a lingering affection for communism is the equivalent to the Stockholm syndrome⁸ for some Russian intellectuals. Another we can mention is Israel Shamir.

Without property, man is a slave to the state. Even Medieval peasants had their land and couldn't be evicted by bankers or tax collectors. A Romanian friend has told me tales about life under communism. For example, the authorities deemed that his grandmother had more house than she needed. So they took over some of its rooms and moved in another family and a retired military man. She had no say in the matter.

Dominion on 2012-12-04 at 00:43 said:

The right to property is fundamental in order to preserve the ability to attain freedom (the Traditionalist notes, of course, that it is not freedom in and of itself, as the American right would have us believe). However, the right is not absolute. The banker or corporate shark who exploits the worker and nation cannot hide behind his right to property when the State exercises its own rightful duty to uphold Justice.

⁸http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Stockholm_syndrome

On the topic of communism, two important points must be made: first, that "communism" is many times used as an umbrella term to describe varying and contradictory elements, making it very much the equivalent of the "fascist" epithet. Second, that the way in which certain Traditionalists view "socialism" (that is to say, a society in which the worker has some sort of democratic control over capital and where the State advances these reforms) as being far from antithetical to the aims of Tradition is far more nuanced than some seem to think. The best criticism I have heard from these branches is that the exploited worker is viewed as a mere unit of production; socialism's aim is to view the worker as a human being whose work cannot be separated from his inner development. Thus, a socialism which allows workers democratic control over capital is necessary in order to allow the worker to develop his various mental and spiritual capacities.

With regards to the exoteric institutions of Tradition, many movements today which can be called "socialist" have moved in this direction, or at least have the potential to be educated towards this framework. One example is the Russian Communist Party today, which supports the Orthodox Church being a foundation stone of Russia, and aims to maintain social systems which view the family as a social good and unit, such as the public kindergarten system. It also wants to maintain small and medium sized businesses, which is not so distant from the distributist view of property's role. Dugin's fourth political theory is useful in that, using Being as its basis, it takes what is useful from the previous theories, including socialism. But what is base must be made subtle; what is made from the dust of the so-called enlightenment must be baptized in the water which brings true enlightenment. Be it property and the market, socialism and the worker, or the fasces and the authority of the State, this will need to be done in order to build an order in which the values of Tradition are embodied.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-04 at 02:54 said:

Cologero is correct on the need for all persons to be property owners. Property is the basis of an individual life as Maurras articulately said above....

I often wondered myself why Russians like Dugin who were victims of Communist repression suddenly turned nostalgic for the USSR....

Do you think though there's any merit in the argument that since the USSR fell before the USA it was therefore not as degenerated ?

Saladin on 2012-12-04 at 19:59 said:

I am only vaguely familiar with Dugin. His Geopolitics is certainly interesting. Tradition has no use for Communism, and communism is totally opposed to Tradition. As Cologero said "without property, man is a slave to the state." There has never been a Tradition that has not protected the concept of Private Property.

Saladin on 2012-12-04 at 20:06 said:

Thanks for the link Jason! Dugin suggests that we read Evola "from the Left"! That explains a lot! He clearly has his own reading of Tradition but I completely agree with Cologero that this may be a bit of Stockholm Syndrome and definitely not "the prophesied counter-initiation" figure.

5.9 Principle VIII: Heredity

Where there is no vision, the people perish: but he that keeps the law, happy is he.

PROVERBS 29:18

In this insightful section, Maurras shows the importance of heredity, both in regard to progeny, but also with respect to the transmission of the "fruits" of a society through its bloodline. He points out that it is the society of those with faith who are most likely to understand this, and that it is due to God's very law: Be fruitful and multiply. Those angst-filled existentialists can fulfill this task only paradoxically by making it a sacred task. As faith declines, men see no need to preserve and pass on their heritage.

Nature proceeds most commonly by imitation and repetition: but it also has innovations, caprices, initiatives. In that case it acts with an extreme vigor.

When it lets a soldier be born in the house of peaceable magistrates, or a marine in the descent of wine growers, the new vocation is marked rather strongly, it is served by a rather firm will so that all resistances are broken. But these resistances, these difficulties have some good. These hardships are natural tests, letting the predestined strong pass, but rejecting the others in the hereditary condition most suitable to them, because nature assures them defense and protection.

As the means of action towards a future, heredity is the most direct and the simplest of all.

Its general utility results from the destiny of the generator gifted with reason, who reproduces himself before dying.

Human life would be shamefully short if nature had not furnished societies with a procedure that transmits the fruits of its works through the blood.

The impersonal passion, whose deposit man holds, acts only through him in order to get to others, but delegates to the children which he procreates a power over the goods that he likewise procreated, very often for them. The inert posterity which comes from his hand will be vivified by his living posterity. When his great sons begin to enrich his heritage, all workers a little amorous of his work feel with some truth that he is going to conquer death twice. The power of bequeathing his remains gives to the activity of a well-filled life the highest natural laurels.

Let us note that the Christian societies of the Middle Age, penetrated by the supernatural sentiment of a future life, always proved themselves extremely sensitive to the terrestrial reward of the father in his sons. They sang, with all their soul, "Abraham et semini ejus in secula" ["to Abraham and to his sons forever"].

Our different royal or imperial races arise out of nations fervently convinced of the reality of the kingdom of heaven: how would less believing peoples pay less attention to the carnal wish of hereditary duration? It is their only defense against time; they have only that anchor to throw on the abyss of the future. In a pinch, hereditary ambitions should have weakened through a sudden flight of celestial hopes; would the opposite be understood?

We can reason this way:

If some God hidden in the secret of hearts or soaring on the interplanetary abyss assists, immobile and mute, ardent and all powerful, the development of the efforts of humanity, it is His own law that He con-

firms in things and men; He can only bless its increased effects.

But if the spaces are empty and if the human heart is itself not assisted by any “internal consolation”, all the happiness of the being and all the benefits of life appear more exposed to the erosion of time and the blow of death, their tradition, their transmission then seems more precious in its solitary immensity to perpetual destitution. All means of saving or prolonging the shaky personal effort becomes more sacred perhaps! The thought threatened is attached more closely to the philosophy of order and the knowledge of the laws of its preservation. Should this order succumb, the believers keep refuge in the divine City: he who no longer believes undergoes the catastrophe of everything that his dream vied with death.

Posted on 2012-12-09 by Cologero

5.10 Principle IX: The Duty of Heritage

In this particularly beautiful passage, Maurras explains the duty of one generation to pass on its culture, customs, and traditions to the next, which in turn, has the duty to accept and develop that heritage. The loss of one’s traditions needs to be taken at least as seriously as the attention we pay today to the possible extinction of various fishes and insects. Unfortunately, the youth of today are the new disinherited, since their fathers have passed on little except a hatred for their own past. How that plays out is uncertain, unless and until they rise up to reclaim what is rightfully theirs.

In order to justify what common sense and custom maintain by force, let us not talk about rights, but instead duty.

The duty to bequeath and make a will.

The duty to inherit.

Those who are called disinherited or proletarian are sometimes understood to be preaching that that is not just in their point of view. That is just and beneficial for everyone.

The good that is established in a natural or legal family can have doubtful sources: it is redeemed and moralized by its fixity, by the firm benefit that it establishes around itself in stabilizing the conditions of life, in distributing work, in securing it, in preparing a point of solid support to the generations to come.

There is no difference between the damages caused to nature by the death of a beautiful animal, followed by the return of its elements to the universal dust, and the destruction of an ordinary fortune to the death of its creator.

There is a dead loss for society as for nature, the obligation to take up again a long and painful task.

Prosperous social organisations are those that prevent these realities from dissolving into the void and which help to keep them from a total death: these purveyors of life, being the born-enemies of destruction, made a respected institution from its heritage, and, one could say, a type of sacrament from its legacy.

Posted on 2012-12-16 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-16 at 21:27 said:

Truly beautiful indeed. The West is in dire straits as even the descendents of the former elite are losing their ancestral heritage.....and instead of rising up to reclaim what is ours, too many faux traditionalists look to another culture....

5.II Principle X: Tradition

Maurras concludes his list of fundamental principles with Tradition. This will be a disappointment to those who want to reduce

everything to the rational, since traditional is beyond that. It is tied, as he says, to “blood and soil”, that is, one’s ancestors and the heritage they bequeathed. The deracinated modern mind is limited by the idea, the simulacra of the “proposition” nation.

Yet, tradition is not blind. Its successes serve as the paradigm for the future, its failures as lessons to be learned; there is no point to perpetuate errors. This is a living tradition, not stuck in the past through inertia. A true Tradition is never lost, it is only hidden. If it had one starting point, it can have a second. It will be anew only by men who know who they are.

Tradition means handing down.

Tradition gathers the forces of blood and soil. It is retained even when leaving one’s country, as an eternal temptation to return to it.

True tradition is critical, and for lack of its distinctions, the past is no longer of use for anything, its successes stop being models, its setbacks stop being lessons.

In all tradition, as in all heritage, a reasonable being deducts and must deduct the liabilities.

Tradition is not inertia, its opposite; heritage is not nepotism, its counterfeit.

All traditions had a beginning and the sentiments of monarchistic fidelity, if they rise up very high, do not do so indefinitely: what began can begin again; what had one point of departure can find a second.

The opposition between reason and tradition, which is the same as the antithesis of reality and the idea, or art and nature, and that can be assimilated to the opposition of vinegar and oil, the sweet and the bitter, the fluid and the solid, in a cosmogony of infant peoples.

Posted on 2012-12-23 by Cologero

* * *

White Stag Knight on 2012-12-23 at 11:31 said:

Maurras, must be handled delicately and with dialectic quasi-Rabbinic intellectualism of finesse. He was not condemned by Catholicism without reason. He cannot be the center of our Right Hand Path counter-revolution. He can be but a source of truths to be mined, but no Doctor.

The nationalism of Maurras, in fact, signified in one sense the miasma of international European aristocracy and the fragmentation of Christendom.

We aim to resurrect the Holy Roman Imperium of Christ Rex.

No single nation can exist in self-deifying separatism and claim special privileges.

The Empire is Universal.

Cologero on 2012-12-23 at 12:32 said:

Obviously, White Knight, we can't disagree with you. However, using his own standard, if we add Maurras' assets and deduct his liabilities, we are still in the black. My prime motivation has been this: to show that a pagan non-theist relying on positive science can still discern Tradition. That is because the Logos is made visible in creation. There are many men today in that position who would still nevertheless want to align with Tradition. Maurras shows that honest science does not necessarily have that corrosive effect assumed by the anti-Tradition.

His hyper-nationalism is not the ultimate reality, but remember that the Empire does not deny nor annihilate nationhood. At one point, there was a group around Maurras that floated the idea of an alliance of the Latin-speaking nations. That would have been a start toward reunifying the ecumene. Had that materialized, the role of Romania would have been important in uniting the East and the West.

Dominion on 2012-12-23 at 14:46 said:

Thank you so much for translating this work. I'm beginning to think it would be worth it to learn French simply to read the originals. Seeing as the Action Francaise was of a royalist nature, perhaps there is room here for an article comparing Maurras' view of the royal vs the religious spheres in the social order with those of Evola and Guenon? I would guess that he would approximate Evola to a greater degree, having the Church being more subject to the King, but if there is one thing I have learned from these principles it is that he is not to be underestimated in his depth.

With regards to what you say about the role of nationhood in Tradition, I see the proper view more and more espoused in the "Identitaire" movement that is currently exploding over Europe. They hold the local (city and region), national, and European levels of identity as valid and complementary. I have found (observing it from a distance from across the pond) that there are many in that movement who are familiar with some Traditional works, Evola figuring large (with his shortcomings compared to Guenon or some others causing some problems, admittedly).

Do you think a possibility exists of leading those who are open from a “mere” nationalism to one informed by Tradition?

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 00:38 said:

Cologero – can you provide some links in English or French explaining in more detail Maurras’ plan of reuniting the Latin nations ? I was unaware that he went beyond French nationalism and would like to read more on this.

Cologero on 2012-12-27 at 06:08 said:

Here is an overview: *L’union des latins*⁹.

In Maurras’ own words: *Les Forces latines*¹⁰.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 17:41 said:

Thank you, Sir. I’ve just read both and find myself in agreement with Maurras – one point he made that I never considered before is that the southern Catholic Germans are actually descended from Roman colonists, and the failed Holy Roman Empire was an attempt to Latinise the Germans. I’m finding myself in accord with his notion of Catholicism being part of the Latin race’s blood, his version of the continuation of Romanity rings truer than Evola’s idea of Germany being the successor to Roma.

⁹<http://maurras.net/2011/10/06/union-des-latins/>

¹⁰<http://maurras.net/textes/196.html>

Maurras' Short Articles

6.1 All Soul's Day

Around the second of November, I would like to avoid naming here the living, or rather to be concerned with them only insofar as they themselves are concerned with men who had already departed from life. A melancholy memory is not a simple dream, and nothing deep down is more useful to those who remain than the strong tenor of those who have left.

But perhaps it would be suitable, while on this subject, to make a distinction. There is the universal cult of the dead, of all the dead, of those who had existed, provided that they had belonged to the human race; and there is, closely related, the particular cult, more reserved, prouder, and, in my sense, more beneficial. That renders to the elite among the dead, those whom the positivists call, a little verbosely, "the great types of humanity", and the Catholics, more briefly, the "saints". The first of these cults presents a great drawback; in teaching us to venerate all of defunct humanity, it trains us logically to venerate, en bloc, all of living humanity, that is to say, to make us accept and even venerate the worse

faults that it commits even though we recognize them as much in ourselves as in our neighbours. The second cult shows the opposite benefit; by obliging us to hold the dead as our models, it forces us to select from among these scattered people, hence, indirectly, to make a critique of our own characters: by applying our minds to consider those great dead men, it opens us up to the way of personal exaltation and perfection.

The consequence is that human solidarity, to use that term, must belong much less to the crowd of our predecessors, than to the persons of the past who have realized, in a great way, the fine natural traits of man. Those who pass up the opportunity to serve their great memory, pass up an undoubted opportunity to help themselves, to correct themselves, and to improve themselves.

That said, what to think of the cold and sad silence that has greeted these last few weeks—in the newspapers, in the reviews, everywhere finally where they pride themselves on their thought and style—the great news of the discovery of a newly published book of Bossuet? Regarding the second tract on the États d'oraison ("States of Prayer"), if it had taught nothing new of the opinions and sentiments of the illustrious bishop, if it had been only a sketch, a pale appendix to some known works, it still would have been necessary to honour in it, after two hundred years, some unheard contemplative words of a voice which fills the world. This indifference of the critics and the public, had, moreover, no excuse, and the six chapters published the other day in la Quinzaine by the fortunate author of the discovery, Abbot Levesque of Saint-Sulpice, was worthy of attention and of commentary for the same reason that *Relation sur le quietisme* ("Relation to quietism"), so fine, so piquant and solid, especially because of the first tract of États d'oraison whose eloquence equals the power of the ideas.

The honour of our times will have been to render to Bossuet his rightful place. We have displaced him from it. First, by literary rancour: reread Paul Albert and the other critics of romanticism, and you will see how

much this great man baffles them. It is that, if it is not right, at least it is possible to contend that a Jean Racine or a Jean de La Fontaine have united a marvellous vigour to their supreme perfection: to deceive the inane, or perhaps by innate taste in reserve, these two poets have disguised their strength under elegance and grace. But this force bursts out divinely in Bossuet. I do not know which imagination was more powerful than his or more allied, for example, to that of Homer; he joins to it a sentiment, an almost dramatic passion: nevertheless, order is never weakened in him. It is not necessary to be astonished if true strength is naturally harmonious and there is always something weak or morbid, even vertiginous, in disorder. The most fanciful of men—Plato, Aristophanes—were the most reasonable, the most sensible, and the finest.

After the romantics, Bossuet bored Renan. Pardon the word, let us rather not apply it to the person of Renan, but to the adjuncts, the dependants, if you like, to the low offices of this illustrious writer: there were in him some parts corrupted by Hegelianism. Bossuet's unswerving logic resisted it. I imagine that it would still resist it if, by some miracle, Bossuet returned among us. Everything that the Germans said against the principles of reason is something confused. They always mixed the orders. All the same, in a superior order, our reason would be defective, there remains an order, the human order, where, in spite of all, it exercises itself supremely. That is what the author of *La Synthèse subjective* discerned with true genius. The influence of Comte has led the wise public back to Bossuet; as for those who don't have time for reflection, the fortunate intervention of Mr. Brunetière produced around the same time the same happy effect.

So that the most harmonious of men is admired with unanimity.

The silence maintained on the new treasure added to the old treasure by M. Levesque is therefore doubly inexplicable. From where I am writing, I can, by turning a little, see the complete set of Bossuet's books stacked up on the shelves familiar to me, and I have on this table, the His-

toire des Variations, that I can open at my liking, assured of meeting in it the perfection of life from its first pages. Nevertheless, I would not know how to compare for its vivacity, the beautiful freshness of pleasure, that emotion already old to the emotion that the newly discovered chapters have given me.

A statue recently pulled out of the ground, even from an inferior age, touches and moves for an instant with more force than the most beautiful things known. Judge if chance brings to daylight a masterpiece from Phidias' school! We have here a masterpiece from Phidias himself. Space is lacking to justify my sentiment in regard to the profound and subtle ideas exposed in the second tract of the *États d'oraison*. But I am sure that we will tremble at the simple sound of the eloquence, its rhythm, and its performance.

In the chapter *Que la foi se perd dans l'incompréhensibilité de Dieu* ("Faith is lost in the incomprehensibility of God"):

It is a doctrine common among the holy Fathers and among theologians, mystical as well as scholastic, that we know God by negation rather than by affirmation; that is to say, that we know well what he is not, but we do not know what he is: so, in order to reach the lofty knowledge of the Divine Being, it is necessary to reject all our ideas and form our consciousness a little closer to the way we form a statue, by removing, from the marble from which it is formed, first one piece and then another, because it is the analogy which they use following the author of the Divine Names. So, they say, in order to know God, it is necessary to deny, in a certain sense, everything that we think of Him and everything that we say about Him, not as false, for it would be an impiety and an atheism to deny that God is holy, eternal, almighty, the "I Am", Father, Son, and Holy Spirit, and, in these three persons, one God: we don't deny, therefore, these things as false, not pleasing to God! But we reject them in some fashion as still poorly proportionate and suitable to the immense perfection of the Di-

vine Being: so that whatever effort that we make to know Him well, however sublime are the ideas that are presented to our spirits or the thoughts that we try to form from them, we deny that they are equal to his high and impenetrable majesty.

In the chapter *Theology and contemplation of saint Augustine*:

But among the Fathers where this divine theology seems to me the most highly expressed, it is St. Augustine where he says to God: "I sought you outside, and you were within, I found you there without your entering by any of my senses. You didn't come there with colours or exquisite tastes; you didn't run there with odours or with pleasant sounds and chants. If you are a light, you are a light without a cloud, without sunset, and without body: you are nothing that I see, that I touch, that I sense, that I imagine in my mind, of that which I am: for my spirit, my mind, which is what I find most excellent in myself, learns, unlearns, forgets, loves certain things and then is disgusted by them; and God is not all that because He never changes. In rejecting, then, all those things and all those sense images, and opening only the eyes of the soul, it sees in itself, without any form, a justice which judges it and which it judges not, but by which it judges everything; a truth that slips away, for as little can one come near the sense of it as to touch it.

That is only a translation, a summary, a paraphrase; and genius breaks out in each word. Bossuet, moreover, excels in summaries. And he is perhaps the only classical Christian among whom the crudest citations of the Bible and of the Fathers, even though extremely numerous, do not subsequently result in a blemish in style. He establishes and transforms everything. His example can let us judge the value of modern theories of invention and originality.

But let us cite once more, a single sentence that ends on a charming inflexion: Faith makes it known to the soul that it is made in the image

and likeness of God; this links two things: one, that it is pleased to gather its thoughts to contemplate in them the image of God; the other, that it can not stop in itself, but it is gently attracted and elevated to God, of whom it is the beautiful and living image. Yet, it is a mistake to blame oneself for admiring similar things in Bossuet. His spirit is too far above the sentences thus sketched out! But strength consists in finding the whole in its least objects and, thereby, according to a view loved by Hugo, even the small appears great.

From “Barbarie et Poésie”, originally published in *Revue Encyclopédique*,
October 31, 1896.

6.2 Remembering the Dead

This translation of Charles Maurras’ *All Soul’s Day*¹ originally appeared in Taki’s Magazine².

On **All Soul’s Day**, we honor the memory of the dead, especially those closest to us in our hearts and mind. **Charles Maurras** refers to this as “the universal cult of the dead, of all the dead, of those who had existed, provided that they had belonged to the human race”; this is a subjective memory. Although it is praiseworthy to remember our ancestors, Maurras points out this drawback:

in teaching us to venerate all of defunct humanity, it trains us logically to venerate, en bloc, all of living humanity, that is to say, to make us accept and even venerate the worse faults that it commits even though we recognize them as much in ourselves as in our neighbours.

¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/library/AllSoulsDay.pdf>

²http://takimag.com/article/all_souls_day/

Alongside this, there is an objective memory in the sense that it is part of our experience and, therefore, quite real in the Positivist sense. Maurras describes this cult as:

more reserved, prouder, and, in my sense, more beneficial. That renders to the elite among the dead, those whom the positivists call, a little verbosely, “the great types of humanity”, and the Catholics, more tersely, the “saints”.

This form of remembrance has a certain benefit:

by obliging us to hold the dead as our models, it forces us to select from among these scattered people, hence, indirectly, to make a critique of our own characters: by applying our minds to consider those great dead men, it opens us up to the way of personal exaltation and perfection.

Maurras summarizes:

The consequence is that human solidarity, to use that term, must belong much less to the crowd of our predecessors, than to the persons of the past who have realized, in a great way, the fine natural traits of man. Those who pass up the opportunity to serve their great memory, pass up an undoubted opportunity to help themselves, to correct themselves, and to improve themselves.

Comte’s follower, **Antoine Baumann**, expands on this idea:

Humanity does not mean in any way the whole of men scattered among the living on this planet, nor the simple total of the living and the dead. It is only the group of men who have cooperated in the great human work, those who persist in us, whom we continue, those of whom we are the true debtors, the others being at

times only “parasites” or “producers of manure”. This large human elite is not a futile image. It forms what there is of the most real in us. We feel it as soon as we reach down to the secret of our nature. Subjects of mathematical and astronomical facts, subjects of physical facts, chemical facts and the facts of life, we are moreover subjects of special facts in the human family. We depend on our contemporaries. We depend even more on our predecessors. What thinks in us, before us, is the human language, which is not our personal work, but the work of humanity, it is also human reason which preceded us, which surrounds us and anticipates us; it is human civilisation in which a personal contribution, as powerful that it may be, is never but a molecule of a tiny energy in the drop of water added by our contemporaries in the current of this vast river. Actions, thoughts, or feelings, are products of the human soul: our personal soul is there almost for nothing. The true positivist repeats rather like Saint Paul: *in ea vivimus, move-mur et sumus* “in him we live, move and have our being”, and if he put his heart in harmony with his science and his faith, he can only add, in an act of adoration, the slightly modified words from the Psalmist: *Non nobis, Domine, non nobis, sed nomini tuo da gloriam!* “Not To Us O Lord Not To Us But To Your Name Give Glory”

Auguste Comte explains the objective reality of the **Great Being**:

The most important applications constantly derive from the theories formed in a simple scientific purpose and which often were cultivated during several centuries without producing any practical result. One can cite a very remarkable example of it in the beautiful speculations of Greek geometers on conic sections which, after a long series of generations, served, in determining the renovation of astronomy, to finally lead to the art of navigation to the degree that it attained in these days and to which it would never have appeared without the purely theoretical works of Archimedes and

Apollonius; so that Condorcet was able to say with reason in this matter: “The sailor whom an exact observation of longitude preserves from the shipwreck owes his life to a theory conceived two thousand years before, by men of genius who had in view simple geometric speculations.”

This is the time to bring to mind those “persons of the past” who have, over the course of time, built up the edifice of civilisation, not because they need it, but rather because we do. These persons are not always those who receive the most public adulation, which is often a mask for contemporary ideology. Instead, seek out the neglected and unknown, those whose ideas still live in the Great Being, though they may be suppressed in our time. The religious have their saints and mystics; the knights had the cult of the Nine Worthies³; Hermetists recall their own predecessors. There are forgotten men of genius who still affect our lives; do not neglect them.

Posted on 2010-11-01 by Cologero

³<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=331>

Other Translations

7.1 Eastern Wisdom and Western Knowledge

by **Ananda Coomaraswamy**

East and West, The Crisis of the Modern World, Introduction to the Study of Hindu Doctrine, and Man and His Becoming, Luzac, London, (1941-1946) are the first in a series in which the majority of **Rene Guenon's** works already published in French will appear in English. Another versions of *Man and His Becoming* had appeared earlier. M. Rene Guenon is not an "Orientalist" but what the Hindus would call a "master," formerly resident in Paris, and now for many years in Egypt, where his affiliations are Islamic. His *Introduction general à l'étude des doctrines hindoues* appeared in 1921. As a preliminary to his further expositions of the traditional philosophy, sometimes called the *Philosophia Perennis (et Universalis)* must be understood, for this "philosophy" has been the common inheritance of all mankind without exception), Guenon cleared the ground of all possible misconceptions in two large and rather tedious, but by no means unnecessary, volumes, *The Spiritist Fallacy* (a work for which **Bhagavad Gita**, XVII, 4, "Men of darkness are they who make a

cult of the departed and of spirits,” might have served as a motto), and *Theosophy, History of a Pseudo-Religion*.

These are followed by *Man and his Becoming according to the Vedanta* and *The Esoterism of Dante, The King of the World, St. Bernard, East and West* and *Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power, The Symbolism of the Cross, The Multiple States of Being*, and *Oriental Metaphysics*.

More recently Guenon has published in mimeographed, and subsequently printed, editions *The Reign of Quantity and the Sign of the Times*, and *The Principles of Infinitesimal Calculus*.

In the meantime important articles from Guenon’s pen appeared monthly in *La Voile d’Isis*, later *Études Traditionnelles*, a journal of which the appearance was interrupted by the war, but which has been continued as from September-October, 1945. *Études Traditionnelles* is devoted to “La Tradition Perpétuelle et Unanime, révélée tant par les dogmes et les rites des religions orthodoxes que par la langue universelle des symboles initiatiques”. The Perpetual and Unanimous Tradition, revealed as much by the dogmas and the rites of the orthodox religions as by the universal language of initiatory symbols. Of articles that have appeared elsewhere attention may be called to “Islamic Esoterism” in “Cahiers du Sud”. Excerpts from Guenon’s writings, with some comment, have appeared in ‘Triveni’ (1935) and in the *Visvabharati Quarterly* (1935, 1938).

A work by L. De Gaigneron entitled *Vers la connaissance interdite* is closely connected with Guenon’s; it is presented in the form of a discussion in which the Atman (Spiritus), Mentalité (“Reason”, in the current, not the Platonic, sense), and a Roman abbé take part; the “forbidden knowledge” is that of the gnosis which the modern Church and the rationalist alike reject, though for different reasons — the former because it cannot tolerate a point of view which considers Christianity only as one amongst other orthodox religions and the latter because, as a great Orientalist (Professor A. B. Keith) has remarked, “such knowledge, as is not empirical, is meaningless to us and should not be described as knowledge”

— an almost classical confession of the limitations of the “scientific” position. Guenon’s French is at once precise and limpid, and inevitably loses in translation; his subject matter is of absorbing interest, at least to anyone who cares for what Plato calls the really serious things. Nevertheless it has often been found unpalatable; partly for reason already given, but also for reasons that have already been stated, paradoxically enough, by a reviewer of Blakney’s Meister Eckhart in the ‘Harvard Divinity School Bulletin’, who says that, “To an age which believes in personality and personalism, the impersonality of mysticism is baffling; and to an age which is trying to quicken its insight into history the indifference of the mystics to events in time is disconcerting.” As for history, Guenon’s “he who cannot escape from the standpoint of temporal succession so as to see all things in their simultaneity is incapable of the least conception of the metaphysical order” adequately complements Jacob Boehme’s designation of the “history that was once brought to pass” as “merely the (outward) form of Christianity.” For the Hindu, the events of the Rgveda are nowever and dateless, and the Krishna Lila “not an historical event”; and the reliance of Christianity upon supposedly historical “facts” seems to be its greatest weakness.

The value of literary history for doxography is very little, and it is for this reason that so many orthodox Hindus have thought of Western scholarship as a “crime”: their interest is not in “what men have believed,” but in the truth. A further difficulty is presented by Guenon’s uncompromising language: “Western civilization is an anomaly, not to say a monstrosity.” Of this a reviewer has remarked that “such sweeping remarks cannot be shared even by critics of Western achievements..”

I should have thought that now that its denouement is before our eyes, the truth of such a statement might have been recognized by every unprejudiced European; at any rate Sir George Birdwood in 1915 described modern Western civilization as “Secular, joyless, inane, and self-destructive” and Professor La Piana has said that “What we call our civ-

ilization is but a murderous machine with no conscience and no ideals” and might well have said suicidal as well as murderous. It would be very easy to cite innumerable criticisms of the same kind; Sir S. Radhakrishnan holds for example, that “civilization is not worth saving if it continues on its present foundations,” and this it would be hard to deny; Professor A. N. Whitehead has spoke quite as forcibly — “There remains the show of civilization, without any of its realities.”

In any case, if we are to read Guenon at all, we must have outgrown the temporally provincial view that has for so long and so complacently envisaged a continuous progress of humanity culminating in the twentieth century and be willing at least to ask ourselves whether there has not been rather a continued decline, “from the stone until now,” as one of the most learned men in the U.S.A. once put it to me. It is not by “science” that we can be saved:

the possession of the sciences as a whole, if it does not include the best, will in some few cases aid but more often harm the owner.

We are obliged to admit that our European culture is a culture of the mind and senses only.

The prostitution of science may lead to world catastrophe.

Our dignity and our interests require that we shall be the directors and not the victims of technical and scientific advance.

Few will deny that the twentieth century thus far has brought us bitter disappointment.

We are now faced with the prospect of complete bankruptcy in every department of life.

Eric Gill speaks of the “monstrous inhumanity” of industrialism, and of the modern way of life, as “neither human nor normal nor Christian... . It is our way of thinking that is odd and unnatural.” This sense of frustration is perhaps the most encouraging sign of the times. We have laid

stress on these things because it is only to those who feel this frustration, and not to those who still believe in progress, that Guenon addresses himself; to those who are complacent everything that he has to say will seem to be preposterous.

The reactions of Roman Catholics to Guenon are illuminating. One has pointed out that he is a “serious metaphysician,” i.e. one convinced of the truth he expounds and eager to show the unanimity of the Eastern and scholastic traditions, and observes that “in such matters belief and understanding must go together.” *Crede ut intelligam* believe in order to understand is a piece of advice that modern scholars would, indeed, do well to consider; it is, perhaps, just because we have not believed that we have not yet understood the East. The same author writes of East and West,

Rene Guenon is one of the few writers of our time whose work is really of importance ... he stands for the primacy of pure metaphysics over all other forms of knowledge, and presents himself as the exponent of a major tradition of thought, predominantly Eastern, but shared in the Middle Ages by the scholastics of the West ... clearly Guénon’s position is not that of Christian orthodoxy, but many, perhaps most, of his theses are, in face, better in accord with authentic Thomist doctrine than are many opinions of devout but ill-instructed Christians.

We should do well to remember that even St. Tomas Aquinas did not disdain to make use of “intrinsic and probable proofs” derived from the “pagan” philosophers.

Gerald Vann, on the other hand, makes the mistake which the title of his review, “Rene Guenon’s Orientalism” announces; for this is not another “ism,” nor a geographical antithesis but one of modern empiricism and traditional theory. Vann springs to the defense of the very Christianity in which Guenon himself sees almost the only possibility

of salvation for the West; only possibility, not because there is no other body of truth, but because the mentality of the West is adapted to and needs a religion of just this sort. But if Christianity should fail, it is just because its intellectual aspects have been submerged, and it has become a code of ethics rather than a doctrine form which all other applications can and should be derived; hardly two consecutive sentences of some of Meister Eckhart's sermons would be intelligible to an average modern congregation, which does not expect doctrine, and only expects to be told how to behave.

If Guenon wants the West to turn to Eastern metaphysics, it is not because they are Eastern but because this is metaphysics. If "Eastern" metaphysics differed from a "Western" metaphysics — as true philosophy differs from what is often so called in our modern universities — one or the other would not be metaphysics. It is from metaphysics that the West has turned away in its desperate endeavor to live by bread alone, an endeavor of which the Dead Sea fruits are before our eyes. It is only because this metaphysics still survives as a living power in Eastern societies, in so far as they have not been corrupted by the withering touch of Western, or rather, modern civilization (for the contrast is not of East or West as such, but of "those paths that the rest of mankind follows as a matter of course" with those post-Renaissance paths that have brought us to our present impasse), and not to Orientalize the West, but to bring back the West to a consciousness of the roots of her own life and of values that have been transvalued in the most sinister sense, that Guenon asks us to turn to the East.

He does not mean, and makes it very clear that he does not mean, that Europeans ought to become Hindus or Buddhists, but much rather that they, who are getting nowhere by the study of "the Bible as literature," or that of Dante "as a poet," should rediscover Christianity, or what amounts to the same think, Plato ("that great priest," as Meister Eckhart calls him). I often marvel at men's immunity to the *Apology*, *Phaedo* or

the seventh chapter of the *Republic*; I suppose it is because they should not hear, “thought one rose from the dead.”

The issue of “East and West” is not merely a theoretical (we must remind the modern reader that from the standpoint of the traditional philosophy, “theoretical” is anything but a term of disparagement) but also an urgent practical problem. Pearl Buck asks,

Why should prejudices be so strong at this moment? The answer it seems to me is simple. Physical conveyance and other circumstances have forced parts of the world once remote from each other into actual intimacy for which peoples are not mentally or spiritually prepared. ... It is not necessary to believe that this initial stage must continue. If those prepared to act as interpreters will do their proper work, we may find that within another generation or two, or even sooner, dislike and prejudice may be gone. This is only possible if prompt and strong measures are taken by peoples to keep step mentally with the increasing closeness to which the war is compelling us.

But is this is to happen, the West will have to abandon what Guenon calls its “proselytizing fury,” an expression that must not be taken to refer only to the activities of Christian missionaries, regrettable as those often are, but of those of all the distributors of modern “civilization” and those of practically all those “educators” who feel that they have more to give than to learn from what are often called the “backward” or “unprogressive” peoples; to whom it does not occur that one may not wish or need to “progress” if one has reached a state of equilibrium that already provides for the realization of what one regards as the greatest purposed of life.

It is as an expression of good will and of the best intentions that this proselytizing fury takes on its most dangerous aspects. To many this “fury” can only suggest the fable of the fox that lost its tail, and persuaded the other foxes to cut off theirs. An industrialization of the East may be

inevitable, but do not let us call it a blessing that a folk should be reduced to the level of a proletariat, or assume that materially higher standards of living necessarily make for greater happiness. The West is only just discovering, to its great astonishment, that “material inducements, that is, money or the things that money can buy” are by no means so cogent a force as has been supposed; “Beyond the subsistence level, the theory that this incentive is decisive is largely an illusion.”

As for the East, as Guenon says, “The only impression that, for example, mechanical invention make on most Orientals is one of deep repulsion; certainly it all seems to them far more harmful than beneficial, and if they find themselves obliged to accept certain things which the present epoch has made necessary, they do so in the hope of future riddance ... what the people of the West call ‘rising’ would be called some ‘sinking’; that is what all true Orientals think.” It must not be supposed that because so many Eastern peoples have imitated us in self-defense that they have therefore accepted our values; on the contrary, it is just because the conservative East still challenges all the presuppositions on which our illusion of progress rests, that it deserves our most serious consideration.

There is nothing in economic intimacies that is likely to reduce prejudice or promote mutual understanding automatically. Even when Europeans live amongst Orientals, “economic contact between the Eastern and Western groups is practically the only contact there is. There is very little social or religious give and take between the two. Each lives in a world almost entirely closed to the other — and by ‘closed’ we mean not only ‘unknown’ but more: incomprehensible and unattainable.” That is an inhuman relationship, by which both parties are degraded.

Neither must it be assumed that the Orient thinks it important that the masses should learn to read and write. Literacy is a practical necessity in an industrial society, where the keeping of account is all important. But in India, in so far as Western methods of education have not been imposed from without, all higher education is imparted orally, and to have heard

is for more important than to have read. At the same time the peasant, prevented by his illiteracy and poverty from devouring the newspapers and magazines that form the daily and almost the only reading of the vast majority of Western “literate,” is, like Hesiod’s Boeotian farmers, and still more like the Gaelic-speaking Highlanders before the era of the board schools, thoroughly familiar with an epic literature of profound spiritual significance and a body of poetry and music of incalculable value; and one can only regret the spread of an “education” that involves the destruction of all these things, or only preserves them as curiosities within the covers of books.

For cultural purposes it is not important that the masses should be literate; it is not necessary that anyone should be literate; it is only necessary that there should be amongst the people philosophers (in the traditional, not the modern sense of the word), and that there should be preserved deep respect on the part of laymen for true learning that is the antithesis of the American attitude to a “professor”. In these respects the whole East is still far in advance of the West, and hence the learning of the elite exerts a far profounder influence upon society as a whole than the Western specialist “thinker” can ever hope to wield.

It is not, however, primarily with a protection of the East against the subversive inroads of Western “culture” that Guenon is concerned, but rather with the question, What possibility of regeneration, if any, can be envisaged for the West? The possibility exists only in the event of a return to first principles and to the normal ways of living that proceed from the application of first principles to contingent circumstances; and as it is only in the East that these things are still alive, it is to the East that the West must turn. “It is the West that must take the initiative, but she must be prepared really to go towards the East, not merely seeking to draw the East towards herself, as she has tried to do so far. There is no reason why the East should take this initiative, and there would still be none, even if the Western world were not in such a state as to make any effort in this

direction useless. ... It now remains for us to show how the West might attempt to approach the East.”

He proceeds to show that the work is to be done in the two fields of metaphysics and religion, and that it can only be carried out on the highest intellectual levels, where agreement on first principles can be reached apart from any propaganda on behalf of or even apology for “Western civilization.”

The work must be undertaken, therefore, by an “elite.” And as it is here more than anywhere that Guenon’s meaning is likely to be willfully misinterpreted, we must understand clearly what he means by such an elite. The divergence of the West and East being only “accidental,” “the bringing of these two portions of mankind together and the return of the West to a normal civilization are really just one and the same thing.” An elite will necessarily work in the first place “for itself, since its members will naturally reap from their own development an immediate and altogether unfailing benefit.” An indirect result — “indirect,” because on this intellectual level one does not think of “doing good” to others, or in terms of “service,” but seeks truth because one needs it oneself — would, or might under favorable conditions, bring about “a return of the West to a traditional civilization,” i.e. one in which “everything is seen as the application and extension of a doctrine whose essence is purely intellectual and metaphysical.”

It is emphasized again and again that such an elite does not mean a body of specialists or scholars who would absorb and put over on the West the forms of an alien culture, nor even persuade the West to return to such a traditional civilization as existed in the Middle Ages. Traditional cultures develop by the application of principles to conditions; the principles, indeed, are unchangeable and universal, but just as **nothing can be known except in the mode of the knower**, so nothing valid can be accomplished socially without taking into account the character of those concerned and the particular circumstances of the period in which they

live.

There is no “fusion” of cultures to be hoped for; it would be noting like an “eclecticism” or “syncretism” that an elite would have in view. Neither would such an elite be organized in any way so as to exercise such a direct influence as that which, for example, the Technocrats would like to exercise for the good of mankind. If such an elite ever came into being, the vast majority of Western men would never know of it; it would operate only as a sort of leaven, and certainly on behalf of rather than against whatever survives of traditional essence in, for example the Greek Orthodox and Roman Catholic domains. It is, indeed, a curious fact that some of the most powerful defenders of Christian dogma are to be found amongst Orientals who are not themselves Christians, or ever likely to become Christians, but recognize in the Christian tradition an embodiment of the universal truth to which God has never nor anywhere left himself without a witness.

In the meantime, Guenon asks, “Is this really ‘the beginning of an end’ for the modern civilization? ... At least there are many signs which should give food for reflection to those who are still capable of it; will the West be able to regain control of herself in time?” Few would deny that we are faced with the possibility of a total disintegration of culture. We are at war with ourselves, and therefore at war with one another. Western man is unbalanced, and the question, Can he recover himself? is a very real one. No one to whom the question presents itself can afford to ignore the writing of the leading living exponent of a traditional wisdom that is no more essentially Oriental than it is Occidental, though it may be only in the uttermost parts of the earth that it is still remembered and must be sought.

Posted on 2012-10-27 by Cologero

7.2 Lohengrin

This is a chapter from *The Middle Ages* by **Karl Heyer**.

In the knowledge of the Mysteries it is known that the great leaders of mankind, the initiates, are those who help humanity take a new step in development. Lohengrin is the messenger of the Holy Grail. He appears before medieval consciousness as the great leader and initiate who takes mankind a step further during the middle part of the Middle Ages. He brought the culture of the towns, he inspired the citizenry as they came into being. This is the Lohengrin individuality: and Elsa of Brabant is nothing but a symbol of the medieval folk soul who is to take a further step of development under the influence of Lohengrin. The legend of this progress in human history is beautifully and movingly portrayed.

By the question she asks from curiosity, Elsa brings about the disappearance of the initiate. This expresses the increasing earthly darkening of consciousness of the people who find their path of development in the towns. Materialism sets in, and only centuries later will this darkened consciousness, that has, however, set human beings free, once more receive a call from the spiritual world, a call for further great changes of consciousness coming from the continuing, though transformed stream of the Holy Grail.

The fertile seeds of the modern economic realm, as it later grew on capitalist, bourgeois foundations during the centuries of the fifth post-Atlantean era, were certainly sown in the Middle Ages. The same cannot be said, however, of the modern state. Its roots lie the territories of the princes who gradually began to organise their states with the help of legally trained civil servants. This tendency was based on the countryside, not on the towns which were often engaged in direct dispute with the princes. With regard to the time beginning around the fifteenth century, Rudolf Steiner pointed to the following:

People in the towns were proud of their individuality and freedom, as may be seen in the portraits that have come down to us from those days... But the village communities remained outside. The power of the territorial princes made itself felt. People in the villages who gradually found themselves in opposition to the towns found their leaders among the ones who took their part, or said they would take their part, against the towns.

Under the influence of pressure from the surrounding countryside the towns became a part of wider administrative structures that embodied the principles of Roman law. The modern state came into being. It was formed working inwards towards the towns from the surrounding countryside. What conquered the towns from the surrounding countryside was a juridical Latin or Roman element that was beginning to emerge and had indeed grown so powerful that there was no longer any chance for another stream that was struggling to come to the surface among the rural populations. In England and Bohemia, for example this was the stream of Wycliffe and Huss, and the Bohemian Brethren. None of this managed to take hold. The only thing that really succeeded in gaining the upper hand was the Roman administrative element.

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